

स्टेट फोकस पेपर
State Focus Paper
2025-26

तमिल नाडु
Tamil Nadu



राष्ट्रीय कृषि और ग्रामीण विकास बैंक
NATIONAL BANK FOR AGRICULTURE AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

तमिल नाडु क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, चेन्नई
TAMIL NADU REGIONAL OFFICE, CHENNAI



दृष्टि

ग्रामीण समृद्धि के लिए राष्ट्रीय विकास बैंक

ध्येय

सहभागिता , संधारणीयता और समानता पर आधारित वित्तीय और गैर - वित्तीय सहयोगों, नवोन्मेषों, प्रौद्योगिकीय और संस्थागत विकास के माध्यम से समृद्धि लाने के लिए कृषि और ग्रामीण विकास का संवर्धन

VISION

Development Bank of the Nation for Fostering Rural Prosperity.

MISSION

Promote sustainable and equitable agriculture and rural development through participative financial and non- financial interventions, innovations, technology and institutional development for securing prosperity.



FOREWORD

NABARD undertakes annual credit planning exercise, starting with preparation of Potential Linked Credit Plans (PLPs) for each district. The process involves multi-level consultation with all the stakeholders and convergence of programmes implemented by State Government, Central Government, Bankers etc. The State Focus Paper (SFP) is a consolidation of such exploitable district level potential as identified in the respective PLPs. The document quantifies potential both in physical and financial terms and estimation of bank credit segment to actualise the potential.

The State Focus Paper also highlights various policy/ programme framework of state and central governments and suggest refinements, new frameworks and infrastructure required for smooth offtake of bank credit in the State of Tamil Nadu. It gives me immense pleasure to present the State Focus Paper for 2025-26 which projects a total credit potential of ₹9,37,629 crore for Priority Sector activities as defined by the Reserve Bank of India. This estimate encompasses ₹4,34,583 crore for agriculture, ₹3,45,245 crore for MSME and ₹1,57,801 crore for other priority sectors.

Overall, priority sector lending has been playing a crucial role in promoting economic growth and development in Tamil Nadu particularly in Agriculture and MSME. Addressing infrastructure and input issues, risk mitigation through insurance schemes, adequate marketing and storage infrastructure and above all Irrigation infrastructure are factors that are key for development of the State in future. Despite Tamil Nadu's extensive irrigation infrastructure, inadequate water storage capacity, aging infrastructure, lack of modernisation, climate impacts etc. are areas of concern that need attention. Further for growth of MSME, initiatives for improving Digital infrastructure, easy access to credit, vocational training and education, industry- academia partnerships, access to technology and innovation, Business incubators and accelerators are required. The State Focus Paper has delved into the above aspects and has come out with suggestions/measures for improvement.

I place on record my gratitude to State Government, Line Departments, RBI, SLBC, Bankers, District Collectors, LDM, NGOs, farmers and other stakeholders for their valuable inputs in preparation of this document and wholehearted support to NABARD in our endeavour. We welcome suggestions for further augmenting the document on an ongoing basis.

R Anand
Chief General Manager



प्रस्तावना

नाबार्ड प्रत्येक जिले के लिए संभाव्यता युक्त ऋण योजना (पीएलपी) की तैयारी के साथ ही वार्षिक ऋण आयोजना बनाता है। इस प्रक्रिया में सभी हितधारकों के साथ बहु-स्तरीय परामर्श और राज्य सरकार, केंद्र सरकार, बैंकों आदि द्वारा कार्यान्वित कार्यक्रमों का अभिसरण शामिल होता है। राज्य फोकस पेपर (एसएफपी) संबंधित पीएलपी में पहचानी गई ऐसी दोहन योग्य जिला स्तरीय क्षमता का समेकन है। यह दस्तावेज़ भौतिक और वित्तीय दोनों दृष्टि से क्षमता का आकलन करता है और क्षमता को वास्तविक बनाने के लिए बैंक ऋण खंड का अनुमान लगाता है। राज्य फोकस पेपर राज्य और केंद्र सरकारों के विभिन्न प्राथमिकता/कार्यक्रम ढांचे पर भी प्रकाश डालता है और तमिलनाडु राज्य में बैंक ऋण के सुचारू प्राप्ति के लिए आवश्यक परिशोधन, नए ढांचे और बुनियादी ढांचे का सुझाव भी देता है। मुझे 2025-26 के लिए राज्य फोकस पेपर पेश करते हुए बहुत खुशी हो रही है जो भारतीय रिज़र्व बैंक द्वारा परिभाषित प्राथमिकता क्षेत्र की गतिविधियों के लिए ₹9,37,629 करोड़ की कुल ऋण क्षमता का अनुमान लगाता है। इस अनुमान में कृषि के लिए ₹4,34,583 करोड़, एमएसएमई के लिए ₹3,45,245 करोड़ और अन्य प्राथमिकता वाले क्षेत्रों के लिए ₹1,57,801 करोड़ शामिल हैं।

कुल मिलाकर, प्राथमिकता ऋणीकरण क्षेत्र तमिलनाडु में विशेष रूप से कृषि और एमएसएमई में आर्थिक वृद्धि और विकास को बढ़ावा देने में महत्वपूर्ण भूमिका निभा रहा है। बुनियादी ढांचे और इनपुट मुद्दों का निवारण, बीमा योजनाओं के माध्यम से जोखिम को कम करना, पर्याप्त विपणन और भंडारण बुनियादी ढांचा और सबसे बढ़कर सिंचाई बुनियादी ढांचा ऐसे कारक हैं जो भविष्य में राज्य के विकास के लिए अति महत्वपूर्ण हैं। तमिलनाडु के व्यापक सिंचाई बुनियादी ढांचे के बावजूद, अपर्याप्त जल भंडारण क्षमता, पुराना बुनियादी ढांचा, आधुनिकीकरण की कमी, जलवायु प्रभाव आदि चिंता के क्षेत्र हैं जिन पर विशेष ध्यान देने की आवश्यकता है। इसके अलावा, एमएसएमई के विकास के लिए डिजिटल बुनियादी ढांचे में सुधार, ऋण तक आसान पहुंच, व्यावसायिक प्रशिक्षण और शिक्षा, उद्योग- शैक्षणिक भागीदारी, प्रौद्योगिकी और नवाचार तक पहुंच, बिजनेस इनक्यूबेटर और एक्सेलेरेटर के पहल की आवश्यकता है। राज्य फोकस पेपर ने उपरोक्त पहलुओं पर गहराई से विचार किया है और सुधार के लिए सुझाव/उपाय प्रस्तुत किए हैं।

इसी संदर्भ में, मैं राज्य सरकार, संबंधित विभागों, भारतीय रिज़र्व बैंक, एसएलबीसी, बैंकर्स, जिला कलेक्टरों, एलडीएम, एनजीओ, किसानों और अन्य हितधारकों के प्रति आभार व्यक्त करता हूं जिन्होंने इस दस्तावेज़ को तैयार करने में महत्वपूर्ण योगदान और नाबार्ड को हमारे प्रयास में दिल से सहयोग दिया है। हम इस दस्तावेज़ को आगे बढ़ाने के लिए निरंतर आपके सुझावों का स्वागत करते हैं।

आर आनंद
मुख्य महाप्रबंधक

Index

Sr.No.	Particulars	Page No.
1	Executive Summary	1
2	State Map	15
3	Broad Sector wise PLP projection for the year 2025-26	16
4	Sector/ Sub-sector wise PLP Projections for year 2025-26	17
5	State profile	18
6	Banking Profile	19
8	Chapter 1 - Major Socio-Economic Indicators of the State	20
9	Chapter 2 - Banking Sector Profile	27
10	Chapter 3 - NABARD's Perception on the Development Perspective of the State	33
11	Chapter 4 - Potential Credit Outlay	77
12	Chapter 5 - Status and prospects of Cooperatives	108
13	Chapter 6 - Infrastructure Support	114
14	Chapter 7 - Details of Policy Initiatives of GoI, RBI, NABARD and the State Government	121
15	Appendix I - Climate Action and Sustainability	139
16	Appendix II - Potential of Geographical Indications in the State	143
17	Annexure I - District-wise and Sector-wise PLP projections	145
18	Annexure II - Ground Level Credit Flow – Agency-wise, Sector and Sub-sector-wise	150
19	Annexure III - Critical infrastructure support to be provided	152
20	Annexure IV - Critical interventions required for creating a definitive impact	160
21	List of Abbreviations	183
22	Contact Details of DDMs	190

Executive Summary

NABARD as a Development Financial Institution, plays a crucial role in credit planning for Agriculture and rural sector for all States in India, through preparation of district wise potential linked credit plan under Priority Sector for the banking system, including Rural Financial Institutions (RFIs), on annual basis. The potential linked credit plans (PLPs) of all districts are thereafter aggregated to arrive at the total credit potential for the State, which is discussed in detail in the State Focus Paper. Assessment of credit potential is done through analysis of sector specific physical potential, infrastructure support, past credit trends, future planned developments, credit absorption capacity, government priorities through various schemes, available forward and backward linkages, local skills and natural resources.

This document serves as a useful reference to provide pointed focus on the development of priority sectors of the State with institutional credit support.

The State Focus Paper 2025-26 identifies total exploitable credit potential of ₹9,37,629.43 Cr for the state of Tamil Nadu under Priority Sector

State Profile

Total geographical area of Tamil Nadu is 130.33 lakh hectare which constitutes 4% of the National geographical area and falls in Semi and Dry sub humid climate. Tamil Nadu has 6% of the Nation's population (2011 Census). As per 10th Agriculture Census, 2015-16, the number of operational land holders in the State is 79.38 lakh, with operating cultivable land of 59.71 lakh Ha. 93% of total land holdings are Marginal and Small farmers, operating 62% of the total cultivable land. The average size of the land holding in the State is 0.75 hectare which is less than the average size of land holding of the country at 1.08 hectare.

Economy

Tamil Nadu is the most progressive state in India in terms of many economic and social parameters. It is the second largest economy (₹24.27 lakh crore in 2023-24) in the country, with an ambitious target of achieving a trillion-dollar economy by 2030. Tamil Nadu's Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) grew 8.13% in 2022-23 and 8.23% in 2023-24 at constant prices, while at current prices, the growth rates were 15.48% in 2022-23 and 13.71% in 2023-24. The growth rates for the All India GDP was 6.99% in 2022-23 and 8.15% in 2023-24 at constant prices, while at current prices, they were 14.21% in 2022-23 and 9.60% in 2023-24. In 2023-24, the services sector contributed 53% to the state's economy, followed by manufacturing at 34% and agriculture at 13%. The services sector grew at 9.4% in 2023-24, followed by manufacturing at 7.1% and agriculture at 4.3%.

Banking Scenario

There were 13528 bank branches in Tamil Nadu as on 31 March 2024, comprising of 3607 branches in rural areas, 4943 in semi-urban and 4977 in urban areas, with 6338 branches of Public Sector Banks, 4639 of Private Sector Banks, 663 of Regional Rural Bank, 979 of Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank, TNSCARD and DCCBs, 863 of Small Finance Banks, 11

of SIDBI, 35 of Payment Banks. Besides, 4454 Primary Agriculture Co-operative Societies (PACS), 39 Large Area Multipurpose Societies (LAMPS), 180 Primary Co-operative Agricultural & Rural Development Bank (PCARDB), 128 Urban Co-operative Banks, 1705 Employees Co-operative Thrift and Credit Societies, 131 Multi-Purpose Co-operative Societies (MPCS), 1364 Weavers Co-operative Societies (WCS), 112 Marketing Co-operative Societies/Federation (MCS) and Business Correspondents (BCs) are also engaged in disbursement of credit for agricultural activities and other activities.

Co-operative Sector

The Co-operative Credit Structure in the State consists of Short Term and Long Term. The Short Term structure has three-tiers, with the Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank Ltd (TNStCB) at the apex level with 51 branches, 23 District Central Co-operative Banks (DCCBs) at district level with 927 branches, and 4454 PACS. Co-operative Banks have 978 branches, comprising of 297 rural branches, 269 Semi-urban branches, 412 urban & Metro. TNStCB and all the 23 DCCBs are on CBS platform. PACS computerization is being implemented under the GoI project, covering 4532 Co-operative Societies including all the 4,453 PACS and the same is expected to be completed by 31 March 2025. This will facilitate general public in a larger way besides strengthening the functioning of PACS and to have effective monitoring.

The Long-Term Co-operative Credit structure consists of Tamil Nadu State Co-operative Agricultural and Rural Development Bank (TNSCARDB) and 80 Primary Co-operative Agricultural and Rural Development Bank (PCARDB).

Centrally Sponsored Project on Computerisation of PACS (CSPCP) in Tamil Nadu

This scheme aims at computerization of all functional ACS leading to increase in efficiency, profitability, transparency and accountability. All the 4532 cooperative societies have been covered under the CSPCP project for bringing all the functional societies onto a common software, linking them with NABARD through State Cooperative Bank (StCB) and District Central Cooperative Banks which is implemented by NABARD.

Performance under Annual Credit Plan 2023-24

The target fixed under ACP for the FY'24 was ₹ 700420 crore as against which disbursement was ₹ 663993 crore registering an achievement of 94.8% and 24.73% growth from previous year. Total Agriculture Credit during FY 2023-24 was Rs.404334cr registering an achievement of 105%. As on 31 March 2024, CD ratio for all financial institution stood at 121% which is higher than the previous FY (113%).

Agriculture

Agriculture is the livelihood for around 45% of the rural population in Tamil Nadu. Major food crops grown in the State are rice, jowar, ragi, bajra, maize, pulses and oil seeds like groundnuts, sesame, and sunflower. Few other crops that are cultivated extensively are cotton, sugarcane, tea, coffee, and coconut. Paddy is the leading crop and is grown in all the seasons i.e., Kuruvai, Samba and Kodai. The production of food grains during the year 2023-24 was 118.02 lakh MT (as per Third Advance Estimate, 2023-24) amidst natural calamities like

deficit rainfall during south-west monsoon, crop damage due to cyclone in northern districts and extremely heavy rainfall in southern districts during December 2024. Tamil Nadu is one of the leading Horticulture States in the country contributing 6.09% of national horticulture production and 5.47% of total horticulture crops in terms of area at national level. Rapid growth of demand for horticulture commodities and products have resulted in shift or diversification from traditional food crops to horticulture crops like banana, coconut, mango, vegetables, medicinal / herbal / aromatic plants etc.

Agriculture Budget 2024-25

For the fourth successive year, an exclusive Agriculture Budget 2024-25 for the State of Tamil Nadu was presented keeping in line the Government's priority for the Agriculture sector. Focus of the Agriculture Budget 2023-24 is on crop diversification, flood protection, water conservation and farmer welfare Schemes. Agriculture Budget for 2024-25 increased the allocation for agriculture and allied sectors to **₹42,281.88cr**, i.e. 8.7% higher than the ₹38,904 Cr in the Budget estimate for 2023-24.

Developmental Activities facilitated/ channelled through NABARD

Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF)

In rural areas of Tamil Nadu, major infrastructure gaps identified are in irrigation, roads and bridges, power supply, education, skilling etc. NABARD has been partnering with Government of Tamil Nadu for filling these gaps by extending support for creation of infrastructure in Agriculture, Social and Rural Connectivity Sectors through various funds like RIDF, WIF, NIDA, CFF, LTIF, MIF, DIDF and FIDF. NABARD funded 47295 projects to the tune of ₹37902.04 Cr for creation of rural infrastructure. Of this, an amount of ₹31719.22 crore has been disbursed as on 31.12.2024. Investments under RIDF, in turn, have helped NABARD to fulfil the mandate by improving the credit absorption capacity, increased access to markets, enhanced incomes and better quality of life in rural Tamil Nadu. Currently, assistance from RIDF is available for supporting 39 eligible activities grouped under three distinct heads viz. Agriculture and related sectors, Social Sectors and Rural Connectivity.

NABARD Infrastructure Development Assistance (NIDA), is a line of credit for funding rural infrastructure projects for funding rural infrastructure projects directly to State Government and State-owned Institutions under 16 eligible activities. NABARD, so far has extended ₹6767.23 crore to State Government and State-owned Institutions under various activities.

Fisheries & Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF), is implemented through NABARD to fund the public infrastructure components to State Governments/Union Territories for various fishery-based infrastructure activities. As on date, NABARD has extended ₹1314.73 crore to State Government.

Credit Facility for Federations (CFF) is extended with objective of providing short-term loans to State Marketing /Co-operative federations and Corporations involved in procurement and marketing of Agricultural commodities and supply of agricultural inputs. NABARD, has extended ₹17,500 crore to various State Govt Corporations.

Warehouse Infrastructure Fund (WIF), a dedicated fund of Govt. of India implemented through NABARD, aims for extending financial assistance to public and private players in the warehousing sector for eligible activities. As on date, NABARD has extended ₹2636.60 crore to State Government.

Food Processing Fund (FPF), a fund constituted by Govt. of India in NABARD for promotion of food processing industry in the organised sector on a cluster basis by providing affordable credit for setting up of designated food parks notified by Ministry of food Processing industries (MOFPI), GoI and establishing food processing units therein. As on date NABARD has extended ₹439.79 crore to various stakeholders in Tamil Nadu for establishment of food parks.

Further, NABARD, has extended ₹1357.93 crore and ₹549 crore under Micro Irrigation Fund (MIF) and Dairy processing & Infrastructure Development Fund (DIDF) respectively.

Financial Inclusion

NABARD has been extending grant assistance to Banks for almost a decade and a half for putting in place the required financial inclusion infrastructure, as well as for providing financial literacy. Despite the best efforts put in by all the stakeholders, there exist disparities in terms of financial exclusion and in-adequacy of technology adoption. Therefore, a differentiated strategy has been adopted from the year 2019-20 for extending support under FIF, to provide more thrust on backward districts and technologically weak banks, to deepen the efforts of financial inclusion for the benefit of hitherto excluded population.

The Rural Cooperative Banks (RCBs) and RRBs in the State are guided by NABARD for on-boarding to technology solutions including regulatory requirements. The RCBs and the RRBs in the State have been extended grant assistance for on-boarding to Public Finance Management System (PFMS) portal of Government of India, Bharat Bill Payment System, Positive Pay System and implementation of BHIM-UPI in Banks. Banks have been supported to the tune of ₹70 lakh for various technological interventions.

To expand digital payment infrastructure in rural areas, NABARD is extending financial support to all banks (Scheduled Commercial Banks/Small Finance Banks/Payment Banks/RRBs/Cooperatives) for deployment of PoS/m-PoS devices in tier 3 to 6 centres. All Banks are being encouraged to deploy micro-ATMs in Schools/ colleges/milk societies /fixed BC points/Branches/PACs and other non-credit societies. During the past FY, Banks have been sanctioned grant support to the extent of ₹25 lakh and ₹426.35 lakh from NABARD for deployment of PoS devices and micro-ATMs in the State respectively.

Financial Literacy

With a view to catering to the demand side of the FI initiative, there is a need for spreading financial and digital literacy among the rural population. 64 Centers for Financial Literacy covering 192 blocks were set up by four Lead Banks (Indian Overseas Bank-20, Indian Bank - 22, Canara Bank -16 and State Bank of India -6) with grant assistance of ₹1875.2 lakh from NABARD.

In order to achieve a meaningful and comprehensive Financial Inclusion and to ensure financial security to the poor and the vulnerable, especially in Special Focus Districts in the

State, NABARD has sanctioned grant support of ₹89.75 lakh to various Banks towards conduct of around 1800 Financial & Digital Literacy Awareness Programmes across the State.

Watershed Development initiatives

NABARD has been partnering with Tamil Nadu Watershed Development Agency (TAWDEVA), CSR funds and NGOs for implementation of watershed projects. So far 203 watershed projects have been sanctioned in 28 districts covering 2.19 lakh ha. in the State with a cumulative grant support of ₹183.28 crore. Out of these 203 projects, 141 are implemented in partnership with the GoTN, 41 under full grant by NABARD through NGOs and 21 projects under CSR partnership mode. Climate Proofing activities are being implemented in 30 completed Watershed projects in 09 districts with grant assistance of ₹15 crore.

SEWOH Phase III projects – KfW Soil Project

NABARD in collaboration with KfW is Implementing SEWOH Phase III programme (KfW Soil Project) on ‘Integration of Watershed Development for rehabilitation of degraded soil and climate change adaptation’ to reduce vulnerability to climate change by the stabilization, enhancement and sustainable use of soil and water resources. NABARD TNRO has sanctioned 25 KfW Soil projects in 14 districts with grant support of Rs.15.42 crore, to 13 Project facilitating agencies (PFAs) covering beneficiaries of small and marginal farmers. Under this KfW Soil project, the various components sanctioned are additional SWC measures, Soil Health improvement and productivity enhancement measures, Promotion of sustainable NRM, CCA farming practices and Food security, Measures to Mitigate CC risk and Capacity building, institutional building and knowledge management.

Tribal Development

NABARD has sanctioned 30 Tribal Development Fund (TDF) Projects with grant support of ₹75.18 crore, to various Project Implementing Agencies (PIAs) covering beneficiaries from 15108 families. Under these TDF projects, various activities like support for horticulture orchard / plantation in one or half acre wadi area, water resources Development & Soil Conservation activities, livelihood activities for landless families, capacity building/awareness programs/training programs etc., Community health and women development are being undertaken.

Farmers Producers Organization

Tamil Nadu is having a conducive ecosystem for formation and nurturing of FPOs. There are around 1200 FPOs in the State, of which 476 have been promoted by NABARD and around 386 with the support of TNSFAC through TN State Government and the remaining by various other agencies apart from few self-promoted FPOs. Initiatives of NABARD include grant support to FPOs, with total grant of ₹94.28 crore, capacity building, market facilitation, establishment of NABKISAN for financing FPOs, establishment of three incubation centres for providing business services for FPOs (Tamil Nadu) and supporting GoI scheme of promotion of 10,000 FPOs.

Off Farm Producers Organisations (OFPOs)

Aggregating producers into Clusters/OFPOs is one best mechanisms to improve access of small producers in off-farm sector to investment, technology and market. NABARD has been promoting the formation and nurturing of Off Farm Producer Organizations since 2016-17.

NABARD, TN RO as on 31 December 2024, has sanctioned grant assistance to the tune of **₹186.38 lakh** for formation and nurturing of **04 major OFPOs** in Tamil Nadu aggregating over 1500 producers.

Skill Development

With the growing unemployment amongst rural youth and asymmetrical development of skill-based employment opportunities concentrated in Metros, Urban and semi urban areas, there is a wide gap between the demand for skilled job and rural youth to be imparted skilling, reskilling and up- skilling through capacity building/training. NABARD addresses the issue through its skill development programme 32 Skill development programmes for providing training to 925 rural youth were supported with total financial sanction of ₹160.55 lakh during 2023-24. The 20 agencies supported included ETIs, NGOs and CSR partners. An amount of ₹148.24 lakh was disbursed in 2023-24 and ₹71 lakh was disbursed in 2024-25 (up to 31.12.2024) for Skill development programmes.

Marketing initiatives

Under Rural Mart scheme of NABARD assistance is provided to producers/artisans/weavers for setting up shops in a prominent location on a highway, religious place, place of tourist importance, thoroughfare where a number of people pass through, for selling locally made products. Under the scheme grant assistance of ₹239.26 lakh has been extended to 60 Rural Marts and Mobile Rural Marts upto 31 December 2024.

A haat or bazaar is an open-air market that serves as a trading venue for local people in rural areas. These are periodic markets which normally works on a weekly cycle. Under NABARD's 'Rural Haat' scheme, cumulatively 13 Rural Haats have been sanctioned to various agencies with a grant assistance of ₹150.66 lakh.

NABARD has been organizing as well as sponsoring artisans to participate in exhibition conducted across the State and Pan India, exhibitions, buyer seller meet and Start-up Immersion Program for Agri-Start-ups. These provide effective forward linkage to the rural masses for their produce with assured income and employment as also to boost their earning capacity. During 2023-24, grant support of ₹31.32 lakh has been provided to various artisans and an amount of ₹40.61 lakh has been extend during 2024-25 (31.12.2024) under this scheme.

Micro Credit

Bank Linkage Programme

Tamil Nadu is one of the front runner States in India in SHG-Bank Linkage Programme. Bankers, along with proactive support from NGOs and Tamil Nadu Corporation for

Development of Women (TNCDW) had provided adequate credit to the SHGs in ensuring the success of SHG - BLP.

As of March 2024, SHGs in TN reported a savings balance of ₹2854.39 crore and credit outstanding of ₹21766.63 crore. With 90% of these groups being women-led, SHG-BLP has shattered myths about the “non-bankability” of the poor. However, the state’s SHG NPAs are at 6.67%, much higher than the national average of 2.05%. NABARD’s capacity-building initiatives aim to address this concern.

Enterprise Development Programmes

NABARD supports SHG skill-building via the Micro Enterprise Development Programme (MEDP) and Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programme (LEDP), offering training in diverse fields like food processing, embroidery, livestock farming, and handicrafts. Between 2018 and 2024, 290 MEDPs were sanctioned with NABARD assistance of ₹242.9 lakhs. Similarly, 160 LEDPs were sanctioned with NABARD assistance of ₹871.8 lakhs by October 2024. The My Pad-My Right (MPMR) initiative in collaboration with NABFOUNDATION promotes sanitary pad production through SHGs, enhancing livelihood and menstrual hygiene. In TN, it has been launched in Ramanathapuram and Virudhunagar.

NABARD supports the m-Suvidha scheme, a DPR mode project, to enhance the capacities & income levels of SHGs and JLGs by identifying skill gaps and promoting sustainable micro-enterprises with credit support from banks. The scheme aims to establish at least 500 micro-enterprises through a cluster approach, facilitating collaboration with sector experts fostering economic empowerment for women.

Joint Liability Groups

NABARD had extended the concept of SHG - BLP to a new mode -Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) initially for augmenting flow of credit to landless tenant farmers cultivating land for crop loan purposes and subsequently to micro entrepreneurs/artisans and others.

Tamil Nadu is one of the front runner States in JLG nurturing and promotion. As at the end of 31 March 2023, 38.66 lakh JLGs were extended bank loan to the tune of ₹13892441.31 lakh (source: *Status of Microfinance in India 2023-27*)

NABARD has signed MoUs with various scheduled Banks for formation and credit linking of JLGs through BC model by engaging the BCs for formation of JLGs.

Credit Potential Estimates for 2025-26

Crop Production, Maintenance and Marketing - ₹3,08,670.03 Cr

Paddy is the leading crop and is grown in all the seasons i.e., Kuruva, Samba and Kodai. Tamil Nadu has gained commendable status in the horticultural sector with bananas and mangoes. Major reasons for increased credit flow under crop loans is growing awareness among farmers of various schemes and facilities available/introduced by GoTN/GoI, Interest subvention scheme of GoI. Interest incentive scheme of GoTN for Co-operative banks whereby crop loan at an interest rate of 0% is also an important reason for increased bank credit.

Adoption of smart technologies including climate smart agriculture for increasing the efficiency of water, nutrients and energy, micro-irrigation and other water saving irrigation technologies, site-specific nutrient management, conservation of agriculture etc., reducing the cost of cultivation through soil health revitalization, focus on rainfed areas through various tools such as watershed development, contingency crop planning, weather forecast, crop insurance etc., creation of robust agriculture infrastructure reforms in extension, adoption of e-NAM platform for trading of agriculture commodities in all the regulated and co-operative markets, efficient markets with a dynamic supply chain are indispensable for the development of the agricultural sector.

Water Resources - ₹7,168.80 Cr

Tamil Nadu constitutes 4% of India's geographical area and is inhabited by 6% of India's population but has only 3% of water resources. More than 95% of the surface water and 80% of the ground water have already been put in use. The per capita availability of water resources is 750 cubic meters when compared to the national average of 2,200 cubic meters. Agriculture is the largest consumer of water in the State using 75 % of the State's water resources. The State is entirely dependent on rains for recharging its water resources. Monsoon failures lead to acute water scarcity and severe drought and hence taking appropriate measures to arrest the alarmingly decreasing levels of ground water viz. usage of micro irrigation systems, drip to be encouraged along with water harvesting structures.

Farm Mechanization - ₹12,051.18 Cr

Farm Mechanization has immense potential to expand production, improve timeliness of operations, better utilization of irrigation potential and infrastructure, compensate for labour shortages, and alleviate drudgery in agricultural operations. Thus, farm mechanization brings about significant improvement in agricultural productivity, which underscores the strong need for mechanization of agricultural operations. Post-harvest machinery also helps in value addition and conservation of produce and by-products from qualitative and quantitative damages.

Plantation and Horticulture including Sericulture - ₹7884.31 Cr

Tamil Nadu is one of the leading horticulture States in India. Tamil Nadu enjoys a unique position in the plantation and horticulture sector on account of its location and its varied agro climatic factors. Rapid growth of demand for horticulture commodities and products have resulted in shift or diversification from traditional food crops to horticulture crops like Banana, Coconut, Mango, Vegetables, Medicinal / Herbal / Aromatic plants etc. Further, the sector is a growth engine for economic development.

Forestry and Wasteland Development - ₹2,444.61 Cr

Tamil Nadu has 26,419.23 sq km of recorded forest area, accounting for 20.31% of the geographical area of the State. Tamil Nadu govt. has formulated its State Forest Policy in 2018 in consonance with National Forest Policy with special emphasis on Nurturing a rich heritage, preserving ecology, enhancing the forest, tree cover and enriching wildlife habitats on scientific principles. The State has constituted Biodiversity Board to manage the key

biodiversity resources in the State. The State also has Wetland Authority to guide, monitor and regulate the management of wetlands.

Animal Husbandry – Dairy - ₹26,751.82 Cr

Animal husbandry is a source of regular income and subsidiary employment to nearly 70% of the rural population. Various initiatives of the State Government, like community fodder development, strengthening the animal husbandry infrastructure, providing veterinary services, establishment of new semen bank, veterinary center will ensure better quality of the animals and produce. Further, establishment of cold storage facilities, addressing transportation bottlenecks, upgradation of processing units, strategic focus on enhancing dairy infrastructure, introducing advanced breeding techniques, modern healthcare practices, adoption of digital tools, promoting entrepreneurship and providing financial support for value-added ventures will unlock new avenues for economic growth within the dairy industry. Formation of new dairy cooperative societies and promoting dairy FPOs can empower small-scale farmers, enhance the capabilities of dairy farmers, enabling them to adopt modern practices and diversify their income sources and providing them with collective bargaining power, access to resources, and a fair share of the market value.

Animal Husbandry – Poultry - ₹10,984.50 Cr

The state has witnessed rise in poultry farms, both small-scale and commercial, catering to the escalating demand for eggs and poultry meat. Poultry rearing, which was a cottage industry, has now become a big industry. Bridging infrastructure gaps, cold storage facilities, processing units, adequate supply chain management, adoption of sustainable and efficient poultry farming methods, advanced breeding techniques, disease management protocols, infusion of cutting-edge technologies, adoption of digital tools, encouraging the production of specialty poultry products and supporting the establishment of processing units for value-added goods will improve productivity, product quality, ensure enhanced income for poultry farmers, open new avenues for market expansion and create a resilient, efficient, and economically viable poultry sector in the state.

Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery - ₹6376.02 Cr

Encouraging the production of specialty products, such as high-quality wool or specific meat breeds, establishing modern slaughter houses, advanced breeding techniques, disease management protocols, infusion of cutting-edge technologies, adoption of digital tools, adequate supply chain management, adoption of sustainable and efficient farming methods and supporting the establishment of processing units for value-added goods can open new avenues for market expansion and increased income for farmers. By strategically focusing on modernizing infrastructure, promoting technology adoption, investing in skill development, and strengthening cooperative structures will create a resilient, efficient, and economically viable livestock sector in the state.

Fisheries - ₹5066.74 Cr

Tamil Nadu is a leading State with Marine, Inland and Coastal waters with rich biodiversity of aquatic fauna and flora. The sector plays an important role in the socio - economic development of the state by providing livelihood to a large number of fishers and fish farmers, generating employment opportunities in allied sectors and ensuring nutritional security. During 2022-23, the sector contributed 6.26% to the State's agricultural GDP. Tamil Nadu stands at 5th in marine fish production in the country with a total fish production of 8.29 lakh tonnes. The fisheries sector contributed ₹6,957.67cr to foreign exchange earnings by exporting 1.23 lakh tonnes of fish and related products during the period (Fishery Policy Note 2024-25).

Adequate cold storage facilities, modernization of processing units, addressing logistical challenges in transportation to facilitate the supply chain, embracing sustainable fishing practices, advanced fishing techniques, aquaculture practices, diversification into high-value species, promotion of aquaculture, development of value-added fishery products, adoption of digital tools will ensure quality production and productivity of fish and fishery products, create opportunities for entrepreneurship and employment generation which in turn contribute to the state's economy.

Farm Credit- Others, including Two Wheelers for farmers - ₹7777.14 Cr

Despite the giant strides made in mechanization of farm operations using power driven vehicles, the demand for Bullocks, Bullock-carts and two-wheelers for agriculture transport, continues to exist owing to the presence of a large number of small and marginal farmers.

Food and Agro Processing sector - ₹15462.95 Cr

Food and Agro Processing sector contributes substantially to the state's economy, fostering linkages between agriculture and industry. Infrastructure gaps stand out as a significant hurdle to the optimal functioning of the food and agri-processing industry in Tamil Nadu. Training programs aimed at enhancing technical know-how in modern processing methods, quality assurance, and marketing strategies can lead to improved overall efficiency and competitiveness in the market.

Adequate storage facilities, establishing modern processing units, efficient supply chain, improved transportation networks, adequate market linkages, availability of quality raw materials, incorporating advanced processing techniques, quality control measures, collaborative efforts with research institutions and private enterprises, strengthening institutional frameworks for credit availability, adherence to international quality standards, innovative packaging and marketing strategies, establishment of agri-export zones and food processing parks will ensure creation of a resilient, efficient, and economically viable food and agri-processing sector in the state.

Storage and Marketing Infrastructure - ₹9,914.18 Cr

The efficient storage and marketing of agricultural produce are vital components of the agricultural value chain, playing a crucial role in ensuring fair returns for farmers, reducing post-harvest losses, and enhancing overall agricultural sustainability. The total state-owned storage capacity is held through three public sector agencies viz. Food Corporation of India (FCI), Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) and State Warehousing Corporations (SWC).

The storage capacity available with Government agencies is primarily used for keeping central stock of food grains for the buffer stock, public distribution systems and other Government schemes, which consequently leaves only a marginal capacity for other players to store their produce.

Further, implementation of digital platforms for market information, establishing online trading mechanisms, and incorporating advanced inventory management systems can significantly improve efficiency, transparency, and overall market access.

Land/wasteland Developmen and Soil conservation - ₹2589.34 Cr

Efficient management of land resources is a prerequisite for increasing agricultural production especially as the average size of the land holding in the State is 0.75 hectare, i.e., less than the national average size of land holding (1.08 Hectare). While the state has made significant strides in agricultural productivity, sustainable agriculture is hampered by soil degradation, water scarcity, and the lack of comprehensive watershed management. The need for substantial investments in modernizing land development and watershed management infrastructure, focusing on advanced soil conservation techniques, efficient irrigation systems, integrated watershed planning, robust institutional frameworks, providing financial support for community-driven watershed projects, and conducting awareness programs for farmers, incentivizing agroforestry practices and implementing participatory irrigation management need emphasis.

Agriculture Infrastructure – Others - ₹3438.86 Cr

The state boasts a diverse agricultural landscape, and these sectors play a crucial role in ensuring improved crop quality and soil fertility. Establishment of tissue culture laboratories, availability of quality planting materials, promoting decentralized vermi-compost production units, infusion of cutting-edge technologies into the tissue culture, ensuring scalability and sustainability, creating an enabling ecosystem for widespread adoption and facilitating the establishment of community-based vermi-compost units will ensure overall efficiency, sustainable practices in agriculture and generation of additional income for farmers.

Food & Agro Processing - ₹15462.95 Cr

The Food and Agro-Processing sector in Tamil Nadu encompasses the transformation of raw material from various agricultural sources including food grains, horticultural and plantation products, forest produce, livestock, and fisheries into value-added products. This industry is pivotal in preserving food, generating employment, and boosting export revenues.

Ancillary Activities – Others - ₹8003 Cr

Agriculture ancillary activities provide the necessary vigour and the requisite linkages for the agriculture sector to establish, strengthen and grow further. Some of the ancillary activities are Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centres (ACABC) which aim not only to supplement efforts of the government's public extension support to farmers but also to create gainful self-employment opportunities to agriculture professionals and facilitate timely services to farmers on crop management.

Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) - ₹3,45,245 Cr

Tamil Nadu is one of the most industrialised State in the country with the highest number of factories – 15% of India's total (Invest India, GoI). Tamil Nadu also ranks third in total exports in the country, with USD 46.46 billion offering significant market potential for businesses. The MSMEs of Tamil Nadu are a key contributor to the State's economy and to Tamil Nadu's vision of becoming one Trillion USD economy. With over 25 lakh Udyam registrations, Tamil Nadu is the 2nd in the country in Udyam registrations (Ministry of MSMEs, GoI). 26% of Tamil Nadu's entrepreneurs are women which is a testimony to the State's inclusive growth and conducive business environment.

Tamil Nadu is a leader in Auto parts and components, readymade garments and leather and leather goods. The majority of MSMEs in Tamil Nadu are concentrated in sectors such as food and beverages, textiles and apparel, printing, metal fabrication, machinery and equipment, leather, rubber and plastics, chemicals, wood and furniture etc. Manufacturing MSMEs are largely concentrated in Chennai, Coimbatore, Erode, Kanchipuram, Krishnagiri, Madurai, Salem, Tiruppur, Virudhunagar and Vellore Districts. Service MSMEs are concentrated in Chennai, Coimbatore, Dindigul, Kanchipuram, Namakkal, Salem, Thoothukudi, Thiruvallur, Trichy and Vellore districts.

The GoTN has announced many schemes/subsidy schemes for MSME sector such as subsidy schemes for micro manufacturing enterprises, industrially Backward Blocks and Agro Based Enterprises, Special Capital Subsidy for Thrust Sector Enterprises, Generator Subsidy, back-ended Interest Subsidy.

Facilitating the creation of a conducive environment for MSMEs to connect with markets and ensuring easy access to affordable credit, enabling regulatory environment, simplifying administrative processes, and strengthening the credit delivery mechanism have been outlined in the paper.

Export Credit - ₹25847.63 Cr

Tamil Nadu is a significant contributor to India's export landscape, with key exports including garments, textiles, automobiles, agricultural products (such as fruits, rice, and vegetables), cotton, oil, turmeric, fireworks, handicrafts, rubber and rubber products, leather and leather goods, horticultural products, spices, masala, silk and cotton sarees, and marine products.

Tamil Nadu is a key exporting State with a share of 10.15% of India's total exports in 2023-24 and has been rightly acknowledged as the leading State in the Export Preparedness Index compiled by the Government of India. The electronics sector witnessed an astounding growth with exports touching USD 9.5 billion which is 33% of India's total exports in this sector. Industry-friendly electronics policy, ease of doing business, skilled talent and presence of port infrastructure have been key enablers. Likewise, the State leads in exports of auto & auto components, engineering goods, textiles, leather and other principal commodities, with the State achieving a whopping USD 44 billion export performance in 2023-24.

To bolster its export capabilities further, Tamil Nadu has developed four Agri Export Zones targeting specific commodities: cut flowers in Hosur (covering Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri), flowers in Nilgiris District, mangoes in Theni (including Dindigul and Madurai), and cashew nuts in Cuddalore (covering Thanjavur and Pudukkottai).

Tamil Nadu topped the Export Preparedness Index (EPI) released by NITI Aayog in 2022. The state continues to attract foreign direct investment (FDI), having drawn \$34.5 billion from April 2000 to March 2021 and maintaining its position among the top five FDI attracting states during this period.

Education - ₹20,727.54 Cr

Tamil Nadu state has made commendable strides in primary education, achieving near-universal enrollment. Tamil Nadu is one of the most literate states in India. As of 2025, the literacy rate in Tamil Nadu is reported at 80.09%, reflecting a slight decline from the 80.33% recorded in 2011, yet still surpassing the national average of 74.04%. The State has made remarkable strides in education, achieving nearly 100% Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) in primary and upper primary education.

Tamil Nadu has consistently performed well in National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF), having 18 institutions in the overall category within the top 100 ranks and 36 institutions within the top 200 ranks, 22 Universities within the top 100 ranks and 33 Universities within the top 200 ranks. Tamil Nadu is one of the key states for higher education and destination for higher education aspirants. There is huge scope for education loans in the state.

Housing - ₹54951.06 Cr

Tamil Nadu's housing sector reflects a mixed landscape, with notable achievements in urban housing and challenges in rural housing. While urban areas witness a relatively higher rate of housing development, rural regions grapple with issues of inadequate housing infrastructure, limited access to housing finance, and challenges in implementing affordable housing schemes. Recognizing these disparities, the State Focus Paper advocates for targeted investments and policy measures to bridge the housing gap and make housing opportunities more inclusive. Tamil Nadu Housing Board (TNHB), Tamil Nadu Adi Dravidar Housing and Development Corporation Limited (TAHDCO) and Tamil Nadu Slum Clearance Board (TNSCB) are the major agencies working towards affordable housing for every citizen including houses for economically weaker sections and provision of universal housing for all sections of society and makes the state, slum free.

Social Infrastructure - ₹13630.11 Cr

Social infrastructure comprising education, health and nutrition care, housing and water supply are important for economic development as they go hand in hand to ensure that the impact of synergy can be realized in full measure. The Government plays a very significant role in the development of the social sector. The share of social sector in total expenditure in Tamil Nadu is higher than that of other southern States and as well as all-India. Education, skills, healthcare, sanitation, drinking water etc are sectors that the government is paying attention. Private investments supported by institutional finance can support Government efforts in modernizing and reaching the unreached segments. Tamil Nadu spends around ₹1,59,575.5 crore towards social sector amounting to 35.2% of Total Disbursements (RBI publication on State Finances: A Study of Budgets of 2024-25).

Renewable Energy - ₹3348.16 Cr

The daily average energy consumption of the State is about 360 Million Units (MU). The per capita consumption of electricity is high in Tamil Nadu at 1792 kWh in 2023-24, as compared to the average of 1640 kWh in 2022-23. Tamil Nadu is the only state where one-third of the installed power comes from renewable sources. The total installed capacity of Power in Tamil Nadu stands at 36,563.27 MW as on 01 April 2024, of which, 9,015.09 MW i.e. 24.66% from Wind, 7995.53 MW i.e., 21.87% from Solar, 206.79 MW i.e., 0.57% from Bio-mass and 684.40 MW i.e., 0.57 % from Co-generation which are renewable sources of energy.

The GoTN is committed to mitigate the climate change effects by bringing out policies conducive to promote renewable energy generation in the state. Municipal and Industrial wastes could also be useful sources of energy while ensuring safe disposal. Renewable Energy (RE) sources provide a viable option for on/off grid electrification & wide industrial applications.

Tamil Nadu is endowed with significant renewable energy potential. The State is blessed with almost 300 sunny days in a year. The State stands fourth highest in installed Solar capacity in India. It has an installed capacity of 8145.53 MW (State Capacity – 7396.37 MW and CTU capacity – 599.16 MW) as on 01 April 2024.

Tamil Nadu has the highest off-shore wind energy potential with maximum Wind Speeds ranging from 9 m/s to 11 m/s. Tamil Nadu stands first in installed wind capacity in India. The state has the total installed wind capacity of 10591.68 MW (State capacity – 9015.09 MW and CTU capacity – 1576.59) as on 01.04.2024, which is 24% of the Nation's wind power capacity.

The share of renewable energy, which at present stands at 20.88% of the total energy generation is proposed to be increased to 50% by 2030.

Informal Credit Delivery - ₹39296.33 Cr

Tamil Nadu is the pioneer in implementation of SHG Bank Linkage Programme, a massive micro credit programme piloted by NABARD in 1992. The key objective of the Micro Credit Innovations by NABARD has been to facilitate sustained access to financial services for the unreached segments of the population viz. the poor in rural hinterlands, through various products and delivery channels in a cost effective and sustainable manner.

The State has 11.41 lakh SHGs with a savings of ₹2854.40 crore and loan outstanding of ₹21766.63 crore in respect of 5.20 lakh SHGs as on 31 March 2023. Out of 10.70 lakh SHGs, only 5.20 lakh i.e. 46% SHGs have been credit linked which creates massive scope for financing this sector. Further the focus now needs to shift to development and financing of entrepreneurial skills of SHG members and graduating them to next level of sustainable livelihood.

Map of Tamil Nadu

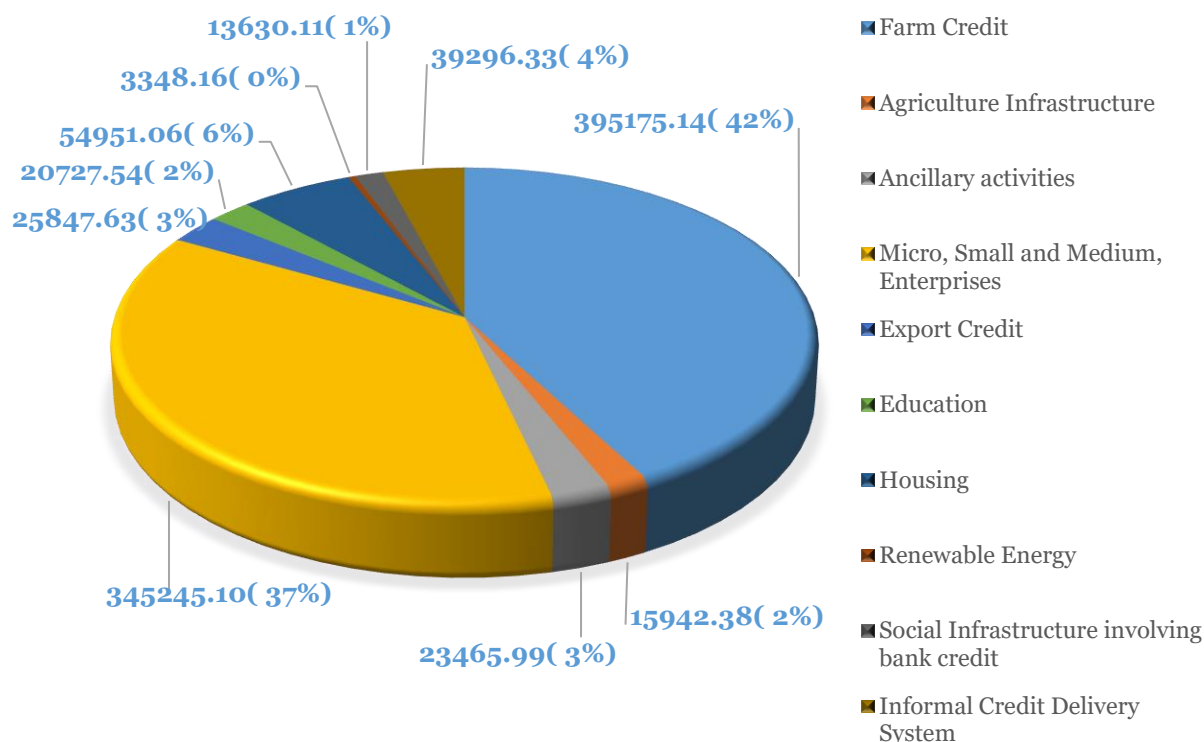


Broad Sector wise PLP projections for the year 2025-26

State: Tamil Nadu

(₹ crore)

Sl. No	Particulars	PLP Projections 2024-25	PLP Projections 2025-26
A	Farm Credit		
i	Crop production, Maintenance & Marketing	268708.61	308670.02
ii	Term Loan for agriculture and allied activities	70692.76	86505.12
	Sub Total (i + ii)	339401.37	395175.14
B	Agriculture Infrastructure	13927.45	15942.38
C	Ancillary activities	21662.18	23465.99
I	Credit Potential for Agriculture (A+B+C)	374991	434583.51
II	Micro, Small and Medium, Enterprises	317060.67	345245.10
III	Export Credit	25314.41	25847.63
IV	Education	22325.32	20727.54
V	Housing	51517.81	54951.06
VI	Renewable Energy	2625.77	3348.16
VII	Social Infrastructure involving bank credit	9492.26	13630.11
VIII	Informal Credit Delivery System	30751.4	39296.33
	Total Priority Sector (I to VIII)	834078.63	937629.43



Sector/ Sub-sector wise PLP Projections for year 2025-26.

State: Tamil Nadu

		(₹ crore)
Sr. No.	Particulars	TOTAL
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	3,08,670.02
1	Water Resources	7,168.80
2	Farm Mechanisation	12,051.18
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	7,884.31
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	2,444.61
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	26,751.82
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	10,984.50
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	6,376.02
8	Fisheries	5,066.74
9	Farm Credit- Others	7,777.14
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	86,505.12
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	3,95,175.14
10	Construction of storage & marketing infrastructure	9,914.18
11	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	2,589.34
12	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	3,438.86
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	15,942.38
13	Food & Agro Processing	15,462.95
14	Ancillary activities - Others	8,003.04
E	Ancillary Activities Total (14 to 15)	23,465.99
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	4,34,583.51
G	MSME	3,45,245.10
H	Export Credit	25,847.63
I	Education	20,727.54
J	Housing	54,951.06
K	Social Infrastructure	13,630.11
L	Renewable Energy	3,348.16
M	Informal Credit Delivery	39,296.33
N	Total (H to M)	1,57,800.83
	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	9,37,629.43

State Profile				
State - Tamil Nadu				
1. PHYSICAL & ADMINISTRATIVE FEATURES			2. SOIL & CLIMATE	
Total Geographical Area (Sq.km) - RBI booklet	130058		Agro-climatic Zone	Seven (North Eastern Zone, North Western Zone, Western Zone, Cauvery Delta Zone, Southern Zone, High Rainfall Zone, Hilly Zone)
No. of Districts -RBI booklet	38		Climate	Semi dry sub humid climate
No. of Taluks - RBI booklet	310		Soil Type	Red loam, laterite, black, sandy coastal alluvium and red sandy soil
No. of Revenue Villages - RBI booklet	17680		4. RAINFALL & GROUND WATER (Actual)	
No. of Panchayats(Town/District/Village) -PN DoRD&PR	490 / 12525			
3. LAND UTILISATION ['000 ha]				
Total Area Reported	13033		Normal	Actual(2023)
Forest Land	2157		2020	2021
Area Not Available for Cultivation	NA		2022	
Barren and Unculturable land	457		920	1035
Permanent Pasture and Grazing Land	107		986	1233
Land under Miscellaneous Tree Crops	180		Variation from Normal	(-) 4
Culturable Waste	351			(+)243
Current Fallow	890		Net annual recharge	Net annual draft
Other Fallow	1848			Balance
Net Sown Area	4837		22423 MCM	13558 MCM
Total or Gross Cropped Area	6260			8875 MCM
Area Cultivated More than Once	1423			
Cropping Intensity [GCA/NSA] (%)	129.42			
6. WORKERS PROFILE [in '000]			5. DISTRIBUTION OF LAND HOLDING [in '000] (2015-16)	
Cultivators	NA		Classification of Holding	Holding
Small/Marginal Workers	NA			Area
Agricultural Labourers	NA		Nos.	% to Total
Workers engaged in Household Industries	NA		<= 1 ha	ha.
Workers engaged in Allied Agro-activities	NA		6224	% to Total
Other workers	NA		6224	78.41
8. HOUSEHOLDS [in '000]			>1 to <=2 ha	2169
Total Households	18524982		>2 to <=4 ha	1555
Rural Households	9528495		>4 to <=10 ha	714
BPL Households	NA		>10 ha	317
10. VILLAGE-LEVEL INFRASTRUCTURE [Nos]			Total	5970
Villages Electrified	15049		7938	100.00
Villages having Agriculture Power Supply	NA			
Villages having Post Offices	NA			
Villages having Banking Facilities	NA			
Villages having Primary Schools	NA			
Villages having Primary Health Centres	1851			
Villages having Potable Water Supply	NA			
Villages connected with Paved Approach Roads	NA			
13. IRRIGATION COVERAGE [000 Ha.]			7. DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE [in '000] (2011 Census)	
Total Area Available for Irrigation (NIA + Fallow)	49		Category	Total
Irrigation Potential Created	NA		Male	Female
Net Irrigated Area(Total area irrigated at least once) (ha)	2920		Population	72147
Area irrigated by Canals / Channels	683		Scheduled Caste	14438
Area irrigated by Wells & Borewells	1834		Scheduled Tribe	795
Area irrigated by Tanks	399		Literate / Literacy rate %	51837/80.09
Area irrigated by Other Sources	40		BPL	8657.64
Irrigation Potential Utilized (Gross Irrigated Area)	39			NA
15. AGRO-PROCESSING UNITS			9. HOUSEHOLD AMENITIES [Nos. in '000 Households]	
Type of Processing Activity	No of units	Cap.[MT]	Having brick/stone/concrete houses	NA
Food (Rice/Flour/Dal/Oil/Tea/Coffee)	NA	NA	Having electricity supply	NA
Sugarcane (Gur/Khandsari/Sugar)	40	NA	Having source of drinking water	NA
Fruit (Pulp/Juice/Fruit drink)	NA	NA	Having access to banking services	NA
Spices (Masala Powders/Pastes)	NA	NA		
Dry-fruit (Cashew/Almond/Raisins)	NA	NA		
Cotton (Ginning/Spinning/Weaving)	NA	NA		
Milk (Chilling/Cooking/Processing)(TLPD)	35/281/21	1445/1221/3507		
Meat (Chicken/Mutton/Pork/Dry fish)	NA	NA		
Animal feed (Cattle/Poultry /Fishmeal)	NA	NA		
17. ANIMAL POPULATION AS PER CENSUS [in lakh Nos]			11. INFRASTRUCTURE RELATING TO HEALTH & SANITATION [Nos]	
Species	2007	2012	2019	Anganwadis
Cattle (cross breed & native breed)	111.88	88.14	95.18	52395
Buffalo	20.09	7.81	5.19	Dispensaries
Sheep	79.90	47.87	45.00	1832
Goat	92.74	81.43	98.89	Hospitals
Pigs	2.84	1.84	0.67	8713
Others-Horses, Ponies and Donkeys	0.11	0.14	0.07	Hospital Beds(incl Tertiary Care)
Total Livestock	307.58	227.23	245.00	129618
Rabbits	0.13	0.52	NA	
Backyard Poultry	294.78	139.19	212.65	
Farm Poultry	1017.76	1034.29	995.16	
Total Poultry	1312.54	1173.49	1207.81	
Source to be mentioned :			12. INFRASTRUCTURE & SUPPORT SERVICES FOR AGRICULTURE	
Statistical Hand book of Tamilnadu 2021-22 & Agriculture Policy of Tamil Nadu 2024-25 ,HANDBOOK OF STATISTICS ON INDIAN STATES RRI-2023			Fertiliser /Seed/Pesticide Outlets [Nos]	12881
Sources (if not mentioned against the respective item):			Total N/P/K Consumption [LMT]	23.50
Item Nos. 7.9 & 10 - Census 2011; Item Nos. 1,2, 3, 4,5,6,11, 12, 13,14,16 - Dept. of Agr./Dir. of Eco. & Stat.; Item No. 8 - MoHA,GOI; Item No. 15 - District Ind Centre/Dir. of Eco. & Stat.; Item No. 17 - AH Census ; Item Nos. 18 & 19 - Dir. of Animal Hus./Dir. of Eco. & Stat.			Certified Seeds Supplied [MT]	28011
			Pesticides Consumed [MT]	1952
			Agriculture Tractors [Nos]	NA
			Power Tillers [Nos]	NA
			Threshers/Cutters [Nos]	NA
			14. INFRASTRUCTURE FOR STORAGE, TRANSPORT & MARKETING	
			Rural/Urban Mandi/Haat [Nos]	NA
			Length of Pucca Road [Km]	271137
			Length of Railway Route [Km]	4033
			Public Transport Vehicle [Nos]	28027
			Goods Transport Vehicle [Nos]	NA
			16. AREA, PRODUCTION & YIELD OF MAJOR CROPS	
			Crop	2021-22
			Area (lakh ha)	Prod. (lakh MT)
			22.17	79.06
			21.58	75.57
			9.55	35.92
			9.16	36.20
			8.02	4.98
			7.91	5.03
			1.48	3.02
			1.73	3.19
			1.48	161.67
			1.61	169.25
			4.32	10.83
			4.14	949.20
				2288.00
			Production of Cotton(lint), Jute, Mesta & Sanhemp are in Bales(177.8 kg per bale in India),	
			18. INFRASTRUCTURE FOR DEVELOPMENT OF ALLIED ACTIVITIES	
			Veterinary Hospitals/Dispensaries [Nos]	152/ 2741
			Animal Markets [Nos]	NA
			Disease Diagnostic Centres [Nos]	34
			Milk Collection Centres [Nos]	NA
			Artificial Insemination Centers [Nos]	3819
			Fishermen Societies [Nos]	1457
			Exotic Cattle Breeding Farms [Nos]	1
			Inland Fish seed Centre [Nos]	44
			Animal Husbandry Tng Centres [Nos]	24
			Fish Markets [Nos]	21
			Dairy Cooperative Societies [Nos]	10211
			Poultry hatcheries [Nos]	NA
			Improvred Fodder Farms [Nos]	1
			Slaughter houses [Nos]	182
			19. MILK, FISH, EGG PRODUCTION & THEIR PER CAPITA AVAILABILITY	
			Fish(2022-23)	Production [Lakh Tones]
			8.29	Per cap avail. [Kg./p.a.]
			Egg(2022-23)	Production [Lakh Nos]
			215607	Per cap avail. [nos/p.a.]
			Milk(2022-23)	Production [LMT]
			103.17	Per cap avail. [gm/day]
			Meat(2022-23)	Production [LMT]
			7.04	Per cap avail. [kg/year]
				9.80

Banking Profile										
State - Tamil Nadu										
NETWORK & OUTREACH (As on 31 March 2024)										
Agency	No. of Banks/Soc	No. of Branches				CD RATIO				
		Total	Rural	Semi-urban	Urban & Metro	Agency	31-Mar-22	31-Mar-23	31-Mar-24	
Commercial Banks/ SFB/ Private Sector Banks/Payment Banks	46	11886	2963	4395	4528	Commercial Banks	109	114	120	
Regional Rural Banks	1	663	347	279	37	Regional Rural Banks	119	155	168	
Cooperative Banks including SCARDB	25	979	297	269	413	Cooperative Banks	114	85	115	
All Agencies	72	13528	3607	4943	4978	All agencies	109	113	121	
DEPOSITS OUTSTANDING					LOANS & ADVANCES OUTSTANDING					
Agency	Amount of Deposit [Rs. crore]					Amount of Loan [Rs. crore]				
	31 Mar 22	31 Mar 23	31 Mar 24	Growth (%)	Share (%)	31 Mar 22	31 Mar 23	31 Mar 24	Growth(%)	Share(%)
Commercial Banks	1023443	1123223	1263516	12	95	1116820	1282606	1519781	18	95
Regional Rural Banks	17093	13182	14980	14	1	17624	20479	25130	23	2
Cooperative Banks	45622	68559	46742	-32	4	51872	58545	53526	-9	3
All Agencies	1086158	1204964	1325238	10	100	1186316	1361630	1598437	17	100
PERFORMANCE TO FULFILL THE NATIONAL GOALS (As on 31 March 2024)										
Agency	Priority Sector Loans		Loans to Agr. Sector		Loans to Weaker Sections		Loans under DRI Scheme		Loans to Women (o/s)	
	Amount [Rs.'Cr]	% of Total Loans	Amount [Rs. Cr]	% of Total Loans	Amount [Rs. Cr]	% of Total Loans	Amount [Rs. Cr]	% of Total Loans	Amount [Rs. Cr]	% of Total Loans
Commercial Banks	609157	40	363126	24	246195	16	20	0	255006	17
Regional Rural Banks	28153	112	26099	104	23272	93	0	0	14877	59
Cooperative Banks	24734	46	15109	28	13909	26	3	0	5986	11
Others	1949	0	0	0	188	0	0	0	188	0
All Agencies	663993	42	404334	25	283564	18	23	0	276058	17
AGENCY-WISE PERFORMANCE UNDER ANNUAL CREDIT PLANS										
Agency	2021-22			2022-23			2023-24			Average Ach[%] in last 3 years
	Target [Rs.Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. 'Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	Target [Rs.Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. 'Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	Target [Rs.Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. 'Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	
Commercial Banks	332557	361801	109	346918	472176	136	620633	609157	82	109
Regional Rural Banks	14478	13218	91	13399	22882	171	29662	28153	83	115
Cooperative Banks	14732	14486	98	11051	22911	207	28301	24734	79	128
SCARDB	2222	0.6425	0	178			107		82	27
Others	167	8270	4952	14366	14357	100	21717	1949	82	1711
All Agencies	364156	397776	109	385912	532326	138	700420	663993	95	114
SECTOR-WISE PERFORMANCE UNDER ANNUAL CREDIT PLANS										
Broad Sector	2021-22			2022-23			2023-24			Average Ach[%] in last 3 years
	Target [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	Target [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	Target [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [Rs. Cr]	Ach'ment [%]	
Crop Loan	72869	149293	205	131086	211568	161	255863	279408	83	150
Term Loan (Agri.)	81752	89585	110	77890	114749	147	130620	124926	80	112
Total Agri. Credit	154665	238878	154	208976	326317	156	386483	404334	82	131
Non-Farm Sector	11993	140463	1171	126702	180309	142	266614	229544	83	465
Other Priority Sector	197498	18435	9	50234	25699	51	47323	30115	82	48
Total Priority Sector	364156	397776	109	385912	532326	138	700420	663993	82	110

Source : SLBC and GLC data from banks

Chapter I

Major Socio-Economic Indicators of the State

1.1. Introduction: Tamil Nadu is the tenth largest State in the country with a geographical area of 1,30,058 Sq.km. The state shares about 4.11 % of the country's total geographical area and has a coastline of 1076 km. It is located in the Indian Peninsula between Bay of Bengal in the east, the Indian Ocean in the south and sharing borders with the Union Territory of Puducherry and Southern Indian States of Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka on the north and Kerala on the west. The State has 38 districts, 87 Revenue Divisions, 310 Taluks, 1349 Firkas, 17680 Revenue Villages, 15 Municipal corporations, 121 Municipalities, 385 Panchayat Unions (Blocks), 490 Town Panchayats, 12525 Village Panchayats, 39 Lok Sabha Constituencies and 234 Assembly Constituencies.

1.2 Agro-climatic zones: Based on rainfall, soil characteristics, cropping pattern and irrigation potential, the State has been divided into seven distinct agro-climatic zones, viz., North Eastern, North Western, Western, Cauvery Delta, Southern, High Rainfall and Hill and high altitude Zones. All the districts under Cauvery Delta were declared as Protected Special Agricultural Zone by GoTN. There are four seasons in the State viz., Southwest Monsoon (June to September), Northeast monsoon (October to December), winter (January to February) and hot weather (March to May).

1.3 Rainfall: The State's average annual rainfall is around 990 mm which is less than the National average of 1,257 mm. The quantum of rainfall received is 39% during the Northeast monsoon, 42% during the southwest monsoon, 11% during summer, and 8% during winter. The total surface water potential of the State is 865 TMC, which includes 260 TMC realized from the neighboring States through Inter-State Agreements.

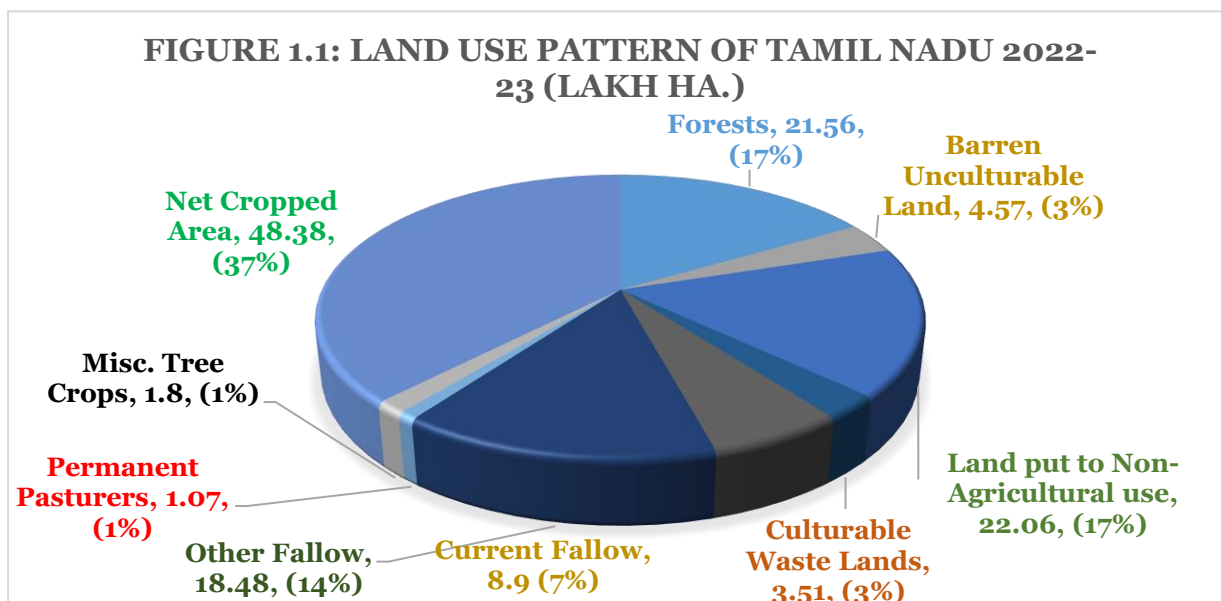
(Source: Statistical Handbook of Tamil Nadu 2021-22, Department of Economics & Statistics, GoTN)

1.4 Population: Tamil Nadu is the seventh most populated state in the country with a population density of 555 persons per sq. km. against the national average of 382 (as per 2011 Census). The state shares about 6% of the country's total population. The total population is 7.21 crore out of which the male population is 3.61 crore and female population is 3.60 crore. The rural population is 3.72 crore forming 51.60% of the total population and the urban population is 3.49 crore forming 48.40% of the total population. The state's literacy rate was 80.09% in 2021, which is above the national average of 77.7% with male literacy at 82.04% and female literacy at 64.55%.

(Source: <https://tnenvs.nic.in/Database/Demography>)

1.5 Pattern of Land Holding: As per the 10th Agricultural Census, Tamil Nadu has 79.38 lakh landholders cultivating an area of 59.71 lakh ha. 93% of total land holdings are owned by Marginal and Small farmers, operating 62 % of the total cultivable lands. The remaining 7% are medium and large farmers accounting for 38% of the total cultivable lands. The average land holding size of Tamil Nadu is 0.75 ha, which is less than the national average of 1.08 ha.

(Source: Policy Note 2024-25, Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Department)



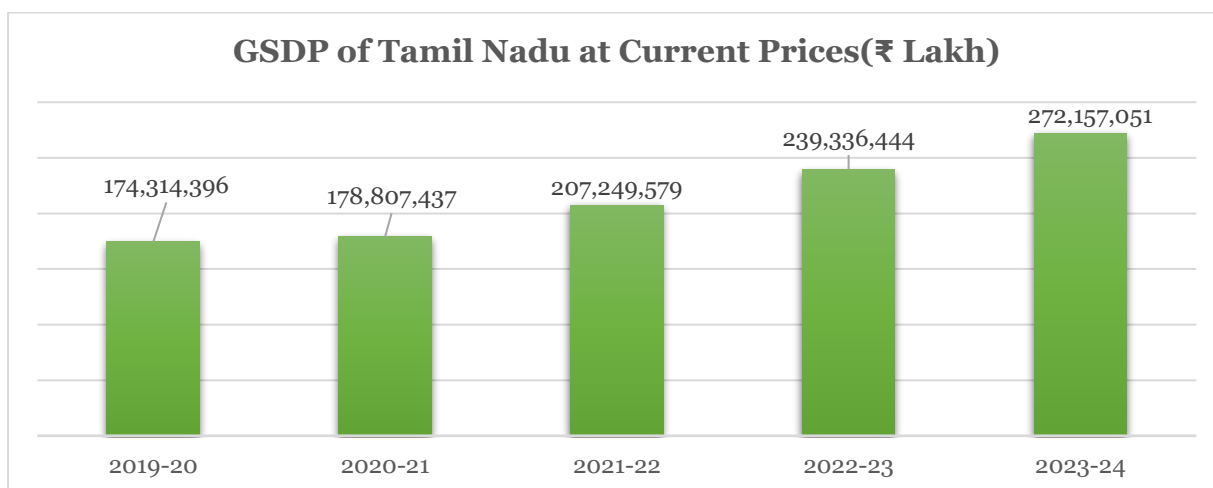
Total Geographical Area - 130.33 lakh Ha

Cropping Intensity (%) - 129.42

(Source: Policy Note 2024-25 Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Department)

1.6 Economy: Tamil Nadu is the most urbanized state in the country and is the second largest economy with projected Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) of ₹ 31.6 lakh crore for 2024-25 (current prices), amounting to a growth of 16% over 2023-24.

Figure 1.2 : GSDP of Tamil Nadu



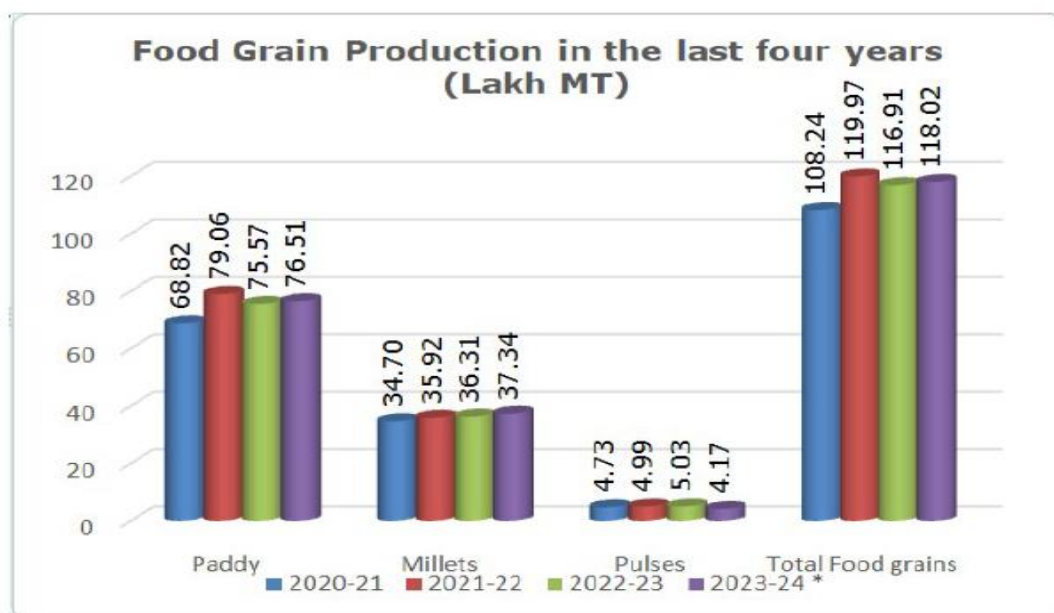
(Source: RBI Handbook of Statistics on Indian States 2023-24)

In 2023-24, at current prices, agriculture, manufacturing, and services sectors contributed 13%, 34%, and 53%, respectively, to the state economy. Tamil Nadu is one of the highly industrialised states of the country. Per capita GSDP of the State is estimated to be ₹3.15 lakh (at current prices) as against the national per capita GDP of ₹1.97 lakh. The State has set a target of achieving \$1 Trillion economy by 2030.

1.7 Net area irrigated and sources of irrigation: Tamil Nadu is one of the most water starved States with only 3% of the nation's water resources, putting high stress on irrigation and

making it vulnerable to seasonal fluctuations resulting in uncertainty in agriculture production. There are 34 major rivers in Tamil Nadu, which are grouped into 17 major river basins and 127 sub basins. Net irrigated area in the State was 29.20 lakh ha. in 2022-23. There is an increase in gross irrigated area to gross cropped area from 46% during 1970-71 to 61% in 2022-23. Of the net irrigated area, 63% was irrigated through wells and bore wells.

1.8 Agriculture production: Agriculture is the livelihood for around 45% of the rural people in Tamil Nadu.



***2023-24 – As per the Third Advance Estimate of the Dept of Economics and Statistics**

The principal food crops of the State include paddy, jowar, ragi, bajra, maize, other millets and pulses. Horticulture crops such as mango, banana, tomato, cucurbits and commercial crops such as sugarcane, cotton, sunflower, coconut, cashew, chillies, gingelly and groundnut are also extensively grown in Tamil Nadu. Major plantation crops grown are tea, coffee, cardamom and rubber. Major forest produces are timber, sandalwood, pulp wood and fuel wood. Paddy is the leading crop and is grown in all 3 seasons' viz. *Kuruwai* (Apr-Jul), *Samba* (Aug-Nov) and *Kodai* (Dec-Mar). Tamil Nadu has also gained a commendable status in cash and oilseed crops viz., groundnuts, sesame, sunflower, etc. Food grain production fell to 107.00 lakh metric tonne during the year 2023-24, against 116.80 lakh metric tonne achieved during the year 2022-2023. Tamil Nadu is poised to achieve 129.63 lakh metric tonne of food grain production in 2024-25.

(Source: Policy Note 2024-25 Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Department)

1.9 Horticulture: Tamil Nadu is one among the leading horticulture States in India, contributing 6.09% of production with 5.47% of area at national level. In Tamil Nadu, horticulture crops are cultivated in an area of 16.03 lakh ha., with a total production of 233.9 lakh MT. Area cultivated under fruit crops during 2022-23 was 3.34 lakh ha. Mango and banana are the main fruit crops. Vegetable crops and plantation crops are cultivated in an area of 3.62 lakh ha. and 7.33 lakh ha. respectively. The climatic conditions prevailing in Tamil Nadu is favourable for growing flowers like jasmine (malligai, mullai, pitchi and kakada), tuberose (sambangi), crossandra, chrysanthemum, rose, marigold, nerium, etc. 27% of the total flower area cultivated is *Jasminum* sp. (gundu malligai, mullai, pitchi and kakada) followed by *Chrysanthemum* (Samanthi), which shares 20% of the area

cultivated. The major spices and condiment crops grown in Tamil Nadu are red chillies, turmeric, tamarind, coriander seeds, black pepper, cardamom, clove, betel vine, ginger, garlic, etc. Plantation crops contribute to major area under the total horticulture crops cultivated in Tamil Nadu. The area under plantation crops covered by coconut is 63.21% with production of 63.07% of the total production of plantation crops. This is followed by cashew nut, organized plantation crops (tea, coffee, rubber and cardamom), arecanut and cocoa.

(Source : Policy Note 2024-25- Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Department)

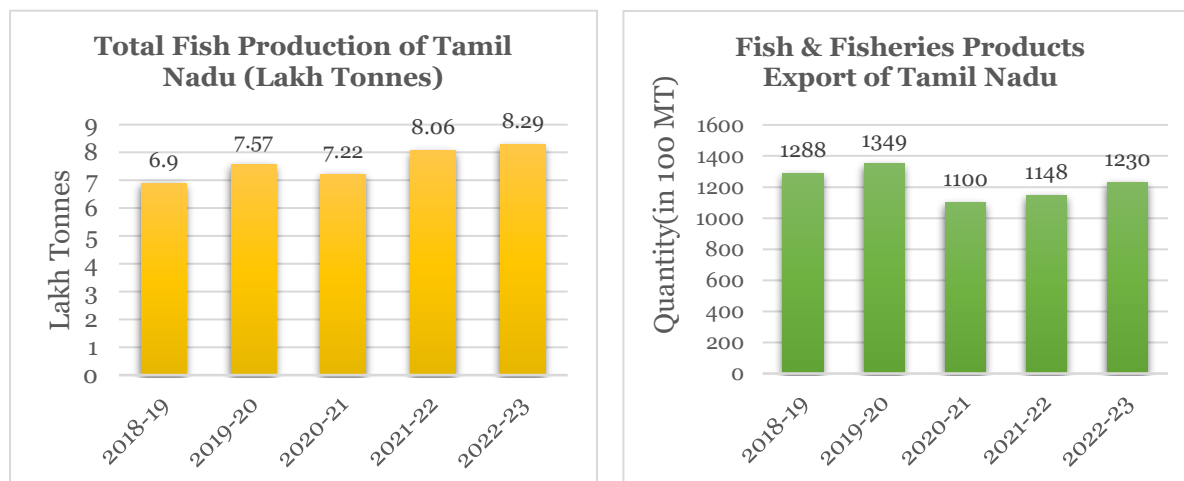
1.10 Animal Husbandry: Livestock sector contributes about 5.63% to Tamil Nadu's Gross State Value Added (GSVA) and 43.70% to agriculture and allied activities. Tamil Nadu has 9.52 million cattle, 0.52 million buffaloes, 4.50 million sheep, 9.89 million goats, 0.07 million pigs and 120.78 million poultry sharing a considerable proportion to national livestock wealth. The State ranks 1st in respect of poultry, 4th in sheep, 7th in goat, 13th in cattle and 14th in buffalo population in the country. Tamil Nadu has 245 lakh of livestock and 1207.80 lakh poultry (2019 census).

The milk production in Tamil Nadu in 2023-24 has increased by 6.93% as compared to 2022-23. The per capita availability of milk in India increased to 471 gram per day in 2023-24 from 459 gram per day in 2022-23. In Tamil Nadu, the per capita availability of milk has increased from 369 grams per day in 2022-23 to 384 grams per day during 2023-24. (Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2024, MoFAHD, GoI)

1.11 Fisheries: Tamil Nadu is enriched with diverse, abundant and productive brackish, marine and inland fisheries resources, providing the fisheries sector an important role in maintaining prosperity of the state. The state has 14 coastal districts with an Exclusive Economic Zone of 1.9 lakh sq. km and a continental shelf of 41,412 sq.km. The State has 608 fishing villages, and the fisheries sector supports livelihood of more than 10.48 lakh marine fisher folk.

Tamil Nadu has 1,076 km long coastline, which is the 2nd largest in the country. Marine fish production of the State during 2022-23 was 8.29 lakh Tonnes, of which 1.23 lakh Tonnes, valued at ₹6,957.67 crore has been exported. The inland fisheries sector supports the livelihood of 2.36 lakh inland fisherfolk of the State. An estimated brackish water area of 56,000 ha is available in the form of lagoons, estuaries and back waters, which are potential source of capture fisheries. There are 2360 farms spread over an area of 4536.46 ha under coastal aquaculture.

Figure 1.4: Fish production in Tamil Nadu and Exports



During the year 2022-23, the sector's contribution to the State agriculture GDP was 6.26%. The State's contribution from fisheries sector in the foreign exchange was ₹6957.67 crore by exporting 1.23 lakh metric tonnes of fish and fishery products during the year 2022-23. Tamil Nadu possesses 3.86 lakh ha. of effective inland water resources comprising reservoirs, major irrigation tanks, minor irrigation tanks, short seasonal tanks, ponds, rivers, and backwaters. (Source: Fisheries by Animal Husbandry, Dairying, Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare Department Policy Note 2024-25)

1.12 Industry Sector: Tamil Nadu leads the country with the highest number of factories at 39672 engaging 15% of persons in India and contributing 10.33% of the gross value addition to India's manufacturing GDP.

The state ranked 3rd for Gross Value Added(GVA) (₹ 14.44 lakh Cr.), Net Value Added (₹1.93 lakh Cr.) and 4th for invested capital (₹3.27 lakh Cr.). Tamil Nadu is one of the most efficient state economy in terms of net value added to output and high employment generation. Tamil Nadu is a manufacturing hub in the country due to its significant presence in sectors such as automobiles and auto-components (including Electric Vehicles), textiles & wearing apparel, leather, chemicals (including rubber & plastic), electronics, machinery, and fabricated metal products. The State is home to 130 "Fortune 500" companies such as BMW, Hyundai, Daimler, TVS, Renault-Nissan, Citroen, DELL, HP, Samsung, Michelin, MRF, Danfoss, Vestas, Hitachi, L&T, Foxconn, Tata etc. With the launch of the revised EV Policy during February 2023, Tamil Nadu is looking forward to enhance its footprint in the EV sector. Companies such as Ola Electric, Ather Energy, Simple Energy, Switch Mobility have a strong presence in Tamil Nadu.

Tamil Nadu is a key exporting state with a share of 10.15% of India's total exports during 2023-24 and has been rightly acknowledged as the leading state in the Export preparedness Index (EPI) compiled by Government of India. The electronic sector witnessed an astounding growth with exports touching US \$9.5 billion which is 33% of India's total exports in this sector. The state also leads in exports of auto and auto components, engineering goods, textiles, leather and other principal commodities, with the State achieving a whopping US \$44 billion export performance during 2023-24.

(Source: Industries Department Policy Note 2024-25, ASI Report 2022-23)

1.13 Renewable Energy: Tamil Nadu is at the forefront of India's renewable energy (RE) transformation with the total installed capacity of Power in Tamil Nadu standing at 41126.68 MW, of which, 26% is from Wind, 19.81% is from Solar, 0.50% is from Bio-mass and 1.66 % is from Co-generation which are renewable sources of energy. Renewable energy accounts for 48% of total installed capacity in the state. TN stood third in total renewable energy installed capacity and fifth in renewable energy generation. Tamil Nadu stands 4th in India in solar energy with an installed capacity of 8211.38 MW. Tamil Nadu stands 2nd in the installed wind capacity of 10603.54 MW accounting for 24 percent of the nation's wind power capacity. Tamil Nadu has the highest off-shore wind energy potential with maximum wind speeds ranging from 9 m/s to 11 m/s.

(Source: Energy Department Policy Note 2024-25 & GOI Renewable Energy Statistics 2023-24)

1.14 Service Sector: The state economy is predominantly service sector based with 53.62% of Gross State Value Added (GSVA) contributed by this sector. Chennai is the largest software exporter in India next to Bangalore. India's largest IT Park is housed near Chennai. GoTN has promoted numerous industrial parks like Rubber Park, Apparel Park, Floriculture Park and Agri Export Zones. It is also a hub for e-publishing. Namakkal is a major transport hub of the country. Transport, real estate, banking & insurance also continue to be major contributors under service sector. The sector has been recording impressive growth over the years.

1.15 Infrastructure: Tamil Nadu has a well-established transportation system that connects all parts of the State. The density of road in Tamil Nadu is 2084.71 km per 1000 sq.km, which is higher than the national average of 1926.02 km per 1000 sq.km. The total length of road network in the State is 2.71 lakh km. The State has a well-developed rail network that connects the State with all the major cities of the country. Tamil Nadu has 4 international airports at Chennai, Coimbatore, Madurai, and Tiruchirappalli and two domestic airports at Tuticorin and Salem. Tamil Nadu with a long coastline has 3 major ports at Chennai, Ennore, and Tuticorin, and 17 minor ports besides several fishing harbors/ landing centers. Tamil Nadu has 2 cruise terminals and various helipads for connectivity across the state. International Airports, major ports, railway lines and roadways connect the state with the rest of the country and other parts of the world.

(Source: *Highways and Minor Ports Department Policy Note 2024-25*)

1.16 Social Sector: Tamil Nadu has achieved universal access to schooling at all levels. Tamil Nadu spends around ₹1,59,575.5 crore towards social sector amounting to 35.2% of Total Disbursements (RBI publication on State Finances: A Study of Budgets of 2024-25). Tamil Nadu has consistently performed well in National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF), having 18 institutions in the Overall category within the top 100 ranks and 36 institutions within the top 200 ranks, 22 Universities within the top 100 ranks and 33 Universities within the top 200 ranks, 32 Arts and Science colleges are within top 100 ranks and 73 colleges within top 200 ranks. Besides 10 Research Institutions are within top 100 ranks and 35 Engineering Colleges are within top 100 ranks. Tamil Nadu has a high number of engineering colleges. Technical training institutions and universities provide high standards of education. The State also has Tamil Nadu Agriculture University (TNAU), Tamil Nadu Veterinary and Animal Sciences University (TANUVAS) and Tamil Nadu Dr J Jayalalitha Fisheries University (TNFU) which cater to the knowledge dissemination on agriculture, animal husbandry and fishery sectors, respectively. Tamil Nadu has a robust public as well private health infrastructure. Good hospitals providing excellent medical facilities attract a large number of patients from other parts of the country and world especially for the specialized cancer, dental and optical treatment. With advanced medical care available in Chennai, Vellore, Coimbatore, and Madurai, Tamil Nadu has become a favored destination of medical tourism.

(Source: *Higher Education Department & School Education Department Policy Note 2024-25*)

1.17 Culture & Tourism: Tamil Nadu has some of the most remarkable temple architecture in the country and a living tradition of music, dance, folk arts and fine arts. Tamil Nadu is renowned for its temple towns and heritage sites, monuments, forts, hill stations, waterfalls, national parks, beaches, local cuisine, natural environment and wildlife. Tamil Nadu has five UNESCO-declared World Heritage sites such as Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram, Brihadeeshwarar Temple at Thanjavur, Airavatheeswara Temple at Darasuram, Gangaikonda Cholapuram Brihadeeshwarar Temple at Jayankondam, and Nilgiri Mountain Railways. The above historical monuments have made Tamil Nadu, the most preferable tourist destination in the country. Tamil Nadu has five UNESCO world heritage sites of Western Ghats are Kalakkad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve, Srivilliputtur Wildlife Sanctuary, Sathyamangalam Wildlife Sanctuary, Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary and Mukurthi National Park.

Tamil Nadu is the land of more than 400 “Archaeological Society of India” monuments and sites. It is home to the Nilgiris Mountain Range, part of a UNESCO-recognized natural site and one of India’s three ecological hotspots for species endemism. Furthermore, the state has 37 protected areas extending over 7,000 sq km and a coastline packed with beaches, mangroves, coral reefs, and more.

Tamil Nadu has released the first-ever Tourism Policy in 2023 that plans to focus on development of 12 Priority Tourism Segments viz., Adventure Tourism, Recreation Tourism,

Caravan Tourism, Rural and Plantation Tourism, Coastal Tourism, Cultural Tourism, Medical and Wellness Tourism, Religious Tourism, Eco-Tourism, MICE Tourism, Heritage Tourism, Film Tourism for the development of the sector in Tamil Nadu.

(Source: <https://www.tamilnadutourism.com/>, Policy Note 2024-25 Tourism, Culture and Religious Endowments Department, Tamil Nadu Tourism Policy 2023)

Chapter II

Banking / Financial Sector Profile

2.1. Introduction

There were 13528 bank branches in Tamil Nadu as on 31 March 2024, comprising of 3607 branches in rural areas, 4943 in semi-urban and 4977 in urban areas, with 6338 branches of Public Sector Banks, 4639 of Private Sector Banks, 663 of Regional Rural Bank, 979 of Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank, TNSCARDDB and DCCBs, 863 of Small Finance Banks, 11 of SIDBI, 35 of Payment Banks. Indian Overseas Bank, with a branch network of 1105 branches are the Convenor of State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC), a consultative body to discuss issues and suggest measures/ solutions for effective banking. SLBC is assisted by 38 Lead District Managers functioning at the district level (*Source: SLBC*). As on 31 March 2024, there are 68 NBFC-mFIs functioning in Tamil Nadu having a network of 3450 branches.

Table 2.1: No. of branches of Banks in Tamil Nadu

Banks	No. of branches
Public Sector Banks	6338
Private Sector Banks	4639
Regional Rural Bank	663
Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank, TNSCARDDB and DCCBs	978
SIDBI	11
Small Finance Banks	863
Payment Banks	35

Besides, 4454 Primary Agriculture Co-operative Societies (PACS), 39 Large Area Multipurpose Societies (LAMPS), 180 Primary Co-operative Agricultural & Rural Development Bank (PCARDDB), 128 Urban Co-operative Banks, 1705 Employees Co-operative Thrift and Credit Societies, 131 Multi-Purpose Co-operative Societies (MPCS), 1364 Weavers Co-operative Societies (WCS), 112 Marketing Co-operative Societies/ Federation (MCS) and Business Correspondents (BCs) are also engaged in disbursement of credit for agricultural activities and other activities.

2.2. Performance against Priority Sector Lending Goals

The Banks have surpassed targets set by RBI under Priority Sector Lending guidelines. The performance under Priority Sector Lending during the last three years is as under:

Table 2.2: Performance under priority sector lending

Item	National Norm	Achievement (%)		
		March 2022	March 2023	March 2024
Advances to Priority Sector	40	50	48	42
Advances to Agriculture	18	24	24	25
Advances to Weaker Sections	10	17	21	18
Advances to Women	5	NA	NA	17
DRI Advances to Total Advances of previous year	1	NA	0.02	0

(Source: SLBC)

The target fixed under ACP for the FY'24 was ₹ 700420 crore as against which disbursement was ₹ 663993 crore registering an achievement of 94.8% and 24.73% growth from previous year. The sector wise performance of ACP for the last three years is as under:

Table 2.3: Sector- wise performance under Annual Credit Plan

(₹ Crore)

Sector	2021-22			2022-23			2023-24		
	Tar.	Ach.	% Ach	Tar.	Ach.	% Ach	Tar.	Ach.	% Ach
Agriculture & Allied	165185	238878	145	208978	326317	156	386483	404334	105
MSME	117224	140463	120	126702	180309	142	266614	229544	86
Education	14109	1047	7	4731	1171	25	3177.88	1544	49
Housing	34133	7256	21	13659	8784	64	15815.13	9072	57
Export Credit	10527	1283	12	3327	913	27	1764.69	1967	111
Renewable Energy	1885	236	13	6290	195	3	621.07	799	129
Social Infrastructure	1807	282	16	1614	293	18	1227.64	263	21
Others	19286	8330	43	20613	14344	70	24716.92	16470	67
Total Priority Sector	364156	397775	109	385914	532326	138	700420	663993	95
Source: SLBC and GLC data from banks. The above compilation is based on GLC data sourced from LDMs.									

2.3. Credit Deposit Ratio

The CD ratio of the Banks in Tamil Nadu continues to be above 100%. It showed an upward movement from 109% during March 2022 to 114% during March 2023 and further to 121% during March 2024. The CD ratio is above the RBI prescribed norm of 60%. (Source: SLBC)

2.4. Outreach of Banking Sector - Rural Financial Institutions

2.4.1. Commercial Banks

As on 31 March 2024, there were 11875 branches of Commercial Banks which include 6338 branches of PSBs, 4639 branches of Private sector banks, 863 branches of Small Finance Banks and 35 branches of Payment Banks. The important performance parameters of commercial banks are furnished as under:

Table 2.4: Performance of Commercial Banks

(₹ crore)

Particulars	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	Growth (%)
No. of Branches	11719	11192	11886	6.2
CD Ratio (%)	109	114	120	5.3
Deposits	1038298	1123223	1263516	12.5
Advances	1134444	1282606	1519781	18.5
Priority Sector Advances O/S	307317	472176	609157	29.0
Agri Advances O/S	169388	284055	402010	41.5

(Source: SLBC)

Bank deposits posted an incremental growth of 12.5% during 2023-24 as compared to the previous year. Advances, Priority Sector Advances O/s and Agri Advances registered a growth

of 18.5%, 29.0% and 41.5% respectively.

2.5.2 Regional Rural Bank

Tamil Nadu Grama Bank, the only RRB in the State had a network of 663 branches as on 31 March 2024 (347 rural, 279 semi-urban and 37 urban branches). Major performance parameters are as under:

Table 2.5: Performance of RRB

(₹ crore)

Particulars	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	Growth (%)
No. of Branches	644	655	663	1.2
CD Ratio (%)	118	155	168	8.4
Deposits	17093	13182	14980	13.6
Advances	17617	20479	25130	22.7
Priority Sector Advances	10215	22882	28153	23.0
Agri Advances	9602	20494	26099	27.3

(Source: SLBC)

TNGB registered an incremental growth of 22.7%, 23% and 27.3% under advances, PSL Advances and Agri Advances, respectively. 94% of RRB branches are in rural and semi-urban areas. Share of RRB in priority sector lending in the state during 2023-24 stood at 4%. In terms of deposits TNGB accounts for 1% of total deposits in the State.

2.5.3 Co-operative Credit Structure

The Co-operative Credit Structure in the State consists of Short Term and Long Term. The Short-Term structure has three-tiers, with the Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank Ltd (TNStCB) at the apex level with 51 branches, 23 District Central Co-operative Banks (DCCBs) at district level with 927 branches, and 4454 PACS. Co-operative Banks have 978 branches, comprising of 297 rural branches, 269 Semi-urban branches, 412 urban & Metro.

TNStCB and all the 23 DCCBs are on CBS platform.

The Long-Term Co-operative Credit structure consists of Tamil Nadu State Co-operative Agricultural and Rural Development Bank (TNSCARD) and 180 Primary Co-operative Agricultural and Rural Development Bank (PCARD).

The status of Co-operative banks as on 31 March 2024 in Tamil Nadu is provided below.

Table 2.6: Performance of Co-operative Banks

(₹ crore)

Particulars	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	Growth (%)
No. of Branches	928	979	979	-
CD Ratio (%)	113	85	115	35.3
Deposits	45622	68559	46742	-31.8
Advances	51872	58545	53526	-8.6
Agri Advances	10888	14309	15109	5.6
Priority Sector Advances	14486	22911	24734	8

(Source: SLBC)

The CD ratio of Co-operative banks as on 31 March 2024 increased to 115% from 85% as on 31 March 2023. Deposits and Advances of the Co-operatives have shown a negative growth over the previous year. It registered an incremental growth of 5.6% and 8.0% under Agri Advances and Priority sector advances. In terms of deposits and advances, Cooperative banks accounted for 3.53% and 3.35% respectively.

Progress on CBS in Co-operatives: All the 24 Rural Co-operative Banks (TNStCB and 23 DCCBs) have implemented Core Banking Solution, with branches and head offices of all the 24 RCBs under the platform.

Centrally Sponsored Project on Computerisation of PACS (CSPCP) in Tamil Nadu This scheme aims at computerization of all functional PACS leading to increase in efficiency, profitability, transparency and accountability in the working of PACS. All the 4532 co-operative societies have been covered under the CSPCP project for bringing all the functional societies onto a common software, linking them with NABARD through State Co-operative Bank (StCB) and District Central Co-operative Banks which is implemented by NABARD.

2.6 Non-Performing Assets (NPAs):

As on 31 March 2024, the NPAs under Priority Sector Advances decreased from ₹ 33958 Crore to ₹29828.52 crore in absolute terms in Commercial Banks, Small Finance Banks, Co-operative Banks and Regional Rural Banks. The NPAs have reduced in percentage terms under agriculture loans, export credit and the NPAs under major loans in respect of Commercial Banks, Co-operative Banks and RRBs. The total NPAs including Priority Sector and Non-Priority Sector as on 31 March 2024 stood at ₹64635.13 crore.

Table 2.7: Sector-wise Non-Performing Assets in respect of Commercial Banks, RRB and Foreign Banks

Sr. No	Particulars	As on					
		31 March 2022		31 March 2023		31 March 2024	
		Amount	% of NPA	Amount	% of NPA	Amount	% of NPA
1	Housing Loan	1457.00	2	969.54	0.16	840.88	1.3
2	Education Loan	3920.00	8	4676.87	0.75	3302.43	5.1
3	Agriculture Loan	14332.00	6	9804.40	1.57	9118.65	14.1
4	MSME	24424.00	1.73	16487.39	2.65	15464.36	23.9
5	Export credit	101.00	0.78	39.39	0.01	21.29	0.03
6	Renewable energy	14.00	0.59	7.51	0.00	6.73	0.01
7	Social Infrastructure	898.00	2	731.93	0.12	508.16	0.8
8	Other priority sector loan	958.00	1.15	469.05	0.08	566.02	0.9
9	Overall priority sector lending	46105.00	1.16	33186.08	5.33	29828.52	4.7

(Source: SLBC)

Table 2.8: Sector- wise Non-Performing Assets in respect of Co-operative Banks
(₹ Crore)

	Particulars	As on							
		31 March 2021		31 March 2022		31 March 2023		31 March 2024	
		Amount	% of NPA	Amount	% of NPA	Amount	% of NPA	Amount	% of NPA
1	Agriculture loans	181	5	332	1.65	332	1.43	1120.82	6.34
2	MSME	16	85	3.32	0.02	3	0.01	9.11	17.9
3	Educational loans	1	1	0.96	0.01	0	0.00	0.03	7.1
4	Housing loans	57	13	37.63	0.64	38	0.16	37.1	7.6
5	Others	406	5	520.15	3.25	399	1.71	352.46	4.6
6	Overall Priority Sector	661	0.02	558.05	5.56	772	3.32	1519.52	5.9

(Source: SLBC)

The total NPAs including Priority Sector and Non-Priority Sector for Co-operative banks as on 31 March 2024 stood at ₹1519.52 crore.

2.7 Financial Literacy and Credit Counselling Centers (FLCCCs)

Financial Literacy Centres (FLCs) are the building blocks or the basic units that initiate the financial literacy activities at the ground level. FLCCs centres would provide financial literacy and credit counselling, the activities of the Rural Development. There are 74 FLCCCs functioning in the state which provide financial literacy and credit counselling to the public. The thrust of FLCCCs during FY 2023-24 was to popularise digital and cashless transactions. NABARD has sanctioned grant support of ₹89.75 lakh to various Banks towards conduct of around 1800 Financial & Digital Literacy Awareness Programmes across the State.

2.8 Rural Self-Employment Training Institutes (RSETIs)

RSETIs, train and hand hold rural youth for employment/self-employment. In Tamil Nadu 4 banks, i.e., Indian Overseas Bank, Indian Bank, Canara Bank and State Bank of India have been assigned the Lead Bank responsibility. They have opened RSETIs in the Lead districts allotted to them. There are 35 RSETIs in the state which conducted 961 training programmes during 2023-24 covering 29,073 trainees, 23,418 persons were secured employment/self-employment, and 14,569 persons were credit linked.

2.9 Social Security Schemes

The important social security schemes being implemented are:

2.9.1 Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), a National Mission on Financial Inclusion, was launched in August 2014 with a view to increase banking penetration and promoting financial inclusion by covering all households with at least one bank account. In the state, 146.54 lakh PMJDY accounts were opened as on 31 March 2024, of which 70.86 lakh in rural areas and 75.67 lakh in urban areas. Besides, 146.54 lakh accounts have an aggregate balance of ₹ 5051.12 crore. Further, 73.04% of PMJDY accounts have been issued RuPay Cards and 71.01% accounts are Aadhaar seeded. Banks are making efforts to take up financial literacy activities in rural areas to bring down the number of zero balance accounts and increase utilization/ activation of RuPay Cards.

2.9.2 Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY) envisages Personal Accident Insurance (PAI) cover of ₹2 lakh for a premium of ₹20 per annum. In the state, there were 1766.20 lakh eligible no. of cases as on 31 March 2024.

2.9.3 Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) provides Life insurance cover of ₹2 lakh for a premium of ₹436 per annum. In the state, 79.54 lakh accounts were enrolled as on 31 March 2024.

2.9.4 Atal Pension Yojana (APY) a pension scheme for workers in the unorganized sector under which the subscribers would receive a guaranteed fixed monthly pension ranging from ₹1000 to ₹5000, at the age of 60 years, depending on their contributions and age of joining. The minimum age of joining APY is 18 years, and maximum age is 40 years as on 31.03.2024, cumulative subscriber for the state stood at 41.27 lakh.

Chapter III

NABARD's perception on the development perspectives of the State

3.1 State of Economy

Tamil Nadu is the most progressive state in India in terms of many economic and social parameters. It is the second largest economy (₹27.21 lakh crore in 2023-24) in the country, with an ambitious target of achieving a trillion-dollar economy by 2030 (Handbook of statistics on Indian States 2023-24, RBI). It is a highly industrialized state, contributing 12.25% of the manufacturing real GDP of the country and its share of India's real GDP is 9.08% (2022-23). Tamil Nadu ranks first in number of factories and Export Preparedness Index (2022); second in urbanization (53.68%, next only to Kerala), low Infant Mortality Rate (13), and low birth rate (13.8) and in head count ratio, i.e., percentage of population who are multidimensionally poor (2.2%); third in credit-deposit ratio (in 2022-23) and life expectancy at birth, and fourth in literacy and per capita. It is a benchmark state for model startup ecosystem, and it is placed in the 'Best Performer' category in the States Startup Ranking, 2022 income (Economic overview of Tamil Nadu 2023-24, MSE).

3.1.1 Economic Outlook

Tamil Nadu's Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) grew 8.13% in 2022-23 and 8.23% in 2023-24 at constant prices, while at current prices, the growth rates were 15.48% in 2022-23 and 13.71% in 2023-24. The growth rates for the All India GDP were 6.99% in 2022-23 and 8.15% in 2023-24 at constant prices, while at current prices, they were 14.21% in 2022-23 and 9.60% in 2023-24. Tamil Nadu's inflation rates were 5.97% in 2022-23 and 5.37% in 2023-24, compared to the All-India inflation rates of 6.65% and 5.38% during the respective periods.

Tamil Nadu's average economic growth rate was 5.80% in real terms from 2012-13 to 2020-21. The growth rates for 2021-22, 2022-23, and 2023-24 were 7.89%, 8.13%, and 8.23% respectively at constant prices. This resulted in an average growth rate of 8.08%, reflecting a notable improvement in the State's overall economic performance compared to earlier years.

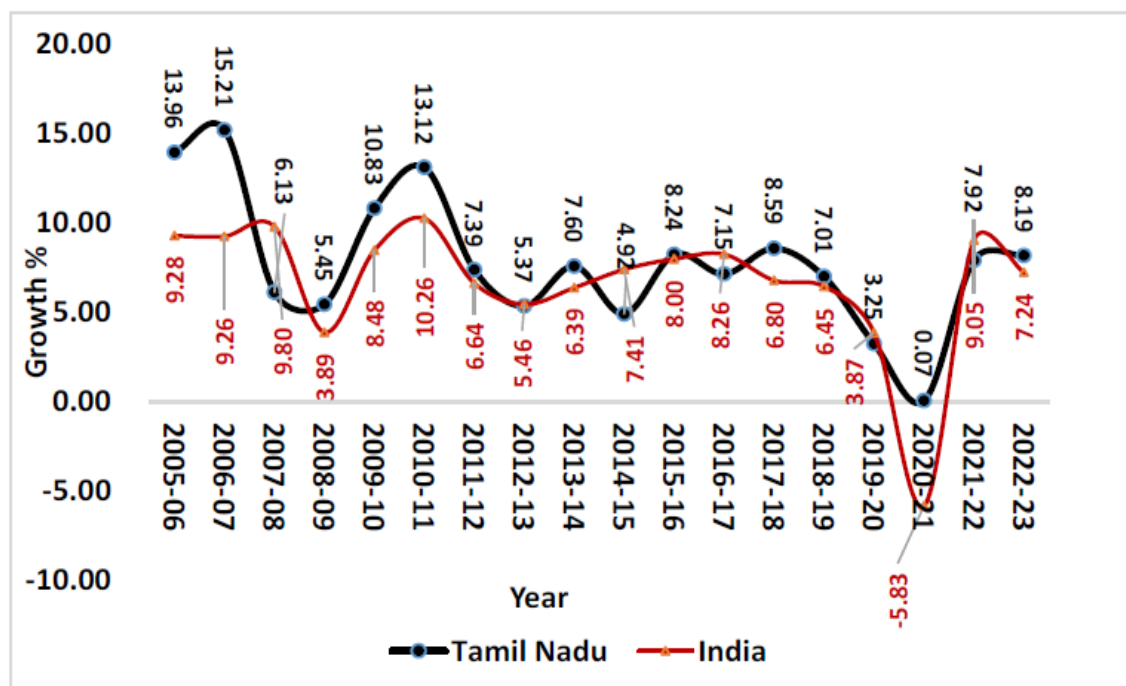
Tamil Nadu's per capita income was estimated at ₹1,66,590 in 2022-23 and ₹1,79,732 in 2023-24, compared to India's per capita income of ₹99,404 in 2022-23 and ₹1,06,744 in 2023-24 at constant prices. Tamil Nadu's per capita incomes were 1.68 times the national per capita income for both years. At current prices, Tamil Nadu's per capita income was ₹2,77,802 in 2022-23 and ₹3,15,220 in 2023-24, whereas the All-India per capita income was ₹1,69,496 in 2022-23 and ₹1,84,205 in 2023-24. Thus, Tamil Nadu's per capita income at current prices was 1.71 times of the national per capita income in 2023-24. (TN Department of Economics and Statistics)

3.1.2 Sector contributions

In 2023-24, the services sector contributed 53% to the state's economy, followed by manufacturing at 34% and agriculture at 13%.

The services sector grew at 9.4% in 2023-24, followed by manufacturing at 7.1% and agriculture at 4.3%.

Figure 3. 1: Economic Growth (percent): Tamil Nadu Vs India



Source (Basic Data): MOSPI Website.

As one of the most urbanized and industrialized states in the country, it has an increasing share of non-agriculture sectors. While this is a positive feature in terms of the state's overall growth story, this also makes the economy more vulnerable to external shocks. The state is trying to address the consequent uncertainty to achieve sustainable growth.

3.2 Capital Formation in Agriculture

To provide focus and higher priority for agriculture and farmers welfare, the State Government for the first time announced a separate budget for agriculture in 2021-22. For the fourth consecutive year, GoTN announced exclusive agriculture budget for 2024-25 after extensive consultations with farmers, farmers' associations, academicians, NABARD and other financial institutions, exporters, traders, etc. The Agriculture Budget for 2024-25, increased the allocation for agriculture and allied sectors to ₹42,281.88 crore, as against allocation of ₹38,904 crore for 2024-25.

Table 3.1: Investment in Agriculture (2024-25) (₹ crore)

Sl. No	Particulars	Amount
1	Total State Budget	42,281.88
2	Revenue Expenditure (Agri. & Allied Sectors and irrigation)	8801.32
3	Capital Expenditure (Agri. & Allied Sectors and irrigation)	33480.56
4	Share (%) of Capital Expenditure in Total Agriculture Budget	21%
5	Share (%) of Revenue Expenditure on Total State Budget for Agriculture	79%

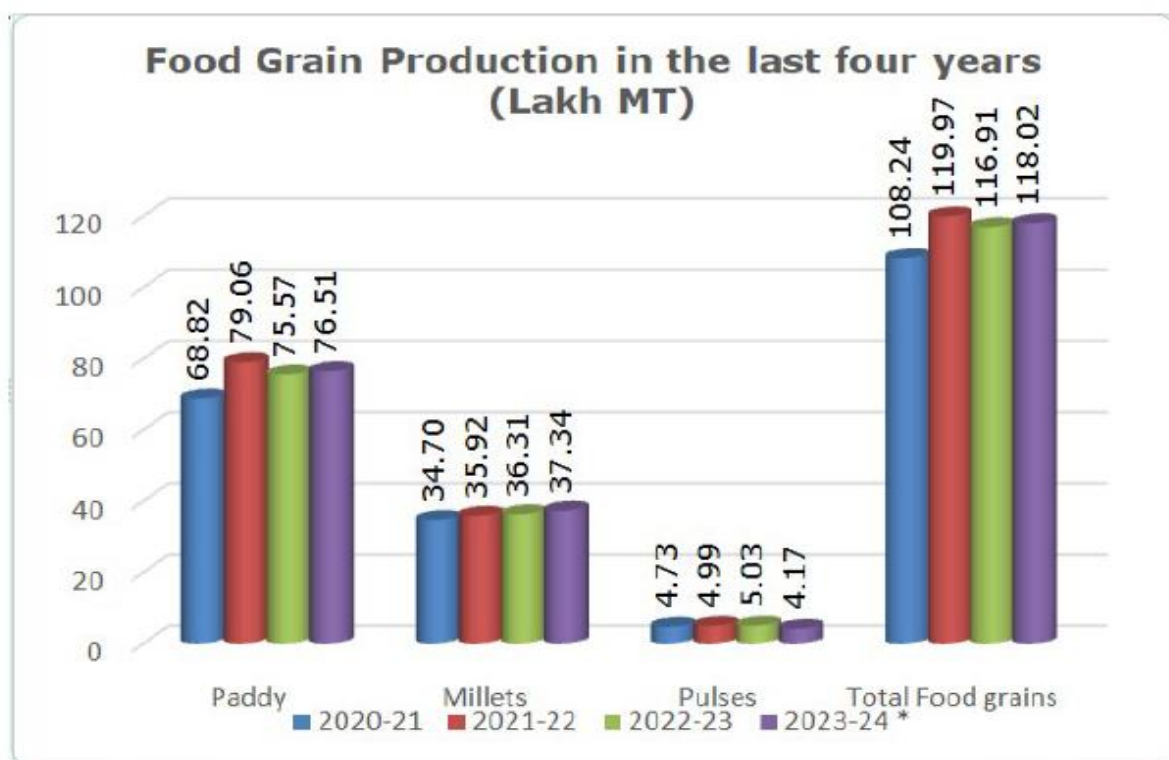
3.2.1 Credit flow to Agri Sector

In addition to government expenditure, access to credit is one of the most important contributors to capital formation in agriculture by private sector. Against the prescribed Annual Credit Plan target of ₹3,86,481.00 crore banks have disbursed ₹4,04,334.39 crore during 2023-24 resulting in the achievement of 104.62%. The critical role played by NABARD in credit planning exercise is complemented through its refinance and direct finance products, for ensuring and enabling credit delivery to the last mile. During the FY 2024, NABARD extended refinance to banks to the extent of ₹33189.69 crores against farm sector credit extended by banks in the State, of which, 52% of the total refinance was extended for investment credit, further facilitating capital formation sustaining the growth in the sector.

3.2.2 Agriculture Production and Productivity

Policy reforms brought by GoTN in improving land resources (soil and nutrients) conservation, judicious utilization of water resources for crop intensification, integrated resource management, agriculture infrastructure management, new & renewable energy resources to increase farm efficiency, invigorating agricultural extension machinery, human resource management and distress mitigation led to a technological transformation in agriculture which enabled the state to remain on high growth trajectory.

Figure 3.2

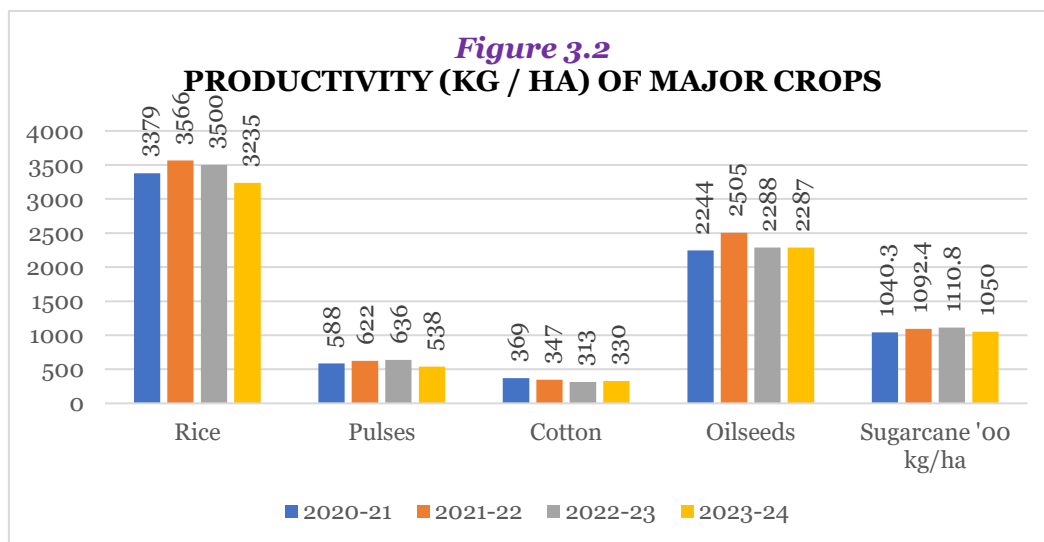


***2023-24 – As per the Third Advance Estimate of the Dept of Economics and Statistics**

(Source: Policy Note 2024-25, Agriculture Department, GoTN)

Tamil Nadu has made impressive strides in agriculture sector and achieved a two-fold increase in food grain production since the launch of Second Green Revolution in 2011-12. The

technological breakthrough in increasing productivity and cultivable area has removed the impasse in agriculture production and paved way for the state to surpass 100 lakh MT of food grain production. The productivity of food grains and major crops over the last 4 years, is indicated in figure 3.2.



(Source: Policy Note 2024-25, Agri - Farmers welfare Department, GoTN)

3.3 Financing SF/MF, Oral Lessees/Tenant Farmers/Sharecroppers, etc.

The State accounts for 79.38 lakh land holders who cultivate an area of 59.71 lakh hectare. As per the 10th Agricultural Census conducted by the GoI, an overwhelming 93% of these land holdings belong to Marginal and Small farmers, overseeing 62% of the total cultivable lands. The remaining 7% of land holdings are in the hands of medium and large farmers, managing 38% of the total cultivable lands. The average land holding area in Tamil Nadu stands at only 0.75 hectare, compared to the national average of 1.08 hectare.

With a view to augment flow of credit to landless and tenant farmers, Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) model was conceived and promoted by NABARD. Tamil Nadu is one of the front runner states in JLG nurturing and promotion. JLGs are also being encouraged to federate themselves as Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) to reap the economies of scale in procurement of inputs and marketing of their produce/finished products. As on 31 March 2024, the State had 38.66 lakh JLGs and the banks had disbursed a cumulative amount of ₹13892441.31 lakh to these groups. NABARD supports the Training and Capacity Building of the Joint Liability Groups and a total of 38,092 lakh JLG members were trained, and an amount of ₹952 lakh was released to various JLG Promoting Institutes (JLGPIs) towards promoting and credit linking 66,471 JLGs as on 31 March 2024. (Source: Status of Microfinance in India 2023-24)

KCC, RuPay, KCC/Crop Insurance, Land Records, Digitalisation and Creation of charge

3.4 Kisan Credit Card Scheme

The Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme aims to provide timely and adequate credit support to farmers under a single window with a flexible and simplified procedure. The scheme covers various needs such as short-term credit for crop cultivation, post-harvest expenses, produce

marketing loans, consumption requirements of farmer households, working capital for farm maintenance, and investment credit for agriculture and allied activities. The scheme has been expanded to include farmers involved in fisheries and animal husbandry activities.

The Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme in Tamil Nadu has shown significant progress with a notable increase in both the number of beneficiaries and the amount disbursed. The total number of farmers who received Kisan Credit Cards (KCC) from all financial institutions, including Commercial Banks, Small Finance Banks (SFBs), Cooperative Banks, and Regional Rural Banks (RRBs), for the fiscal year 2023-24 was 43.70 lakh, with a total amount disbursed being ₹52,503.42 crore. Cooperative Banks have consistently served larger number of farmers and disbursed ₹20,993.01 crore to 25.83 lakh farmers in FY 2023-24 as against ₹12,096.68 crore to 13.63 lakh farmers in FY 2022-23. RRB in Tamil Nadu disbursed ₹5462.80 crore in FY 2023-24 as against ₹2314.06 crore in FY 2022-23 registering a growth of 136%.

3.4.1 Nationwide Animal Husbandry, Dairying, and Fisheries (AHDF) Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Campaign

GoI has launched Nationwide Animal Husbandry, Dairying, and Fisheries (AHDF) Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Campaign for the year 2024-25, from September 15, 2024, to March 31, 2025. The campaign is expected to significantly increase the number of KCCs issued to farmers in the animal husbandry, dairy, and fisheries sectors.

Disbursements under KCC Animal Husbandry during 2023-24 was ₹11082.59 crore to 10.79 lakh farmers as against ₹2989.42 crore to 3.42 lakh farmers in FY 2022-23 registering phenomenal growth of 214.80%. This mainly on account of various campaigns to boost KCC disbursement to animal husbandry farmers. Disbursements under KCC Fisheries during 2023-24 was ₹1,295.51 crore as against ₹413.73 crore in FY 2022-23 registering growth of 213.13%. The total no. of beneficiaries for which KCC for animal husbandry and fisheries issued during the FY 2023-24 is 11.73 lakh.

3.4.2 KCC-Modified Interest Subvention Scheme (MISS)

MoA&FW, GoI approved the continuation of the KCC Interest Subvention Scheme (ISS) for the financial year 2024-25. Interest Subvention of 1.5% p.a. will be available to banks, on their own funds used for short term loans (crop loans and WC loans for animal husbandry, fisheries, dairy, bee keeping etc.) up to ₹3.00 lakhs per farmer subject to maximum of ₹2.00 lakh per farmer for WC loans for AH&F, Dairy, beekeeping etc. provided the lending institutions make available short-term credit to farmers @ 7% p.a. An additional interest subvention @ 3% will be available to such of those farmers repaying on time. Farmers paying promptly, would thus get short term loans @ 4% p.a. With additional interest subvention of 3% by Govt of Tamil Nadu, farmers of the state need not pay any interest on KCC loans.

The Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare (MoA&FW), is actively implementing the modified Interest Subvention Scheme (MISS) through the Kisan Rin Portal (KRP) from Scheme Year 2022-23 onwards, to streamline the claim submission process for the Kisan Credit Card (KCC) holders. This initiative is critical in ensuring the timely and transparent disbursement of benefits to farmers availing the benefits under KCC Scheme.

3.4.3 Crop Insurance - Ghar Ghar PMFBY Abhiyan

GoI has launched the "Ghar Ghar PMFBY Abhiyan" under the campaign titled "Saturation of Loanee Farmers under PMFBY for Kharif & Rabi 2024-25." This initiative aims to ensure maximum coverage of eligible loanee farmers under the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) by banks.

Under the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) scheme for Tamil Nadu during the Kharif 2024 season, a total of 30,662 loanee farmers and 2,86,553 non-loanee farmers enrolled, covering an area of 93.4 thousand hectares. The gross premium collected, was ₹25.91 crore which included contributions from farmers, the state government, and the GoI. The sum insured stood at ₹739.50 crore. A total of 6,496 farmers benefitted from the scheme, receiving support for crop losses, highest being Nagapattinam District, followed by Thiruvavur.

3.5 Digitization of Land Records - Agri Stack and GRAINS

Agri Stack is the digital foundation being set up by the government to make it easier to bring various stakeholders together to improve agriculture in India and enable better outcomes and results for the farmers by using data and digital services. Agri Stack is an infrastructure and foundational layer that enables various government and private entities to provide farmers with tailored services by providing them access to high-quality, validated, attested and current data. Agri Stack will provide data to identify genuine farmers (Farmer ID), pinpoint the farm location (Farm ID) through geotagging and track what crop is being grown by them through a Crop Survey. Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) and standardized protocols defined by the Unified Farmer Service Interface (UFSI) will enable the seamless and standardized exchange of information and data with authorized private entities and their digital systems.

Growers Online Registration of Agriculture Inputs System (GRAINS), a unified farmer's service interface portal of GoTN is aligned with Agri Stack portal of GoI which will be utilized for availing all the scheme benefits by the farmers under a single platform. The three core registries of the GRAINS consist of Unified Farmer Database, Geo-referencing of land parcels in Tamil Nadu and Digital Crop Survey which forms the architecture of the GRAINS portal. The GRAINS portal in Tamil Nadu offers a range of services to various stakeholders. By using reliable farmer data from the portal, the financial institutions can extend seamless credit and other financial services to farmers. It's a new platform where information on bank accounts, Aadhar numbers of landowners and cultivators, land facts, and crop cultivation details would be collected and digitised.

A pilot Digital Crop Survey (DCS) was taken up in 110 villages of the state @ 3 villages per district during 2023. DCS has been carried out in all districts of Tamil Nadu through Revenue Department. Registration of 54.21 lakh farmers has been completed. Land parcels of about 133.62 lakh have been captured. The crop survey has been completed for Kharif season 2024 and crop survey for Rabi season commenced from 01 November 2024. The data is captured using "e-Adangal" application. The "Tamil Nilam" application database maintains the details of land record and in turn handles all the transactions relating to Land Records in the State. The Tamil Nilam application is interfaced with the e-Adangal application to access the land details like Survey No., Sub-Division No., Total extent of land, Classification of land, Assessment of Land, Name of the Owner, etc.

3.6 Agriculture and Allied Activities - Prospects & Performance

3.6.1 Agriculture

During the year 2023-24, food grain production of 107 lakh MT has been achieved (Handbook of Statistics of Indian States 2023-24, RBI) amidst natural calamities like deficit rainfall during south-west monsoon, crop damage due to Michaung cyclone in northern districts and extremely heavy rainfall in southern districts during December 2024.

3.6.1.1 Initiatives of the State Government: GoTN presented exclusive Agriculture Budget with a total outlay of ₹42,281.88 crore (2024-25) covering Agriculture, Horticulture, Agricultural Engineering, Agri marketing Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Department of Sugar, Seed Certification, Organic Certification, Animal Husbandry, Fisheries, Cooperatives, Rural Development, Forestry, Water Resources, Dairy, etc. The budget is expected to trigger robust growth in agricultural sector of the state.

The following Priority Schemes are implemented by GoTN in Agriculture

1. Chief Minister's Mannuyir Kaathu Mannuyir Kaappom Scheme

In agriculture, there is a decrease in fertility of soil, due to mono cropping and cultivation of high nutrient exhaustive crops. Increased use of chemical fertilisers and pesticides to get high crop yields, has also reduced microbial population in soil, resulting in decline of soil health and fertility. If this situation persists, it will only leave barren soil for generations to come. Considering this situation, this Scheme is being implemented in the year 2024-25 with a financial allocation of ₹206 crore with 22 components to maintain soil health for supply of healthy food to the society and to protect the welfare of the people.

2. One Village One Crop Scheme

A new scheme "One Village - One Crop" scheme will be implemented in 15,280 revenue villages to bring about renaissance in rural areas. Awareness will be created among the farmers through organising demonstrations by choosing one crop per village with an area of 5-10 acre, covering the agricultural activities such as land preparation, use of high yielding variety seeds, seed treatment, sowing, integrated nutrient management for paddy and other important crops during 2024-25.

3. Tamil Nadu Millet Mission (Five Year Scheme)

Tamil Nadu Millet Mission will be implemented for a period of 5 years from 2023-24 to 2027-28 to increase the area and production of millets. The Tamil Nadu Millet Mission is continued with the financial outlay of ₹65 crore in the year 2024-25.

4. Alternative Crop Cultivation in Kuruvai season

This scheme has been implemented in an area of 50,463 acre with the financial outlay of ₹8.48 crore in order to promote the cultivation of less water requiring crops like millets, pulses and oilseeds as an alternative for paddy in Kar/ Kuruvai and Sornavari seasons. Under this scheme, 23,510 acre of millets, 21,158 acre of pulses, and 5,795 acre of oilseeds have been achieved and 43,341 farmers have benefited. As a result, the production of 9,404 MT of millets, 5,290 MT of pulses and 6,259 MT of oilseeds have been obtained.

5. Making Youth into Agri-Entrepreneurs

The scheme of Making Youth into Agri-Entrepreneurs is being implemented in the state since 2021-22 to encourage young agricultural graduates and create opportunities for establishing Agri based business. Under this scheme, financial assistance of ₹1 lakh is being extended to young Agriculture/Horticulture/Agri- Engineering graduates for establishing agri based

business. Financial assistance of ₹88 lakh was extended to 88 agriculture graduates during the year 2023-24.

3.6.1.2 Initiatives of NABARD

Special Refinance Schemes

1. Transformation of PACS as MSC

Primary Agricultural Cooperative Credit Societies (PACS) are grass root level Cooperative institutions primarily involved in meeting the credit requirement of the farmer members. There is a felt need to develop PACS as Multi Service Centres (MSC) for meeting credit plus requirements of the members and also to enable the societies to diversify their business and act as one stop shop for requirements of its members.

To develop PACS into MSC, a Special Refinance Scheme (SRS) was introduced by NABARD at concessional ROI of just 3% to StCBs for providing assistance to PACS through DCCBs. In Tamil Nadu TNStCB provided the concessional funding to PACS at 4% p.a through DCCBs. In convergence with GoI interest subvention scheme of Agri Infrastructure Fund (AIF) at PACS level the ROI was just 1% p.a. Further, NABARD provides for need based grant component of 10% of loan amount or ₹2.00 lakh whichever is lesser to eligible PACS towards managerial support, capacity building of members and PACS & brand promotion and market promotion.

Under the above scheme so far 4599 projects involving 2050 PACS with total project cost of ₹384.16 crore have been sanctioned in Tamil Nadu. Concessional refinance to the extent of ₹347.29 crore has been provided by NABARD. PACS under the scheme have been earning additional annual income in the range of ₹2 lakh to ₹16 lakh. Additional services undertaken by PACS include Custom Hiring Centres, godowns, mini oil mills, rural haats, mini food processing units, farmers markets, agri drones etc.

2. WASH Activities

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) aim to provide clean water and sanitation for all. Access to safe water, sanitation and hygienic conditions is essential to protect human health during infectious disease outbreaks, especially in the times of on-going COVID-19 pandemic. NABARD has launched a special refinance facility named 'WASH' to eligible FI for financing WASH activities like construction of toilets, construction of overhead tanks, setting up of biogas plant, rainwater harvesting structure etc. The financing of WASH activities is a "Thrust" area and will be eligible for 95% of eligible loan as refinance at a concessional rate.

3.6.2 Irrigation

Tamil Nadu state has limited water resources and the rainfall in the state is seasonal. In Tamil Nadu, 95% of the surface water and 80% of the ground water have already been put to use. Among the sources of irrigation, net area irrigated by tube wells, borewells and open wells is 63%, followed by canals is 23% and by tanks is 14% of total net area irrigated of 29.29 lakhs ha. There are about 90 reservoirs, 41,123 tanks and 18.40 lakh wells (including tube/bore wells) in the state.

Table 3.2: Water Source wise Net Area Irrigated 2022-23

Source of Irrigation	No.	Net Area Irrigated (Lakh Ha.)	% with reference to Net Area Irrigated
Canals	2,241	6.83	23.39
Tanks	41,123	3.99	13.66
TubeWells & Bore wells	3,71,084	5.42	18.56
Open wells	14,69,659	12.92	44.25
Others	45,129	0.04	0.14
Total		29.20	100

As per the National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources Of India, 2023 out of 313 taluks, 125 taluks have been categorized as safe, 56 taluks as semi-critical, 27 as critical, 100 as overexploited and 5 taluks as saline/ poor quality. State has 34 rivers, which have been grouped into 17 major river basins and 127 Sub-basins. The normal rainfall in the State is 922 mm. The total surface water potential of the State is 865 T.M.C.ft.

Construction of Artificial Recharge Structures such as Check Dams, Bed Dams, Sub surface Dykes, Recharge Shafts and Wells, Percolation Ponds etc., are being carried out to protect, harness and improve the available ground water resource of the State.

3.6.3 Horticulture and Plantation Crops

In Tamil Nadu, horticulture crops like fruits, vegetables, plantation crops, spices, medicinal and aromatic crops, and flowers are cultivated in an area of 16.03 lakh hectares with a total production of 233 lakh MT. In Tamil Nadu, the area and production of horticulture crops has increased by 3.32% and 4.35% respectively in 2023-24 when compared to previous year.

Table 3.3: Area, Production and Productivity of Horticulture crops

Sl. No.	Category	2022-23 (Final)			2023-24 (II Advance Estimate)		
		Area (Lakh Ha)	Production (Lakh MT)	Productivity (MT/Ha)	Area (Lakh Ha)	Production (Lakh MT)	Productivity (MT/Ha)
1	Fruit crops	3.34	74.43	22.31	3.34	75.29	22.52
2	Vegetable crops	3.62	91.96	25.38	3.63	92.36	25.46
3	Plantation	7.33	56.08	7.65	7.59	56.28	7.41
4	Spices & Condiments	1.16	3.31	2.84	1.11	3.30	2.97
5	Medicinal and Aromatic	0.14	1.43	10.14	0.16	1.68	10.52
6	Flower crops	0.44	5.87	13.29	0.47	6.31	13.55
	Total	16.03	233.08		16.30	235.22	13.55

(Source: Policy Note 2024-25, Agri - Farmers welfare Department, GoTN)

Table 3.4: Tamil Nadu - Position in Production of various Horticultural crops at National level

First	Second	Third
1. Clove	1. Cocoa	1. Coconut
2. Tamarind	2. Chrysanthemum	2. Aonla
3. Jasmine		3. Banana
4. Tuberose		4. Watermelon
5. Tapioca		5. Elephant foot yam

(Source: Final Estimates 2022-23, Horticulture Statistics Division, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, New Delhi)

To encourage the cultivation of high-income-generating horticultural crops, specific schemes are being implemented.

3.6.3.1 State Horticulture Development Scheme (SHDS)

State Horticulture Development scheme was implemented with 100% State Government contribution with an objective of increasing the area and production of Horticultural crops and enhance the farmers income. Under this scheme, the components such as area expansion of horticulture crops, hydroponics and vertical garden, protected cultivation, distribution of terrace garden kits & fruit plants kit, intercropping of vegetable with banana, tapioca and other perennial horticulture crops, integrated nutrient & pest management in betel vine, distribution of plastic crates, establishing low cost onion storage structures, establishing cottage mushroom units, establishing gardens in government educational institutions and orphanages, curry leaf cluster, jasmine mission, chilli zone and moringa mission were implemented.

i. Kalaigarin All Village Integrated Agriculture Development Programme – (KAVIADP)

The scheme has been implemented with horticulture-based components in 1,997 Villages at an outlay of ₹25.88 crore in 2021-22, 3,204 villages at an outlay of ₹28.81 crore in 2022- 23 and 2,504 villages at an outlay of ₹17.20 crore in 2023-24. The components such as promotion of vegetable cultivation for increasing the arrival of vegetables in the market, area expansion of perennial horticulture crops, distribution of fruit plant kits to attain nutritional self-sufficiency has been implemented under the scheme. Further, the schemes viz., Micro irrigation, National Horticulture Mission, National Agriculture Development Programme, Rainfed Area Development, State Horticulture Development Scheme, Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization Programme have also been dovetailed in the selected villages.

ii. Palmyrah Development Mission (PDM)

In this scheme, the components such as distribution of palmyrah seed nuts, distribution of palmyrah seedlings, value addition units for palmyrah value added products, distribution of palmyrah tree climbing equipment were implemented through the Department of Horticulture. Further, distribution of equipment for production of palmyrah value-added products along with training, providing equipment to women for making products from palmyrah leaves with training are being implemented by Tamil Nadu Palm Products Development Board.

iii. Integrated Horticulture Development in Dryland areas

During the year 2024-2025, ₹3.64 crore was allocated to provide subsidy to farmers to take up cultivation of drought tolerant and nutritious fruit crops like Fig, Manila, Tamarind, Amla, Wood apple, Ber, Dragon fruit, etc, creation of water harvesting structures, distribution of mulching sheets to ensure adequate moisture to plants by preventing evaporation. Intercropping in perennial crops is also encouraged under the scheme to provide additional income to farmers.

iv. Promotion of cultivation of Horticultural Crops

Cultivating horticultural crops in a conducive environment yields distinctively high-quality produce, resulting in favorable market prices eg., Kodaikanal Garlic, Ramanathapuram Mundu Chillies, Saathur Samba Chillies, Kolli Hill Pepper, Kanniyakumari Cinnamon, Theni Cardamom, Coimbatore Nutmeg and Cocoa which are widely preferred by consumers. Back-ended subsidy is being extended to those cultivating geo-tagged Mundu chillies. To encourage increased cultivation of these area-specific horticultural crops, quality planting materials will be provided at a subsidy.

v. Integrated Coconut Development Scheme

The area under coconut cultivation is increased by 10,000 acres along with intercropping by distributing seven lakh quality coconut seedlings at an outlay of ₹4.8 crore. Assistance is given for intercropping with banana upto five year old coconut gardens and nutmeg in well-developed coconut gardens. To meet the demand for coconut seedlings, assistance is extended for the establishment of coconut nurseries, upgradation of state coconut nurseries, rejuvenation of old coconut gardens and setting up of unit for conversion of coconut waste into organic manure. To increase the productivity of coconut and to motivate the farmers to adopt improved technologies, demonstrations will be made in farmers' fields and state coconut nurseries.

vi. Micro Irrigation Scheme

Micro Irrigation Scheme is being implemented to increase the area under cultivation and to increase the production and productivity through judicious use of irrigation water. In the past three years, an area of 6.91 lakh acres has been brought under Micro Irrigation at a cost of ₹2,114.32 crore benefitting 2.82 lakh farmers. During the year 2024-2025, Micro Irrigation systems will be installed in an area of 2.22 lakh acres benefitting of one lakh farmers. Focus will be given to critical and over exploited firkas in which the ground water is depleting rapidly.

vii. Installation of automated irrigation system in farmers field

Due to challenges in securing labour for agricultural activities, subsidy will be granted for the installation of automated irrigation systems, promoting the precise application of water directly to the plant's root zone as needed. An allocation of ₹25 crore will be made for this initiative in 2024-2025, to benefit 12,000 farmers.

viii. Special Scheme for Mukkani Development

Recognizing the universal appeal and nutritional value of the three fruits - mango, jackfruit, and banana (Mukkani), special schemes will be implemented to enhance the cultivation area and production, ensuring their availability to all. These initiatives are aimed at not only meeting the preferences of consumers but also at augmenting the income of farmers engaged in the cultivation of mangoes, jackfruits, and bananas. The interventions include establishment of Mango orchard, area expansion of banana and jackfruit, providing Good Agricultural Practices and Technical advice suited for export etc.

ix. Promotion of Medicinal plants cultivation

Recognizing the growing appreciation for traditional medicine and the increased demand for herbal crops, cultivation of medicinal crops such as Gloriosa, Senna, Periwinkle, and Coleus is supported covering an extent of 1,680 acres.

x. Integrated Cashew Development Programme:

Cashew is currently cultivated in an area spanning 2.07 lakh acres in Tamil Nadu, yielding approximately 43,500 MT of cashew nuts. Despite having processing facilities with a capacity of 4 lakh MT, only 10 per cent of cashew kernels are being produced within the State. To boost both the area and production of cashew, an allocation of ₹2.36 crore has been made. In addition, to emphasize the importance of using organic inputs in the production of high-quality cashew nuts demonstration unit are being setup in 2,470 acres.

xi. Promotion of Chilli Cultivation

During 2023, Prosopis has been successfully eradicated in an area covering 2,470 acres, and chillies have been cultivated in its place. In the year 2024-25, the eradication of Prosopis will continue in an additional area of 1,230 acres, and chillies will be cultivated to expand the area under chilli cultivation. This effort is focused on the identified Chilli cluster, which includes Ramanathapuram, Virudhunagar, Sivagangai, and Thoothukudi districts. Further, chilli cultivation will be promoted as a fallow crop, covering an area of 3,700 acres after the harvest of paddy and other cereals.

xii. Date palm cultivation

In Tamil Nadu, iron rich Date palm cultivation will be expanded in an area of 250 acres at an outlay of ₹30 lakh from Union and State Government funds.

xiii. Promotion of Permanent Pandal Cultivation

The establishment of a permanent pandal is crucial to enhance the production, productivity and quality of pandal vegetables like bitter gourd, snake gourd, ribbed gourd, bottle gourd etc., In the year 2024-25, a permanent pandal will be established in 770 acres, at an outlay of ₹9.40 crore.

xiv. Promotion of Traditional Vegetables

Recognizing the significance of traditional vegetables, an allocation of ₹2 crore will be made to facilitate cultivation of traditional vegetables in 2,470 acres.

xv. Production of Moringa during off-season

Even though Moringa is being cultivated in an area of 51,800 acres in Tamil Nadu, the supply of Moringa is low during the months between October and January. Covering the Moringa tree with a polythene sheet will prevent falling of leaves and flowers thereby ensuring production even during the off-season. This technology will be implemented on pilot basis in a small scale in State Horticulture farms.

3.6.4 Agriculture Marketing & Agriculture Business**3.6.4.1 Market Committees and Regulated Markets:**

In Tamil Nadu, 27 Market Committees have been established under which 284 Regulated Markets are functioning as per the provisions of Tamil Nadu Agricultural Produce Marketing (Regulation) Act 1987, and its Rules 1991. Further, the State has 27 market committees, 4995 food processing industries, 63 e-NAM Mandis, 225 rural markets, 410 Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) and 214 mandis. (Source: *Food Processing Towards Sustainable Growth Opportunities, MOFPI, 2023*). No fee is collected from farmers for the services

rendered. One per cent of the sale value of the produce is collected as market fee from traders. Besides, license fee is also collected from traders and weigh men. During 2023-24, 30.59 lakh MT of agricultural commodities were transacted, and ₹154.20 crore was collected as revenue.

To meet the immediate money requirement of farmers and to protect farmers from distress sale during glut seasons, pledge loan facility is extended to a maximum of ₹5 lakh per farmer with interest free period of 15 days and 5% interest is levied after that period. Traders can also avail pledge loan to a maximum of ₹2 lakh at 9% interest rate. During the year 2023-24, 1,505 farmers availed ₹35.80 crore and 260 traders availed ₹4.61 crore as pledge loan.

3.6.4.2 e-Negotiable Warehouse Receipt: To enable the farmers and traders to avail loans from scheduled commercial banks upto 80% of the value of their produce stored in the 150 Warehouse Development Regulatory Authority (WDRA) accredited storage godowns available in the Regulated Markets, eNegotiable Warehouse Receipt (e-NWR) are issued. So far, ₹77.58 crore has been sanctioned to 80 beneficiaries.

During 2024-25, action is being taken to get WDRA accreditation for additional 100 storage godowns.

3.6.4.3 e-National Agriculture Market (e-NAM): In Tamil Nadu, eNational Agriculture Market has been implemented in 157 Regulated Markets since October 2017 in a phased manner and online trading is being done. In eNAM markets, 219 agri commodities including coconut are traded. During 2023-24, 104.85 lakh numbers of coconut and 7.72 lakh MT of other agricultural produce to the value of ₹2,532 crore have been transacted in eNAM Markets and e-payment to a tune of ₹1,791 crore has been made through eNAM portal to 5.50 lakh farmers. To benefit the farmers by reducing transportation cost and post-harvest handling loss, farm gate trade has been promoted during 2023-24. So far, 33.41 lakh numbers of coconut and 26,383 MT of other agricultural produce to the value of ₹52.92 crore have been transacted through eNAM portal from the farm gate of 12,354 farmers.

In Tamil Nadu, out of 284 Regulated Markets, 157 Regulated Markets are linked to eNAM (55%).

3.6.5 Food and Agro-processing

Supply Chain Management project has been implemented to reduce the post harvest loss, to link the supply chain of the farmers with that of exporters, processors and consumers for an uninterrupted supply of fruits and vegetables of high quality to the consumers and to improve the income of the farmers. Under this scheme, in Phase-I, 64 primary processing centres have been established in 11 districts at a cost of ₹482.36 crore. These primary processing centres are equipped with post-harvest infrastructure like pack house, cold storage cum storage godowns, primary processing machineries for cleaning, sorting and packing have been established and are functioning. So far, 1.61 lakh MT of vegetables and fruits have been handled in these primary processing centres and 2.14 lakh farmers have benefited. The special infrastructures like Gamma Irradiation Unit, Individually Quick Freezing unit (IQF), Vapour Heat Treatment (VHT) plant and APEDA pack house have been established under this scheme in order to increase the shelf life and to improve the export quality of fruits and vegetables.

Under this scheme, in Phase II, 20 Primary processing Centres have been established in nine districts viz., Salem, Erode, Tiruvallur, Kancheepuram, Chengalpattu, Tiruvannamalai,

Cuddalore, Villupuram and Karur at a total financial outlay of ₹102.47 crore and action is being taken to operationalise all these Primary Processing Centres.

3.6.5.1 Establishment of Food Parks

Food Parks are being implemented to increase the income of farmers by reducing wastage of food products, value addition of farm products etc.,

i) A Mega Food Park is being developed in an extent of 50 acres at Gangaikondan, Tirunelveli District at a cost of ₹77 crore. In these, Industrial (Food) plots are being developed and leased out for long term to food processing investors.

ii) Small Food Parks in an area of 10 acres each with common infrastructure are being established at a project cost of ₹191.88 crore in seven Districts namely Cuddalore, Theni, Dindigul, Krishnagiri, Tiruvannamalai, Salem and Madurai.

Industrial (Food) plots are being developed in these food parks and action is being taken to lease out to food processing investors.

3.6.5.2 Initiatives of NABARD

Food Processing Fund (FPF): Tamil Nadu is a strong player in agro food processing industry and its share of Indian output is about 7 per cent. FPF has been established by GoI to provide impetus to the development of food processing sector. NABARD has so far sanctioned loan assistance of ₹439 crore under the fund for establishment food processing infrastructure.

3.6.6 Animal Husbandry

Animal husbandry stands as a cornerstone of agriculture, sustaining over two-thirds of Tamil Nadu's rural population. This sector is not just a source of livelihood; it acts as a robust contributor to the rural economy, elevating the economic status of small and marginal farmers, as well as landless agricultural labourers. The rapid expansion of animal husbandry in the state has proven pivotal, providing gainful employment and economic stability. The economic interdependence of crop and livestock sectors is a key consideration in Tamil Nadu's agricultural landscape.

3.6.6.1 Status of the sector

The contribution of livestock sector to the Gross Domestic Product (GDP) is immense. During 2022-23, the Gross State Value Added (GSVA) in Livestock Sector was ₹1,23,822 crore at current prices (Advance Estimate). Livestock sector contributes about 5.69% to GSVA of the State and 45.32% to agriculture and allied activities.

Table 3.5: Livestock and Poultry Population (As per the 20th Livestock Census in State)

Species	Population (In lakh Nos.)
Cattle	95.19
Buffalo	5.19
Sheep	45.00
Goat	98.88
Pigs	0.67
Others (Horses, Ponies, Mules, Donkeys and Camel)	0.07
Total Livestock	245.00
Fowls and other birds (Farm)	995.16
Fowls and other birds (backyard poultry)	212.64
Total Poultry	1,207.80

3.6.6.2 Animal Husbandry – Dairy:

The cattle population in Tamil Nadu rose to 95.19 lakh from 88.14 lakh between 19th and 20th Livestock census periods. During 2023-24, milk production in Tamil Nadu is 10.80 MT, contributing a share of 4.52% of total milk production in the country. The milk production in Tamil Nadu in 2023-24 has increased by 6.93% as compared to 2022-23. The per capita availability of milk in India increased to 471 gram per day in 2023-24 from 459 gram per day in 2022-23. In Tamil Nadu, the per capita availability of milk has increased from 369 grams per day in 2022-23 to 384 grams per day during 2023-24. (Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2024, MoFAHD, GoI)

The state is endowed with native breeds of cattle such as Kangeyam (Tiruppur, Erode, Coimbatore and Karur districts), Umbalachery (Thanjavur, Tiruvarur, Nagapattinam and Cuddalore districts), Alambadi (Dharmapuri, Erode and Salem districts), Pulikulam (Sivagangai, Madurai, Dindigul and Theni districts), Bargur (Erode district), Toda buffaloes (The Nilgiris district). Apart from these native cattle breeds, high milk yielding cross bred of Jersey (in plains) and Holstein Friesian (in hills) are being reared extensively by farmers.

3.6.6.3 Animal Husbandry – Poultry:

The Potential in the sector is due to a combination of factors - growth in per capita income, a growing urban population and falling real poultry prices. Poultry sector in India can be broadly divided into two sub-sectors – one with a highly organized commercial sector with about 80% of the total market share and the other being unorganized with about 20% of the total market share.

Poultry farming has undergone a transformation from being mere backyard avocation to the present vibrant and dynamic commercial enterprise in Tamil Nadu. Poultry rearing is a commercial activity prominent in the districts of Namakkal, Salem, Erode and Coimbatore. Namakkal belt continues to be the egg basket of the State contributing around 65% of the total egg production. The State ranks 1st in respect of poultry with 120.78 million poultry and ranks second in egg production, 21560.66 Million number of eggs. The per capita availability of egg is 281 nos./year against the ICMR recommendations of 180 nos. of eggs/year.

3.6.6.4 Animal Husbandry – Sheep, Goat and Piggery:

Tamil Nadu has 4.50 million sheep, 9.89 million goats and 0.07 million pigs. The State ranks 4th in sheep and 7th in goat population in the country. The population of goats has increased to 98.89 lakh from 81.43 lakh during this period. The total meat production in India in 2021-22 was 9.29 million tonnes with contribution of poultry meat by 51.44%. Tamil Nadu produced 0.69 million tonnes of meat in 2021-22 with the share of 7.38% in total meat production and ranks sixth in the nation. The State possesses the native breeds of sheep such as Mecheri (Salem and Erode districts), Ramnad White (Thoothukudi and Ramanathapuram districts), Madras Red (Chennai, Kancheepuram and Tiruvallur districts), Kilakaraisal (Ramanathapuram, Virudhunagar, Madurai and Dindigul districts), Vembur (Thoothukudi district), Tiruchi Black (Perambalur, Ariyalur, Tiruchirappalli and Villupuram districts), Coimbatore (Coimbatore and Tiruppur districts) and Nilgiri (The Nilgiris district). Native goat breeds of Tamil Nadu are Kanni Adu (Virudhunagar, Thoothukudi and Tirunelveli districts), Kodi Adu (Thoothukudi and Tirunelveli districts) and Salem Black (Salem, Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri districts). Tamil Nadu has 245 lakh of various major species of animal heads, besides 1207.80 lakh poultry (2019 census).

3.6.6.5 Schemes implemented by the state department of AH:

Specialized Veterinary Health Care and Awareness Camp, Awareness creation on balanced feeding, Fodder Demonstration Programme in Farmers Field, Commercial fodder production, Rejuvenation of Meikkal / Grazing land on Scientific lines, Promoting alternate fodder (Azolla), Promoting alternate fodder production techniques (Hydroponics), fodder preservation/ conservation activities under National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA), creation of women entrepreneurship, Scheme for Establishing Small Scale Native chicken farm units (250 birds / unit) in Rural Areas, Establishment of Silage Making units, Fodder Development in Departmental Farms, Innovative Poultry Productivity project for Low Input Technology birds and broilers and Entrepreneurship Development through Native Chicken Rearing.

Major challenges of animal husbandry sector are breed improvement while preserving diverse genetic resources, shortage of feed and fodder, effective control of animal diseases and dissemination of technology, skills and quality services to farmers for improving productivity, which need to be addressed on priority basis. Further, improving the access of small livestock holders to efficient markets is necessary for fast tracking growth of the livestock sector.

Government of Tamil Nadu is addressing all the challenges of this sector through the following policy initiatives such as Investing for better lives through livestock, Feed and fodder supply, Expanding commercial and backyard poultry production systems, Improving animal health care delivery system, Improving animal breeding infrastructure, Investing in Human Resources development and R&D for sustainability and Maintaining ecology, environment and wildlife.

3.6.6.6 Schemes implemented by GOI

1 National Livestock Mission:

The focus of the scheme is on entrepreneurship development and breed improvement in poultry, sheep, goat and piggery including feed and fodder development. The scheme is implemented with the following three Sub-Missions:

- i. **Sub-Mission on Breed Development of Livestock & Poultry:** The sub-mission proposes to bring sharp focus on entrepreneurship development and breed improvement in poultry, sheep, goat and piggery by providing the incentivization to the individual, FPOs, SHGs, Section 8 companies for entrepreneurship development and also to the State Government for breed improvement infrastructure.
- ii. **Sub-Mission on Feed and Fodder development:** This sub-mission aims towards strengthening of fodder seed chain to improve availability of certified fodder seed required for fodder production and encouraging entrepreneurs for establishment of fodder Block/Hey Bailing/Silage Making Units through incentivisation.
- iii. **Sub-Mission on Extension and Innovation:** The sub-mission aims to incentivize the Institutes, Universities, Organizations carrying out research and development related to sheep, goat, pig and feed and fodder sector, extension activities, livestock insurance and innovation.

2 Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF)

The Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF) has been approved for incentivising investments by individual entrepreneurs, private companies, MSME, Farmer Producers Organization (FPOs) and Section 8 companies to establish the infrastructure. The projects under the AHIDF shall be eligible for loan upto 90% of the estimated / actual project cost from the scheduled bank based on submission of viable projects by eligible beneficiaries. The beneficiary contribution in case of micro and small units as per MSME ceiling, beneficiary contribution could go up to 15%. The beneficiary contribution in other categories of enterprises could go up to 25%. Interest subvention of 3% is available for all eligible entities. The guarantee coverage would be up to 25 % of the credit facility of the borrower.

3.Support to State Dairy Cooperative & Farmers Producers Organization (SDCFPO): Under the scheme one time support in the form of Interest subvention on working capital loans has been introduced from the financial year 2020-21. “Supporting Dairy Cooperatives and Farmer Producer Organizations engaged in dairy activities” was approved to provide working capital loan to State Cooperatives and Federations. The objectives of the scheme are as under:

- To assist the State Dairy Cooperative Federations by providing soft working capital loan to tide over the crisis on account of severely adverse market conditions or natural calamities.
- To provide stable market access to dairy farmers.
- To enable State Cooperative Dairy Federations to continue to make timely payments of dues to the farmers.
- To enable the cooperatives to procure milk at a remunerative price from the farmers, even during the flush season.
- The interest subvention component is being implemented by the Department through NDDDB. The scheme provides for interest subvention of 2% p.a. on working capital loans availed by the eligible Participating Agencies (PAs) from banks and financial institutions. For prompt and timely repayment, additional interest subvention of 2% p.a will be payable at the end of the loan repayment period. The products covered under the scheme for availing working capital loans are Skimmed Milk Powder (SMP), Whole Milk Powder (WMP), White Butter and Ghee

4. Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) was launched in December 2014 with an outlay of ₹2025 crore for development and conservation of indigenous breeds through selective breeding in the breeding tract and genetic upgradation of nondescript bovine population. The scheme comprises of two components namely National Programme for Bovine Breeding

(NPBB) and National Mission on Bovine Productivity (NMBP). Rashtriya Gokul Mission is to promote establishment of breed multiplication farm on hub and spoke model. Under the scheme 50% capital subsidy is available for eligible entrepreneurs (Individual/SHGs/ FCO/ FPO/ JLGs and section 8 companies).

3.6.6.7 Role of NABARD in AH sector in Tamil Nadu

NABARD is supporting the development of AH in the state through various interventions.

1. Infrastructure Creation

- i. NABARD as on 31.12.2024 sanctioned an amount of ₹1497.41 crore for 3326 projects and released ₹1235.64 crore under Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF) for construction of Veterinary dispensaries, milk processing units and for establishment of Advanced Institute for Integrated Research on Livestock and Animal Sciences.
- ii. Apart from RIDF, NABARD has sanctioned ₹303 crore under Dairy Processing Infrastructure Development Fund (DIDF) to National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) for on-lending to Salem, Thanjavur, Tiruchirapalli and other Milk Cooperative Unions of TCMPF in Tamil Nadu. Under DIDF NABARD has sanctioned ₹246 crore to National Co-operative Development Corporation for on-lending to Theni, Thoothukudi and other Milk Co-operative Unions of TCMPF in Tamil Nadu.

3.6.7 Fisheries

Tamil Nadu is a leading State with Marine, Inland and Coastal waters with rich biodiversity of aquatic fauna and flora. The sector plays an important role in the socio - economic development of the state by providing livelihood to a large number of fishers and fish farmers, generating employment opportunities in allied sectors and ensuring nutritional security. During 2022-23, the sector contributed 6.26% to the State's agricultural GDP. Tamil Nadu stands at 5th in marine fish production in the country with a total fish production of 8.29 lakh tonnes. The fisheries sector contributed ₹6,957.67 crore to foreign exchange earnings by exporting 1.23 lakh tonnes of fish and related products during the period (Fisheries Policy Note 2024-25).

3.6.7.1 Marine Fisheries:

Tamil Nadu has a coastal length of 1,076 km spread across 14 coastal districts and 41,412 sq.km of continental shelf area with an Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) of 1.9 lakh sq. Km. This supports the livelihood of 10.48 lakh marine fishers living in 608 Fishing villages. There are 5440 mechanized and 44,487 traditional fishing crafts actively engaged in fishing. Further, promotion of mariculture enables the fisher folk to switch over from the concept of only capturing the marine resources to diversification into stocking and harvesting. (Fisheries Policy Note 2024-25).

3.6.7.2 Inland Fisheries:

Tamil Nadu possesses 3.86 lakh ha effective inland water resources comprising reservoirs, major irrigation tanks, minor irrigation tanks, short seasonal tanks, ponds, rivers, backwaters and other water bodies. The inland fisheries sector supports the livelihood of 2.36 lakh inland fishers of the State. (Fisheries Policy Note 2024-25).

3.6.7.3 Recent initiatives of the State Government:

- Providing 50% subsidy to procure new Tuna Long liner-cum-Gill netter boats to support the fishers to harvest the relatively underexploited oceanic fishery resources like Tuna and

Tuna-like fishes. Under this scheme, 50% of the estimated unit cost of ₹60 lakh or up to a maximum of ₹30 lakh is provided as subsidy for construction of new Tuna Long liner-cum-Gill netter boat.

- The native species of the State are often having high demand as they are considered as local delicacies and has immense health benefits. To address the huge demand for native fish species such as Pearl spot, Calbasu and Cauvery carp, 79 native fish species hatcheries are established in 3 Districts viz., Salem, Thanjavur and Cuddalore at a total cost of Rs 4.40 crore. New native fish hatcheries viz., Pearl spot hatchery at Parangipettai in Cuddalore district, Calbasu hatchery at Agarapettai in Thanjavur district and Sel carp hatchery at Mettur in Salem district are being established.
- The Government have accorded administrative sanction to the tune of ₹3249 lakhs from 2021-22 to 2023-24 for the development of various inland fisheries development schemes in Tamil Nadu under Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) and the schemes are under implementation.
- The State has set up a Marine Finfish Seed Rearing Centre at Mandapam in Ramanathapuram District to supply fish seeds to the marine cage culture. This unit has produced 83,000 marine finfish seeds.
- Tamil Nadu is the top producer of seaweeds in India and the Government promotes the seaweed farming as an alternative livelihood activity for fisher folk. Empowerment of fisherwomen through seaweed culture in Tamil Nadu is being done by the Government. A total sum of ₹2.43 crore has been provided to 1,956 coastal fisher women for procurement of 16,000 monoline and rafts for seaweed cultivation. Government has decided to establish Multipurpose Seaweed Park in Tamil Nadu at a total cost estimate of ₹127.71 crore. Under this flagship project, an appropriate full-fledged infrastructure facility for holistic development of seaweed farming and value addition of seaweed will be created in Hub-I and Hub-II facilities in Ramanathapuram and Pudukkottai districts respectively. The preliminary construction works of the project in Hub-I facilities at Ramanathapuram is under process.
- Tamil Nadu has established Genetically Improved Farmed Tilapia (GIFT) hatchery in Government fish farm, Krishnagiri, with a capacity to produce 25 Lakh GIFT seeds every year.
- Tamil Nadu is the second largest exporter of ornamental fish in the country. To promote ornamental fish culture and to generate employment, a pilot project on “Development of Ornamental Fisheries in Tamil Nadu” has been taken up in the State with a total project outlay of ₹4.70 crore with an eligible subsidy of ₹2.25 crore comprising Central share of ₹1.50 crore and State share of ₹0.75 crore.

3.6.7.4 Initiatives of NABARD

NABARD has been supporting infrastructure and other developmental activities in this sector under RIDF as well as FIDF. The details of the same are as under:

1. Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF)

NABARD as on 31.12.2024 sanctioned an amount of ₹1939.36 crore for 174 projects and released ₹1500 crore under Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF) for construction of fishing harbours, jetties and inland fisheries.

2. Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF)

The objectives of this GoI scheme is creation and modernization of fisheries infrastructure in the coastal districts. The Scheme is in operation till 31 March 2026. A total of 64 projects are sanctioned for Tamil Nadu with an FIDF loan of ₹ 1314.73 crore, of which ₹ 916.49 crore has been utilized as on 31 Dec 2024.

3.6.8 Agro Forestry

In consonance with National Forest Policy, the Tamil Nadu Government fully recognizes the challenges and has formulated its State Forest Policy 2018 with specific emphasis on the following principles:

- Nurturing a rich heritage and preserving ecology of distinct geographical characteristics of the State;
- Enhancing the forest and tree cover;
- Enriching wildlife habitats on scientific principles, without sacrificing the livelihood needs of the local communities specially the tribal communities and the other forest dwellers.

"Sub-mission on Agro forestry (SMAF)" under National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA)

The Tamil Nadu Forest Department is the Nodal department to implement the Agro forestry scheme in Tamil Nadu for the projects under the mission ([http:// agricoop.nic.in /sites/default/files/GUD2482016.pdf](http://agricoop.nic.in/sites/default/files/GUD2482016.pdf))

- To encourage and expand tree plantation
- To Create rural livelihoods, especially for the small farmer
- To ensure availability of quality planting material
- To popularize various Agroforestry practices/models suitable to agro ecological regions and land use conditions.
- To create database, information and knowledge support in the area of agroforestry.
- To provide extension and capacity building support to agroforestry sector.

Interventions under the Mission are: -

- Nursery Development for quality planting material (NDQPM)
- Peripheral and Boundary Plantation (PBP)
- Low Density Plantation on Farm Lands (LDPFL)
- High Density Block Plantation (HDBP)
- Demonstration of Agroforestry Models
- Capacity Building & Trainings

The department has established 3 corporations viz., Tamil Nadu Forest Plantation Corporation Limited (TAF CORN), Tamil Nadu Tea Plantation Corporation Limited (TANTEA) and Arasu Rubber Corporation Limited (ARC) to raise, maintain and harvest eucalyptus trees for pulpwood and production of cashew nuts, tea & rubber.

Restructured Bamboo Mission is being implemented to increase the area under bamboo plantations and to promote the entire value chain of bamboo from raising seedlings to value added products making. About 19% of the recorded forest area is under bamboo trees.

Forest College and Research Institute (FC&RI) a constituent college of Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU) has set up Mettupalayam Agroforestry Business Incubation Forum (MAFBIF) with funding support from Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute, Govt. of Tamil Nadu (EDII TN), to promote entrepreneurship in the fields of timber

and non-timber forest products, post-harvest technology, food processing, agro waste management & IT/ AI tools for agroforestry by providing guidance on technology, its validation, licensing and commercialization.

Paper industries such as Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Limited (TNPL), Seshasayee Paper and Boards Limited, etc. are having contract farming practices wherein they supply seedlings to farmers and also offer consultancy for raising eucalyptus and casuarina plantations. The wood is bought back by them at fixed price.

3.6.9 Climate Change – Adaptation and Mitigation

Climate Change is an undisputed reality causing severe impact on the natural environment, human lives, economic assets and activities thus posing an urgent need for comprehensive climate action. GoTN places significant importance on addressing climate change, recognizing it as a major challenge that threatens the state's environmental, economic, and social well-being. The state has adopted a proactive approach to mitigate and adapt to the impacts of climate change through various policies, plans, and initiatives.

3.6.9.1 Tamil Nadu State Action Plan on Climate Change (TNSAPCC):

The TNSAPCC, launched in 2015, is a comprehensive framework. It provided the first State-wide and cross sectoral climate change impact and vulnerability assessment. The plan also formulated a range of adaptation and mitigation strategies to be implemented by various Departments, showcasing the state's commitment to combat climate change. To reiterate its commitment to addressing the critical issue of climate change, the GoTN has prepared the second edition of the State Action Plan on Climate Change (TNSAPCC 2.0) for the years 2022-2030.

The action plan has identified the following eleven vulnerable sectors, viz.,

1. Sustainable Agriculture & Allied Sectors
2. Water Resources
3. Forests & Biodiversity
4. Coastal Area Management
5. Strategic Knowledge and Climate Literacy
6. Children and Youth for Climate Action
7. Disaster Management and Mitigation
8. Health and Sanitation
9. Sustainable Habitat
10. Enhanced Energy Efficiency & Solar Mission
11. Gender and Climate Change

3.6.9.2 District Climate Change Mission (DCCM):

For the first time in the Country, the GoTN has set up DCCM with the District Collector as the Mission Director and the District Forest Officer as the District Climate Officer to strengthen the climate response at the grassroots level. The objectives of the DCCM are to:

- 1) work with all Departments at the District level in line with the State Action Plan.
- 2) closely associate itself with the Project Management Unit of the Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC).

- 3) coordinate with the activities of the Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission in developing Climate Smart Villages, Climate Resilient Green Temples, Green Schools, Creation of Bio-shield, Blue Flag Beach, Sustainable Habitat, Carbon enrichment programme and Waste to energy power generation.
- 4) conduct District Stakeholder workshops on integrating Climate Change adaptation and mitigation at the grassroots level to enhance development planning.

3.6.9.3 Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC):

The State Government has set up TNGCC to implement the three key Missions of the Government of Tamil Nadu, viz.,

1. Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission (TNCCM): The objective of this mission to embark on Climate Change adaptation and mitigation activities.

2. Green Tamil Nadu Mission (GTNM): The State plans to augment the national efforts in creating the additional carbon sink of 2.5 to 3 billion tonnes in its forest and tree cover by the year 2030 as a part of its Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) commitments under the Paris Agreement by adopting (i) Forest land restoration by encouraging planting of indigenous/native species and (ii) Increasing Tree cover outside conventional forests for climate change adaptation and mitigation.

3. Tamil Nadu Wetlands Mission (TNWM): Wetlands being an important Carbon and Methane sink has the potential for reversing the global warming related climate vulnerabilities and risk to the environment and human lives. The objective of this mission is ecological restoration of wetlands in Tamil Nadu.

The Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC) has setup a specialized Project Management Unit (PMU) for coordinating and monitoring project activities under all the three Missions in partnership with the Tamil Nadu Infrastructure Fund Management Corporation Limited (TNIFMC).

3.6.9.4 Initiatives of NABARD

In Tamil Nadu & Puducherry the following 3 NAFCC projects have been sanctioned with the total grant sanction amounting to ₹65 crore.

1. Management and Rehabilitation of Coastal Habitats and Biodiversity for Climate Change Adaptation and Sustainable Livelihoods in Gulf of Mannar
2. Integrated Surface Water Management through rejuvenation of 20 tanks and 32 village ponds for Climate Change adaptation in Puducherry
3. Climate Proofing of Rainfed Watersheds in Salem and Virudhunagar districts of Tamil Nadu

3.7 MSMEs in Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu is one of the most industrialised State in the country with the highest number of factories – 15% of India's total (Invest India, GoI). Tamil Nadu also ranks third in total exports in the country, with USD 46.46 billion offering significant market potential for businesses. The MSMEs of Tamil Nadu are a key contributor to the State's economy and to Tamil Nadu's vision of becoming one Trillion USD economy. With over 25 lakh Udyam registrations, Tamil Nadu is the 2nd in the country in Udyam registrations (Ministry of MSMEs, GoI). 26% of Tamil Nadu's entrepreneurs are women which is a testimony to the State's inclusive growth and conducive business environment.

Table 3.6: Distribution of MSMEs across categories, according to Udyam as of 31st May 2024

Category	No of MSMEs	Percentage
Micro	24,52,052	97.80%
Small	51,022	2.03%
Medium	4,388	0.17%
Total	25,07,462	100%

The growth of MSMEs in Tamil Nadu can be attributed to both the industrious entrepreneurs and workforce in the State, as well as the progressive development policies adopted by the GoTN. These policies have also helped sustain the targets under the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

3.7.1 Agencies for MSME in Tamil Nadu: The following agencies play a major role in creating an enabling environment for the development of MSMEs in the State:

1. Tamil Nadu Small Industries Development Corporation Limited(TANSIDCO): Establishes and maintains Industrial Estates and provide industrial plots and sheds for MSMEs, promotes Industrial Clusters and Common Facility Centres (CFCs), contruction of workers' hostels for the benefit of workers.. It as establishes Plug and Play facilities as per the present requirements of business.

2. Tamil Nadu Small Industries Corporation Limited (TANSI)

Manufactures and supplies wooden and steel furniture to State Government Departments and their organisations, provides good quality furniture to the open market at affordable cost.

3. Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute – Tamil Nadu (EDII–TN)

Promotes entrepreneurship education and self-employment across the State and innovation among school and college students.

4. Bureau for Facilitating MSMEs of Tamil Nadu (FaMeTN)

Facilitates MSMEs for access to credit, markets - domestic and international, investment, skilling, sustainability and sector specific initiatives.

5. Tamil Nadu Startup and Innovation Mission (TANSIM – StartupTN)

Provides an enabling ecosystem for startups in the State, facilitates financial support to startups & incubators and balanced growth of the startup ecosystem. It also links startups with mentors to benefit.

6. Tamil Nadu Coir Business Development Corporation (TANCOIR)

Promotes and develops the coir sector, encourages developing new Coir products thereby creating market for Coir products so as to attract the Coir market in India and abroad. Facilitates schemes and other financial support for coir MSMEs in Tamil Nadu.

7. Tamil Nadu Food Processing and Agriculture Export Promotion Corporation (TNAPEX)

Promotes agro processing sector in Tamil Nadu. It also develops and implements initiatives for the promotion of value-added agricultural products such as processed foods, beverages, and extracts.

3.7.2 Skill India Scheme related to agriculture and non-agriculture

3.7.2.1 Skill Development

The objective of the National Policy on Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, 2015 is to meet the challenge of skilling with speed and standard (quality). It aims to provide an umbrella framework to all skilled activities being carried out within the country, to align them to common standards and link the skilling with demand centres. The objective of this skill certification and reward scheme is to enable and mobilize a large number of Indian youths to take up outcome-based skill training and become employable and earn their livelihood.

Under Skill India Mission, Skill Development Ministry is implementing Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) 2016-20 to impart Short Term Training (STT) and Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) on pan-India basis including State of Tamil Nadu covering all districts.

The Make in India Programme is designed to facilitate investment, foster innovation, protect intellectual property and build best-in-class manufacturing infrastructure. The Skill India Programme complements the Make in India Programme of the GoI.

3.7.2.2 Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation

Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation is the State Nodal Agency for Skill Development whose vision is to transform the state into skill hub by skilling the youth to enhance their employability and match the expectations of the Industry. The agency implements the following State and Central Government Schemes:

1. Short Term Skill Training (STT)

TNSDC actively collaborates with Government Agencies, reputed private skill training institutions and industry partners to impart industry oriented and placement linked skill training. Under this scheme candidates can register in TNSDC portal for free training offered by TNSDC. Trainees will be assessed & certified by State Council for Vocational Training (SCVT)/ Sector Skill Council (SSC) or any other reputed agency as decided by TNSDC.

2. Skill Certification Under Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning commonly known as RPL refers to an assessment process used to evaluate a person's existing skill sets, knowledge and experience gained either by formal, non-formal or informal learning. It aims to align the competencies of the un-regulated workforce of the country to the standardized National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF).

3. MSME Skill Training and Employment Scheme

In order to ensure supply of quality workforce to the MSME sector, candidates were given intensive training under MSME Skill Training and Employment Scheme in the MSME units for which a monthly stipend of ₹2000/- per candidate is being paid by TNSDC.

4. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) 2.0

TNSDC implements the Centrally Sponsored State Managed (CSSM) component of PMKVY-2.0. The scheme is being implemented from March 2018 onwards through 160 approved Training Partners and 385 Training Centres. As on December 2019, a total number of 41,991 candidates have been enrolled out of which 39,150 candidates have completed the training.

5. Skills Acquisition and Knowledge Awareness for Livelihood Promotion (SANKALP)

SANKALP project aims to implement the mandate of the National Skill Development Mission (NSDM), which was launched by Ministry of Skill Development Entrepreneurship, through its core sub-missions. The project will be implemented in mission mode through World Bank support and is aligned with the overall objectives of the NSDM. To identify skill challenges of aspirational districts under SANKALP projects are sanctioned to aspirational Districts (i.e. Virudhunagar and Ramanathapuram). Various system strengthening and inclusion activities have been planned under this scheme.

3.8 Off Farm Sector

3.8.1 Off Farm Sector Projects in DPR mode

DPR involves the formulation of location specific developmental projects in the off-farm sector aimed at mainstreaming holistic, and financially sustainable livelihood solutions by targeting input supply, technology up gradation, credit, environmental issues, market support, etc., leading to promotion of viable off-farm enterprises, sustainable employment, increased productivity and improved flow of and access to credit.

Box 3.1 Sustaining Nature and Nurturing Lives: A Tribal Eco-Tourism Success in Arepalayam

Under the "My District My Project" (MDMP) scheme, a Tribal Community-Driven Sustainable Eco-Tourism Initiative was implemented by ICAR KVK MYRADA from 2022 to 2024 to benefit 150 Sholigar tribal households in Arepalayam village, Thalavadi block, Erode district, Tamil Nadu. Supported by



a grant of ₹25 lakhs under Grama Vikas Nidhi, the project aimed to enhance livelihoods through eco-tourism. Prior to the intervention, the area, declared a tiger reserve in 2011, lacked livelihood opportunities and exposure for marketing tribal products, despite its potential for income generation. Key challenges included integrating eco-tourism with local livelihoods and addressing the tribal community's lack of awareness and reluctance to participate in skill development programs. The project successfully established a common facility center, rural mart, and eco-tourism infrastructure, including an SHG kitchen, a tribal hut for tourists, nurseries, vermicompost units, and biofloc



models. It also provided training in utilizing invasive Lantana camara for low-cost furniture and handicrafts. The initiative promoted forest-based produce, enhanced skills in herbal processing, minor forest produce (MFP) collection, and value addition, while fostering sustainable employment and entrepreneurship. By combining eco-tourism with cultural preservation, the project created year-round

economic opportunities, empowering the tribal community and ensuring environmental sustainability.

Tamil Nadu RO has so far sanctioned grant assistance to the tune of ₹184.08 lakh to 07 districts namely Cuddalore, Erode, Trichy, Madurai, Virudhunagar, Sivagangai and Ramanathapuram.

During 2023-24 under DPR Mode the RO sanctioned grant assistance for Projects titled “Click Rameswaram” in Rameshwaram district, “Mobile Food Truck for Transgenders” in Sivagangai district and “Establishment of Millet Based Food Processing Micro Enterprise” in Ramanathapuram District.

3.8.2 Off Farm Producers Organization (OFPO)

NABARD has been supporting promotion and nurturing of Off-farm activities in the areas of Handloom/ Powerloom weavers, Jute, Coir, Food processing and other Micro enterprises. NABARD has so far sanctioned grant assistance to the tune of **₹186.38 lakh** for formation and nurturing of **04 major OFPOs** viz., Navasaarigai OFPO in Tiruvannamalai district, Aruppukottai Vastra in Virudhunagar district. Kanjamalai OFPO in Salem district & Green Fem OFPO in Madurai district.

Grant Assistance of ₹46.36 lakh was released during 2023-24 under the scheme to these ongoing OFPOs.

Box 3.2 Weaving Prosperity: Revitalized Silk Handloom Weaving by Navasaarigai OFPO

The Navasaarigai Silk Handloom Weaver Producer Company Limited was established in Tiruvannamalai district, Tamil Nadu, under Gramiya Vikas Nidhi scheme benefiting 553 weavers from the Devigapuram and Nedugunam villages. Implemented by the Rural Education and Development Society over three years, the project received ₹94.31 lakh from NABARD's Off-Farm Development Department for constructing a Common Facility Center (CFC), providing training, and managing the Off-Farm Producer Organization (OFPO). Additionally, NABKISAN extended a loan of ₹13 lakh. Marketing support included participation in NABARD expos, onboarding to ONDC platforms, and e-commerce platforms like Amazon, Flipkart, and Pinterest. Prior to the intervention, weavers operated on a wage model, earning an average of ₹5,000 per saree with only 6–7 months of work annually. Challenges such as health issues (e.g., varicose veins, cataracts), migration of younger generations, limited storage facilities, inadequate access to technology, financial constraints, and lack of market insights were prevalent. The initiative eliminated middlemen, increasing weavers' income by 10–20%. For instance, weavers who previously earned ₹1,000 per saree now earn ₹1,100–₹1,200 through the Navasaarigai OFPO. This intervention enhanced income, provided year-round employment, and ensured better working conditions for the weaving community.



3.8.3 Skill Development

To improve the chances of employment amongst the rural youth new job-oriented Skill Development Programmes such as Field technician - Computing & Peripherals, Sewing Machine operator - knitting, Medical Lab Technician, Home health Aide etc. were sanctioned. New activities like Food processing, Plumbing and Sanitary work, Micro-finance management, Mat weaving, Handicrafts making from Banana Stem waste, Making Native snacks of TN, Industry-oriented PHP programming, Entrepreneurship in Multiple SDPs for differently

abled candidates, training programmes for widows etc. were also sanctioned.

Box 3.3 Transforming Lives: Empowering Women in Tirunelveli through Wig-Making Training

The Wig Making Training program, implemented by the Adyar Cancer Institute, aimed to empower 60 women in Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu, by providing them with skill development in wig-making. This 4-month program was supported by NABARD with an amount of ₹15 lakh and targeted women from the villages of Mukkudal, Anandhanadarpatti, and Pananjad in the Pappakudi block. Prior to the training, these women were involved in beedi rolling, a low-income and health-risk



occupation linked to cancer. The training offered an alternative livelihood, reducing their dependence on beedi rolling. Despite initial challenges in convincing women to shift to wig-making due to taboos surrounding hair work and concerns about income loss, the program ultimately led to a positive change. The women transitioned to wig-making, now earning a stable income, which has helped improve their financial independence and reduced their health risks.

32 Skill development programmes for providing training to 925 rural youth were supported with total financial sanction of Rs 160.54 lakh during 2023-24. The 20 agencies supported included RSETIs, NGOs and CSR partners. An amount of ₹ 148.24 lakh was disbursed in 2023-24 and ₹71 lakh was disbursed in 2024-2025 (up to 31.12.2024) for Skill development programmes.

An amount of ₹ 23.82 lakh was sanctioned to Rural Training Centre, Karaikudi for conduct of skill development training programmes including administrative cost, during the financial year 2023-24.

Box 3.4 Driving Change: Empowering Youth Through Automotive Skill Development

The 92-day training initiative for 30 candidates from economically backward communities in Vellore district, Tamil Nadu was conducted by J K Fenner India Ltd. under the Skill Development Programme with a grant assistance of ₹6.87 lakh. The programme provided comprehensive hands-on training in two- and three-wheeler servicing, targeting school/college dropouts, unemployed youth, and daily wage workers with no stable income. Despite the challenges in identifying deserving



candidates and securing placement tie-ups, the programme achieved significant outcomes. Placement support was provided to all participants, with 24 candidates securing jobs in reputed companies like Khivraj Motors, Royal Enfield, and TVS. As a result, the trainees, who were previously unemployed or dependent on inconsistent wages, now earning stable monthly incomes ranging from ₹12,000 to ₹25,000, meeting the growing demand for automotive service technicians in and around Chennai. This initiative successfully transformed the participants' economic conditions, providing them with sustainable livelihood opportunities and bridging the skill gap in the automotive sector.



3.8.4 Rural Mart/Mobile Van

A Rural Mart is a retail marketing outlet for direct selling of products of FPOs, OFPOs, SHGs, Rural artisans, weavers, etc., without the involvement of middlemen, which helps better realization of prices. A grant assistance of ₹47.40 lakh was sanctioned for implementation of 4 Rural Marts and 4 mobile vans in 8 districts to enable selling of products of SHGs, FPOs, OFPOs, etc. An amount of ₹25.33 lakh was released for Rural Marts and Mobile Rural Marts during 2023-24. Under the scheme grant assistance of ₹239.26 lakh has been extended to 60 Rural Marts and Mobile Rural Marts as on 31 December 2024.

Box 3.5 Boosting Farmers' Livelihoods: The Rural Mart Initiative in Paramakkudi

The OFDD - Rural Mart project, implemented by Mugavai Farmers Producer Company in Paramakkudi, Ramanathapuram district, Tamil Nadu, aimed to support farmers by providing a platform to market their products. The scheme, with a grant assistance of ₹3.50 lakh, facilitated the setting up of a rural mart. The shop located at the District Collectrate was designed to



market products such as palm crafts, sea shell crafts, millet cookies, oils, masala items, and other goods produced by the beneficiaries of various NABARD programs. Before the project, the FPO had limited opportunities to sell their value-added products. Despite a minor delay in completing the rural mart, the initiative had a positive impact. The shop receives an average of over 2,000 visitors per day, generating daily sales of ₹6,000. It also provides a platform to showcase NABARD interventions to visiting dignitaries, further promoting the products and programs.

3.8.5 Exhibitions & Melas

Neithal Festival-2023, four-day carnival, showcasing Tami Nadu's uniqueness, culture and folk arts was conducted in Thoothukudi district. 58 stalls were setup with grant assistance of ₹10.38 lakh extended by NABARD under GVN Fund.

“Madurai Utsav–CRAFT Exhibition” in which 50 stalls with artisans, weavers, primary producers of FPOs, OFPOs and SHGs etc. supported under various schemes of NABARD displayed their products. Grant assistance of ₹15.48 lakh was sanctioned for the event under GVN.

An amount of ₹31.32 lakh during 2023-24 and ₹40.61 lakh was sanctioned in 2024-25 to various agencies and artisans for participation in exhibitions held by NABARD ROs in different States.

3.8.6 Rural Haats

A Haat or Bazaar is an open air, periodic market that serves as a trading venue for local people in rural areas. Rural Haat Scheme provides for grant assistance for creation / upgradation of basic infrastructure in Rural Haats in all rural areas.

An amount of ₹30.00 lakh was sanctioned to two Rural Haats in Virudhunagar district. An amount of ₹6.00 lakh was released towards Rural Haat projects during 2023-24. Under NABARD’s ‘Rural Haat’ scheme, cumulatively 13 Rural Haats have been sanctioned to various agencies with a grant assistance of ₹150.66 lakh.

Box 3.6 Empowering Farmers Locally: Transforming Rural Livelihoods with Rural Haat

The Rural Haat project, implemented by Vinoba Bhave FPCL in Virudhunagar district, Tamil Nadu, benefitted farmers across 23 villages in the Tiruchuli taluk. NABARD sanctioned a ₹15 lakh grant for the construction of the haat, which included raised platforms with shade, paved pathways, solar lighting, compost pits for waste management, small godown facilities, and toilet blocks. Prior to the project, the existing haat lacked essential facilities, forcing farmers to travel 10-15 km to



sell their produce, often resulting in distress sales. Without a designated selling space, farmers were also dependent on middlemen. The new haat enabled farmers to market their produce locally, saving time and reducing transportation costs. It also attracted more buyers, boosting farmers' income. Additionally, the haat provided access to essential agricultural inputs like seeds and fertilizers, easing the farmers' burdens and improving their overall productivity.

3.8.7 Rural Agri Business Incubation:

NABARD had sanctioned grant assistance of ₹1224.37 lakh in 2017 to Tamil Nadu Agriculture University (TNAU) for a project period of five years to set up an Agribusiness Incubation Centre viz. MABIF. The project is completed, and the Project Closure Report (PCR) was submitted by MABIF to NABARD in January 2024.

During the project period, MABIF provided handholding to 784 incubatees, out of which 118 have been registered as start-ups under DPIIT. It has generated employment for 5,500 persons

through startups, connecting 482 FPOs and benefitting over 70,000 rural people. Food processing centre, Food testing labs, Cattle Feed Processing Centre, Bio Floc unit, etc have been setup within the campus.

MABIF has become a self-sustaining centre and the Intellectual Property Facilitation centre has applied for 117 trademark, 19 patents and 33 Geographical indicators (GI) of which 50 trademarks and 4 GIs have been granted / registered.

3.9 Micro Credit

3.9.1 SHG – Bank Linkage Programme

The Self-Help Group (SHG)–Bank Linkage Programme (BLP) has emerged as a globally recognized microfinance model, fostering financial inclusion and empowering marginalized communities. As of March 2024, SHGs in TN reported a savings balance of ₹2854.39 crore and credit outstanding of ₹21766.63 crore. With 90% of these groups being women-led, SHG-BLP has shattered myths about the “non-bankability” of the poor. However, the state’s SHG NPAs are at 6.67%, much higher than the national average of 2.05%. NABARD’s capacity-building initiatives aim to address this concern.

3.9.2 SHG –BLP - NRLM

National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM), a programme of GoI, is implemented in Tamil Nadu as TNSRLM by TNCDW. TNSRLM envisages creation of sustainable livelihoods of the rural poor living below the poverty line within a period of 5 to 7 years in all the rural districts of Tamil Nadu. Under the programme Village Poverty Reduction Committees are established which is an independent body of the target poor. They are the important link between the Project and the Village Community, who are responsible for implementing the Project at the village level. Further, SHG federations are formed and strengthened at the panchayat level, called Panchayat Level Federations (PLFs) with the representation from target communities. Panchayat Level Federations have been promoted as the Community Based Organisations to strengthen and lead the SHGs by providing various financial and other services. These PLFs are restructured and registered under Tamil Nadu Societies Registration Act, 1975. The PLFs provide a common platform for the SHGs for their economic empowerment and act as custodians of SHGs. Any poverty alleviation project fund is routed through PLF to the target poor. The office bearers of the PLF shall operate the financial transaction of project fund. PLFs are availing bulk loan ranging from 10 lakhs to 3 crores from banks for onlending to SHG members, to fill the gap in financing made by the Banks.

3.9.3 Micro Enterprise Development Programme (MEDP) & Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programme (LEDP)

NABARD supports SHG skill-building via the Micro Enterprise Development Programme (MEDP) and Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programme (LEDP), offering training in diverse fields like food processing, embroidery, livestock farming, and handicrafts. Between 2018 and 2024, 290 MEDPs were sanctioned with NABARD assistance of ₹242.9 lakhs.

NABARD supports the m-Suvidha scheme, a DPR mode project, to enhance the capacities & income levels of SHGs and JLGs by identifying skill gaps and promoting sustainable micro-enterprises with credit support from banks. The scheme aims to establish at least 500 micro-enterprises through a cluster approach, facilitating collaboration with sector experts fostering economic empowerment for women.

Similarly, 160 LEDPs were sanctioned with NABARD assistance of ₹871.8 lakhs by October 2024. The My Pad-My Right (MPMR) initiative in collaboration with NABFOUNDATION promotes sanitary pad production through SHGs, enhancing livelihood and menstrual hygiene. In TN, it has been launched in Ramanathapuram and Virudhunagar.

Box 3.7 Empowering Narikuruva Women through Silk Thread Jewellery Enterprise

Under the mCID-Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programme, the Rural Education and Development Society implemented an 18-month project to support 90 Narikuruva women from marginalized communities in Kanchipuram district, Tamil Nadu. NABARD provided ₹70.5 lakhs to establish a demonstration unit and conduct a 45-day training program in silk thread jewelry production.

Narikuruva women, primarily involved in selling bead accessories on streets, faced challenges such as limited access to raw materials and inadequate marketing opportunities. Leveraging Kanchipuram's reputation as the "Silk City," the project aimed to convert silk waste into high-value silk thread jewelry and accessories.



Post-implementation, the impact has been transformative. While bead accessories were sold for ₹200–₹300 earlier, silk thread products now fetch up to ₹2,000 per set. The initiative culminated in the launch of a dedicated shop named "Vagarikai," inaugurated by the Minister for Youth Welfare and Sports Development at the Sriperumbudur bus stand.

This project not only enhanced the income levels of Narikuruva women but also empowered them with sustainable livelihoods, paving the way for their economic and social upliftment.

3.9.4 Joint s Groups (JLGs)

Agriculture continues to be the predominant sector of Tamil Nadu economy as more than 40 per cent of the population depend on agriculture and allied activities. Providing credit to small and marginal farmers as also to share croppers and tenant farmers by formal banking system poses a challenge in view of their spatial disbursement and large number of small accounts.

As part of the financial inclusion of the poorest of the poor, NABARD had extended the concept of SHG - BLP to a new mode -Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) initially for augmenting flow of credit to landless tenant farmers cultivating land for crop loan purposes and subsequently to micro entrepreneurs/artisans. Tamil Nadu is one of the front runner States in JLG nurturing and promotion. As at the end of 31 March 2023, 38.66 lakh JLGs were extended bank loan to the tune of ₹13892441.31 lakh (source: *Status of Microfinance in India 2023-27*)

NABARD has signed MoUs with various scheduled Banks for formation and credit linking of JLGs through BC model by engaging the BCs for formation of JLGs.

NABARD supports promotion of JLGs through grant assistance under JLG Incentive Scheme to Joint Liability Promoting Institutions (JLGPIs), viz. Banks, Farmers' Clubs, NGOs, etc. Besides grant support, NABARD also provides capacity building for all stakeholders, 100 per cent refinance support for loans sanctioned and released by banks to JLGs. JLGs are also being encouraged to federate themselves as Farmer Producer Organisations to reap the economies of scale in procurement of inputs and marketing of their produce/ finished products.

3.9.5 Training, onboarding and marketing of products on E-commerce, social media platforms and ONDC

NABARD supports digital marketing by funding training and onboarding of products of SHG/JLG/PO/OFPO on E-commerce platforms, social media, and ONDC, in collaboration with sector experts. NABARD also supports physical marketing by funding the establishment of gram dukaans, movable carts, and stalls in various locations. In 2023-24, 13 projects were sanctioned under these schemes, with NABARD providing assistance of ₹19.86 lakh.

Box 3.8 Boosting Local Agriculture through Gram Dukan in Tiruvannamalai

The Gram Dukan project, implemented in Tiruvannamalai district by Thellar Farmer Producer Company Limited (FPCL), with support from NABARD (₹3.73 Lakh), addresses challenges in marketing farmer products and establishing consistent market linkages. A one-stop shop has been established in Thellar block, where local farmers can showcase and sell their products. FPCL's key commodities include groundnut, sesame, blackgram, coconut, and paddy, with value-added activities like oil extraction, oil cake sales, and cattle feed production. Other initiatives include the establishment of a cattle feed unit and a mini rice mill through funding from the Tamil Nadu Rural Transformation Project (TNRTP).



The impact of Gram Dukan has been significant, benefiting over 1,000 shareholders by offering better prices for their products. The supermarket generates profits from over 60 commodities, with a turnover of ₹11 lakh since inception in 2024. NABARD's financial support has been crucial in fostering local economic growth and sustainability.

3.10 Financial Inclusion

3.10.1 Financial Inclusion Support under Financial Inclusion Fund (FIF) of NABARD

NABARD has been extending grant assistance to Banks for almost a decade and a half for putting in place the required financial inclusion infrastructure, as well as for providing financial literacy. Despite the best efforts put in by all the stakeholders, there exist disparities in terms of financial exclusion and in-adequacy of technology adoption. Therefore, a differentiated strategy has been adopted from the year 2019-20 for extending support under FIF, to provide more thrust on backward districts and technologically weak banks, to deepen the efforts of financial inclusion for the benefit of hitherto excluded population.

The Rural Cooperative Banks (RCBs) and RRBs in the State are guided by NABARD for on-boarding to technology solutions including regulatory requirements. The RCBs and the RRBs in the State have been extended grant assistance for on-boarding to Public Finance Management System (PFMS) portal of GoI, Bharat Bill Payment System, Positive Pay System and implementation of BHIM-UPI in Banks. Banks have been supported to the tune of ₹70 lakh for various technological interventions.

To expand digital payment infrastructure in rural areas, NABARD is extending financial support to all banks (Scheduled Commercial Banks/Small Finance Banks/Payment Banks/RRBs/Cooperatives) for deployment of PoS/m-PoS devices in tier 3 to 6 centers. All Banks are being encouraged to deploy micro-ATMs in Schools/ colleges/milk societies /fixed BC points/Branches/PACs and other non-credit societies. During the past FY, Banks have been sanctioned grant support to the extent of ₹25 lakh and ₹426.35 lakh from NABARD for deployment of PoS devices and micro-ATMs in the State respectively.

With a view to catering to the demand side of the FI initiative, there is a need for spreading financial and digital literacy among the rural population. 64 Centers for Financial Literacy covering 192 blocks were set up by four Lead Banks (Indian Overseas Bank-20, Indian Bank - 22, Canara Bank -16 and State Bank of India -6) with grant assistance of ₹1875.2 lakh from NABARD.

In order to achieve a meaningful and comprehensive Financial Inclusion and to ensure financial security to the poor and the vulnerable, especially in Special Focus Districts in the State, NABARD has sanctioned grant support of ₹89.75 lakh to various Banks towards conduct of around 1800 Financial & Digital Literacy Awareness Programmes across the State.

Box 3.9 Expanding Rural Banking Access through Micro ATMs in Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu Grama Bank (RRB) deployed 330 micro ATMs with NABARD's support of ₹66 lakh as part of an initiative to improve digital transactions and enhance last-mile connectivity in over 2,000 villages. Deployed at branches and through Banking Correspondents, these devices have significantly increased banking touch points in rural areas.

The initiative has benefitted farmers, small entrepreneurs, senior citizens, rural women, school children, SHG members, and rural youth. On average, 3,85,329 financial transactions and 3,09,372

non-financial transactions are performed monthly. Key outcomes include increased usage of digital transactions, improved connectivity for banking services, enhanced security for transactions, and easier money transfers. The deployment of micro ATMs has effectively addressed banking accessibility challenges and has contributed to the growth of rural digital financial services.



3.11 Past trends in credit flow

The trend in Ground Level Credit Flow in Priority sector during the past three year are given below.

Table 3.7: Trends in credit flow (₹ crore)

Broad Sector	2021-22			2022-23			2023-24			Avg Ach % in last 3 years
	Target	Ach.	Ach %	Target	Ach.	Ach %	Target	Ach.	Ach %	
Crop Loan	72869	149293	205	131086	211568	161	255863	279408	109	158
Term Loan (Agri.)	81752	89585	110	77890	114748	147	130619	124926	96	118
Total Agri. Credit	154665	238878	154	208976	326316	156	386482	404334	105	138
Non-Farm Sector	11993	140463	1171	126702	180308	142	266614	229544	86	466
Other Priority Sector	197498	18435	120	50234	25697	51	47323.3	30114.8	64	78
Total Priority Sector	364156	397776	109	385912	532321	138	700420	663993	95	114

Source: SLBC and GLC data from banks. The above compilation is based on GLC data sourced from LDMs.

3.12 Sustainable Agriculture Practices

3.12.1 Initiatives of State Government: The State Government is aiming at achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) before 2030 by implementing various schemes. To restore water related ecosystem, to give importance for rainwater harvesting and to implement the water resource management is the 6th goal of SDGs, the following soil and water conservation and water management schemes are implemented.

1. Kalaigarin All Village Integrated Agricultural Development Programme

In the past three years, this scheme was implemented in 7,705 villages throughout Tamil Nadu. Under the component, creation of water source for dryland clusters, so far, 916 wells have been newly created and installation of Electric/ Solar powered pumpsets is being done. For the creation of water source for Individual SC/ST – small and marginal farmers, so far 1,306 wells have been newly created. To harvest the rainwater in their own land by farmers, so far 1,759 farm ponds were created. Under the component of rehabilitation and improvement works in panchayat union minor irrigation tanks, ooranies, ponds, supply channels and other water harvesting structure- 5,731 have been desilted so far.

2. Creation and maintenance of water harvesting structures

In order to overcome the water scarcity by way of increasing the ground water level by harvesting the runoff rain water, from the year 2021-22, maintenance works have been carried out in the already constructed 2,505 structures. During the current year, 100 new water harvesting structures like community ponds are to be created besides taking up maintenance works in 500 existing water harvesting structures created in various watersheds.

3. Special Area Development Programme

For conserving the natural resources of hilly areas, soil and water conservation works and land development works are being implemented in the Western Ghat areas and its forest fringe villages, under Special Area Development Programme, thereby benefitting the agricultural lands. Under this scheme, totally 153 Nos. and 12,971 metres of soil and water conservation and land development works have been carried out during the year 2023-24 at a cost of ₹16.24 crore in the 11 districts.

4. Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization Project

The World Bank funded Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization Project (TNIAMP) is being implemented since 2017-18 with the aim of increasing agricultural production in the irrigated areas, with an integrated approach covering various sectors. An amount of ₹15.53 crore has been allocated for the construction of farm ponds. So far, 1,397 farm ponds have been constructed upto phase IV-1st year for an amount of ₹10.42 crore. In the year 2023-24, financial sanction of ₹3.02 crore has been received for the construction of 275 farm ponds in 12 districts.

5. Creation of low cost ground water recharge structures

Low-cost ground water recharge structures developed by Tamil Nadu Agricultural University are to be taken up on pilot basis in 250 bore wells / tube wells and open wells created in the clusters under the Kalaignar Scheme at an outlay of ₹1 crore in the year 2024-25.

6. Creating awareness among the farmers about rainwater harvesting methods

The important aspects of construction and maintenance of rainwater harvesting methods and techniques like summer ploughing, contour bunding, field bunding, bench terracing, stonewall, farm pond, sunken pond, oorani, village pond, check dam, artificial recharge structures and maintenance of water harvesting structures are to be imparted to the farming community in co-ordination with Krishi Vigyan Kendras in every district by means of conducting awareness campaigns.

3.12.2 Initiatives by NABARD

1. Watershed Development initiatives

NABARD's participatory watershed development programme is being implemented in rainfed/dryland areas with major objectives of conservation of soil and water resources, enhancement of farm production, productivity and farmers' income and improvement in overall socio-economic status of farmers, women and landless labourers. The programme is implemented with 'Ridge to Valley approach' by treating each and every piece of land for in-situ soil and water conservation through a process of participatory net planning involving watershed community.

NABARD has been partnering with the GoTN for implementation of watershed projects. The State nodal department for implementation of watershed projects is Tamil Nadu Watershed Development Agency (TAWDEVA). There are 203 watershed projects sanctioned in 28 districts covering 2.19 lakh ha in the State with a cumulative sanction of ₹183.28 crore.

Out of these 203 projects, 141 are implemented in partnership with the GoTN, 41 under full grant by NABARD and 21 projects under CSR partnership mode. So far 1.64 lakh ha. has been treated with grant assistance of ₹134.38 crore. Climate Proofing activities are being implemented in 30 completed Watershed projects in 09 districts with grant assistance of ₹14.8 crore.

Under CSR, RO has entered into MoU with 7 corporates and has implemented 7 watershed projects. The corporates with whom we have entered into CSR are Hand in Hand Inclusive Development Services, JSW Steel Works Ltd, Dalmia Bharat Group, TVS Motor Group, Rotary Club of Madras Coromandel, Bannari Amman Sugars Ltd. and Titan Company Ltd.

Box 3.10 Reviving Waters, Reclaiming Lands: The Transformational Impact of the Pulleri Watershed

The Pulleri Watershed Development Programme, implemented by the National Agro Foundation from 2019 to 2024, benefited 3,178 households in Pulleri village, Tirukkalukunram block, Chengalpattu district, Tamil Nadu. Supported by a grant of ₹95.86 lakh, the project addressed critical issues, including low groundwater levels caused by over-extraction for paddy cultivation and the absence of rainwater harvesting structures. Major challenges included ensuring plantation survival and fostering community engagement. Capacity-building programs for the Village Watershed Committee were pivotal in overcoming these challenges and promoting active participation. The project achieved significant outcomes, increasing the watershed's water holding capacity by 30,633 m³ (306.33 lakh litres) per fill through the construction of masonry check dams, percolation ponds, and sunken ponds, effectively reducing excess runoff. Groundwater levels improved steadily over three years, with an increase of up to 1.26 meters during peak summer. Additionally, 28 hectares of fallow land were reclaimed and brought under cultivation, enhancing agricultural productivity. The project's integrated approach to water conservation and community involvement ensured its success, creating long-term benefits for the region and fostering sustainable resource management.



of masonry check dams, percolation ponds, and sunken ponds, effectively reducing excess runoff. Groundwater levels improved steadily over three years, with an increase of up to 1.26 meters during peak summer. Additionally, 28 hectares of fallow land were reclaimed and brought under cultivation, enhancing agricultural productivity. The project's integrated approach to water conservation and community involvement ensured its success, creating long-term benefits for the region and fostering sustainable resource management.

As, Tamil Nadu is a water stressed State, where more than 95% of the surface water and 80% of the ground water have already been utilised, watershed and spring shed development in hilly terrain would help in rejuvenation of natural resources especially soil and water. Tamil Nadu has been selected as one of ten states by NABARD HO to implement the pilot project on Sustainable Participatory Groundwater Management. Four pilot projects will be sanctioned in overexploited blocks of 4 districts.

2. Integration of Watershed Development for rehabilitation of degraded soil and climate change adaptation' under SEWOH Phase III of KfW funded programme

NABARD in collaboration with KfW is Implementating SEWOH Phase III programme (KfW Soil Project) on 'Integration of Watershed Development for rehabilitation of degraded soil and climate change adaptation' to reduce vulnerability to climate change by the stabilization, enhancement and sustainable use of soil and water resources. The total cost of the programme is EUR 5.40 million, out of which Financial Contribution of EUR 4.5 million will be contributed by KfW and balance 0.90 million will be contributed by NABARD (EUR 0.46 Million) and Farmers (EUR 0.43 million). NABARD TNRO has sanctioned 25 KfW Soil projects in 14 districts with grant support of ₹15.42 crore, to 13 Project facilitating agencies (PFAs) covering beneficiaries of small and marginal farmers. Under this KfW Soil project, the various components sanctioned are additional SWC measures, Soil Health improvement and productivity enhancement measures, Promotion of sustainable NRM, CCA farming practices

and Food security, Measures to Mitigate CC risk and Capacity building, institutional building and knowledge management.

Box 3.11 From Barren Fields to Thriving Farms: A Soil Rehabilitation Journey in Dharmapuri



The project "Implementation of Soil Rehabilitation & Climate Change Adaptation Measures in Vattuvanahalli Watershed," led by DEEPS, spanned three years and benefited 1,372 individuals from MBC and SC communities in Vattuvanahalli, Pennagaram block, Dharmapuri district, Tamil Nadu. Supported by a ₹63.60 lakh grant, it addressed soil and water management, livelihood promotion, and climate adaptation across 681 hectares. Challenges like seasonal migration, wage disparities, and water scarcity were resolved through the Village Watershed Committee's active participation.

The project transformed barren lands into productive areas, improving rainwater harvesting and groundwater levels, benefiting 325 families. Key interventions included agricultural implements worth ₹3 lakh, kitchen garden seeds for 55 families, 2,000 teak seedlings, IPM training for 30 beneficiaries, and soil and water testing for 200 families. Additionally, 150 beneficiaries received country chicks. These measures enhanced soil fertility, crop productivity, and water availability, ensuring sustainability and fostering climate resilience for the local community.

7. Tribal Development

The tribal communities are dependent mainly on agriculture, forests and livestock for livelihood. But, the dwindling forest resources, accentuated by primitive agriculture practices like shifting cultivation, mono-cropping, etc., have jeopardized the agriculture and livestock productivity and led to shrinking water resources and reduced fuel & fodder supply. This has largely affected family income leading to rampant migration to urban areas leaving their productive assets idle. In many parts of the country, the tribal communities reside in inaccessible areas and are still devoid of common infrastructure facilities such as roads and communication, health and education and safe drinking water, which do not allow them to absorb technological and financial facilities, being provided by the government.

The model of tribal development conceived by NABARD encompasses Natural Resource Management in rain-fed tribal areas, microfinance initiatives and women upliftment through people participation.

NABARD has sanctioned 30 Tribal Development Fund (TDF) Projects to various Project Implementing Agencies (PIAs). Under these TDF projects various activities like ensuring plantation in 0.5 to 1.0 acre wadi area, Water resources Development & Soil Conservation activities, Livelihood activities for landless families, Capacity building/awareness programs/training programs etc., Community health and women development are undertaken.

Box 3.12 Harvesting Hope: Orchard Development for Paliyar and Muduvar Tribes in Theni

The Integrated Orchard Development Project, implemented under the Tribal Development Fund by the All Rural Development and Social Construction Society, supported 100 Paliyar and Muduvar tribal beneficiaries across 10 villages in Bodinayakanur and Periyakulam taluks, Theni district, Tamil Nadu. The project, with a grant of ₹64.95 lakh, spanning five years and aims to develop orchards by planting cardamom, coffee, and pepper, along with intercrops like avocado, nutmeg, clove, jackfruit, silk cotton, and silver oak. Livelihood interventions included SHG formation, animal husbandry, capacity building, and other support services. Before the project implementation, the tribals, recently awarded land under the Forest Rights



Act, worked as bonded laborers in Kerala and faced frequent migration. Challenges included wild animal attacks in the orchard and logistical difficulties due to inadequate transport facilities in Mudhuvargudi village. With NABARD's support, saplings were provided under the program, enabling the tribals to settle on their own land and generate sustainable income. The initiative transformed barren lands into productive orchards, yielding 70 kg of cardamom and 110 kg of pepper, which were marketed directly. Intercropping with beans further improved land productivity, ensuring a stable income and enhancing the livelihoods of the tribal community.

Table 3.8: Status of TDF projects in Tamil Nadu (31.12.2024)

No. of PIAs	No. of Districts covered	No. of TDF Projects Sanctioned	No. of on-going TDF Projects	No. of families		
				With land-holding	Land less	Total
18	16	30	13	11048	4060	15108

8. JIVA

NABARD has introduced 'JIVA Programme' an agroecological transformational approach through natural farming in order to address the emerging challenges of land degradation, climate change, loss of biodiversity, poor productivity, food and nutrition security concerns and economic distress of farmers due to chemical inputs and water intensive mono cropping and declining net returns.

JIVA encompasses changing social relations, empowering farmers, adding value locally and privileging short value chains. JIVA triggers significant impacts in the project area, a few of

them being sustainability in natural resource use, food, nutrition and agriculture systems, enhancement and stabilization of farm income, climate resilience and contribution to mitigation of climate change, enhancement of ecosystem services and natural regenerative processes, stimulation to local economy aiding in its growth and employment, improved human wellbeing with healthy food and improved nutrition, etc.

Box 3.13 Sowing Sustainability: Natural Farming Brings New Opportunities to Kolli Hills



The JIVA Pilot Project, implemented by MSSRF in Kolli Hills, Tamil Nadu, promotes natural farming practices among tribal families. With a ₹30 lakh grant, 30 lead farmers were trained during the one-year pilot phase, including Mrs. Venilla from Orpuram village. She allocated two acres of her land to natural farming, adopting integrated farming models and bio inoculums after participating in Before the project, Mrs. Venilla practiced mono-cropping with low yields and relied on costly chemical inputs. The initiative addressed these challenges by introducing sustainable techniques, enhancing crop diversity, and reducing input costs.

The project has significantly improved yields and empowered Mrs. Venilla, who has now become a resource person, inspiring others in her community to adopt natural farming. With the sanction of four-year upscaling phase (₹90 lakhs), the project aims to further promote sustainable agricultural practices and uplift tribal families in Kolli Hills.

9. Farmers Producers Organization

Tamil Nadu has a conducive ecosystem for formation and nurturing of FPOs. There are around 1200 FPOs in the State, of which 476 have been promoted by NABARD, 386 by TNSFAC and the remaining by various other agencies, viz., NCDC, GOI-SFAC, NAFED, TRIFED apart from few self-promoted FPOs. Keeping in view the FPOs will be playing a major and decisive role in shaping the Indian Agriculture in the years ahead and a promising approach to address the issues of small and marginal farmers, NABARD has taken a proactive step in promotion of 476 FPOs covering 2.84 lakh farmers under its various funds with a grant support of ₹94.28 crore which includes 74 specialised FPOs in AH and Fisheries sector.

NABKISAN, a subsidiary of NABARD set up specifically cater to the credit needs of the FPOs. MABIF, Incubation centre established by NABARD is providing end-to-end services to the FPOs especially food processing besides providing incubation support. NABARD has also supported GOI in formulating a policy for promotion of Central Sector Scheme on 10,000 FPOs.

Table 3.9: FPOs supported by NABARD in Tamil Nadu State

Name of the Fund	No of FPOs	Sanctioned (₹Lakhs)	Major products	
PRODUCE	169	1531.14	Minor millets	Value
PODF-ID	108	1221.12	Pulses	Addition
PODF-ID (AH/Fisheries)	74	658.60	Groundnut	Flowers
CSS on 10,000 FPOs	125	6017.27	Paddy	Pepper
			Maize	Spices
			Fruits	Dairy
			Vegetables	Palm jaggery
			Coconut	Palm leaf products
			Marine fisheries etc..	Betelvine
Total	476	9428.13		

i. Initiatives of Government of Tamil Nadu on FPOs

The State Government has formulated the following three schemes to assist the FPCs:

- Mezzanine Capital Assistance (MCA) to enhance the quantum of credit,
- Credit Guarantee Scheme (CGS) to access credit
- Revolving Fund Support (RFS) to avail concessional credit.

These Schemes are jointly implemented by the Department of Agricultural Marketing and Agri Business, Government of Tamil Nadu and NABKISAN Finance Ltd (Subsidiary of NABARD).

ii. Important initiatives of the Government of India

a) Centrally sponsored scheme for promotion of 10,000 new FPOs over 5 years has been operationalized. Cluster Based Business Organizations (CBBOs) have been identified for facilitating formation of FPOs.

b) Under the Scheme, around 465 FPOs were sanctioned in Tamil Nadu. NABARD-125 FPOs, TNSFAC-50 FPOs, NCDC-95 FPOs, SFAC-91 FPOs, Trifed-1 and NAFED- 103 FPOs.

c) Till date Equity Grant Assistance has been sanctioned benefitting 88204 farmers covering 283 FPOs in the State.

d) Grant assistance of ₹ 25 lakhs per FPO is extended to CBBOs for promotion and nurturing of FPOs and ₹ 18 lakhs per FPO towards Management cost, capacity building and training.

e) Credit Guarantee Fund of ₹ 1,000 crore, for providing credit guarantee cover (CGC) to all eligible Lending Institutions, was created and maintained by subsidiary of NABARD . Eligible lending institutions can avail Credit Guarantee cover, ranging from 75% to 85% of the quantum of loan, with a maximum ceiling of ₹ 1.50 crore per FPO.

iii. NABKISAN Finance Limited – Frontrunner in financing of FPOs

- 430 FPCs were sanctioned assistance under TNGMCAS (Tamil Nadu Government Mezzanine Capital Assistance Scheme) scheme amounting to ₹ 37.47 crore.
- 224 FPCs have been sanctioned assistance of ₹ 28.91 crore under TRFFPC (Tamil Nadu Government Revolving Fund Scheme for FPCs).
- 47 FPCs sanctioned assistance under TCGFPC scheme amounting to ₹ 6.72 crore.
- 410 FPCs were credit linked with NABKISAN in the above scheme.

Box 3.7 Strengthening Livelihoods of Fisherwomen through Fisheries FPO

Anbalaya Marine Fish Farmer Producer Company Ltd (FFPO), located in Thondi, Ramanathapuram, Tamil Nadu, is creating significant change for local fisherwomen. Initially supported by NABARD's MEDP, the FPO formation began by training 60 women in fishnet production, offering them an alternative livelihood to fish vending. Traditionally, fisherwomen earned lower wages and faced income instability due to fluctuating fish stocks and market prices.



NABARD supported the FPO promotion with the grant support of ₹8.9 lakh. It was also supported with Mezzanine assistance of ₹5 lakh and working capital assistance of ₹10 lakh through NABKISAN. The FFPO, registered in October 2022, has grown to 510 members and operates two Common Facility Centers (CFCs) in Thondi. These centers employ 20-25 women, who now produce high-quality, customized fishing nets, including nets for various types of fish, crabs, prawns, and squid. The women earn between ₹400 to ₹700 daily, with positive feedback on the quality of their nets. The FPO has

shown strong financial growth, with a turnover of ₹36.87 lakh in FY 2023-24 and ₹31.20 lakh in FY 2024-25 (as of December 2024).

Looking ahead, the FPO plans to set up an additional CFC at Passipattinam and expand into seaweed and fish value addition, further diversifying income opportunities for its members. NABARD's continued support has been pivotal in this successful transformation.

10. Farm Sector Promotion Fund

The Farm Sector Promotion Fund (FSPF) is created in NABARD with the primary objective to support farm innovations, technology transfer and capacity building of farming community in the realm of agriculture and allied activities.

There are about 16 ongoing projects in 12 districts across Tamil Nadu and UTP with total grant sanctioned amounting to ₹263 lakh to various agencies including KVKs, Agricultural Universities and Research Institutions. These projects are sanctioned under various areas like Climate Resilient Integrated Farming System; Artificial intelligence based precision aquaculture technologies for sustainable shrimp farming; Strengthening the Value Chain Process in Agroforestry; Promotion of Millets for Livelihood enhancement of farmers through Capacity Building on Improved Production and Value Addition technologies; Digitizing Agriculture Marketing through mobile Application; Training & Demonstration of IoT based UAV assisted smart agriculture system; Environmental Sustainability through Integrated Multi-Trophic Aquaculture for fishermen; Enhancement of fishery production by artificial reef deployment for small-scale fishermen; Formulation and Scaling up the production and commercialization of products from Banana Fibre residue to increase the income of farmers; Improving Production Potential of Kangayam Cattle through Scientific Intervention;

Establishing model IFS units for food and nutritional security of Cauvery Delta Zone and Enhancing agricultural efficiency and rural empowerment in Cauvery Delta Zone through Drone Technology.

Box 3.14 Building Resilience: The Integrated Mangrove Fishery Farming System in Cuddalore

The Integrated Mangrove Fishery Farming System (IMFFS) project, implemented by the M S Swaminathan Research Foundation in Mudasalodai village, Cuddalore district, Tamil Nadu, aimed to enhance the adaptive capacity of the fishing community to sea level rise. Supported by a grant of ₹20 lakh under FSPF, the project focused on creating farm ponds, providing mangrove plantation training, supporting fish and crab culture, and mobilizing fisher families for mangrove conservation. The goal was to transform saline areas into productive aquaculture land, thereby improving livelihood security in the face of climate change.

Cuddalore district faces frequent flooding, making the community vulnerable to climate impacts. Despite initial challenges, such as uniting diverse fisher communities for mangrove management and dealing with seabass infections and salinity fluctuations, the project achieved significant progress. The initiative improved social cohesion between Irular tribes and traditional fishers, creating a collective approach to mangrove resource management. The project generated both direct and indirect income through fish and crab harvesting, while also increasing women's involvement in decision-making and leadership roles.



3.13 Rural Infrastructure and linkage support

1. **Rural Infrastructure Development Fund:** NABARD's partnership with the GoTN for creation of rural infrastructure extends over 47,295 projects involving an RIDF loan of ₹ 37902.04 crore. Currently, the assistance from RIDF is available for supporting 39 eligible activities grouped under three distinct heads viz.
 - i. Agriculture and Related Sectors
 - ii. Social Sectors
 - iii. Rural Connectivity
2. **Warehouse Infrastructure Fund (WIF):** Under the fund, a cumulative loan of ₹2636.60 crore has been sanctioned to the State Government for supporting creation of infrastructure for storage of agricultural commodities, out of which ₹ 2526.06 crore has been disbursed as on 31.12.2024.
3. **Food Processing Fund (FPF):** Tamil Nadu is a strong player in agro food processing industry and its share of Indian output is about 7 per cent. FPF has been established by

GoI to provide impetus to the development of food processing sector. NABARD has so far sanctioned loan assistance of ₹439 crore under the fund for establishment food processing infrastructure.

4. **NABARD Infrastructure Development Assistance (NIDA):** NIDA is designed to directly fund the State Governments / State owned institutions /Corporations on both on-budget as well as off-budget for creation of rural infrastructure outside the ambit of RIDF borrowing. During the year 2020-21, NIDA loan of ₹ 6529.30 crore was sanctioned towards six projects pertaining to irrigation and rural drinking water supply. Cumulative disbursements as on 30.11.2024 towards the above sanctioned projects is ₹ 5667.94 crore.

3.14 Scope for Organic farming

Organic farming has significant potential in Tamil Nadu, given the state's diverse agro-climatic zones, growing demand for organic products, and strong government and community support. The scope for organic farming in Tamil Nadu is expanding, driven by both market trends and environmental considerations.

3.14.1 Under the new Chief Minister's Mannuyir Kaathu Mannuyir Kaappom Scheme (CM MK MKS) announced during the Tamil Nadu Agri Budget 2024-25 and being implemented with a financial allocation of ₹206 crore, one of the component is to create awareness on organic farming. In this component one model organic farming plot will be established in one village per block, with a financial allocation of ₹38.50 lakh. Provision of ₹ 27 crore for the 725 organic farming clusters to complete certified organic standards with all the activities from sowing to marketing to improve profit of the farmers.

3.14.2 Organic Certification

Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department is established in 2007 by the GoTN is accredited by the Agricultural and Processed Food Export Development Authority (APEDA) to certify the System of Organic Crop Production, Processing and Export. The National Centre for Organic Farming and Natural Farming functioning under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare has authorized the Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department to issue Organic Certificates under Participatory Guarantee System.

Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department provides the System Certification to Crop Production, Processing and Trading of Organic Products meant for export. The certification issued by Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department is equivalent to the standards of European Union and Swiss Organic Farming Ordinance. The National Programme on Organic Production (NPOP) system of certification enables the organic products to be marketed within India and to other countries. It enables the Organic farmers, processors, traders, and exporters to obtain the organic certificate in accordance with the National Programme on Organic Production norms. The scope of organic certification is valid for a period of one year. The organic regulations ensure the avoidance of synthetic chemical fertilisers, pesticides, weedicides and genetically engineered crops.

The Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department offers scope for Crop Production Processing & Trading under the Participatory Guarantee System. Currently the department extends its certification programme to Individuals(farmers), Groups, On-farm and Off farm

Processing, Handling and finally Certifying Large Contiguous traditional / default organic areas.

3.14.3 Status of Organic Certification

During the year 2023-24, an area of 83,979 acres have been registered under organic certification. The total number of farmers registered across the state is 39,428. This includes 2,772 individual farmers, 36,656 farmers, farmer groups, food processors and organic traders. Tamil Nadu Organic Certification Department is the only certification body to register the highest number of individual operators at National level. Tamil Nadu Department of Organic Certification has issued Transaction Certificate for export and domestic trade of 92.15 MT of organic produce worth ₹155 lakh. The major products certified for export are coconut, coffee, and turmeric.

Chapter IV

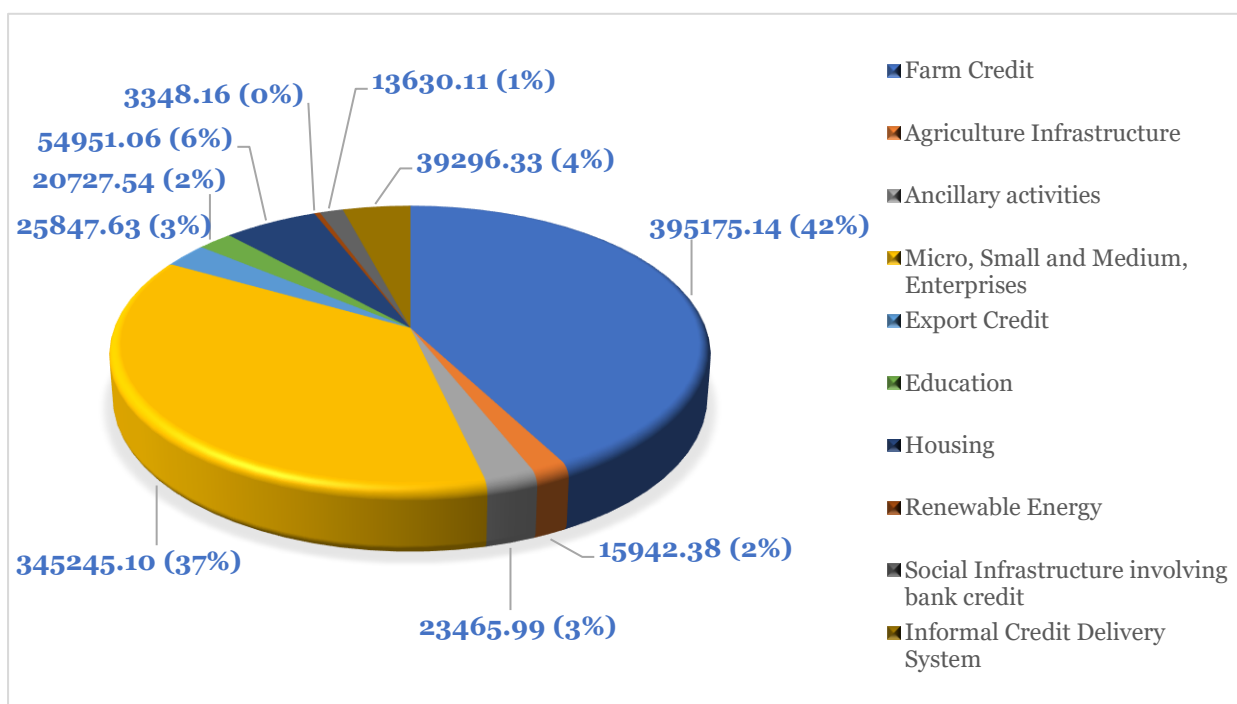
Potential Credit Outlay

The Potential Credit Outlay for priority sector for the state as a whole for FY 2025-26 has been estimated at **₹ 937629.43 crore** as against a potential of **₹ 834078 crore** for FY 2024-25 registering an increase of 12.41%. The broad sector wise projections of the year 2025-26 vis-à-vis 2024-25 as per the revised priority sector guidelines are furnished in table 4.1:

Table 4.1: Sector wise Potentials 2024-25 (₹ crore)

Sl. No	Particulars	PLP Projections 2024-25	PLP Projections 2025-26
A	Farm Credit		
i	Crop production, Maintenance & Marketing	268708.61	308670.02
ii	Term Loan for agriculture and allied activities	70692.76	86505.12
	Sub Total (i + ii)	339401.37	395175.14
B	Agriculture Infrastructure	13927.45	15942.38
C	Ancillary activities	21662.18	23465.99
I	Credit Potential for Agriculture (A+B+C)	374991.00	434583.51
II	Micro, Small and Medium, Enterprises	317060.67	345245.10
III	Export Credit	25314.41	25847.63
IV	Education	22325.32	20727.54
V	Housing	51517.81	54951.06
VI	Renewable Energy	2625.77	3348.16
VII	Social Infrastructure involving bank credit	9492.26	13630.11
VIII	Informal Credit Delivery System	30751.40	39296.33
	Total Priority Sector (I to VIII)	834078.63	937629.43

Figure 4.1: Sector wise Potentials 2025-26



Ground Level Credit (GLC) Flow under Priority Sector

The total priority sector lending during the year 2023-24 stood at ₹6,63,993 crore as against the target of ₹ 7,00,420 crore i.e., an achievement of 95%. Lending to Priority Sector was higher than the revised RBI norms for PSL lending. (Table no 2.2 in banking profile). Details indicated in Chapter II.

The percentage share of SCBs, StCBs, RRB and Others in the achievement of year 2023-24 was 91.74%, 3.73%, 4.24% and 0.29% respectively. The emerging trend in priority sector lending of different agencies is furnished as under:

Table 4.2: Agency wise Ground Level Credit for last 3 years and target for 2024-25

Agency	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
Comm. Banks	332557	361801	346918	472176	620633	609157	620632
StCB/CCBs	14732	14486	11051	22911	28301	24734	28301
RRBs	14478	13218	13399	22882	29662	28153	29661
SCARDB	2222	0	178	0	107	0	107
Others	167	8271	14368	14357	21717	1949	21717
Total	364156	397776	385914	532326	700420	663993	700418

4.1 Farm Credit

4.1.1 Crop Production, Maintenance and Marketing

Major food crops grown in the State are paddy, jowar, ragi, bajra, maize, pulses and oil seeds like groundnut, sesame, and sunflower. Few other crops that are cultivated extensively are cotton, sugarcane, tea, coffee, and coconut. Paddy is the leading crop and is grown in all the seasons i.e., Kuruvai, Samba and Kodai. Tamil Nadu has gained commendable status in the horticultural sector with bananas and mangoes. Major reasons for increased credit flow under crop loans is growing awareness among farmers of various schemes and facilities available/introduced by GoTN/GoI, Interest Subvention Scheme of GoI. Interest Incentive Scheme of GoTN for cooperative banks whereby crop loan is disbursed at an interest rate of 0% is also an important reason for increased bank credit.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Crop Loan has been estimated at ₹3,08,670.03 crore

Suggested action points

- Agri-clinics with custom hiring center may be established in all blocks.
- There is an urgent need for drying yards in all Panchayat Village for drying paddy before selling them at Direct Procurement Centres.
- Establishment of Sugarcane Research Station in Thirumanur block, Ariyalur district.
- Setting up of State Seed Farms & Coconut Farms to meet the quality seed requirements of farmers.

4.1.2 Water Resources

Tamil Nadu constitutes 4 percent of India's land area and is inhabited by 6 percent of India's population but has only 3 percent of India's water resources. More than 95 percent of the surface water and 80 percent of the ground water have already been put into use. Major uses of water include human/animal consumption, irrigation and industrial use. The per capita availability of water resources, however, is just 900 cubic meters when compared to the national average of 2,200 cubic meters. Agriculture is the largest consumer of water in the State using 75 per cent of the State's water resources. (www.tnenvi.nic.in). The State is largely dependent on both the monsoons. The annual average rainfall is around 990 mm (47% during the north-east monsoon, 35% during the south-west monsoon, 14% in the summer and 4% in the winter). Since the State is entirely dependent on rains for recharging its water resources, monsoon failures lead to acute water scarcity and severe droughts. Hence taking appropriate measures to arrest the alarmingly decreasing levels of ground water viz. usage of water harvesting systems and micro irrigation systems are essential.

There are 34 Rivers in the State which have been grouped into 17 major River Basins and 127 Sub-Basins. Cauvery is the only major basin. Of the others, 13 basins are medium and 3 are minor river basins. The annual surface water generated within the State is 692.78 TMC (19,619 MCM). The State depends on neighboring States (Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Kerala) for considerable quantum of flows, which is about 261.70 TMC (7411 MCM) annually. Thus, the total surface water potential of the State is 865 TMC. In respect of ground water availability, out of the 1,202 Firkas, 482 Firkas are categorised as Safe, 395 Firkas as Over-Exploited, 64 Firkas as Critical, 227 Firkas as Semi-Critical and 34 Firkas as Saline.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under water resources has been estimated at ₹ 7168.80 crore

Suggested Action Points

- Rainwater Harvesting structures like Farm Ponds, Check Dams/ Percolation ponds may be promoted on large scale in critical and over-exploited blocks, considering the rainfall dependency.
- Ground water recharge structures, watershed projects in the over-exploited areas of the district.
- Complete the remaining phases of Cauvery- Vaigai- Gundaru rivers and Sadayanery- Thamirabharani rivers linking projects for improving agricultural productivity in association with improving livelihood.
- Desilting/ renovation, bunding and bush clearance in all tanks and clean and strengthen water channels to enhance storage.
- Renovate irrigation structures in a mission mode.
- Establish rainwater harvesting structures, ground water recharge structures and strengthen of riverbeds of major rivers in Salem district viz., Vashista, Sarabanga and Swetha.
- Construction of dedicated sewage lines to protect the canal water.
- Modernization of existing canal irrigation system will ensure availability of adequate water to tail end areas.

- Piped Irrigation system in Kallikudi, Kallupatti, Sedappatti blocks from Vaigai Dam and Periyakulam block from Periyar Main Canal.
- Tail-end regions in canal systems, such as those in Alangayam, Kandili, and Natrampalli blocks, face water deficit. Modernization of existing canal irrigation system will ensure availability of adequate water to tail end areas.
- Construction of artificial recharge structures such as check dams, sub surface dykes, recharge pits, recharge trenches, recharge shafts, etc., in the rivers and construction of farm ponds at individual farmlands.
- Installation of tail end regulators in all the rivers draining into the sea to prevent seawater intrusion.
- Concrete lining of Lower Bhavani Project (LBP) canal and bunds may be given topmost priority as more than 50% of the water is lost due to severe seepage (as against the allowable limit of 33%). Besides, breaching of canal also occurs very often. This work would help in giving water till the tail end and also can bring additional area of 20000 ha. under irrigation.

4.1.3 Farm Mechanisation

Farm Mechanization is one of the technological inputs that is required to improve the process which can transform the subsistence farming to commercial farming. It has the potential to expand production, improve timeliness of operations, better utilization of irrigation potential and infrastructure, compensate for labour shortages, and alleviate drudgery in agricultural operations. Thus, farm mechanization brings about significant improvement in agricultural productivity, which underscores the strong need for mechanization of agricultural operations. Keeping this in view, an ambitious target of increasing the availability of farm power from 2.02 kW per ha (2016-17) to 4.0 kW per ha by the end of 2030 has been set for the country. The average farm power availability in the state of Tamil Nadu is 1.50 kW/ha, which is mainly restricted to tillage operations. This needs to be increased to at least 2 kW/ha as envisaged under the GoI's Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM), to increase farm income. Post-harvest machinery also helps in value addition and conservation of produce and by-products from qualitative and quantitative damages.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Farm Mechanization has been estimated at ₹ 12,051.18 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to individual farmers or FPOs for post-harvest equipment.
- Extend credit to startups involving servicing/repairing farm machinery.
- Extend credit to set up custom hiring centers by FPOs, SHGs.
- Capacity building of unemployed youth through RSETIs on repair and maintenance of farm machinery

Government

- Establish Custom Hiring Centres in all the blocks and set up workshops for repairing high value farm machineries.
- Establish Custom Hiring Centres through FPOs with provision for drones and IOT based automation services.

- Agri Engineering Department may promote the use of drones and IOT based farm automation in the application of agri-inputs through FPOs for improving the efficient utilization of natural resources and wider reach of technology among the farmers.

4.1.4 Plantation and Horticulture

Growing plantation and horticulture crops are an ideal option to improve livelihood security, enhance employment, attain food & nutritional security and increase income through value addition. The sector also facilitates diversified opportunities with high value crops, generating employment, ensuring nutritional security and ecological sustainability; and enhancing the export earnings.

Tamil Nadu enjoys unique position in the plantation and horticulture sector on account of its location and its varied agro climatic factors. Tamil Nadu is one of the leading Horticulture States in the country contributing 6.09% of the national horticulture production and 5.47% of the total horticulture crops in terms of area at national level. Tamil Nadu accounts for nearly 4.67% of the area under fruits and 3.24% of area under vegetables in the country. In terms of production, the State's share is nearly 6.65% in fruits and 4.45% in vegetables. Under plantation, Tamil Nadu accounts for 15.57% of the total area and 22.54% of total production. Tamil Nadu accounts for 2.32% of area and 1.80% production under spices, 15.91% of area and 26.92% of production under loose flowers and 7.36% under cut flowers. (Source: Third Estimates of Area and Production of Horticulture Crops for 2023-24 (<https://agriwelfare.gov.in/en/StatHortEst>)). Rapid growth of demand for horticulture commodities and products have resulted in shift or diversification from traditional food crops to horticulture crops like banana, coconut, mango, vegetables, medicinal / herbal / aromatic plants etc. Further, the sector is a growth engine for economic development. Out of the total geographical area of 130.05 lakh Ha, horticulture crops are cultivated in 16.03 lakh Ha, with a total production of 233 lakh MT. Mango (44%) and banana (33%) are the leading fruit crops in Tamil Nadu contributing to more than 75% towards total area under fruits category. Similarly, tapioca (24%), onion (12%) and tomato (11%) are the leading vegetable crops in Tamil Nadu. Under plantation crops, coconut (65%), cashew (12%) and tea (9%) are the leading plantation crops in Tamil Nadu. (Source: Agriculture Policy Note, 2024-25). Off-season production of mango and round the year production of grapes is unique to Tamil Nadu.

The major Central and State Government Schemes implemented by the Department of Horticulture and Plantation crops are:

- a. Micro Irrigation scheme under Per Drop More Crop component of Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)
- b. Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH) - National Horticulture Mission (NHM)
- c. National Agricultural Development Programme (NADP)
- d. National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA)
 - i. Rainfed Area Development (RAD)
 - ii. Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY)
- e. National AYUSH Mission - Medicinal Plants (NAM-MP)
- f. National Bamboo Mission (NBM)
- g. Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization Project (TNIAMP) - Horticulture - IAMWARM II Project.
- h. Integrated Horticulture Development Scheme (IHDS)

- i. Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)
- j. Collective Farming Scheme
- k. Integrated Coconut Development Scheme
- l. State Horticulture Development Scheme
- m. Kalaigharin All Village Integrated Agriculture Development Programme (KAVIADP)
- n. Palmyrah Development Mission (PDM)

In addition, the Tea Board, Coffee Board, Rubber Board, Coconut Development Board and Spices Board render assistance to crops like Tea, Coffee, Coconut, Rubber and Spices.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Plantation and Horticulture has been estimated at ₹7884.31 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to value chains in horticulture.
- Encourage unemployed youth to set up private nurseries, to cater growing demand for good quality planting material.
- Enhance credit linked development of potential long gestation horticulture crops and investments through project-based approach, contract farming with user industries, cluster approach, etc.
- Tap the potential for credit flow into the horticulture crops in blocks where NABARD projects have been implemented.
- Encourage credit to processing projects at the farmgate under PMFME Scheme.

Government

- Develop farm clusters for achieving economies of scale.
- Encourage cooperative marketing through suitable incentives.
- Establish scientific onion storage structures to reduce post-harvest losses.
- Establish Food Processing Units through FPOs for processing and value addition of horticulture crops such as banana, mango and coconut in the crop-intensive blocks.
- Establish scientific storage structures for horticulture crops in Ranipet district.
- Jasmine popularly called 'Madurai Malli' is the pride of Madurai with its unique fragrance. Dedicated air cargo services can ensure constant demand and price stability.
- Establish tissue culture unit at Sirumalai to protect the native Virupakshi Banana species.
- Establish Solar Dehydrator for pepper at Kolli Hills, Namakkal district.
- Set up nurseries for supplying quality seedlings in Nagapattinam district.
- Establish Processing facilities for fruits, tomato and drumstick, including drumstick products.
- Set up food processing centres for value addition of coconut as there is scope for producing desiccated coconut powder, virgin oil, neera and other coconut-based products.
- Set up a marketing centre for cocoon in Udumalpet in Tiruppur district, which will go in a long way in reducing the cost of transportation for the farmers (at present, the farmers go to Karnataka to sell cocoons) and improve expansion of sericulture activity in the district.
- Post-harvest marketing infrastructure like banana ripening chamber and market infrastructure like banana auction centre are required in Tirunelveli district.

- Augment the capacity of godowns, cold chain and related infrastructure so as to minimize post-harvest losses and increase the income of farmers.
- Strengthen the existing infrastructure and create additional infrastructure for the Horticulture Farms in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Set up Horticulture Research Station in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Promote Bee Keeping, Mushroom cultivation and Sericulture as an alternate livelihood activity for rural women.
- Promote value addition and post-harvest management to minimize post-harvest losses and enhance farmers income.
- Set up permanent pandal vegetable structures so as to reduce crop damages and increase the vegetable yield.

4.1.5 Forestry and Wasteland Development

Forests as a life support system play a very crucial role in the ecological stability and economic security. The national goal is to have a minimum of one-third of the total land area of the country under forest or tree cover. In the hills and in mountainous regions, the aim is to maintain two-third of the area under such cover in order to prevent erosion and land degradation and to ensure the stability of the fragile eco-system. Social forestry and agroforestry are also advocated to address the present challenges of food, nutrition, energy, employment and environmental security.

In consonance with National Forest Policy, GoTN has formulated its State Forest Policy 2018 with specific emphasis on the following: (1) Nurturing a rich heritage and preserving ecology of distinct geographical characteristics of the State, (2) Enhancing the forest and tree cover, (3) Enriching wildlife habitats on scientific principles, without sacrificing the livelihood needs of the local communities specially the tribal communities and other forest dwellers.

As per the latest India's State of Forest Report, 2023 (Biennial), based on the interpretation of Indian Remote Sensing Resourcesat-2 LISS III satellite data of the period Oct 2017 to Aug 2018, the Forest Cover in the State is 26,450.22 sq km which is 20.34% of the State's geographical area. In terms of forest canopy density classes, the State has 3,586.19 sq.km of very dense forest (VDF) (2.76 % of geographical area), 11,027.03 sq.km of moderately dense forest (MDF) (8.48% of geographical area) and 11,837 sq.km of open forest (9.10 % of geographical area). The State has constituted Biodiversity Board to manage the key biodiversity resources in the State. The State also has Wetland Authority to guide, monitor and regulate the management of wetlands. Further, there is an emphasis on agro-forestry and tree-crop plantations.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 for Forestry and Wasteland Development has been assessed at ₹ 2,444.61 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to dryland horticulture, silvipasture, fodder, etc.
- Extend credit to Non-Timber Forest Produce like medicinal plant cultivation for enhancing the livelihoods of tribal people.
- Extend credit for agro-forestry for long gestation timber/ tree crops.

Government

- About 45242 ha cultivable wasteland in Thoothukudi which is mostly under *prosopis juliflora* may be diverted for alternative commercial crops with time bound action plan.
- Protect the forest reserves in Kalakadu, Cheranmadhavi and Ambasamudram blocks, Tirunelveli district with stringent implementation of legal/administrative measures.
- Regulate tourism to protect the forest resources and animal reserves.
- Introduce Auction Centre for selling timber as in Kerala.
- Upgrade the infrastructure available at Forest Research Centre and Extension Centre-cum-Nursery in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Relax the provisions in respect of scheduled timber trees such as blackwood, red sanders, rosewood, sandalwood and teak wood which are in high demand in market to encourage more farmers to establish these plantations.
- Propagate importance of tree planting, suitability of trees for local conditions, establishing demo plots of plantations and ensuring the availability of good quality seedlings through the Forestry Extension Centres.

4.1.6 Animal Husbandry - Dairy

Animal husbandry is a source of regular income and subsidiary employment to nearly 70% of the rural population. Animals provide nutrient rich food products, draught power, dung as organic manure and domestic fuel, hides & skin and are regular source of cash income for rural households. Livestock Sector is an important subsector of agriculture in the Indian economy. During 2022-23, the Gross State Value Added (GSVA) in Livestock Sector was ₹1,23,822 crore at current prices (Advance Estimate). Livestock sector contributes about 5.69% to GSVA of the State and 45.32% to agriculture and allied activities.

India has vast resources of livestock and poultry, which play a vital role in improving the socio-economic conditions of rural masses. Dairy is the single largest agricultural commodity contributing 5% of the national economy and employing more than 8 crore farmers directly. As per FAO, India is ranked first in milk production contributing 25 percent of global milk production. During 2023-24, milk production in Tamil Nadu is 10.80 MT, contributing a share of 4.52% of total milk production in the country. The milk production in Tamil Nadu in 2023-24 has increased by 6.93% as compared to 2022-23. The per capita availability of milk in India increased to 471 gram per day in 2023-24 from 459 gram per day in 2022-23. In Tamil Nadu, the per capita availability of milk has increased from 369 grams per day in 2022-23 to 384 grams per day during 2023-24. (Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2024, MoFAHD, GoI)

The various initiatives of the GoTN, like community fodder development, strengthening the AH infrastructure, providing veterinary services, establishment of new semen bank, veterinary center will ensure better quality of the animals and the produce.

As per the 20th Livestock Census, the cattle population of the State *vis-à-vis* All India is given below:

Table 4.3: Livestock details

Species	Population in India (Lakh No.)		Population in Tamil Nadu (Lakh No)		% of Population in Tamil Nadu	
	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census
Cattle	1909.04	1,924.83	88.14	95.19	4.61	4.92
Buffalo	1087.02	1,098.52	7.81	5.19	0.71	0.47

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Animal Husbandry - Dairy has been assessed at ₹ 26,751.82 crore

Suggested Action points

Banks

- Extend credit to individuals, SHGs, FPOs for tie-up arrangements with milk societies for assured repayments; try cluster financing approach; encourage setting up of mini dairy units with fodder cultivation including hydroponics as an integral part.
- Extend credit for silage units so as to overcome non-availability of green fodder during summer season.
- Extend credit for milch animals integrated with fodder cultivation in wastelands/marginal lands, wherever feasible.
- Extend credit under KCC-AH to meet the working capital requirement of AH sector.

Government

- Promote dairy infrastructure, new milk routes, producer organizations, etc., in Vellore district.
- Set up milk cooling centers of 5000 LPD capacity in Sawyerpuram, Vilathikulam and Seithunganallur in Thoothukudi district.
- Set up 50 additional dispensaries and development of model fodder farms in Kanniyakumari district.
- Set up Animal Shelters in disaster prone areas of Muthupet in Tiruvarur district to shelter animals during cyclones.
- Improve infrastructure facilities such as training hall, Audio-Visual aids, furniture, etc. in VUTRC, Erode; Burgur Cattle Research Station (BCRS) and Kangeyam Cattle Research station (KCRS) in Erode district.
- Set up a cattle feed manufacturing plant in Tirunelveli district.
- Increase the capacity of the cold storage, milk processing, milk transportation and bulk milk chilling units of the Dharmapuri District Co-operative Milk Producers Union since there is a high milk production in the district.
- Construct Outpatient sheds, renovate/repair the Veterinary Dispensaries which are in bad condition in Ariyalur district.
- Set up a district level animal disease diagnostic lab for disease surveillance and forecasting of animal disease for prevention/immunization in Ariyalur district.
- Set up animal husbandry farm/ fodder farm, hatcheries for poultry, slaughterhouses, milk procurement centres, bulk milk cooler and processing units in Perambalur and Thoothukudi districts.

4.1.7 Animal Husbandry - Poultry

Poultry farming provides subsidiary income and gainful employment to farmers throughout the year. Among the various poultry rearing activities, Layer and Broiler farming are popular on commercial lines. Broiler farming is being taken up on contract basis, wherein small farmers enter into contract arrangements with the larger poultry companies, who provide inputs and buy back the birds. Poultry rearing, which was a cottage industry, has now become a big industry. In the context of attaining nutritional security, poultry eggs, and poultry meat are comparatively less expensive than that of red meat which is an important source of highly nutritious and rich protein source.

According to FAOSTAT production data (2023), India ranks 2nd in Egg Production and 8th in meat production in the world. Egg production in the country has increased from 78.48 billion in 2014-15 to 142.77 billion in 2023-24. Egg production in the country is growing at the rate of 8% per annum. During the year 2023-24, Tamil Nadu produced 22.33 billion eggs which accounted for 15.64% of egg production and stood 2nd in India. The per capita availability of egg is at 291 eggs per annum in Tamil Nadu which is higher than 103 eggs per annum in India in 2023-24.

Meat production in the country has increased from 6.69 MT in 2014-15 to 10.25 MT in 2023-24 with contribution of poultry meat by 48.96%. Tamil Nadu produced 0.77 MT of meat in 2023-24 with the share of 7.49% in total meat production and ranks 6th in the nation. (Source: Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2024)

TANUVAS has developed an indigenous hatching and rearing unit for country chicken with low cost and low mortality rate. Veterinary University Training and Research Centre (VUTRC) affiliated to TANUVAS provides skill training on poultry feed preparation, marketing of country chicken, custom hatching of desi chicken eggs, turkey eggs, etc.

Table 4.4: Poultry population of the State vis-à-vis All India

Species	Population in India (Lakh No.)		Population in Tamil Nadu (Lakh No.)		% of Population in Tamil Nadu	
	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census
Backyard Poultry	2174.9	3170.7	139.19	212.65	6.40%	6.71%
Farm Poultry	5117.2	5347.4	1034.29	995.16	20.21%	18.61%
Total Poultry	7292.1	8518.1	1173.49	1207.81	16.09%	14.18%

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Animal Husbandry - Poultry has been assessed at ₹ 10,984.50 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to establish full- fledged packaging centre and cold storage to improve egg exports.
- Encourage contract farming for broiler activity and extend credit to units for capital investments like sheds, equipment, etc., after ascertaining the credibility and capability of the service providers.
- Extend credit for backyard poultry through SHGs/JLGs.

- Facilitate easy access to credit for small and medium-sized poultry farmers, promoting financial inclusion and supporting investment in modern farming practices.

Government

- Establish cold storages for storing poultry products and egg for export in Namakkal district.
- Provide infrastructure facilities for the health care of birds.
- Promote hatchery units for production & supply of chicks of low-input technology variety birds and day-old chicks to farmers.
- Create adequate awareness among the farmers/ poultry growers on the various schemes implemented by GoI and GoTN.
- Encourage small poultry feed units operated by producer groups/ small farmers group with suitable incentive/ support.
- Construct 4-5 Modern Abattoirs with facilities such as cleaning area for cut animals, cold room for storing of leftover meat, toilets for the public, tea/ coffee parlour, parking place for vehicle, etc., in Erode district to maintain the hygienic condition of cut animals.
- Educate the retail meat traders on the use of Modern Abattoir.
- Arrange for programs to educate poultry farmers on modern farming techniques, disease management, and efficient farm management practices.
- Promote production of maize, which is a major constituent accounting for 40% to 50% of the poultry feed.
- Implement stringent bio-security measures in poultry farms to prevent the spread of diseases, safeguarding the health of the poultry population.
- Strengthen research and extension services to disseminate best practices, new technologies, and disease management strategies to poultry farmers.
- Advocate for the enforcement of robust animal welfare standards, ensuring humane conditions for poultry throughout their lifecycle.

4.1.8 Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat & Pig

Goat is known as 'Poor man's cow' in India and is a very important component of dry land farming. With very low investments, goat, sheep and pig rearing can be made into a profitable venture for small and marginal farmers and landless agricultural labourers as it is a source of livelihood and also provides supplementary income.

Table 4.5: Sheep, Goat and Pig population of the State vis-à-vis All India

Species	Population in India (Lakh No.)		Population in Tamil Nadu (Lakh No)		% of Population in Tamil Nadu	
	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census	19 th LS Census	20 th LS Census
Sheep	650.69	742.61	47.87	45.00	7.36%	6.06%
Goat	1351.73	1488.85	81.43	98.89	6.02%	6.64%
Pigs	102.94	90.55	1.84	0.67	1.79%	0.74%

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery has been assessed at ₹ 6376.02 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend liberal credit to the sector, subject to usual norms, in close coordination with the implementing agencies/ department.
- Extend credit through SHGs/JLGs.
- Extend credit for green fodder cultivation for ensuring better income to farmers taking up stall fed goat rearing.

Government

- Promote among farmers the GoI Subsidy Scheme of National Livestock Mission (NLM) for goat and piggery to improve their income and livelihood.
- Set up market/ shandies for trading goats in Nagapattinam district.
- Construct 4-5 Modern Abattoirs with facilities such as cleaning area for cut animals, cold room for storing of leftover meat, toilets for the public, tea/ coffee parlour, parking place for vehicle, etc., in Erode district to maintain the hygienic condition of cut animals.
- Educate the retail meat traders on the use of Modern Abattoir.
- Promote regulated markets to support fair trade of animal in Ramanathapuram district.
- Promote quality native breeds like Pallaiyadu, Chenkanniyadu which yield 2-4 lambs and are good for meat.
- Encourage rearing of animals in Integrated Farming System (even in 2 acre of land) which will enable the farmer to go for organic farming and use all the resources in the field to reduce the expenses and get better price for organic produce.
- Promote improved fodder management, including investments in fodder cultivation, preservation, and storage facilities, to ensure year-round availability of nutritious feed for livestock.
- Enhance cold storage facilities with incentives.
- Set up at least one cold storage with 10 ton capacity per block for storing meat.
- District Livestock Farms to produce and maintain quality rams and ewes for selling them to local farmers to improve progeny and breeding.
- Arrange to provide quality breeds for increasing the meat production.
- Strengthen backward and forward linkages by fostering partnerships between livestock farmers and markets. Facilitate direct procurement arrangements to ensure fair pricing and reduce dependency on intermediaries.

4.1.9 Fisheries Development

Fisheries is an important economic activity that contributes for significant growth in nutritional security, employment generation and foreign exchange earnings. Tamil Nadu is a leading State with Marine, Inland and Coastal waters with rich biodiversity of aquatic fauna and flora. The sector plays an important role in the socio - economic development of the state by providing livelihood to a large number of fishers and fish farmers, generating employment opportunities in allied sectors and ensuring nutritional security. Tamil Nadu is blessed with

1,076 km long coastline along the 14 coastal districts and forms the second longest coastline in the country. Fisheries sector encompasses fish production from fresh water, marine and brackish water sources. Aquaculture and Mariculture are emerging as a prominent activity for enhancing Fish, Shrimp, Mussels, Seaweed production and income generation in the State.

The fishery resources of the State support the livelihood of 10.48 lakh marine fisherfolk and 2.36 lakh inland fisherfolk. In the fiscal year 2022-23, the sector contributed 6.26% to the State's agricultural GDP. Tamil Nadu stands at 5th position in marine fish production in the country with a total fish production of 8.29 lakh tonnes. The fisheries sector contributed ₹6,957.67 crore to foreign exchange earnings by exporting 1.23 lakh tonnes of fish and related products during the period.

Integrating fish culture with agriculture has proved to be an option for augmenting the unit productivity from aquaculture systems.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Fisheries sector has been assessed at ₹5066.74 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- KCC for fisheries will improve livelihood of fisher folk.
- Design credit schemes which may include working capital requirement through KCC for fisheries that cater to the diverse needs of individuals involved in the fisheries sector, including small-scale and artisanal fishermen.
- Promoting and financing of seaweed culture and processing in priority basis.
- Encourage value chain financing in fisheries sector.
- Promote and strengthen fisheries FPO with bank finance.
- Cold storages of smaller capacities may be promoted with bank finance.
- Facilitate easy access to credit for fishermen and aquaculturists.

Government

- Establish Solar Driers across Coastal Villages for Quality Dry Fish production in Cuddalore, Tiruvallur and Chengalpattu districts.
- Renovation of Fish Landing Centre at Tharuvaikulam, New Harbour, Vembar, Tiruchendur, Kayalpattinam, Veerapandiyanpattinam in Thoothukudi district.
- Since the present lighting arrangement is very weak in Vembar, Keezhvaippar, Sippikulam, Periyasampuram, Pattinamaruthur, Thalamuthunagar, Kombuthurai, Singithurai and Veerapandiyanpattinam in Thoothukudi district, solar lighting may be introduced in these fishing villages.
- Set up adequate processing centers and cold storages in Kanniyakumari district to avoid transporting the fish produce to other places for processing.
- Shore protection measures by converting existing groynes into breakwaters subject to technical feasibility in Kanniyakumari district.
- Create additional infrastructure facilities in the harbours, modernization of harbours, upgradation of fish landing points into fish landing centres with facilities such as auction centre, net mending hall and drying yards; establishment of Fish Seed Farm/ Hatchery,

modernisation of Fish markets and establishment of Fish Processing units in Mayiladuthurai and Nagapattinam districts.

- Establish Integrated Ornamental Fish Market cum Auction Centre in Madurai district.
- Dredging Koraiyaru and Valavanar river and removing the sea sledge in Tiruvarur district.
- Set up freezing plants/ice plants/cold storages for fishery development.
- Desilt tanks suitable for fisheries at regular intervals for taking up inland fishery activities.
- Strengthen embankment of lakes and tanks; provide shutters in the canals which will pave way for more intensive inland fisheries activities.
- Strengthen the infrastructure in the Fish Seed Farms including setting up of freezing plant/cold storage.
- Set up an Aquarium near Courtallam in Tenkasi district.
- Encourage SHGs, SHG Federations, FIGs, FCs and FPOs to attempt fish culture in panchayat tanks.
- Conduct Awareness Camps and Training on freshwater fish farming & ornamental fish breeding.
- Develop and modernize fishing harbors, including facilities for berthing, ice plants, cold storage, and processing units for efficient landing, handling, and preservation of fish.
- Promote investments in cold storage and processing facilities to minimize losses and maintain the quality of fish and seafood products for meeting export standards and ensuring food safety.

4.1.10 Farm Credit- Others, including Two Wheelers for farmers

Despite significant advancements in agricultural mechanization through power-driven vehicles, bullocks and bullock-carts remain indispensable for small and marginal farmers across the agricultural landscape. These traditional farming assets continue to provide critical draught power and transportation capabilities, offering cost-effective solutions for agricultural operations. Two-wheelers have simultaneously emerged as a transformative mobility tool for farmers, enabling efficient transportation of agricultural inputs, quick market access, and low-maintenance mobility. Bullock cart-driven implements present a sustainable approach to reducing farm drudgery without escalating fuel or electricity expenses, while two-wheelers complement these traditional methods by enhancing farmers' operational flexibility. The Agricultural Engineering Department can play a pivotal role by promoting innovative implement designs that integrate traditional bullock-cart technologies with modern two-wheeler adaptations, ultimately empowering small farmers with affordable, sustainable agricultural solutions that respect both technological advancement and economic constraints.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Other Activities sector- Bullocks, Bullock-carts has been assessed at ₹ 7777.14 crore

4.1.11 Sustainable Agriculture Practices

Sustainable agriculture practices in Tamil Nadu are crucial for enhancing farmers' resilience and economic stability. The Integrated Farming System (IFS) emerges as a comprehensive approach to agricultural development, offering multiple benefits including balanced diet provision, income maximization, and employment generation. By combining diverse agricultural activities such as crop production, livestock management, poultry, and fisheries,

farmers can create a symbiotic ecosystem that optimizes resource utilization. Key sustainable agricultural practices include crop rotation, mixed cropping, conservation agriculture, and integrated pest management. The state can promote IFS models like Dairy + Crop Production + Horticulture, which not only improve farm productivity but also ensure environmental harmony. Additionally, implementing strategies such as vermicomposting, bio-fertilizers, rainwater harvesting, and adopting climate-resilient crop varieties can further strengthen agricultural sustainability. These practices help reduce dependency on external inputs, enhance soil fertility, minimize environmental pollution, and provide farmers with year-round income streams, ultimately contributing to the holistic development of rural communities.

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Explore possibility of financing IFS models in cluster mode.

Government

- Strengthen extension services to disseminate information about sustainable agricultural practices and integrated farming.
- Develop programs that focus on educating farmers about soil health, crop rotation, and pest management without excessive chemical use.
- Develop new models of integrated farming with various modern agriculture practices in collaboration with research institutions and private enterprises.
- Incorporate advanced agricultural practices, adopting precision farming technologies, infusion of cutting-edge technologies, skill development initiatives to farmers and agripreneurs, knowledge dissemination, integration of various government schemes and programs, will ensure resilient, efficient, and economically viable integrated farming sector in the state, fostering holistic rural development.
- Promote IFS Model on mission mode as this can help in enhancing farmers' income.
- Initiate Mission on Integrated Farming Systems by converging various schemes of crop, husbandry, horticulture, livestock, and fisheries.

4.2 Agriculture Infrastructure

4.2.1 Construction of Storage and Marketing Infrastructure

The construction of effective storage and marketing infrastructure is crucial for optimizing post-harvest management in Tamil Nadu's agricultural sector. Currently, the state's storage capacity is predominantly managed by three public agencies viz., Food Corporation of India (FCI), Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) and State Warehousing Corporation (SWC). These government entities primarily utilize their storage facilities to maintain buffer stocks essential for public distribution systems and various government initiatives, thereby limiting available space for private stakeholders to store their agricultural produce.

Efficient market operations serve as a vital link between producers and consumers, enhancing the welfare of both groups. Therefore, addressing the infrastructure needs for storage and marketing should be prioritized. The Government of India has introduced several credit-linked schemes, such as the Agricultural Marketing Infrastructure (AMI) Scheme and the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF), aimed at boosting the development of post-harvest facilities and primary processing infrastructure. Under these schemes, financial assistance is provided for constructing or renovating warehouses in rural areas, with subsidies ranging from 25% to 33.33% of the project's capital cost depending on the beneficiary category.

In Tamil Nadu, enhancing storage capacity is imperative to mitigate post-harvest losses, which can range from 15% to 40%. The introduction of innovative solutions like Online Storage Management (OSM) by FCI is expected to improve efficiency in food grain storage and distribution. Furthermore, investments in cold storage facilities are essential for preserving perishable commodities, particularly vegetables and seed spices.

To maximize these opportunities, it is recommended that stakeholders—including state government bodies, banks, and farmer cooperatives—collaborate to develop a robust network of storage facilities that meet both current needs and future demands. This strategic approach will empower farmers to make informed selling decisions while ensuring food security and enhancing overall agricultural productivity in Tamil Nadu.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under this sector has been assessed at ₹9,914.18 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Encourage entrepreneurs by making available adequate credit and facilitate them in availing subsidy from Agri Marketing Infrastructure Scheme and Interest Subvention & Credit Guarantee under Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) for setting up cold storages, rural godowns, seed processing plants and other facilities.
- Extend pledge loan facilities to small and marginal farmers.

Government

- Develop one drying yard per panchayat village by allotting required land by the district administration in all districts.
- Renovate the cold storage in Pudur, Vilathikulam in Thoothukudi district, which will be helpful for chilli farmers in the district.
- Establish warehouse/ rural godown under hub and spoke model in Alwarthirunagari, Srivaikuntam and Karungulam blocks, Thoothukudi district.
- Construction of Onion Cold storage facility in Tirumangalam in Madurai district.
- Storage facilities for different kinds of agricultural products have to be created in the production areas or nearby places particularly in the rural areas of Sivagangai district so that the farmers can transport their produce to these places immediately after harvest in the shortest possible time.
- Establish Regulated Markets (RMs) with 2000 MT Godown and drying yard in uncovered blocks of Thoothukudi district to avoid exploitation of farmers by the middlemen.
- Establish rural shandies/ markets in all locations in Krishnagiri district, where weekly or daily shandies are held, especially in the panchayats in the backward areas of Anchetty, Thally, Veppanapalli, Mathur, etc.
- Create adequate storage and marketing infrastructure in Tenkasi district to increase the holding capacity of farmers and enabling them to get remunerative prices for their produce.
- Establish more Primary Processing Centers (PPCs).
- Promote and strengthen producers' groups to set up godowns / cold storages / primary processing facilities.

- Construct godowns and upgrade infrastructure of Marketing Committees in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Provide necessary support to the banks in mobilizing viable projects for financing under AMI and AIF.
- Accredite the existing storage facilities with various agencies including PACCS as per WDRA guidelines, so that Negotiable Warehouse Receipt System can pick up in the state.
- Encourage collaboration between producer cooperatives/ companies and the corporate sector to promote agro-processing industry.
- Develop and upgrade market yards and grading centers equipped with modern facilities for efficient sorting, grading, and packaging of agricultural produce.
- Promote the integration of traditional markets with e-marketing platforms, enabling farmers to access a broader customer base and receive fair prices for their produce. Facilitate the adoption of digital payment systems in agricultural markets, reducing the reliance on cash transactions and enhancing financial transparency.

4.2.2 Land Development, Soil Conservation and Watershed Development

Land development comprises all the activities undertaken by farmers to improve productivity of land to prevent soil erosion and to improve land quality. Efficient management of land resources is a pre-requisite for increasing agricultural production especially as the average size of the land holding in the State is 0.75 ha, i.e., less than the national average size of land holding (1.08 ha). Land development encompasses activities like land leveling, on-farm development, terraces, stone bunding, drainage, trenches, fences, water-harvesting structures like farm ponds, check-dams, nala-bund, etc. These improve productivity of land to prevent soil erosion, improve land quality and improve productivity by retaining the soil and water component.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under this sector has been estimated at ₹2589.34 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit for land development and land reclamation activities.

Government

- Create irrigation potential by bringing watershed projects in Tirunelveli district.
- Take up soil reclamation measures in the coastal blocks of Nanguneri and Radhapuram to bring "Theri Lands" under cultivation.
- Harness the vast fallow in Melaneelithanallur, Sankarankovil, Vasudevanallur, Kuruvikulam blocks of Tenkasi district.
- Construct farm ponds in farmers' fields in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Encourage Integrated Farming System, diversified farming and Rainfed Area Development among small and marginal farmers.
- Popularize organic manure through Vermi-compost, Urban Compost (Municipal area garbage)

- Promote Integrated Pest Management (IPM), Integrated Nutrient Management (INM), eco-friendly technologies, etc.
- Encourage soil testing, providing soil health cards, balanced application of nutrients to improve the soil fertility and productivity.
- Capacitate farmers on reclamation of saline soils through suitable methods such as scraping, flushing, leaching, drainage and application of soil amendments.
- Encourage land levelling, bunding, field channels, terracing, etc., in the high rainfall areas.
- Install proper drainage structures in high rainfall areas.
- Construct and renovate water storage structures such as check dams, ponds, and reservoirs to enhance water availability during dry periods.

4.2.3 Others - Tissue Culture, Vermicompost, etc.

Seed, pesticide and fertilizer are the trinity of improving the production and productivity of the crops. Better seed replacement coupled with high quality seeds can improve productivity. To foster sustainable agricultural practices, there is a growing emphasis on organic farming methods in Tamil Nadu. These methods include the application of green manure, the use of bio-fertilizers and bio-pesticides, and the practice of vermicomposting. Vermicomposting not only enriches soil fertility but also enhances its physical and chemical properties, promoting healthier crops and improved agricultural productivity. Studies indicate that vermicompost can significantly increase crop yield by improving soil structure and nutrient availability, thus supporting the overall health of the ecosystem. By encouraging the adoption of organic farming techniques, the input costs can be reduced while creating a toxin-free environment. This aligns with broader agricultural development goals that focus on increasing food security, enhancing farmer income, and promoting environmental sustainability. Tissue culture plays an important role in horticulture production. For improving soil fertility in the natural way, organic farming methods of cultivation, application of green manure, use of bio-fertilizers, bio-pesticides and vermicomposting are being promoted among farmers.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under this sector has been estimated at ₹3438.86 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit for organic cultivation of both field and horticultural crops, captive vermicompost units, bio-pesticide and bio-fertilizer units, coir pith composting units, etc.

Government

- Develop Palmyra Cluster and Chilly Cluster units in Thoothukudi district.
- Establish Seed Processing Unit (SPUs) for Paddy, Millets and Pulses in Thoothukudi and Nagapattinam districts.
- Set up drying yard at Vallam and Mailam blocks in Villupuram district.
- Promote activity-based clusters with Common Facility Centre for primary processing among SHGs, JLGs, FIGs and FPOs.

- Establish rural shandies/ market infrastructure in villages where weekly or daily shandies are held especially in the backward areas of Anchetty, Thally, Veppanapalli, Mathur, etc.
- Set up bio-fertiliser production units.
- Encourage bio-inputs production centres in respect of bio-inputs whose efficacy have been proved.

4.3 Ancillary Activities

4.3.1 Food and Agro Processing

The Food and Agro-Processing sector in Tamil Nadu encompasses the transformation of raw material from various agricultural sources including food grains, horticultural and plantation products, forest produce, livestock, and fisheries into value-added products. This industry is pivotal in preserving food, generating employment, and boosting export revenues.

Status of Food Processing in Tamil Nadu: The Department of Agricultural Marketing & Agri Business has initiated measures to reduce post-harvest losses and increase the processing of fruits and vegetables from the current 2% to 10%. Under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana (PMKSY), eight agro-processing clusters are being established with an investment of ₹218 crore in the districts of Theni, Dindigul, Krishnagiri, Tiruvannamalai, Salem, Cuddalore, Villupuram, and Madurai. These clusters aim to enhance processing capabilities and benefit farmers in adjacent areas. (Source: [Ministry of Food Processing Industries](#))

To further augment farmers' income, minimize food wastage, and add value to farm products, the state has introduced the Tamil Nadu Food Processing Policy 2018. This policy encourages investments, innovation, and job creation in the food processing sector. (Source: [NSWS, Tamil Nadu Food Processing Policy-2018.pdf](#)). Additionally, the Tamil Nadu Food Processing and Agri Export Promotion Corporation (TNAPEX) has been established to propel the state's agricultural and food processing sectors towards global prominence by fostering innovation, sustainability, and market-driven strategies. (Source: [TNApex](#))

The Government of India's Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises (PMFME) Scheme, launched in June 2020, is a centrally sponsored initiative under the Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan. With an outlay of ₹10,000 crore for the period FY 2020-2025, now extended to FY 2025-26, the scheme aims to enhance the competitiveness of existing individual micro-enterprises in the unorganized food processing sector and promote its formalization. The PMFME Scheme provides a 35% credit-linked capital subsidy to food processing entrepreneurs, with a maximum ceiling of ₹10 lakh per unit. It also offers seed capital of ₹40,000 per Self Help Group (SHG) member for working capital and the purchase of small tools. Furthermore, the scheme provides a 50% financial grant for branding and marketing support to groups such as Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs), SHGs, cooperatives, or Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) of micro food processing enterprises. (Source: [PMFME](#))

In Tamil Nadu, the PMFME Scheme adopts the One District One Product (ODOP) approach to promote local products in the food processing sector. (Source: [Press Information Bureau](#)). This strategy aims to reap the benefits of scale in terms of procurement of inputs, availing common services and marketing of products.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Food and Agro Processing sector has been estimated at ₹15462.95 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to entrepreneurs in food/agro processing sectors as timely flow of credit will ensure good returns.
- Train and credit link matured SHGs for setting up of small agro processing units in potential rural areas.
- Extend credit to unorganized units to modernize and upscale with the support under PMFME.
- Closely liaise with DIC to leverage on the benefits of various subsidy schemes implemented by the State and Centre for financing activities in the sector.

Government

- Set up Cashew Processing Centres in Cuddalore, Tiruchirappalli (Pachamalai Hills) and Ariyalur districts.
- Establish dedicated Turmeric Export Centre with facilities for sorting, grading and packing to meet international standards, in Erode district to streamline the logistics of handling and exporting turmeric.
- Set up Food Processing Centre in Madathukulam, Tiruppur district to improve the processing capacity in tomato, coconut and onion.
- Set up Food Park/Agro Processing Cluster for Cashew.
- Set up Bulk Milk Cooling/Chilling units in Kalvarayan Hills in Kallakurichi district.
- Set up Mango Processing Unit in Tiruvallur district.
- Establish Processing Centre for egg powder, cold storage and testing lab for egg exports in Namakkal district.
- Establish Mango Pulp units with Common Facility Centre and facility for tetra packing or plastic bottle packing in Krishnagiri district require. Such a common facility will benefit small traders.
- Establish Rice Processing Units in Thanjavur district to meet the growing demand for high-quality rice.
- Set up rice bran oil extraction units, cattle feed units utilizing bran cakes, and facilities for producing husk-based products.
- Establish Banana Ripening Chambers at Sawyerpuram, Srivaikuntam and Alwarthirunagari.
- Tissue culture Propagation Unit at Srivaikuntam in Thoothukudi district.
- Value Addition Units for Maize/Pulses at Thoothukudi, Kovilpatti and Vilathikulam
- Processing facilities for Banana, Jackfruit and Pineapple in Thoothukudi district.

- Establish Common Facility Centres (CFC) for groundnut processing at multiple places in Tiruvannamalai district to enable accessibility to high end processing infrastructure to all farmers in the district.
- Set up Primary Processing units at Village/Cluster levels in Nagapattinam district.
- Set up Agro Processing Clusters/Food Parks to promote food processing industries related to rice, pulses, groundnut, sesame, coconut, mango, cotton and fisheries in Nagapattinam district.
- Set up Common Facility Centre with grading, sorting and packing for Lemon in Tenkasi district.
- Set up Food Park/Agro Processing Cluster in Ariyalur and Perambalur districts.
- Create awareness on branding and the regulations governing the export of food products. Implement strategies to promote the export of processed food products.
- Encourage and incentivise FPOs to take up primary processing and grading for enhancing farmers' income.
- Strengthen quality control through food testing laboratories duly accredited by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI).
- Strengthen backward and forward linkages by facilitating partnerships between agro-processors and farmers.
- Encourage direct procurement arrangements and establish transparent pricing mechanisms to benefit both producers and processors.
- Encourage agro-processors to adopt circular economy practices, including the recycling and reuse of by-products and waste generated during processing.
- Encourage formation of agro-processing clusters where multiple processing units can benefit from shared infrastructure, knowledge exchange, and collaborative marketing efforts.

4.3.2 Other Activities

Agriculture ancillary activities provide necessary vigour and requisite linkages for the agriculture sector to establish, strengthen and grow further. Some of the ancillary activities are setting up Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centres (ACABC) which aim not only to supplement efforts of the government's public extension support to farmers but also to create gainful self-employment opportunities to agriculture professionals and facilitate timely services to farmers on crop management.

Credit needs of small and marginal farmers, especially those who are unable to provide any security, is yet to be fully met by the banking system. The gap could be effectively bridged by the registered MFIs in the districts, especially for low income generating economic activities, including the traditional sectors viz., animal husbandry activities.

Primary Agricultural Cooperative Credit Societies (PACS) are grass root level Cooperative institutions which empower farmers by providing affordable credit, fostering savings, and promoting community-based financial resilience. PACS play a pivotal role in rural economies, offering financial inclusion and stability. Adequate funding ensures farmers' access to resources, technology, and market opportunities, fostering sustainable agricultural practices and overall rural development. Further, it enhances the socio-economic well-being of farmers, strengthens agricultural infrastructure, and contributes to food security.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under this sector has been estimated at ₹8003.04 crore

Suggested Action points

Banks

- Extend credit to eligible beneficiaries under the AC ABC Subsidy Scheme.
- Undertake exposure visit to successful Agripreneurs supported under ACABC.
- PACS may establish the Custom Hiring Centres and act as Business Correspondents to banks for the welfare of the farmers and for increased income.
- Promote Stand up India Scheme.
- Extend credit through MFIs registered with RBI and fulfilling the conditions stipulated for on-lending, after taking due care of avoidance of duplicate financing.

Government

- Create awareness among the farmers for availing the services of AC ABC for appropriate technologies for improving productivity, quality of the farm produce and provide market intelligence for better price realization in the rural areas.
- Encourage AC ABC promoting custom hiring, maintenance of farm equipment, sale of inputs and other services in agriculture and allied areas, including post-harvest management, market linkages for income generation entrepreneurship development.
- Encourage one-stop shop for all credit and non-credit needs of farmers.

4.4 Micro Small and Medium Enterprises

The Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) sector is a vital component of India's economy, contributing significantly to employment generation, innovation, and the country's GDP. As per the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE), 2023-24, conducted by the National Sample Survey Office, Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation, there were approximately 733.99 lakh unincorporated non-agriculture MSMEs in India, out of which the contributions of manufacturing, trade and other services are 27%, 31% and 42% respectively. (Source: https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/publication_reports/Factsheet_of_ASUSE_2023_24.pdf)

With a view to reducing dependency of labour on farm sector activities, development of off-farm sector activities is very critical. Considering the importance of off-farm sector, major initiatives and policy changes have been effected by RBI & GoI. Schemes of GoI viz., Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY), Stand Up India Scheme and Start up India Scheme and various schemes of GoTN continue to facilitate organized growth of MSME sector in the state.

In accordance with the provision of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises Development (MSMED) Act, 2006 and the Central Government Gazette Notification on June 26, 2020, a new criteria for classifying the enterprises as Micro, Small and Medium enterprises has come into effect from 1 July, 2020, which is provided below:

Table 4.6 Criteria for classification of MSME

Classification	Manufacturing Enterprises and Enterprises rendering services	
	Investment in Plant & Machinery or Equipment	Annual Turnover
Micro	Less than ₹ 1 crore	Less than ₹ 5 crore
Small	Less than ₹ 10 crore	Less than ₹ 50 crore
Medium	Less than ₹ 50 crore	Less than ₹ 250 crore

MSME - Priority Sector Lending Classification

All loans to units in the KVI sector will be eligible for priority sector lending classification under the sub-target of 7.5 percent prescribed for Micro Enterprises. Loans up to ₹50 crore to Start-ups, will be eligible for classification under Priority Sector as per definition of Ministry of Commerce and Industry, GoI.

Status of MSME in Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu stands as a significant contributor to India's MSME landscape. As of March 2024, the state accounted for approximately 8% of the country's MSMEs, with around five million enterprises. Notably, Tamil Nadu represents nearly 15.24% of India's micro-enterprises and boasts the highest number of non-farm units. The state is a leader in sectors such as automobile parts and components, readymade garments, and leather goods, providing a robust vendor base to large industries. The majority of MSMEs in Tamil Nadu are concentrated in industries including food and beverages, textiles and apparel, printing, metal fabrication, machinery and equipment, leather, rubber and plastics, chemicals, wood, and furniture. Manufacturing MSMEs are predominantly located in districts like Chennai, Coimbatore, Erode, Kanchipuram, Krishnagiri, Madurai, Salem, Tirupur, Virudhunagar, and Vellore. Service-oriented MSMEs are mainly found in Chennai, Coimbatore, Dindigul, Kanchipuram, Namakkal, Salem, Thoothukudi, Tiruvallur, Trichy, and Vellore.

Recognizing the critical role of the MSME sector in economic development and in reducing dependency on agriculture, both the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the Government of India have implemented several initiatives and policy changes such as Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana, Stand Up India Scheme, Startup India Scheme, etc., and schemes of GoTN viz., Capital Subsidy to MSMEs, Back-Ended Interest Subsidy (BEIS), Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme (AABCS), Naan Mudalvan Scheme, etc.

Tamil Nadu has a rich cultural heritage reflected in its diverse handicrafts. The state is renowned for exquisite crafts such as life-like stone sculptures, celestial bronze figures, brass lamps, rosewood and sandalwood carvings, Tanjore art plates, Tanjore paintings, Pattamadai mats, Kancheepuram sarees, and traditional musical instruments. These crafts not only preserve the state's cultural legacy but also contribute to the economy by providing employment and promoting tourism.

The GoTN places significant emphasis on facilitating credit access for the MSME sector. Various outreach programs are conducted throughout the year to ensure that MSMEs can avail themselves of financial services, thereby promoting inclusive growth and sustainable development.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under MSME has been estimated at ₹3,45,245.10 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Issue Weavers Credit Cards (WCC) to eligible weavers.
- Issue Swarozgar Credit Card (SCC) to small entrepreneurs and artisans.
- Extend MUDRA loans to all eligible applicants with minimum turnaround time so that beneficiaries may avail timely and low-cost credit.
- Liaise with industry associations, training establishments to reach out to the potential new borrowers.
- Extend loans to trainees who have undergone EDP at RUDSETI, RSETI & INDSETI and NABARD's MEDP and LEDPs targeted at SHGs/Women.
- Develop portal on various credit facilities for MSME for financial product dissemination and selection, documentation assistance for both borrower and lender.

Government

- Establish Common Facility Centre for handloom weavers and establishment of a model textile park for power loom sarees and yarn bank in Salem district.
- Set up District level Marketing Centers to provide marketing infrastructure for rural non-farm sector products in Kanniyakumari district.
- Set up Common Facility Centers (CFCs) for sericulture clusters for reeling, spinning and shared equipment in Dharmapuri district.
- Establish higher capacity Common Effluent Treatment Plants either on its own or under PPP mode in Chennimalai, Perundurai SIPCOT, Bhavani and Erode in Erode district for safe disposal of effluents arising from dyeing, bleaching units, tanneries, etc.
- Upload the skill training requirement in Nabskill portal of NABARD.
- Provide necessary infrastructure in industrial clusters for competitiveness of the units.
- Popularise the single window clearance to enable next generation entrepreneurs to take up business activity.
- Establish rural artisan complex / common work sheds.
- Intensify the efforts for cluster development and formation of Off-farm Producer Organisation in identified clusters.
- Extend support to banks in dovetailing with various Govt schemes for MSMEs and assist in recovery of loans.
- Address challenges related to logistics and connectivity by improving transportation infrastructure.
- Enhance road networks, connect industrial zones, and facilitate last-mile connectivity to reduce transportation costs for MSMEs.
- Simplify regulatory processes and compliance requirements.
- Streamline licensing procedures, environmental clearances, and other regulatory aspects to reduce the administrative burden on MSMEs.
- Encourage MSMEs to integrate with e-commerce platforms to broaden their market presence and e-payment systems.

4.5 Export Credit

Tamil Nadu is a significant contributor to India's export landscape, with key exports including garments, textiles, automobiles, agricultural products (such as fruits, rice, and vegetables),

cotton, oil, turmeric, fireworks, handicrafts, rubber and rubber products, leather and leather goods, horticultural products, spices, masala, silk and cotton sarees, and marine products.

Tamil Nadu is a key exporting State with a share of 10.15% of India's total exports in 2023-24 and has been rightly acknowledged as the leading State in the Export Preparedness Index (EPI) compiled by the Government of India. The electronics sector witnessed an astounding growth with exports touching US \$ 9.5 billion which is 33% of India's total exports in this sector. Industry-friendly electronics policy, ease of doing business, skilled talent and presence of port infrastructure have been key enablers. Likewise, the State leads in exports of auto & auto components, engineering goods, textiles, leather and other principal commodities, with the State achieving a whopping US \$ 44 billion export performance in 2023-24.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Export Credit has been estimated at ₹25847.63 crore

To bolster its export capabilities further, Tamil Nadu has developed four Agri Export Zones targeting specific commodities: cut flowers in Hosur (covering Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri), flowers in Nilgiris District, mangoes in Theni (including Dindigul and Madurai), and cashew nuts in Cuddalore (covering Thanjavur and Pudukkottai). The establishment of Mega Food Parks and infrastructure improvements such as solid waste management plants and effluent treatment plants, continuous effluent treatment plants, reliable electricity supply, cold chain infrastructure, food testing laboratories, quality control units, trade centers, pack houses, warehouses, and fleets of reefer trucks, which are pivotal interventions aimed at enhancing export efficiency.

The state has identified ten key Export Hubs: Tiruppur, Karur, Madurai, Ambur, Thoothukudi, Pollachi, Kancheepuram, Chennai, Coimbatore, and Hosur. These hubs are crucial for both traditional exports and emerging manufacturing sectors. To facilitate trade and address export-related challenges, the Government of Tamil Nadu has formed the State Export Promotion Committee (SEPC), chaired by the Chief Secretary. This committee aims to enhance collaboration between the Ministry of Commerce and Industry and state authorities.

The state continues to attract foreign direct investment (FDI), having drawn \$34.5 billion from April 2000 to March 2021 and maintaining its position among the top five FDI attracting states during this period.

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend adequate credit for exporters of medicinal plants and export-oriented products like jasmine, butter, mango and coconut.
- Ensure adequate credit for pre-shipment (packing credit and business loan) and post-shipment (bill discounting and invoice factoring/drip capital).
- Establish specialised branches for export credit to focus financing of export activities and accelerate growth of the sector.

Government

- Establish Export Promotion Centre for Agri & MSME products.
- Establish state of the art grading, sorting and packing unit in Gobichettipalayam to promote agriculture produce exports from Erode district.

- Create awareness about the export potential, export-based production, the procedures for exporting, import norms of various countries, especially on agri products, among the progressive farmers and entrepreneurs, so as to minimize rejections and losses.
- Facilitate technology, ensuring the forward and backward linkages in cashew processing/value addition for export market.
- Focus on export infrastructure, particularly ports-related infrastructure and other issues which affect trade.
- Promote development of digital trade platforms that integrate various stakeholders in the export ecosystem to streamline processes, enhance transparency, and provide real-time data for efficient decision-making.
- Address challenges related to logistics and connectivity by improving transportation infrastructure.
- Enhance connectivity to ports, airports, and major trading hubs to reduce transit time and transportation cost for exporters.
- Establish market intelligence services to provide exporters with real-time information on global market trends, competitor strategies, and potential export destinations.

4.6 Education

Education is a pivotal component of Human Resource Development, significantly contributing to the socio-economic balance in Tamil Nadu, one of India's most literate states. As of 2025, the literacy rate in Tamil Nadu is reported at 80.09%, reflecting a slight decline from the 80.33% recorded in 2011, yet still surpassing the national average of 74.04%. The state has made remarkable strides in education, achieving nearly 100% Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) in primary and upper primary education.

Despite these advancements, access to education loans remains limited. A study by ASSOCHAM indicates that less than 3% of students, primarily from middle-income families, utilize educational loans, which is significantly lower compared to developed nations such as the UK, US, Germany, and France. To address this gap, the Reserve Bank of India has revised its Priority Sector Guidelines to consider loans for educational purposes up to ₹20 lakh as eligible for priority sector lending.

The Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education has implemented the Central Sector Interest Subsidy (CSIS) Scheme, providing a full interest subsidy during the moratorium period on loans for economically weaker sections with a family income cap of ₹4.50 lakh per annum. This initiative supports students pursuing approved courses in technical and professional streams from recognized institutions across India.

Furthermore, the Vidya Lakshmi Portal, maintained by NSDL e-Governance Infrastructure Limited, serves as an essential interface for students to apply for and track their education loan applications seamlessly. The Credit Guarantee Fund Scheme for Education Loans (CGFSEL), established on September 16, 2015, offers government guarantees for education loans up to ₹7.5 lakh without collateral or third-party security, covering 75% of any default amount through the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Ltd.

Tamil Nadu boasts a robust higher education infrastructure with 60 universities and 587 engineering colleges. Each year, approximately 1.10 lakh students enroll in engineering programs, with around 90% attending self-financed institutions. The state also hosts 95 colleges dedicated to other professional courses.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Education sector has been estimated at ₹ 20,727.54 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend adequate credit to students on time and arrange financial literacy awareness programs in colleges through Financial Literacy Centres to inculcate the habit of repayment among students.
- Conduct camps in the Higher Secondary Schools/Colleges, in association with Higher Education Department and provide check list of documents for availing education loan.

Government

- Create awareness on the Central Sector Interest Subsidy Scheme.
- DIC/TAHDCO/KVIC could organize joint campaigns with banks concerned to popularize schemes like UYEGP, NEEDS among student community.

4.7 Housing

Housing plays a critical role in economic, social, and civic development, providing a foundation for a better quality of life and well-being. According to the Census 2011, the housing stock in India increased from 24.9 crore in 2001 to 33.1 crore in 2011, marking a growth of 33% highlighting the sector's rapid expansion. Despite this progress, the estimated housing shortage for the period 2012-2017 highlighted significant gaps, particularly in urban areas where there was a 95% shortage for economically weaker sections and lower-income groups. Rural areas faced a similar crisis with a 90% shortage among those below the poverty line, amounting to a total rural housing deficit of approximately 40 million units.

To address these challenges and achieve Housing for All by 2022, the Government of India (GoI) launched specific initiatives such as the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY) for both urban and rural areas. Under PMAY (Gramin), financial assistance is provided to construct pucca houses for all houseless families and those residing in dilapidated structures. Additionally, the GoI has facilitated Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) up to 100% in development projects and enacted the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Bill, 2013, alongside establishing an Urban Housing Fund. As of 2024, Tamil Nadu has made significant progress under PMAY (Gramin), with over 20 lakh houses sanctioned and nearly 16 lakh houses completed, addressing the housing needs of rural communities. PMAY (Urban) has also facilitated affordable housing in urban areas, with Tamil Nadu ranking among the top-performing states in implementing the scheme.

As per the Reserve Bank of India's Priority Sector Lending norms, individuals can obtain loans up to ₹35 lakh in metropolitan centers (with populations exceeding ten lakh) and ₹25 lakh in other centers for purchasing or constructing dwelling units. The total cost of these units must not exceed ₹45 lakh and ₹30 lakh respectively. Additionally, loans for repairing damaged

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Housing sector has been estimated at ₹ 54951.06 crore

dwelling units up to ₹10 lakh in metropolitan centers and ₹6 lakh in other centers are also eligible. Loans to government agencies for slum clearance and affordable housing projects with at least 50% of the Floor Area Ratio (FAR)/Floor Space Index (FSI) used for units with a carpet area of not more than 60 sq. m. qualify under PSL norms.

In Tamil Nadu, the "Vision-2023" initiative aims to provide world-class infrastructure while promoting affordable housing for all citizens. The ambitious target is to construct 2.5 million houses at an estimated cost of ₹75,000 crore by 2023, focusing on economically weaker sections and striving towards making the state slum-free. This initiative aligns with recent trends indicating a growing demand for affordable housing solutions across India.

The Tamil Nadu Housing Board (TNHB) and the Tamil Nadu Slum Clearance Board (TNSCB) are pivotal in implementing affordable housing schemes. The state government is also exploring public-private partnerships (PPP) for urban housing development, particularly in industrial and economically growing regions such as Chennai, Coimbatore, and Hosur. Tamil Nadu has also aligned its efforts with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) to ensure "Housing for All," thereby contributing to social equity and economic development.

Looking ahead, projections suggest that by 2025, India's housing market will continue to evolve significantly due to urbanization and technological advancements. The sector is expected to contribute approximately 13% to the national GDP by that year, supported by favorable demographic shifts and policy reforms aimed at enhancing housing accessibility. Current estimates indicate a potential housing shortage of 31 million units by 2030, underscoring the urgent need for sustained efforts in this sector.

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Extend credit to beneficiaries of PMAY-G who need credit for constructing house with more facilities.
- Extend credit through sections 25 mFIs and NGOs have successfully demonstrated lending for this sector with good recovery at the ground level for on-lending to individuals for carrying out repair to houses, construction of toilets, house expansion, renovation and replacing thatched roof with concrete structure.
- Popularize reverse mortgage loan among senior citizens.

Government

- Simplify the procedures and for multiple approvals.
- Popularise GoI and GoTN Schemes on Housing.

4.8 Social Infrastructure Involving Bank Credit

Social infrastructure including education, healthcare, nutrition, housing, and water supply, is pivotal for economic development, as these sectors synergistically enhance overall societal well-being. Investments in social infrastructure leads to accelerated economic growth,

The Credit Projection for the Social Infrastructure involving bank credit for the year 2025-26 has been assessed at ₹ 13630.11 crore

increased productivity, poverty reduction, and environmental sustainability. The Government of Tamil Nadu (GoTN) has consistently prioritized the social sector, allocating substantial resources to its development. Tamil Nadu spends around ₹1,59,575.5 crore towards social sector amounting to 35.2% of Total Disbursements (RBI publication on State Finances: A Study of Budgets of 2024-25). The government's focus on these sectors aligns with national policies aimed at achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). For instance, the National Health Policy 2017 emphasizes increasing health expenditure to 2.5% of GDP, while the National Education Policy 2020 calls for educational spending to reach 6% of GDP. These policies underscore the importance of public-private partnerships (PPPs) in developing social infrastructure sustainably and effectively. Education, Skills, Healthcare, Sanitation, drinking water, etc., are sectors that the government is paying attention.

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Tap the potential available for day care/ play schools and coaching centers.
- Extend credit for establishing RO plants as quality of water is a concern.
- Extend credit for setting up schools, health care facilities and sanitation and achieve the Priority Sector targets.
- Institutional financing can hasten the progress under rural sanitation facilities.

Government

- Upgrade the skills of manpower for the infrastructure created.
- Encourage private entity to create and maintain public toilet facilities at major places under Swachh Bharat.
- Improve sanitation infrastructure with focus on rural areas.
- Link toilet constructions to PMAY, wherever possible.

4.9 Renewable Energy

The daily average energy consumption of the State is about 360 Million Units (MU). The per capita consumption of electricity is high in Tamil Nadu at 1792 kWh in 2023-24, as compared to the average of 1640 kWh in 2022-23. Tamil Nadu is the only state where one-third of the installed power comes from renewable sources. The total installed capacity of Power in Tamil Nadu stands at 36,563.27 MW as on 01 April 2024, of which, 9,015.09 MW i.e. 24.66% from Wind, 7995.53 MW i.e., 21.87% from Solar, 206.79 MW i.e., 0.57% from Bio-mass and 684.40 MW i.e., 0.57 % from Co-generation which are renewable sources of energy.

The GoTN is committed to mitigate the climate change effects by bringing out policies conducive to promote renewable energy generation in the state. Municipal and Industrial wastes could also be useful sources of energy while ensuring safe disposal. Renewable Energy (RE) sources provide a viable option for on/off grid electrification & wide industrial applications.

Tamil Nadu is endowed with significant renewable energy potential. The State is blessed with almost 300 sunny days in a year. The State stands fourth highest in installed Solar capacity in India. It has an installed capacity of 8145.53 MW (State Capacity – 7396.37 MW and CTU capacity – 599.16 MW) as on 01 April 2024.

Tamil Nadu has the highest off-shore wind energy potential with maximum Wind Speeds ranging from 9 m/s to 11 m/s. Tamil Nadu stands first in installed wind capacity in India. The state has the total installed wind capacity of 10603.54 MW as on 01.04.2024, which is 24% of the Nation's wind power capacity.

The share of renewable energy, which at present stands at 48% of the total energy generation is proposed to be increased to 50% by 2030.

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under Renewable Energy has been estimated at ₹ 3348.16 crore

Suggested Action Points

Banks

- Popularise various incentive and credit linked schemes under renewable energy sector.
- Extend credit for SPV lanterns, SPV streetlights, SPV home lights, SPV water pumps, SPV power plants Standalone and GRID connected, SPV power plants, etc., so as to reduce the dependence of conventional energy sources.
- Extend credit for bio-gas plants in respect of loans to SHG members for purchase of milch animals.

Government

- DRDA and TEDA may conduct awareness camps for popularizing solar energy devices like solar cooker, solar lantern, solar pump sets, etc.
- Simplify and streamline approval procedures for setting up of renewable energy projects.
- Create awareness among the rural masses about alternative sources of energy, its cost, technology transfer, after sales service, etc.
- Impart skill training to local youth for repair of solar equipment to improve after sales service.

4.10 Informal Credit Delivery System

Tamil Nadu is the pioneer in implementation of SHG Bank Linkage Programme a massive micro credit programme piloted by NABARD in 1992. The key objective of the Micro Credit Innovations by NABARD has been to facilitate sustained access to financial services for the unreached segments of the population viz., the poor in rural hinterlands, through various products and delivery channels in a cost effective and sustainable manner. GoTN has been actively involved in the SHG Bank Linkage Programme, since its inception. The National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM), the poverty reduction programme of GoI, is being implemented as Tamil Nadu State Rural Livelihood Mission (TNSRLM) in all the blocks of Tamil Nadu.

The State has 11.41 lakh SHGs with a savings of ₹2854.40 crore and loan outstanding of ₹21766.63 crore in respect of 5.20 lakh SHGs as on 31 March 2023. Out of 11.41 lakh SHGs, only 5.20 lakh i.e. 46% SHGs have been credit linked which creates massive scope for financing

The Credit Projections for 2025-26 under this sector has been estimated at ₹39296.33 crore

this sector. Tamil Nadu is considered as saturated in terms of formation of new SHGs. The focus now shifts to development of entrepreneurial skills of SHG members and higher doses of credit. Likewise, JLGs are another area where banks have greater role to play in delivering timely and adequate credit.

Suggested Action points

Bank

- Converge the skilling/ upskilling schemes of GoI, GoTN and NABARD to augment flow of credit to this sector and to reduce incidence of NPA.
- Address issues such as dormancy, disintegration of SHGs and NPA under SHG-BLP and converge with the developmental programmes of GoI and GoTN.
- Credit Counsel SHG members through Financial Literacy Counselling Centres to wean them away from over indebtedness and usurious lenders.
- Promote Business Model for JLGs through Business Correspondent (BC) network.

Government

- Establish Common Facility Centres with marketing outlets in each block for the SHGs/ JLGs livelihood enhancement.
- Revive dormant SHGs.
- Identify rural bank branches not participating in SHG-BLP for their active involvement.
- Help bankers in recovery of overdue amount from SHGs.
- Speed up the process of issuing ID cards to avoid multiple membership/lending.
- Motivate SHGs to move towards livelihood and micro entrepreneurship for sustainable growth.
- Develop Federation of SHGs with adequate capacity building of Business Correspondents (BCs) of FIs while ensuring protection of customers' interests.

Chapter V

Status and Prospects of Co-operatives

5.1 Background

A co-operative is defined as ‘an autonomous association of persons united voluntarily to meet their common social, economic and cultural needs as well as their aspirations through a jointly owned and democratically controlled enterprise’.

A co-operative is governed by seven major principles, i.e. voluntary and open membership; principle of democratic member control; principle of member economic participation; principle of autonomy and independence; principle of education, training and information; principle of co-operation and principle of concern for community.

Co-operative enterprises help their members to collectively solve shared socio-economic problems. Co-operatives strengthen bargaining powers of their members, help them get access to competitive markets and to capitalise on new market opportunities. As such, they improve income opportunities, reduce costs and manage risks of the members.

5.2 Status of Co-operatives in the country

Table 5.1 Details of Cooperatives in the country

Sr No	Type	Number of Societies
	A. Details of Non-Credit Co-operative Societies	
1	AH Sector (Milk/Fishery/ Poultry etc.)	215206
2	Consumer Stores	22144
3	Housing Societies	193086
4	Weavers	24838
5	Marketing	9326
6	Labour Societies	45264
7	Agro Processing and Sugar	23575
8	All others (pl. specify)	181334
	Total	714773
	B. Details of Credit Co-operative Societies	
10	Primary Agriculture Credit Societies	99873
	C. Details of Multi State Co-operative Societies	
11.	No. of MSCS	1701

(Source: NCDC portal)

Further, in terms of federations, there are about 481 district level federations, 228 state level federations and 19 national level federations in the country.

5.2.1 Formation of Ministry of Co-operation by GoI

The GoI has set up a separate Ministry for Co-operation on 06 July 2021 which will provide a separate administrative legal and policy framework for strengthening the co-operative movement in the country, to help deepen the presence of co-operatives, to streamline processes for 'Ease of doing business' for co-operatives and enable development of Multi-State Co-operatives (MSCS). In the words of the Hon'ble Prime Minister, "The Co-operative movement is such a model which can provide a successful alternative to socialism and capitalism".

5.2.2 Latest initiatives by Ministry of Co-operation (MoC), GoI

Ministry of Cooperation has undertaken several initiatives to realize the vision of "Sahakar-se-Samriddhi" in association with State Government, NABARD and other institutes and to strengthen & deepen the cooperative movement from Primary to Apex level Cooperatives in the country. Few of the initiatives are as follows:

- a. Model Bye-Laws for PACS making them multi-purpose, multi-dimensional and transparent entities
- b. **Computerization of Primary Agriculture Co-operative Societies:** This scheme aims at computerization of 63000 functional PACS leading to increase in efficiency, profitability, transparency and accountability in the working of PACS.
- c. **Establishing New Multipurpose-PACS/ Dairy/ Fishery co-operatives in all uncovered Panchayats:** It aims to saturate the rural landscape with co-operative ecosystem through formation and strengthening of two lakh new Multipurpose PACS, Dairy and Fisheries co-operative societies over a period of five years, covering all the Panchayats/ villages in the country, thus strengthening the cooperative movement and deepening its reach up to the grassroots.
- d. **World's Largest Decentralized Grain Storage Plan in the cooperative sector:** A plan to create warehouses, custom hiring centers, primary processing units and other agri-infrastructure for grain storage at the PACS level, through the convergence of various GOI schemes, including AIF, AMI, SMAM, PMFME, etc. is approved by the Government.
- e. PACS as Common Service Centers (CSCs) for better access to e-services
- f. PACS are now promoted to form FPOs, Retail Petrol/Diesel Outlets, LPG distribution, to act as PM Bharatiya Jan Aushadhi Kendra, Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samriddhi Kendras (PMKSK), to carry out O&M of rural piped water supply schemes (PWS).
- g. Strengthening the Urban and Rural Cooperative Banks
- h. Relief to Cooperative Societies in the Income Tax Act
- i. Revival of Co-operative Sugar Mills
- j. **Three new National Level Multi-State Societies:** Amending the Multi State Co-operative Societies Act 2002 and established 3 new MSCS for organic farming, certified seeds and promoting exports.
- k. **Capacity building in Co-operatives** through promotion of training and awareness through National Council for Co-operative Training (NCCT) and Establishment of a Co-operative University.

- l. **Use of Information Technology for ‘Ease of Doing Business’:** Under this, Central Registrar’s Office, RCS’s Office of State/UT and ARDBs Computerisation has been undertaken.
- m. New National Co-operative Database for authentic and updated data repository
- n. Formulation of New National Co-operative Policy.

5.3 Status of Co-operatives in the State

Table 5.2 Details of Cooperatives in the State

Sr No	Type	Number of Societies
A. Details of Non-Credit Co-operative Societies		
1	AH Sector (Milk/Fishery/ Poultry etc.)	11393
2	Consumer Stores	533
3	Housing Societies	977
4	Weavers Societies	1364
5	Marketing Societies	112
6	Labour Societies	33
7	Agro Processing and Sugar	605
8	All others (pl. specify)	2705
	Total	17722
B. Details of Credit Co-operative Societies		
10	Primary Agriculture Credit Societies	4467
C. Details of Multi State Co-operative Societies		
11.	No. of MSCS	141

(Source: NCDC portal); Co-operative Policy Note-2024-25-GoTN)

5.3.1 Recent developments/latest initiatives by State Government in strengthening the outreach and activities of co-operatives

Government of Tamil Nadu has ambitious plan to strengthen the existing Primary Agricultural Co-operative Credit Societies (PACS) by leveraging whole of Government approach and use it as means to become a centre of socio-economic upliftment and development of its members and the area which it serves. PACS computerization is being implemented under the GoI project, covering 4532 Co-operative Societies including all the 4,453 PACS and the same is expected to be completed by 31 March 2025. This will facilitate general public in a larger way besides strengthening the functioning of PACS and to have effective monitoring.

PACS functioning in urban areas in the State are facing dwindling share of income from agriculture related loans. Some of such societies were converted into Urban Co-operative Credit Societies to enable them to continue providing credit facilities to the members residing

in their area of operation. There are 116 Urban Co-operative Credit Societies functioning in urban and semi-urban areas.

The Tamil Nadu Co-operative Marketing Federation (TANFED) owns Fertilizer Mixing Units at Pamani in Mannargudi, Tiruvarur district and Eriyodu in Dindigul district. The fertilizer produced in these Units are marketed in the name of “Pamani” through Agricultural Producers Co-operative Marketing Societies (APCMS) and PACS. At present, the share of Co-operatives in fertilizers sales in the State is 25%. TANFED has ventured into production of Neem Powder, Neem Oil Cake, Micro-Nutrient Mixtures, Bio-Pesticides and Bio-Fertilizers.

In Tamil Nadu, 115 Agricultural Producers Co-operative Marketing Societies (APMCs) are functioning with an annual business turnover of Rs. 2,883. 97 Crores in FY 2023-24. Some of the APCMS are acting as Multi-Purpose Co-operative Societies (MPCS), by undertaking activities such as, retail petrol bunkers, medical shops, fair price shops under Public Distribution System (PDS), lead societies for movement of commodities under PDS, besides undertaking traditional activities such as marketing, processing of agricultural produce, value addition and issue of Pledge Loans on agricultural produce. Few APMCs are equipped with electronic weighing facilities to ensure accurate weighment of agriculture produce and modernized auction process with installation of customized software.

Tamil Nadu is the major state with a thriving environment for co-operative warehouses, especially those operated by PACS and APCMS. Currently, there are 4047 warehouses with a total capacity of 5.48 lakh MT under PACS and APCMS in the State. These warehouses were constructed with the support available from the Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF) and Warehouse Infrastructure Fund (WIF) of NABARD.

To facilitate the farmers to sell their agricultural produce nationwide and to avail Produce Pledge Loan at lesser rate of interest from their societies and from nationalized banks, electronic Negotiable Warehouse Receipt (e-NWR) system has been introduced by WDRA. For the first time in India, issue of e-NWR through co-operative societies was initiated in Tamil Nadu in Namakkal and Salem districts. Tamil Nadu has the highest number of co-operative warehouses registered with WDRA.

Government of Tamil Nadu has allotted 7.5 acres of land in Manavanoor Village, Kodaikanal Taluk to the Tamil Nadu Co-operative Union (TNCU) for establishing the National Level Institute of Co-operative Studies, Research and Training, which would be built at a cost of ₹126 crore, to be raised through contribution from select co-operative institutions. This Institute intends to offer in-service training to the employees of Co-operative Department and Co-operative Societies, besides creating facilities for research.

Government of Tamil Nadu has launched the Co-operative Member Support Program with a motive to support and revive the weak or non-viable loss-making Co-operative Societies. Through this program, Apex and the Central Co-operative Societies provide viability gap support at concessional rate of interest to its affiliated societies which are weak or unviable. TNStCB has provided Rs.21.23 Crore support to its 33 affiliated societies and Central Co-operative Banks have also extended support of Rs.24.86 Crore to its 1,317 affiliated societies (PACCS, APCMS, Primary Co-operative Stores and PCARDB) under the scheme during the FY 2023-24.

5.4 Centrally Sponsored Project on Computerisation of PACS (CSPCP) in Tamil Nadu

All the 4532 co-operative societies have been covered by the Government of India under the CSPCP project, as recommended by the Government of Tamil Nadu. This project entails bringing all the functional societies identified onto an Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) based common software linking them with NABARD through State Cooperative Bank (StCB) and District Central Co-operative Banks (DCCBs). NABARD is the implementing agency of this project.

Under the project, hardware has been procured and supplied to all the 4532 identified societies. Capturing of legacy data through Data Capture Tool (DCT) has been completed for all 452 PACS. All the identified Societies are expected to be computerized by 31 March 2025. All PACS officials have been trained to work on the new e-PACS Software.

Computerisation of PACS will provide various benefits such as increasing the efficiency of their operations, ensuring speedy disbursement of loans, lowering of transaction costs, reducing imbalance in payments, seamless accounting with DCCBs and StCB and increasing transparency.

A Digital Transformation for Rural Finance: The PACS Computerization Project in Tamil Nadu

The Ministry of Cooperation, Government of India, in collaboration with State Governments, NABARD, National Federations, training establishments, and other stakeholders, has launched the 'Computerization of Primary Agriculture Cooperative Societies' (CSPCP) project. This initiative aims to computerize 63,000 functional PACS across the country, enhancing their operational efficiency, profitability, transparency, and accountability. The total project cost is ₹2,516 Crore, with NABARD contributing 10% of the total cost. This includes the development of comprehensive software, which covers cyber security, data storage, and training for PACS officials.

NABARD plays a crucial role in the implementation, monitoring, ERP software development, and providing capacity-building training for PACS officials, ensuring the seamless integration of technology into cooperative societies. The project's successful completion will bring numerous benefits, including streamlined operations, better financial management, and improved transparency in transactions.

In Tamil Nadu, 4,532 PACS have been identified for this project, with a total project cost of ₹195 Crore dedicated to computerizing these societies. As of now, 4,528 PACS in Tamil Nadu are already operating under the e-PACS software, marking significant progress in the region.

This computerization will revolutionize the agricultural and financial ecosystems of Tamil Nadu. By digitizing the operations of PACS, farmers will have improved access to financial services, streamlined loan processing, and greater transparency in transactions. The increased efficiency and data-driven decision-making will contribute to higher productivity in agriculture, better resource management, and enhanced financial inclusion for farmers, ultimately supporting sustainable rural development.

5.5 Way forward

The country is moving towards the path of *Sahakar se Samriddhi* through the initiatives of MoC, GoI. Under this, a target of 5,634 new M-PACS formation has been set for Tamil Nadu and the State has initiated groundwork to achieve this, in partnership with NABARD. *Co-operation Among Co-operatives* is another such initiative, aimed at promoting financial transactions of Primary Dairy Co-operative Societies (PDCS) and other non-credit co-operatives through StCB/DCCB. Tamil Nadu, with one of the best co-operative networks in the country, has immense potential to advance these initiatives further.

Reference:

NCDC Portal

Tamil Nadu Co-operative Policy Note, 2024-25

Press Information Bureau, Government of India (pib.gov.in)

Chapter VI

Infrastructure Support

6.1 Introduction

Improvement of rural infrastructure is critical in increasing the competitiveness of the rural areas and their incomes. Several studies show the linkage between infrastructure, poverty reduction, improved livelihoods and holistic development of the people. NABARD has been partnering with GoTN for meeting the above goals by extending support for creation of infrastructure in Agriculture, Social and Rural Connectivity Sectors.

6.2 Rural Infrastructure

Rural infrastructure refers to a wide array of physical infrastructure, including energy and transport equipment, information and communications technologies, water and sanitation facilities, irrigation systems, and market and storage facilities. Rural infrastructure projects are for the essential facilities and services to meet public health and environmental standards and to aid the development of trade, commerce, industry, agriculture, aquaculture, and employment opportunities. Rural infrastructure is also defined as the basic facilities, services, and installations needed for the functioning of a community or society.

Setting up infrastructure in rural areas has certain challenges like reduced economies of scale, higher unit costs, lower incomes, challenges related to pricing of services and there by challenging the willingness of private sector participation. In such a crucial situation, Government has to fill up the gap. Ideally, more contribution from the private sector would help in addressing the rural infrastructure shortcomings.

6.3 Rural Infrastructure Development in the State

The State's Vision towards \$1 Trillion Economy by 2030 lays out the roadmap for building robust infrastructure, skilled human capital, and a thriving innovation ecosystem to serve as catalysts, propelling Tamil Nadu swiftly towards its ambitious \$1 Trillion vision. This vision calls for setting up of robust support infrastructure for planning, production, processing, storage, distribution, marketing and sales of agricultural produce.

6.4 Critical Infrastructural Gap

Major infrastructure gaps identified in rural areas of Tamil Nadu, as per the need and demand of rural population are irrigation, roads and bridges which are essential to connect isolated communities, agriculture and related infrastructure, power supply, education, skilling etc. Plugging these gaps will ignite rural activities and create ample economic and employment opportunities.

6.4.1 Irrigation

Tamil Nadu is a water starved state. Only 58% of the net cultivated area is under irrigated agriculture. The efforts of State Government is towards increasing the farm productivity of crops through effective water use. Due to seasonal and erratic rainfall in terms of timing and geographical distribution, irrigation is critical for successful agricultural operations in the State. The per capita water potential of Tamil Nadu is less than the country's average. It has almost fully developed its surface water potential and rapidly reaching the limit of exploitation of its ground water resources. Further, rising sea levels due to climate change has resulted in intrusion of sea water into freshwater courses which meet the irrigation needs of several area of ayacut in the coastal regions. Consequently, future expansion of irrigated agriculture in Tamil Nadu depends largely on conservation of available water and achieving greater efficiency of water use in the existing systems.

Water Resources Department, GoTN is taking up construction, maintenance, extension and rehabilitation of Irrigation structures such as Dams, Anicuts, Check Dams, Regulators, Barrages, formation and rehabilitation of Canals, Channels, Tanks and Inter-linking & Intra-linking of Rivers, for augmentation of surface water effectively. RIDF loan of ₹532.43 crore has been sanctioned so far towards 86 irrigation projects during 2024-25. RIDF assistance in the State has helped in bringing more than 41.50 lakh ha of land under irrigation. As on date, a cumulative amount of ₹6814.66 crore has been sanctioned to the GoTN for promoting irrigation infrastructure under RIDF.

Box 6.1 Mukkombu Regulator Project: Securing Water, Agriculture and Community Connectivity

The construction of a new regulator across the Southern and Northern arms of the Coleroon River at Mukkombu (Upper Anicut) in Tiruchirappalli district has significantly improved flood and water regulation in the Cauvery Delta. This project, funded by NABARD under RIDF, replaced the partially damaged 182-year-old structure, ensuring irrigation for 12.01 lakh acres in the Cauvery Delta and 60,103 acres in Trichy and Ariyalur districts.



The new regulator, equipped with hydraulic shutters and SCADA, helps manage excess water, protecting towns like Trichy and Srirangam from flooding. Additionally, it supports drinking water schemes and provides a crucial crossing point for locals, including farmers and schoolchildren, who previously had no bridge within 20 km. This initiative has not only enhanced agricultural productivity but also improved the quality of life for the local community.



6.4.2 Agriculture, Allied, Land Development & Soil Conservation

Under Agriculture and Allied Sector, various activities are supported for creating Infrastructure. GoTN through its various departments like Agriculture, Horticulture, Animal Husbandry, Fisheries, Agri marketing etc., has been creating necessary infrastructure

required for regular agricultural and allied sector operations. Some of the major projects supported under the agriculture and allied sectors are listed below:

Agriculture & Horticulture: Post-harvest infrastructure, Infrastructure for the State Horticulture/Agriculture Farms, Agriculture University, etc.

Animal Husbandry: Veterinary Dispensary, Semen Bank, Fodder Development, Construction of

Scientific Bull Shed, Conserving indigenous breeds, Slaughter House, Establishment of Dairy cum power plant, etc.

Fisheries: Construction of Fish Landing Centres, Improvement of Fishing Harbour /Jetties, Fresh water ornamental fish brood bank, seed farms, cold chain, fish processing infrastructure.

Forestry: Teak Plantation, Development of Degraded Forest Lands, Forest Nursery etc
For various activities indicated under Agriculture and Allied activities other than irrigation, NABARD has supported the State Government with cumulative loan amount of ₹6674.34 crore as on date.

6.4.3 Warehousing

Efficient storage facilities minimize distress sales, post-harvest losses and loss of farm income. The State produces approximately 110 lakh MT of food grains, which calls for creation of storage and marketing infrastructure. NABARD has been supporting creation of Storage and Marketing Infrastructure under RIDF, NABARD Infrastructure Development Assistance (NIDA) and Warehouse Infrastructure Fund (WIF). As of date, a cumulative amount of ₹2637 crore was sanctioned under WIF for construction of warehouses and related infrastructure with a total storage capacity of more than 20 lakh MT. Under RIDF, financial assistance of ₹1570.47 crore has been sanctioned as on date for construction of rural markets, godowns and related infrastructure. During 2024-25, WIF loan of ₹23.60 crore has been sanctioned towards 11 projects under this sector.

6.4.4 Animal husbandry/ Dairy development/ Fisheries

Tamil Nadu has a total coastal length of about 1076 km, fishing and related activities are a major livelihood activity for people in coastal areas. To facilitate fishing activities and to prevent the sea erosion, fish landing centres, groynes and fish farms have been also supported under RIDF as well as FIDF. Cumulative assistance towards this sector under RIDF and FIDF are ₹1939.36 crore and ₹1314.73 crore, respectively, as on 31.12.2024. Sanctions during 2024-25 under RIDF towards improvement of fisheries infrastructure in Tamil Nadu is ₹303.25 crore.

Activities supported under Animal husbandry/ Dairy development include Veterinary Dispensary, Semen Bank, Fodder Development, Construction of Scientific Bull Shed, Conserving indigenous breeds, Slaughterhouse, Establishment of Dairy cum power plant, etc. Cumulative sanction of ₹1494.41 crore has been made under RIDF till date towards infrastructure development under this sector in Tamil Nadu.

6.4.5 Power

During 2011-12, Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution Corporation (TANGEDCO) had availed term loan of ₹1,063.25 crore under NIDA for Rehabilitation of Electricity distribution systems damaged by Cyclone “Thane” in Cuddalore and Villupuram districts. The timely financial assistance extended by NABARD under NIDA to GoTN enabled speedy recovery and restoration of major components of the electricity distribution system in Cuddalore and Villupuram districts, within a month.

During 2015-16, NABARD has sanctioned a term loan of ₹238.30 crore to TANTRANSCO (a subsidiary of TANGEDCO) under NIDA for establishment of 400/230-100 KV substation and transmission lines at Palavadi, Dharmapuri district, Tamil Nadu.

Ensuring Sustainable Water Supply in Cuddalore District through CWSS

The Combined Water Supply Scheme (CWSS) for Cuddalore district, Tamil Nadu, aims to provide reliable drinking water to six Town Panchayats—Tittakudi, Pennadam, Mangalampettai, Vadalur, Kurinjipadi, and Gangaikondan—and 625 rural habitations in Mangalore, Nallur, and Vridhachalam Unions. Implemented by the Tamil Nadu Water Supply and Drainage Board, the ₹479 crore project, funded under RIDF XXV with NABARD support of ₹381.79 crore, addresses critical water supply challenges in the region.



Previously, drinking water supply in these areas was below CPHEEO norms—50 LPCD in Town Panchayats and 35 LPCD in rural habitations. The project resolves this by treating runoff discharge water from NLC Mine II at a water treatment plant using ultra-filtration technology. Treated water is distributed via a network of 183.58 km transmission mains and 734.44 km feeder mains to 789 service reservoirs, supplying 135 LPCD to Town Panchayats and 55 LPCD to rural habitations.

This project benefits 6.68 lakh people across 625 villages, creating a sustainable drinking water capacity of 31.26 MLD. It also generates 229 recurring person-days of employment annually, significantly improving access to potable water and enhancing the quality of life for the region's population.



6.3.6 Social Infrastructure

Drinking water supply

NABARD has always supported the State Government's vision to provide World Class, Secure, Affordable and Sustainable Water Supply, Sanitation and Sewerage system Accessible to every citizen of Tamil Nadu.

The norm for Rural Water Supply has been enhanced, by the Government of India from 40 lpcd to the service level of 55 lpcd (litres per capita per day) for the 12th Five-year Plan. Rural Water Supply Schemes are being implemented with State Government Funds under the Minimum Needs

Programme, Government of India assistance under the National Rural Drinking Water Programme (NRDWP), which is subsumed into Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) and financial assistance from NABARD with an objective of providing Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC) to every Rural household. The State has around 126.89 lakh rural households. As on date, under RIDF, 2390 projects related to rural drinking water were sanctioned with a cumulative loan assistance of ₹5348 crore.

Rural Education

Quality infrastructure in education is very critical in mitigating the drop out of children from school and this is possible with good facilities like toilets for boys and girls, labs, library etc. Assistance to primary, middle, high and higher secondary schools in Tamil Nadu for construction of new buildings and providing infrastructure facilities has been provided under RIDF. Cumulative sanction of ₹5831.46 crore has been made under RIDF, till date, towards infrastructure development under this sector in Tamil Nadu.

Support of ₹874.89 crore has been sanctioned during 2024-25 towards projects pertaining to construction of a new classrooms, labs, toilets, purchase of lab equipment's and additional infrastructure facilities like hostel buildings, academic blocks in 966 Government Schools in the State.

Rural Connectivity

Rural Connectivity plays an important role in overall development of the state. Efficient connectivity is required for penetration of education, health care services, banking services, and for connecting farm goods to markets, where logistics is vital. NABARD's funding under RIDF has supported State government to lay more than 52820 km of roads and 16 km of bridges. Cumulative sanction till date towards rural bridges and rural roads in Tamil Nadu is ₹13488 crore.

6.4 Infrastructure support under RIDF

NABARD's partnership with the GoTN for creation of rural infrastructure so far extends over 47,000 projects involving an RIDF loan of ₹38527.41 crore. Of this, an amount of 31993.69 Cr has been disbursed as on 30.11.2024. Investments under RIDF, in turn, have helped NABARD to fulfil the mandate by improving the credit absorption capacity, increased access to markets, enhanced incomes and better quality of life in rural Tamil Nadu.

Currently, the assistance from RIDF is available for supporting 39 eligible activities grouped under three distinct heads viz. Agriculture and Related Sectors (₹13489.00 crore), Social Sectors (₹11550.19 crore) and Rural Connectivity (₹13488.22 crore).

6.5 Infrastructure Support under NABARD Infrastructure Development Fund (NIDA)

NIDA is designed to fund directly the State Governments / State owned institutions /Corporations on both on-budget as well as off-budget for creation of rural infrastructure outside the ambit of RIDF borrowing. Further, funding under NIDA has been broadened by

covering PPP and non-PPP projects by registered entities like Companies, Co-operatives etc. and funding for NBFC -Infrastructure Finance Companies (IFCs) and Public Financial Institutions approved by the RBI.

Activities Eligible for assistance under NIDA include Irrigation, Agri. Marketing, Cold Chain etc., Warehousing and Storage (SWCs are eligible) Dairy Development, Power Sector, Education, Health, Sanitation, Transportation, Rural Tourism and any other infrastructure with income streams adequate to repay the loan.

During 2011-12, Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution Corporation (TANGEDCO) had availed term loan of ₹1,063.25 crore for Rehabilitation of Electricity distribution systems damaged by Cyclone “Thane” in Cuddalore and Villupuram districts. The timely financial assistance extended by NABARD under NIDA to GoTN enabled speedy recovery and restoration of major components of the electricity distribution system in Cuddalore and Villupuram districts, within a month.

During 2015-16, NABARD has sanctioned a term loan of ₹238.30 crore to TANTRANSCO (a subsidiary of TANGEDCO) under NIDA for establishment of 400/230-100 KV substation and transmission lines at Palavadi, Dharmapuri district, Tamil Nadu.

During the year 2020-21, NIDA loan of ₹6529.30 crore was sanctioned towards six projects pertaining to irrigation and rural drinking water supply. Cumulative disbursements as on 30.11.2024 towards the above sanctioned projects is ₹5667.94 crore.

6.6 Infrastructure support under Warehouse Infrastructure Fund (WIF)

Identifying warehousing as a thrust area, GoI had made an allocation of ₹10,000 crore to NABARD during 2013-14 and 2014-15, for supporting creation of infrastructure for storage of agricultural commodities. The fund envisages extension of loans to Public and Private sectors for construction of warehouses, silos, cold storages and other cold chain infrastructure. WIF would be utilized for meeting the growing demand for scientific storage capacity for agricultural commodities in the State.

Under the fund, a cumulative amount of ₹2909 crore has been sanctioned to the State Government, out of which ₹2538 crore has been disbursed as on date. Some of the impactful projects supported under the fund includes establishment of Integrated Supply and Cold chain infrastructure for Fruits, Vegetables & Other Perishables, implementation of E-Trading in Regulated Markets & APMCs and construction as well as renovation of storage godowns under TNCSC.

6.7 Infrastructure support under Food Processing Fund (FPF)

Food processing industry covers a wide range of products such as fruits and vegetables; meat and poultry; milk and milk products, alcoholic beverages, fisheries, plantation, grain processing and other consumer product groups like confectioneries, chocolates, cocoa products, etc. Tamil Nadu is a strong player in agro food processing industry and its share of Indian output is about 7 per cent.

Food Processing Fund (FPF) with a corpus of ₹2,000.00 crore has been established by GoI to provide impetus to the development of food processing sector on cluster basis in the country, to reduce wastage of agricultural produce and to create employment opportunities, especially in rural areas. Under the Fund, NABARD will provide term loans to the State Government, State Government owned entities, entities promoted by GoI, Joint ventures, SPVs, Cooperatives, Federations of Cooperatives, Farmers’ Producer Organizations, Corporates, Companies, Entrepreneurs, etc., to set up Food Parks, Infrastructure for Agro processing clusters and individual processing units in the Designated Food Parks.

NABARD has so far sanctioned loan assistance of ₹68.10 crore has been for establishment of establishment of 7 Agro Processing Clusters in the State at Cuddalore, Krishnagiri, Dindigul,

Madurai, Salem, Theni and Tiruvannamalai. Further, Mega Food Park at Gangaikondan, Tirunelveli has been sanctioned with loan amount of ₹37.68 crore. Three food parks at Manapparai, Theni and Tindivanam are under implementation with a total loan assistance of ₹334.00 crore.

6.8 Infrastructure support under Micro Irrigation Fund (MIF)

In the Union Budget 2017-18, Hon'ble Finance Minister with a view to provide impetus to micro irrigation, announced setting up of a dedicated Micro Irrigation Fund (MIF) to be instituted with NABARD with an initial corpus of ₹5000 crore over a period of 5 years (2017-18 to 2021-22) for facilitating the States to mobilize additional resources for expanding coverage of Micro Irrigation.

The main objective of the fund shall be to facilitate the states in mobilizing the resources for expanding coverage of Micro Irrigation by taking up special and innovative projects and also for incentivizing micro irrigation beyond the provisions available under PMKSY-PDMC to encourage farmers to install micro irrigation systems. During the year 2019-20, an amount of Rs.1357.93 crore has been sanctioned to Government of Tamil Nadu under the fund. An area of about 4.76 lakh ha has been benefitted on completion of the project. Against the sanction of ₹1357.93 crore, and ₹1357.93 crore has been utilized.

6.9 Infrastructure Support under Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF)

In the Union Budget 2018-19, Government of India has announced creation of Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Fund (FIDF) with a corpus of ₹7500.00 crore. The objectives of the scheme are creation and modernization of capture fisheries infrastructure, marine aquaculture infrastructure, in-land fisheries infrastructure, post-harvest infrastructure for fisheries and fish market infrastructure. The Scheme is in operation till 31st March 2026.

A total of 65 projects were sanctioned to Tamil Nadu with an FIDF loan of ₹1314.73 crore, of which ₹854.60 crore has been utilized as on date.

6.10 Way forward

Rural infrastructure is imperative for agriculture, allied activities, poverty alleviation and better access to markets which will have an impact on the economy of any country. In Tamil Nadu, with a 51.6% rural population, priority of the Government of Tamil Nadu is to provide all weather rural connectivity to unconnected rural habitations and upgradation of existing roads to provide market access, providing urban amenities in rural areas for improving the quality of rural life, which is aligning with the priorities of the Government of India.

Focusing on creating resilient and sustainable infrastructure, including social spaces, transport networks and water systems is one of the seven pillars of the ambitious Vision 2030: Tamil Nadu's Roadmap to a \$ 1 Trillion Economy. Ensuring better rural infrastructure will play a major role in realizing the Vision of the Government of Tamil Nadu.

Chapter VII

Details of Policy Initiatives of GoI, RBI, NABARD and State

7.1 POLICY INITIATIVES - GOVT. OF INDIA

7.1.1. Cooperative Development

The Ministry of Cooperation, GoI has taken 54 initiatives to strengthen and deepen the cooperative movement at the grassroots level. The ministry in coordination with state governments NABARD national level federations and other stakeholders is working on the following initiatives:

- i. **World's Largest Grain Storage Plan in Cooperative Sector (WLGSP)**
Ministry of Cooperation (MoC) GoI is implementing Pilot Project for World's Largest Grain Storage Plan in Cooperative Sector. The Pilot Project entails setting up of grain storage infrastructure including warehouse and silos along with other agri-infrastructure including Procurement Centre, Custom Hiring Centre, Primary Processing Centre, Grameen Haats, etc.
- ii. **Centrally Sponsored Scheme for Computerization of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS)**
Government has approved a scheme for Computerization of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) with the objective of increasing efficiency of PACS bringing transparency and accountability in their operations; facilitating PACS to diversify their business and undertake multiple activities/ services. A total of 63000 PACS have been taken for computerization under the project.
- iii. Establishing Multi-purpose PACS/ Dairy/ Fisheries cooperatives in every panchayat with support of NABARD NDDDB NFDB NCDC and other National level Federations PACS as Common Service Centers (CSCs) for better access to e-services
- iv. Ministry of Cooperation has announced supporting more than 300 e-services through PACS in association with MeitY NABARD and CSC e-Governance Services India Limited.
- v. Micro-ATMs to Bank Mitra Cooperative Societies for providing doorstep financial services.
- vi. **Computerization of Agriculture and Rural Development Banks (ARDBs)**
To strengthen the long-term cooperative credit structure the project of computerization of 1851 units of Agriculture and Rural Development Banks (ARDBs) spread across 13 States/ Union Territories has been approved by the Government. NABARD is the implementing agency for the project and will develop a national level software for ARDBs.
- vii. **Co-operative Education – Setting up of World's Largest Cooperative University**
This aims at introduction of cooperative education in independent degree / diploma courses in Schools and Universities.
- viii. **World's Largest Cooperative Training Scheme** - This aims at revamping existing cooperative training structure in the country.
- ix. New Cooperative Policy with a view to strengthen the cooperatives and make them vibrant with increased contribution to the economy.
- x. Amendment to Multi State Cooperative Act 2002 and setting up of 3 new Multi State Cooperative Society (MSCS) in the areas of seed production and marketing; organic products and export from cooperative sector.
- xi. To provide facilities at par with FPOs for existing PACS.

- xii. Establishment of National Cooperative Database Digital Agriculture Mission:

7.1.2. Agriculture

The Digital Agriculture Mission (DAM) aims to revolutionize India's agriculture sector by leveraging digital technology inspired by the success of India's digital revolution in other sectors. With a substantial financial outlay of ₹2817 crore, it focuses on creating a Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for agriculture.

- i. **Agri Stack:**
Key components of the mission include the Agri Stack-a farmer-centric DPI to streamline services with the creation of a unique digital Farmer ID linked to important farmer data such as land records and crop details.
- ii. **Vistaar (Virtually Integrated System to Access Agricultural Resources):**
Vistaar initiative of MoA&FW is an open interoperable and federated network dedicated to agricultural information and advisory services with a mission to empower farmers and enhance their farming practices for better sustainable livelihood.
- iii. **JanSamarth Portal:**
JanSamarth Portal a GoI initiative is a unique digital portal linking credit linked schemes for ease of access to the all the beneficiaries and related stakeholders. Schemes such as e-Kisan Upaj Nidhi KCC AIF etc. are accessible through the portal.
- iv. **Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) Scheme**
The Agricultural Infrastructure Fund (AIF) has played a pivotal role in transforming India's agricultural landscape. In addition to existing activities the purview of AIF scheme has now been extended to the following:
 - Viable Farming Assets: The scheme now includes the creation of infrastructure for viable projects for building community farming assets.
 - Integrated Processing Projects: The list of eligible activities under AIF now includes integrated primary and secondary processing projects.
 - PM KUSUM Component: The aim is to promote sustainable clean energy solutions alongside agricultural infrastructure development.
 - Enhanced Credit Guarantee Coverage: The government proposes to extend AIF credit guarantee coverage for FPOs through the NABSanrakshan Trustee Company Pvt. Ltd.
- v. **Dairy Processing & Infrastructure Development Fund (DIDF)/Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF):**
Government has approved merger of DIDF with AHIDF and extension of AHIDF for another three years till 31 March 2026. Further NABARD is included as loaning entity under the revamped AHIDF scheme.
Fisheries & Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF): GoI has extended the scheme for a period of another 3 years from 01.04.2023 to 31.03.2026.
- vi. **Framework for Voluntary Carbon Market (VCM) in Agriculture Sector:**
The Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare GoI has launched a Framework for Voluntary Carbon Market in Agriculture Sector. Under the Framework the Ministry envisages creating long-term carbon credit benefits primarily for small and marginal farmers by developing a VCM Framework and setting guidelines. NABARD is the nodal agency to coordinate and implement the various pilot projects under the VCM.
- vii. **PM JANMAN (Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan):** PM JANMAN is a recently launched initiative by the Government of India specifically designed to address the socio-economic challenges faced by the Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) across the country. The program aims for the comprehensive

development of 75 PVTGs in 18 states and 1 Union Territory with an allocation of ₹24,104 crore.

7.2. UNION BUDGET

7.2.1. Important Announcements

- i. Digital Public Infrastructure for Agriculture: Issuance of Jan Samarth based Kisan Credit Cards.
- ii. Release of new varieties: 109 varieties of 32 high-yielding and climate-friendly crops will be released for cultivation by farmers.
- iii. Natural Farming: To increase productivity as well as reduce input costs one crore farmers will be linked to natural farming in the next two years. Further 10000 need-based bio-input resource centres will be established.
- iv. Vegetable production & supply chain: To bolster vegetable supply chains the budget proposes the creation of large-scale production clusters near major consumption centres by promoting Farmer-Producer Organizations (FPOs) cooperatives and start-ups for vegetable supply chains including for collection storage and marketing.
- v. Budget focusses on development of Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) a digital crop survey for Kharif crops will be conducted in 400 districts.
- vi. A network of nucleus breeding centres for shrimp broodstocks will be established with funding for shrimp farming and exports facilitated through NABARD.
- vii. Pradhan Mantri Janjati Unnat Gram Abhiyan will be launched to improve the socio-economic condition of tribal communities.
- viii. Mudra Loans: The limit enhanced to ₹20 lakh from the current ₹10 lakh under the Tarun category.
- ix. Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs in the Manufacturing Sector will be introduced for facilitating term loans for purchase of machinery and equipment without collateral or third-party guarantee.
- x. Development of Twelve industrial parks under the National Industrial Corridor Development Programme.
- xi. Phase IV of PMGSY will be launched to provide all weather connectivity to 25000 rural habitations.
- xii. Assistance for flood management and related projects in Assam Bihar Sikkim & Uttarakhand. Assistance for reconstruction and rehabilitation in Himachal Pradesh.
- xiii. Taxonomy for Climate Finance: Government will develop a taxonomy for climate finance for enhancing the availability of capital for climate adaptation and mitigation related investments.
- xiv. Skilling the workforce to create employment opportunities: For raising participation of women in the workforce the budget aims to organize women-specific skilling programmes and promotion of market access for women SHG enterprises. 1000 Industrial Training Institutes are likely to be upgraded for this purpose.
- xv. MSME Units for Food Irradiation Quality & Safety Testing: Financial support for setting up of 50 multi-product food irradiation units in the MSME sector will be provided. Setting up of 100 food quality and safety testing labs with NABL accreditation will be facilitated.
- xvi. Water Supply and Sanitation: In partnership with the State Governments and Multilateral Development Banks Government will promote water supply sewage treatment and solid waste management projects and services for 100 large cities through bankable projects. These projects will also envisage use of treated water for irrigation and filling up of tanks in nearby areas.

7.2.2. Highlights related Agriculture & Farm Sector

Priorities identified for Agricultural Sector

- i. Transforming Agricultural Research
- ii. Release of New Varieties
- iii. Natural Farming
- iv. Mission for Pulses and Oilseeds
- v. Vegetable Production and Supply Chains
- vi. Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for Agriculture
- vii. Shrimp Production and Export.

Focus Areas

- i. Productivity and resilience in Agriculture
- ii. Employment & Skilling
- iii. Inclusive Human Resource Development and Social Justice
- iv. Manufacturing & Services
- v. Urban Development
- vi. Energy Security
- vii. Infrastructure
- viii. Innovation Research & Development and
- ix. Next Generation Reforms

7.3. POLICY INITIATIVES - RBI

- i. **Master Circular on Lead Bank Scheme SHG-** Bank Linkage Programme and Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana - National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM) SHG - Bank Linkage consolidating the relevant guidelines/ instructions issued by Reserve Bank of India.
- ii. **RBI's Green Deposit Framework** - The Green Deposit Framework by RBI is designed to encourage regulated entities (REs) in India such as scheduled commercial banks and deposit-taking non-banking financial companies to offer green deposits. These deposits are earmarked for financing projects that contribute to environmental sustainability such as renewable energy efficiency and pollution control. REs must develop and publicly disclose a comprehensive policy and financing framework detailing how funds will be allocated and managed.
- iii. **Unified Lending Interface (ULI):** The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as part of its strategy to create digital public infrastructure in the country has announced re-engineering of setting up of a new technology platform called the Unified Lending Interface (ULI) which will enable friction-less credit to farmers and MSME borrowers to begin with. The eKCC Portal developed by NABARD has already been integrated with the ULI for fetching and validation of land records to facilitate dispensation of crop loans to farmer members of cooperatives.

7.4. POLICY INITIATIVES - NABARD

7.4.1. Refinance Support

NABARD provides Short Term refinance to Cooperatives RRBs and SFBs for their crop loan lending. To ensure increased and uninterrupted credit flow to farmers as also to give a boost to capital formation in agriculture sector NABARD provides refinance to the Commercial banks cooperative banks and RRBs.

- i. **Schematic Refinance for Water Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH):** To provide clean water sanitation and hygienic conditions to rural and semi urban areas and thereby to protect human health during outbreak of infectious disease NABARD introduced a special refinance scheme on Water Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH).

- ii. **Special Refinance Scheme (SRS) on PACS as MSCs:** NABARD introduced Special Refinance Scheme to saturate all the potential PACS for conversion as Multi Service Centres over a period of three years commencing from the year 2020-21.

7.4.2. Credit-linked subsidy schemes of GoI

- i. **New Agriculture Marketing Infrastructure sub scheme of Integrated Scheme for Agricultural Marketing (ISAM):** GoI had approved the continuation of the scheme till 31 March 2026. The scheme lays special focus on developing and upgrading of Gramin Haats as GrAMs through strengthening of infrastructure.
- ii. **Agri Clinics and Agri Business Centres (ACABC):** The Central Sector Scheme of Agri-Clinics and Agri-Business Centres was launched in April 2002 by Ministry of Agriculture GoI. Composite subsidy of 44% of the project cost for women SC/ST & all categories of candidates from Northeast and Hill states and 36% of project cost for all other beneficiaries is provided under the scheme.

7.4.3. Interest Subvention Schemes of GoI

- i. NABARD implements crop loan interest subvention scheme of GoI for Cooperative Banks and RRBs under which interest subvention of 1.5% is provided to banks for extending crop loans up to ₹3 lakh at a concessional interest rate of 7% per annum. The scheme also provides an incentive of 3% subvention to the farmers making prompt repayment of loans thereby making credit available at an effective interest of 4% per annum.
- ii. **NRLM Interest Subvention:** NABARD also implements interest subvention scheme under DAY-NRLM for Cooperative Banks and RRBs. NABARD has developed a web portal for NRLM Interest Subvention claims by RRBs and Cooperative Banks in respect of WSHGs financed by them under DAY-NRLM.
- iii. GoI introduced Sugar Ethanol Interest Subvention scheme in 2018-19 with a view to increase the production of ethanol and its supply under the Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP). NABARD is the nodal agency responsible for managing the Sugar Ethanol Interest Subvention Scheme of the Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD) Government of India. NABARD has launched a sugar ethanol portal to speed up the claims settlement process.

7.4.4. Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF)

- i. RIDF instituted in NABARD during 1995-96 with the main objective of providing loans to State Governments for completing ongoing rural infrastructure projects at present covers as many as 39 activities classified under three broad sectors viz. (i) Agriculture and Related sector (ii) Social Sector and (iii) Rural Connectivity.

7.4.5. Micro Credit Intervention

NABARD has been extending grant support to partner agencies for promotion and nurturing of SHGs training and capacity building of SHG members and other stake holders besides initiating special programmes for backward regions. A few recent initiatives taken under micro credit are as under:

- i. Scheme for grant support to SHGs/ JLGs/ POs/ Microentrepreneurs for training on onboarding onto E-Commerce platforms/ ONDC/ social media platform.
- ii. Scheme for Grant Support to SHGs/ JLGs/ POs for Physical Marketing of Products.
- iii. NABARD in 2023-24 announced guidelines for a pilot project to be taken up by Regional Offices titled m-Suvidha (Microenterprises through Skill Upgradation for Women) to support need based and location specific developmental projects by strategizing end-to-end interventions.
- iv. **Pilot Project:** Real-time banking solution for SHGs (Money Purse Application)

- v. **Pilot Project – Graduated Rural Income generation Project (GRIP):** A pilot project to build capacities and enable asset generation by ultra-poor rural women and graduating them to access formal financial services through the innovative concept of returnable grant was sanctioned during 2023-24.
- vi. **MoU with NRLM MoRD:** Marking a strategic alliance to benefit rural women SHGs NABARD and the National Rural Livelihood Mission (DAY-NRLM) under the Ministry of Rural Development GoI inked a landmark MoU on 27 February 2024.

7.4.6. Financial Inclusion

Major Policy interventions and launching of new Schemes under the fund during 2023-24 includes:

- i. Support for the Deployment of micro-ATMs to two District Central Co-Operative Banks in Gujarat with a grant support of ₹3.67 crore for deploying 1631 micro ATM devices at PACS (440) and cooperative milk societies (1191).
- ii. **Financial Inclusion under Special Campaign 3.0:** RRBs under guidance of NABARD conducted Special Financial Literacy Camps during October 2023.
- iii. Support under Financial Inclusion Fund (FIF) for Rural Connectivity-HTS-VSAT Dual LTE and SD WAN technologies.
- iv. Incentive Scheme for BCs operating in NE States and hilly states.

7.4.7. Farm Sector Development

- i. **Participatory Sustainable Groundwater Management in Overexploited Blocks/Watersheds:** A pilot project titled "Participatory Sustainable Groundwater Management in Overexploited Blocks/Watersheds" has been launched in five states: Punjab Haryana Rajasthan Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu. This innovative pilot initiative by NABARD is the first of its kind aimed at demand side management of water at the micro-watershed/village level.
- ii. **Expansion of JIVA:** Based on the success of the pilot phase JIVA is being expanded to 25 new projects in central eastern and north-eastern states to further widen and deepen the programme focusing on completed or near-completion watershed/spring shed and tribal development projects with thrust on districts identified under aspirational / low priority sector lending districts.
- iii. **Accelerator approach for growth of FPOs:** NABARD has come up with FPO accelerator programme which is a structured framework to empower FPOs by providing access to specialized training mentorship and resources envisaging the enhancement in FPO's operational efficiency adopt modern agricultural techniques and navigate market complexities.
- iv. **Saturation Drive campaign:** Government has launched the saturation drive to provide FPOs benefits of schemes of Agriculture department in the form of licenses of inputs seeds fertilizer etc. FPOs will also be linked to mandis facilitated with registrations under GST FSSAI and onboarding on platforms like ONDC and other E-retailing platforms for sale of their produce.
- v. **National FPO Policy:** MoA&FW, GoI is working on finalization of a National Policy on FPOs to create a supportive environment for the FPOs after ongoing deliberations and consultative meetings on the draft policy.

7.4.8. Climate Action and Sustainability

- i. NABARD is a Direct Access Entity (DAE) to the Green Climate Fund (GCF) and the National Implementing Entity (NIE) to Adaptation Fund (AF) and National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change (NAFCC).

7.4.9. Off Farm Sector Development

- i. Capacity Building Fund Social Stock Exchange (CBF-SSE): The Capacity Building Fund of Social Stock Exchange (CBF-SSE) was set up in NABARD with funding to be contributed by NABARD, SIDBI, BSE, NSE and the CBF is being used to improve the ability of all stakeholders to navigate through the operational dynamics of SSE understand the nuances processes instruments etc.
- ii. Gram Vihar New Scheme for promotion of Rural Tourism: A new scheme in the name of "Gram Vihar" has been introduced to give a fillip to the rural tourism sector in the country by promoting "homestay" wherein tourists stay with the local families and experience rural lifestyle as well as "away-day" i.e. one day trip without night stay.

7.4.10. Agriculture Credit during 2023-24

- i. Disbursement of agriculture credit during 2023-24 was ₹25.10 lakh crore as against target of ₹20.00 lakh crore indicating achievement of 125%. Commercial Banks RRBs and Co-operatives accounted for 75%, 13% and 12% of the total disbursement respectively.

7.4.11. Technology Facilitation Fund (TFF)

- i. NABARD has set up a Technology Facilitation Fund (TFF) with a corpus of ₹50 crore. The fund is focused on providing support to tech start-ups working in agriculture and rural development sector. The fund provides a range of flexible support mechanisms including grants loans equity and convertible grants designed around the needs of each start-up.

7.5. Policy initiatives - state govt. (including cooperatives)

7.5.1. State Budget

7.5.1.1 Agriculture

- i. **Chief Minister's Mannuyir Kaathu Mannuyir Kaappom Scheme (CM MK MKS):** The scheme aims to promote sustainable and chemical-free farming in Tamil Nadu with a ₹206 crore allocation for 2024-25. It includes green manure seeds, vermicompost beds, bio-fertilizers, neem saplings, traditional crop seeds, soil health campaigns, and tailored fertilizer advice. Key initiatives feature organic farming clusters, integrated farming systems, agroforestry, climate-smart villages, honey production hubs, Uzhavar Angadis and value-added product promotion, enhancing soil fertility and boosting agri productivity.
- ii. **One Village One Crop scheme:** The scheme will be implemented in 15,280 villages to boost rural production, demonstrating land preparation, seed treatment and nutrient management for crops like paddy, millets, pulses, oilseeds, cotton, and sugarcane. Each village will focus on a single crop with demonstrations over 5-10 acres to enhance farmer awareness. Permanent Pest Surveillance Plots will be established to help farmers identify beneficial and harmful insects and adopt effective plant protection measures.
- iii. **Kalaigarnar All Village Integrated Agricultural Development Programme:** The scheme, aligned with the Anaithu Grama Anna Marumalarchi Thittam, aims to enhance self-sufficiency in 12,525 village panchayats over five years by boosting agriculture and converting fallow lands into cultivable lands. ₹200 crore allocated to implement the scheme in 2,482 village panchayats during 2024-25. 2,482 Village Agriculture Development Groups will be formed under the Scheme to provide farmers with training on seasonal crops, advance tech & market strategies.

- iv. **Custom Hiring Centres for the Underprivileged:** 207 Agricultural Machinery Custom Hiring Centres will be established with a subsidy of ₹32.90 crore, benefiting farmers, rural entrepreneurs, and FPOs.
- v. A mobile app for connecting farmers with private machinery owners will also be developed at a cost of ₹50 lakh.
- vi. **Geographical Indication for Agricultural Products:** The initiative aims to obtain Geographical Indication (GI) tags for 10 unique agricultural products from Tamil Nadu, enhancing their market demand and export potential for Sathayamangalam Red Banana, Kolli Hills Pepper, Meenambur Seeraga Samba and others from various districts with ₹30 lakh allocation for obtaining GI tags during 2024-2025.
- vii. **Support to Agri-Tech Startups:** Agri-tech startups will be identified and supported with subsidies based on their objectives, sustainability, and business plans, with ₹10 crore allocated from the State Fund to promote innovation in agriculture.
- viii. To create a Hut-Free Tamil Nadu by 2030, eight lakh concrete houses will be constructed in rural areas. In the first phase, one lakh new houses will be built at a unit cost of ₹3.50 lakh per house in the coming year. For this, a new scheme, Kalaigharinar Kanavu Illam, will be implemented in the coming year at a cost of ₹3,500 crore, providing an opportunity for the poor to build their dream homes.
- ix. A major project, aimed at restoring 5,000 water bodies, will be implemented through community participation under the guidance of leading scientific institutions, cost of ₹500 crore.
- x. In the next two years, this Government will launch the final assault on poverty, rescuing around five lakh of the poorest families from poverty by providing all the necessary Government assistance in an integrated manner through a grand initiative namely, 'Chief Minister's Thayumanavar scheme'.
- xi. **Women development:** ₹1,000 per month is being directly deposited in the bank accounts of 1.15 crore women heads of households under the Kalaighar Magalir Urimai Thittam. For this scheme, an amount of ₹13,720 crore has been allocated in the coming year.
- xii. The Government will cover all educational expenses including tuition and hostel fees for transgender individuals who want to pursue higher education.
- xiii. School education: Construction of new classrooms at a cost of ₹1,000 crore will be undertaken in the coming year. 15,000 smart classrooms will be established in the upcoming financial year at an estimated cost of ₹300 crore.
- xiv. Labour Welfare: The Government will set up 10 new Government Industrial Training Institutes at a cost of ₹111 crore.

7.5.1.2 Industrial Development

- i. SIPCOT will establish a new industrial park, spanning 300 acres near Sengipatti, at a cost of ₹120 crore.
- ii. TIDCO will establish a new 'Space Industrial and Propellant Park', at an extent of 2,000 acres, to promote space technology industries.

7.5.1.3 Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises

- i. Chennai will host the 'Global Start-up Summit' in January 2025, bringing together leading startups and accomplished young entrepreneurs from across the world.
- ii. Three new industrial estates dedicated to Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises will be established in Ottanchathiram Taluk in Dindigul District, Manamadurai Taluk in Sivagangai District and Thiruthuraiipoondi Taluk in Thiruvallur District. at an estimated cost of ₹32 crore.
- iii. An incentive of ₹2 per kg will be provided to the members of 16 co-operative tea factories who supplied green tea leaves during the last year. An amount of ₹9 crore will be allocated for this purpose, benefiting approximately 27,000 small tea growers.

- iv. TANSIDCO will construct a four-storied industrial complex with plug-and-play facilities at Kurichi Industrial Estate, Coimbatore, on 1.2 acres at a cost of ₹37 crore. Additionally, a state-of-the-art Industrial Innovation Centre covering 26,500 sq. ft will be established in Madurai for ₹24 crore. In Sakkimangalam Industrial Estate, Madurai, a three-storied industrial complex spanning 5 acres will be developed at ₹118 crore, creating employment opportunities for 4,500 individuals.

7.5.1.4 Water Resources

- i. In Chennai and surrounding districts, 22 permanent flood prevention and mitigation works are being undertaken at a cost of ₹350 crore. In the southern districts, works for permanent flood control are being undertaken at a cost of ₹280 crore.
- ii. Works for the second phase of 'Extension, Renovation and Modernization of Grand Anicut Canal system will be undertaken at an estimated cost of ₹400 crore in the coming year, thus benefiting an ayacut of 2.3 lakh acre in Thanjavur and Pudukottai Districts.
- iii. **Green Energy:** New pumped storage hydro-electric power stations will be established under public-private partnership with an investment of approximately ₹60,000 crore.

7.5.1.5 Climate Change

- i. The 'Tamil Nadu Endangered Species Conservation Fund' with a corpus of ₹50 crore will be established.
- ii. **'TN-SHORE (Neithal Meetchi Iyakkam)'** has been sanctioned at an estimated cost of ₹1,675 crore. The Mission aims to restore coastal resources across 14 coastal districts of Tamil Nadu covering a stretch of 1,076 km.

7.5.1.6 Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare

- i. The Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme that was launched last year with the objective of promoting entrepreneurs belonging to SC/ST communities has received widespread acclaim. A sum of ₹120 crore will be allocated for this scheme in the coming year.
- ii. In addition to this, under the recently launched 'CM Arise' scheme, entrepreneurs can avail loans up to ₹10 lakh with 35 per cent interest subsidy. An allocation of ₹50 crore will be earmarked in the coming year to implement this programme.
- iii. In order to upgrade the basic amenities in tribal habitations and improve their living standards, a new scheme, 'Tholkudi', will be implemented in the next four years at an outlay of ₹1,000 crore.
- iv. A new scheme will be implemented at a cost of ₹5 crore, wherein 1,000 selected tribal youth will be selected and provided skill training on latest industrial techniques, with accommodation facilities, through the Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation to facilitate employment opportunities.
- v. **Animal Husbandry:** In order to strengthen animal sterilization project and to ensure effective operation of animal birth control centres across Tamil Nadu, an amount of ₹20 crore will be allocated in this Budget Estimates.
- vi. **Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare:** In the coming year, coastal protection and construction works such as bait arches, fish landing centres, dredging and artificial reefs at Kanniyakumari, Nagapattinam, Ramanathapuram, Thanjavur, Mayiladuthurai, Thiruvavur, Chengalpattu, Villupuram, Thiruvallur, and Thoothukudi districts will be taken up at an estimated cost of ₹450 crore.
- vii. **Dairy Development:** Modernization initiatives for installing automated machines equipped with cutting-edge technology in dairy plants, including those in Tiruchirapalli, Madurai, and Salem will be undertaken at an estimated cost of ₹60 crore.

- viii. **Handlooms and Textiles:** In order to improve the quality of textile products with the help of modern technologies and to facilitate their market linkages, 10 mini textile parks will be established by the Government in various districts including Karur, Erode and Virudhunagar at a cost of ₹20 crore.

7.5.2. Highlights related Agriculture & Farm Sector

Tamil Nadu Agriculture Budget 2024-25 with an outlay of ₹42,281.87 crore covers agriculture and related sectors, including animal husbandry, fisheries, water resources, and rural development.

7.5.2.1. Agriculture

- i. **Area expansion in agriculture crops to meet production requirements:** To achieve self-sufficiency in food grain production, Tamil Nadu focuses on expanding cultivation of pulses and oilseeds. Under the Pulses Development Scheme, ₹40.27 crore is allocated to cover 4.75 lakh acres, while the Mission on Area Expansion in Redgram promotes redgram cultivation on 50,000 acres with ₹17.50 crore. The Edible Oilseeds Production Enhancement Scheme, with ₹45 crore, targets 2.50 lakh acres for crops like groundnut and gingelly. An additional ₹3 crore supports gingelly cultivation over 25,000 acres, ₹2 crore aids sunflower expansion on 12,500 acres, and ₹18 lakh boosts castor cultivation on 1,500 acres. Overall, ₹108 crore is dedicated to these initiatives for 2024-25.
- ii. **Scheme for Incentivising Enhanced Crop Productivity:** The scheme aims to boost yields of key crops like food grains, oilseeds, and cotton, focusing on high-yielding seeds, soil health, and nutrient management. Under the Seed Village Scheme, 15,810 MT of seeds will be distributed at a 50-60% subsidy, with ₹35 crore allocated. Gypsum and Zinc Sulphate will improve soil health over 4 lakh acres at ₹9 crore, and micronutrient application for paddy will cover 2 lakh acres at ₹3 crore. Additionally, ₹1 crore is earmarked for gypsum distribution to 50,000 farmers. The scheme has a total budget of ₹48 crore for 2024-25.
- iii. **One Village - One Crop scheme:** The scheme will be implemented in 15,280 villages to boost rural production, demonstrating land preparation, seed treatment, and nutrient management for crops like paddy, millets, pulses, oilseeds, cotton, and sugarcane. Each village will focus on a single crop with demonstrations over 5-10 acres to enhance farmer awareness. Permanent Pest Surveillance Plots will be established to help farmers identify beneficial and harmful insects and adopt effective plant protection measures.
- iv. **Tamil Nadu Millet Mission Scheme (2023-2028):** The scheme aims to enhance the area, production, and productivity of major and minor millets, including Sorghum, Pearl millet, Finger millet, Kodo millet, and others, through the establishment of two Millet Special Zones across 25 districts. With a focus on promoting millets nutritional value, the scheme continues in 2024-25 with an allocation of ₹65.30 crore.
- v. **State Agriculture Development Scheme:** The Tamil Nadu Governments State Agriculture Development Scheme was launched in 2022-23 to drive agricultural progress through strategic planning and farmer engagement.
- vi. **State-Level Productivity Awards:** Cash prizes of ₹2.5 lakh (1st prize), ₹1.5 lakh (2nd prize), and ₹1 lakh (3rd prize) will be awarded to the top farmers achieving highest productivity in Millets, Pulses, Oilseeds, and Sugarcane. A total of 33 awards with an outlay of ₹55 lakh will be given in 2024-25.
- vii. **Alternative Crop Cultivation Scheme:** To promote less water-intensive crops like Millets, Pulses, and Oilseeds. This scheme will cover 1 lakh acres in 2024-25. Subsidies will be provided for seeds, bio-fertilizers, bio-control agents, micronutrient mixtures, foliar nutrient spraying, and harvesting, with an allocation of ₹12 crore.

- viii. **Agri Entrepreneurship Support:** To encourage young graduates to start agri-based businesses, financial assistance of up to ₹1 lakh will be provided to 100 graduates who secure bank loans. A total of ₹1 crore is allocated for this initiative in 2024-25.
- ix. Tamil Nadu Government, through the Nammazhvar Award, honours outstanding organic farmers annually. In 2024-25, three farmers will each receive a citation and a cash prize of ₹5 lakh for their exceptional contributions to organic farming.
- x. Since 2022-23, Tamil Nadu Government has provided an additional 20% subsidy for Small and Marginal Farmers from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities under high-value agriculture schemes. This initiative, promoting inclusive development, will continue in 2024-25 with a budget allocation of ₹18 crore.
- xi. Tamil Nadu, the yarn bowl of India, has implemented the Cotton Cultivation Mission to boost farmers income and cotton production. With an investment of ₹29.72 crore, the cotton area increased from 2.76 lakh acres (2020-21) to 4.27 lakh acres (2022-23) and production rose from 2.42 lakh to 3.19 lakh bales. In 2024-25, ₹14.20 crore has been allocated to further enhance production to 5.50 lakh bales.
- xii. Crop Insurance Scheme supports farmers against income loss from natural calamities. In 2023, ₹14.55 crore was disbursed to 9,988 farmers in Thoothukudi for rain-induced crop loss, and ₹1,775 crore is allocated for the scheme in 2024-25.

7.5.2.2. Sugarcane Development

- i. **Special Incentive for Farmers Supplying Sugarcane in 2023-24:** To encourage sugarcane cultivation and improve farmer income, a Special Incentive (SI) of ₹215 per MT will be provided to farmers who registered and supplied sugarcane to mills during the 2023-2024 crushing season. This is an increase from the previous ₹195 per MT, in addition to the Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) set by the Government of India. The scheme will benefit 1.3 lakh farmers with an allocation of ₹250 crore.
- ii. **Sugarcane Cultivation Development Programme:** With an allocation of ₹7.92 crore from both Union and State Government funds, this program aims to enhance sugarcane productivity. The funds will be used for introducing pest-resistant sugarcane varieties, reducing cultivation costs, expanding cultivation areas, and improving sugar recovery rates.
- iii. To enhance mill efficiency, modernization initiatives will be undertaken, including updating weighbridges, introducing a Rotating Hydraulic Tippler, constructing cement concrete cane yards, and setting up press mud composting yards. An allocation of ₹12.50 crore from Union and State funds will support these upgrades.
- iv. Automation of machinery and procurement of key components, including a new rotor shaft assembly and power control units, will improve operational efficiency & Installation of water treatment plant upgrades will also extend turbine life and improve water quality at allocation of ₹12.40 crore.

7.5.2.3. Horticulture & Plantation Crops

- i. **Integrated Horticulture Development in Dryland areas:** For 2024-2025, ₹3.64 crore will be allocated to subsidize farmers cultivating drought-tolerant fruit crops like Fig, Manila, Tamarind, Amla, Wood apple, Ber, and Dragon fruit, along with creating water harvesting structures and distributing mulching sheets to retain moisture. The scheme also promotes intercropping in perennial crops to boost farmers income.
- ii. **Promotion of cultivation of Horticultural Crops:** To promote high-quality horticultural crops like Kodaikanal Garlic and Ramanathapuram Mundu Chillies, a back-ended subsidy will be provided for geo-tagged Mundu chillies. Additionally, ₹2.70 crore will be allocated to subsidize quality planting materials for these area-specific crops.

- iii. The Integrated Coconut Development Scheme aims to expand coconut cultivation by 10,000 acres, distributing 7 lakh quality seedlings with an outlay of ₹4.8 crore. It will also support intercropping with banana and nutmeg (₹5.7 crore), productivity demonstrations (₹12.50 crore), and input application demonstrations on 25,000 acres (₹12 crore). Additionally, ₹1.15 crore will be allocated for pest and nutrient management, along with training on harvest, solar drying, and oil extraction.
- iv. The Micro Irrigation Scheme aims to enhance cultivation, production, and productivity through efficient water use. Over the past three years, 6.91 lakh acres were brought under micro irrigation, benefiting 2.82 lakh farmers at a cost of ₹2,114.32 crore. In 2024-2025, ₹773.23 crore will be allocated to install systems in 2.22 lakh acres, benefiting 1 lakh farmers, with a focus on over-exploited areas facing rapid groundwater depletion.
- v. A Horticulture Farm Machinery Expo will be organized to raise awareness about machinery, tools, and implements used in cultivation, from land preparation to post-harvest management. An allocation of ₹10 crore from Union and State Government funds will support the event, benefiting farmers, entrepreneurs, and officials.
- vi. **Establishment of New State Horticulture Farm and Parks:** The establishment of new horticulture farms and parks will include the creation of Mullai Garden at Velimalai (₹2 crore), Marutham Park at Thirumalai Samuthiram (₹2 crore), and a Sun Garden near Kanyakumaris seashore (₹2 crore) to attract tourists. A Hibiscus Nursery will be set up at Attur, Chengalpattu (₹1 crore), and a State Horticulture Farm at Naduvakurichi, Tenkasi (₹1 crore) will provide quality planting materials. Additionally, 100 new rose varieties will be introduced at the Government Rose Garden in Ooty to enhance its appeal.
- vii. **Special Scheme for Mukkani Development:** Recognizing the nutritional value of mango, jackfruit, and banana, special schemes will be implemented to enhance their cultivation, ensuring availability and improving farmers income. Mango: Mango orchards will be established in 4,630 acres with southern varieties (Paadiri, Neelum, etc.) and 250 acres for export varieties (Imam Pasand, Alphonso). Farmers will receive training and subsidies for rejuvenating 26,540 acres of old orchards. A growth package for 6,175 acres will include bio-fertilizers and promoters. The scheme will have an outlay of ₹27.48 crore in 2024-2025.
 - **Banana:** Banana cultivation will expand to 5,220 acres. Subsidies will be provided for propping banana bunches in 3,700 acres and distributing sleeves in 4,440 acres to ensure high-quality production. The financial outlay for the Banana scheme is ₹12.73 crore in 2024-2025.
 - **Jackfruit:** The Jackfruit scheme will expand to 1,240 acres with both local and new varieties, and include training, pest management, and processing units. An allocation of ₹1.14 crore will support jackfruit cultivation in 2024-2025.
- viii. **Promotion of Medicinal Plants Cultivation:** With growing demand for herbal crops, ₹5 crore will support the cultivation of medicinal plants such as Gloriosa, Senna, Periwinkle, and Coleus, covering 1,680 acres.
- ix. **Integrated Cashew Development Programme:** To boost cashew cultivation and production, ₹2.36 crore will be allocated to increase the area under cultivation. Additionally, ₹1 crore will be used for organic input demonstrations on 2,470 acres to improve the quality of cashew nuts.
- x. **Promotion of Chilli Cultivation:** In 2024-2025, ₹3.67 crore will be allocated to continue the eradication of Prosopis on 1,230 acres and promote chilli cultivation, expanding the area under chillies in Chilli clusters. The scheme will also support the creation of 200 water harvesting structures in Sivagangai and Ramanathapuram districts.

- xi. **Promotion of Permanent Pandal Cultivation:** A permanent pandal will be set up in 770 acres for cultivating vegetables like bitter gourd and bottle gourd, with an outlay of ₹9.40 crore in 2024-2025.
- xii. **Promotion of Traditional Vegetables:** An allocation of ₹2 crore will be made to cultivate traditional vegetables in 2,470 acres across Tamil Nadu, focusing on the revival of heritage varieties.
- xiii. **Creation of Sales Centres at State Horticulture Farms:** Sales centres will be established at 10 State Horticulture Farms to sell planting materials, bio-fertilizers, farm produce, and accessories, with an allocation of ₹1 crore.
- xiv. **Block-level Demonstration for Horticultural Crops:** One village per block will be selected to set up demonstration plots to showcase horticultural techniques, providing hands-on learning to farmers.
- xv. **Strengthening of Cluster-based Cultivation through Technical Advice:** Regular technical advice will be provided to strengthen cluster-based cultivation initiatives like Jasmine Mission, Jackfruit Mission, and others.
- xvi. **Establishment of Information Centre at Block Offices:** Information Centres will be set up in Block Offices to offer farmers easy access to cultivation techniques, market facilities, and government schemes.
- xvii. **Production of Moringa during Off-season:** A pilot project will implement the use of polythene covers to ensure off-season Moringa production, despite the drop in supply between October and January.

7.5.2.4. Agricultural Mechanization

- i. **Agricultural Mechanisation Programme:** Subsidies will be provided for distributing agricultural machinery like tractors, rotavators, paddy transplanters, drones, and solar dryers to farmers. In 2024-2025, 4,000 power tillers and 4,000 power weeders will be distributed, with a budget of ₹170 crore for 26,179 farmers.
- ii. **Strengthening of Hiring Scheme of Agricultural Engineering Department:** The Agricultural Engineering Department will enhance its hiring services by procuring new vehicles and machinery, constructing sheds, and acquiring spare parts. An allocation of ₹28.82 crore will be made for these initiatives in 2024-2025.
- iii. **Additional Subsidy for Small and Marginal Farmers:** An additional 10% subsidy (total 60%) will be provided for small and marginal farmers to purchase agricultural machinery, including paddy transplanters, with an allocation of ₹5 crore in 2024-2025.
- iv. **Paddy Mobile Dryers:** Subsidy assistance will be provided for distributing 10 mobile paddy dryers to farmers, SHGs, cooperatives, FPOs, and entrepreneurs, with an allocation of ₹90 lakh to improve drying efficiency and shelf life of harvested paddy.
- v. **Initiatives to Popularize Agricultural Machinery:** Farmers will receive training on operating and maintaining agricultural machinery through district-level melas, with technical manuals provided for farmers and field officials.
- vi. **Demonstration of Innovative Agricultural Machinery:** Innovative machinery and implements will be fabricated at Government Tractor workshops and demonstrated to farmers. These technologies will also be made available for hire at nominal charges, with a budget of ₹30 lakh for the demonstrations.
- vii. **Solar Powered Fencing for Crop Protection:** To reduce crop damage from animals, 75,000 meters of solar-powered fencing will be installed across farmers fields, with an allocation of ₹2 crore to enhance protection without harming animals.
- viii. **Creation and Maintenance of Water Harvesting Structures:** The construction of 100 new rainwater harvesting structures and maintenance of 500 existing ones will be carried out to address water shortages, with a budget of ₹2.75 crore.

- ix. **Desilting of 'C' and 'D' Channels in Delta Districts:** Desilting of 2,235 kilometers of channels in the Cauvery, Vennar, and Grand Anaicut sub-basins will be undertaken with a ₹10 crore allocation, benefiting 1,57,000 acres in seven districts.
- x. **Creation of Awareness on Rainwater Harvesting Methods:** The Agricultural Engineering Department will create awareness among farmers on rainwater harvesting techniques like summer ploughing, farm ponds, and check dams through various outreach activities such as seminars, pamphlets, and field demonstrations.

7.5.2.5. Storage & Marketing

- i. **Provision of Mobile Dryers:** Mobile dryers will be provided in 10 districts to ensure optimal moisture content in food grains for better storage and shelf life, with an allocation of ₹2.5 crore.
- ii. **Turmeric Polisher:** Five turmeric polishers and eight boilers will be provided in Erode, Kallakurichi, and Dharmapuri districts to improve the quality and shelf life of turmeric, at a cost of ₹2.12 crore.
- iii. **Common Branding and Packaging Facilities:** Common infrastructure for branding and packaging will be established in Chennai and Coimbatore to help farmers and FPOs market value-added products, with an investment of ₹4.10 crore.
- iv. **Jackfruit Value Addition Centre at Panruti:** A value addition centre for jackfruit will be established in Panruti, Cuddalore District to promote the production and export of jackfruit-based products, with an allocation of ₹16.13 crore.
- v. **Technology cum Market Promotion Centre for Millets:** A centre in Perambalur will provide training on value addition technologies for millet and maize farmers, supported with ₹4 crore in infrastructure development.
- vi. **Renovation of Infrastructure in Regulated Markets:** Renovation of infrastructure in 100 regulated markets will continue, with a ₹50 crore allocation for improvements in the year 2024-2025.
- vii. **Promoting APEDA-Trained Farmers as Exporters:** The scheme will support 100 farmers trained by APEDA in Mango, Coconut, Millets, Moringa, Turmeric, Small Onion, and Cucumber cultivation to become exporters. Each farmer will receive 15,000 for export certification, with a total allocation of ₹15 lakh from the State Fund.
- viii. **Integrating Agricultural Produce with E-Commerce:** The scheme aims to connect farmers with e-commerce platforms for direct online sales of their products, helping generate additional income for farmers and providing consumers with quality products at reasonable prices.
- ix. **Improvement of Agricultural Trade:** The scheme focuses on empowering farmers to determine prices for their produce by linking the stock of farmers produce with traders through social networks. It includes 770 village campaigns per month to raise awareness on post-harvest technologies, grading, value addition, and export procedures.
- x. **Facilitating Farm Gate Trade:** Farm Gate Trade, which enables the direct sale of agricultural produce through the eNAM platform, will be intensified to trade ₹60 crore worth of produce in 2024-2025, ensuring fair prices for farmers.
- xi. **Increase the Pledge Loan Limit to Farmers:** The pledge loan limit for farmers will be increased from ₹3 lakh to ₹5 lakh to prevent distress sales during harvest season glut, ensuring better financial support for stored produce in Regulated Market godowns.
- xii. **WDRA Accreditation for Storage Godowns:** An additional 100 godowns will be accredited with the Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA) in 2024-2025, facilitating pledge loans from nationalized banks through the e-Negotiable Warehouse Receipts system.

- xiii. **Agricultural Exhibition:** Building on the success of previous expos, three Agri Expos will be conducted during 2024-2025 at a cost of ₹9 crore, aimed at engaging farmers, entrepreneurs, and the public in agricultural business and innovations.

7.5.2.6. Palm Development Mission

- i. The scheme aims to increase the number of palm trees and enhance the livelihoods of palm workers. Over the past three years, 47 lakh palm seeds were planted, and 950 individuals received training and equipment for producing value-added products like palm jaggery and candy, while 350 women were trained in making palm leaf products. In 2024-2025, the mission will plant 10 lakh palm seeds and train 300 individuals, including 200 in producing palm-based products and 100 in palm leaf crafts, with necessary equipment provided. The scheme will be implemented with an outlay of ₹1.14 crore.

7.5.2.7. Watershed Development Programme

- i. The programme will focus on natural resource management, production systems, and livelihood support across 275 micro watersheds in 25 blocks of seven districts (Perambalur, Thoothukudi, Krishnagiri, Ramanathapuram, Dharmapuri, Dindigul, and Virudhunagar) with an allocation of ₹43 crore from Union and State funds in 2024-2025.

7.5.2.8. Water Resources Department

- i. The department focuses on constructing barrages, regulators, canals, tanks, and check dams, interlinking rivers, and creating groundwater recharge structures to enhance irrigation. For 2024-2025, ₹110 crore has been allocated to undertake 919 desilting works, covering 5,338 km of rivers, canals, and channels in the Cauvery delta to ensure water delivery to tail-end areas before the South-West monsoon.
- ii. Government has sanctioned the implementation of "Tamil Nadu Water Resources Information and Management System" (TNWRIMS), at an estimated cost of ₹30 crore, for the effective management of water resources in Tamil Nadu. A web portal for this system will be launched soon. In the Budget Estimates, a sum of ₹8,398 crore has been allocated for the Water Resources Department.

7.5.2.9. Animal Husbandry

- i. To boost milk production, incentives for intercropping fodder in gardens and orchards were provided, covering 2,000 acres during 2022-2024. Building on its success, ₹2 crore has been allocated for 2024-2025 to expand the initiative to 5,000 acres.

7.5.2.10. Fisheries

- i. To boost inland fisheries and meet freshwater fish demand, ₹4.60 crore is allocated as subsidies for projects like grow-out fishponds, freshwater aquaculture, Bio-floc and Re-circulatory Aquaculture Systems, and fish feed mills. These initiatives aim to enhance fishermen's income and increase inland fish production.

7.5.3. Highlights related to Rural Development & Non-Farm Sector

7.5.3.1. Co-operation, Food and Consumer Protection

- i. **Co-operative Crop Loan:** For 2024-2025, a target of ₹16,500 crore is set for crop loan disbursement. In 2023-2024, ₹13,600 crore was disbursed to 16.19 lakh farmers. Additionally, ₹700 crore has been allocated for interest subsidy on crop loans, and ₹200 crore for working capital loans for Goat rearing, Dairying, Poultry, and Fisheries.

- ii. **Digitization of Cooperative Banks:** A scheme to digitize Primary Agricultural Co-operative Credit Societies (PACCS) with an allocation of ₹141 crore will streamline credit disbursement and enhance transparency.
- iii. **Multi-Purpose Service Centres:** ₹457 crore has been sanctioned for transforming PACCS into Multi-Purpose Service Centres (MPSCs), offering services like Agricultural Service Centres, Rural Marts, Processing Units, and Storage Godowns. ₹341 crore has been disbursed so far, with 1,380 agricultural machines acquired.
- iv. **e-Banking Services:** Cooperative banks have introduced Unified Payment Interface (UPI) and NEFT services, now used by over one crore customers, facilitating 30 lakh transactions valued at ₹17,000 crore each month.
- v. **Direct Paddy Procurement:** Six new modernized rice mills will be commissioned, and 55 direct paddy procurement stations will be set up, supported by ₹238 crore for paddy storage structures and ₹10,500 crore for food subsidies to ensure food security. An additional ₹500 crore will be allocated as incentives for paddy procurement in Tamil Nadu.

7.5.3.2. Rural Development

- i. Under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme, ₹7,000 crore is allocated for 2024-2025 to implement 2 lakh works, including farm ponds, water recharge shafts, percolation ponds, and stone bunds. These initiatives focus on natural resource management, groundwater improvement, and soil moisture enhancement, alongside single-layer WBM roads to connect tribal villages with markets.
- ii. **Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women:** The Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women will establish 60 coconut nurseries through trained women SHGs in coordination with the Horticulture Department at a cost of ₹2.40 crore. Additionally, ₹2 crore is allocated to form 100 seed production clusters for pulses and oilseeds, with SHGs trained and supported by the Agriculture Department, ensuring seed procurement and distribution with production incentives.
- iii. 10,000 new SHGs will be formed this year to include women from marginalized sections, who have not been part of the SHG network so far. The credit disbursement target has been fixed at ₹35,000 crore for the year 2024-25.
- iv. **Naan Mudalvan Scheme:** With the vision of transforming Tamil youth into global leaders, the Hon'ble Chief Minister launched the Naan Mudalvan programme. Under this scheme, new Skill Labs will be established in 100 Government and Government-aided Engineering, and Arts and Science colleges in the coming year at a cost of ₹200 crore. Under this scheme, 1,000 candidates will be selected annually and provided quality training, with boarding and lodging facilities, for six months in Chennai, Coimbatore, and Madurai regions with an objective of increasing the number of youth clearing Staff Selection Commission, Railway and Bank examinations.
- v. An amount of ₹27,922 crore has been allocated under Chief Minister's Thayumanavar Scheme, which will provide basic needs, such as education, employment opportunities, skill development and housing, to the vulnerable section of the society.

7.5.3.3. Revenue and Disaster Management

- i. The Tamil Nadu Government provides free electricity for agricultural irrigation to promote irrigated farming and enhance food security, benefiting 23.51 lakh farmers with three-phase power connections. To support this initiative, ₹7,280 crore will be allocated as compensation to TANGEDCO.

7.5.3.4. Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises

- i. Tamil Nadu Food Processing and Agri Export Promotion Corporation (TNAPEX)

- **Value-Added Food Product Manufacturing Incubation:** Establishment of incubation facilities for value-added food products at primary processing centres in Dharmapuri, Dindigul, and Nilgiris to enhance utilization.
 - **Export-Oriented Infra Development:** Creation of infrastructure in the agro-industrial corridor at Thanjavur for extracting export-oriented compounds from agricultural produce and biomass.
 - **Food Quality Testing Laboratories:** Setting up food quality testing laboratories at Coimbatore, Madurai, Trichy, and Vellore to certify food products for export purposes.
 - **Value Chain for Agricultural Products:** Development of value chains for Rice, Mango, Banana, Guava, Tomato, Chilli, and marine fish products, including production, processing, marketing, and consumption activities.
 - **Funding:** These schemes will be implemented with a total outlay of ₹72 crore during 2024-2025.
- ii. Under the “**CM Arise**” scheme, entrepreneurs can avail loans up to ₹10 lakh with 35 per cent interest subsidy. An allocation of ₹50 crore will be earmarked in the coming year to implement this programme.
 - iii. **Establishment of Government Industrial Training Institutes:** Ten new Government Industrial Training Institutes will be set up in Cuddalore, Dindigul, and Krishnagiri districts, featuring smart classrooms to enhance learning. The initiative, costing ₹111 crore, aims to improve students’ skills.
 - iv. **Creation of New Industrial Estates:** Three industrial estates for MSMEs will be established in Dindigul, Sivagangai, and Thiruvavur districts over 80 acres at ₹32 crore. The project will create 3,000 direct employment opportunities.
 - v. **Development of Micro Clusters:** Six micro clusters, including apparel, silk, and Siddha medicine clusters, will be developed in districts like Virudhunagar, Chengalpet, and Salem with common facilities under a ₹25 crore government-funded initiative.
 - vi. **Comprehensive Tourism Development:** Tourism destinations like Kanniyakumari, Madurai, and Thanjavur will undergo upgradation and new developments under a comprehensive plan, including maintenance and youth training for job creation.

7.5.4. Govt Sponsored Programmes linked with Bank Credit

- i. **New Entrepreneur cum Enterprise Development Scheme (NEEDS)** - The Government’s flagship scheme aimed at nurturing first-generation entrepreneurs. It offers training to young entrepreneurs in planning and launching manufacturing or service enterprises. Post-training, participants can access term loans from banks or TIIC to establish their ventures. The project cost ceiling was raised from ₹100 lakh to ₹500 lakh in 2018, with a capital subsidy cap increased from ₹25 lakh to ₹30 lakh. For FY 2024-25, ₹101 crore has been allocated for subsidy assistance under the scheme. Efforts are also underway to onboard Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) onto the TReDS platform, ensuring timely payments to MSMEs.
- ii. **Unemployed Youth Employment Generation Programme (UYEGP)** - The scheme aims to address unemployment among socially and economically weaker sections, as outlined in the MSME Policy. The scheme supports educated unemployed youth in setting up self-employment ventures in manufacturing (₹15 lakh), service (₹5 lakh), or business (₹5 lakh) sectors with a state government subsidy of up to 25% (maximum ₹2.50 lakh) with objectives of promoting self-employment in rural and urban areas, mitigating rural-to-urban migration due to unemployment, providing livelihood opportunities for marginalized groups and enabling collateral-free loans under CGTMSE for micro-enterprises.
- iii. **Back-ended Interest Subsidy scheme under MSME** - The scheme launched by the MSME Department, Government of Tamil Nadu, supports new micro and small

- manufacturing enterprises by reducing financial burden on term loans. It provides a 5% interest subsidy for 5 years, with a maximum subsidy of ₹20 lakh for loans up to ₹2 crore under CGTMSE and ₹25 lakh for loans up to ₹5 crore for technology upgradation or modernization. For loans up to ₹1 crore, the maximum subsidy is capped at ₹10 lakh. This initiative aims to promote growth and modernization in the MSME sector.
- iv. **Subsidy for Fund Raising from SME Exchange** - The scheme "Subsidy for Fund Raising from SME Exchange" by the Micro Small and Medium Enterprises Department, Government of Tamil Nadu, is introduced with the objective to facilitate high growth potential SMEs in the State to raise equity capital through SME Exchange utilizing IPOs, in both the manufacturing and services sector. The government will provide assistance for listing & raising money in the SME stock exchange. Assistance with a maximum of ₹30,00,000, subject to 50% of the total expenditure incurred on SME IPO.
 - v. **Capital Subsidy** - The Capital Subsidy scheme by the MSME Department, Tamil Nadu, helps reducing the capital burden for MSMEs by providing a 25% subsidy on eligible plant and machinery costs, up to ₹150 lakh. Additional subsidies include 5% (up to ₹5 lakh) for Women, SC/ST, Differently Abled, and Transgender entrepreneurs; 10% (up to ₹5 lakh) for micro-enterprises; and 5% (up to ₹25 lakh) for existing enterprises expanding or diversifying. An extra 25% subsidy (up to ₹10 lakh) is offered for adopting cleaner, environmentally friendly technologies. This initiative promotes inclusive growth and technological advancement in MSMEs.
 - vi. **Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme** - Tamil Nadu Government has launched "Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme (AABCS)" which supports SC/ST entrepreneurs by offering a 35% capital subsidy (up to ₹1.5 crore) and a 6% interest subvention on loans for procuring machinery and equipment. Implemented by the MSME Department through ICDIC with support from FaMeTN, StartupTN, and the Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute, the scheme is overseen by a State Level Steering Committee that reviews its progress quarterly and recommends enhancements to ensure its effectiveness.

Appendix I

Climate Action & Sustainability

Climate Action - Scenario at Global & National Level

Climate Change and its Impact

Climate change is affecting every region on the Earth, in multiple ways. The IPCC AR6[] highlights that human-induced climate change is intensifying weather and climate extremes, resulting in unprecedented heatwaves, heavy rainfall, and severe droughts. The frequency and intensity of these events are likely to increase, posing significant risks to ecosystems, biodiversity, and human societies.

India is exposed to a whole range of climate and weather-related hazards. India with diverse geographical regions, long coastline, biodiversity, and high dependence on natural resources is one of the most vulnerable countries to climate change risks worldwide. Further, more than half of India's population lives in rural areas and depends on agriculture & allied activities, which are highly sensitive to climate change, threatening the livelihoods of people dependent on them.

There is emerging evidence that the productivity of crops, livestock and fish is likely to be affected with implications to food security, livelihoods, and sustainability in agriculture. In India, several studies have projected declining crop yields, in the absence of adaptation to climate change. As per the district level risk and vulnerability assessment of Indian agriculture to climate change undertaken by ICAR-CRIDA, 109 districts out of 573 rural districts (19% of total districts) are 'very high-risk' districts, while 201 districts are high-risk districts. Sixth Assessment Report (AR6) of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), 2022 ICAR-CRIDA (2019): Risk and Vulnerability Assessment of Indian Agriculture to Climate Change.

Climate Finance and Challenges

Climate finance requirement of India is enormous. While the preliminary financial estimates for meeting India's climate change actions as per NDC was USD 2.5 trillion between 2015 and 2030, estimated financial requirement of India to become net-zero by 2070 as per IFC is US\$10.1 trillion. There are various estimates of financial requirements that vary greatly due to varying levels of detail, but it is important to note that they all point to a need for tens of trillions of US dollars. India's updated NDCs also indicates the need to better adapt to climate change by enhancing investments in development programmes in sectors vulnerable to climate change, however financial requirements for adaptation are very large and will increase in the future. To fully meet our NDCs in a timely manner, India requires enhanced new and additional financial, technological and capacity building support. However, financial, and technological commitments by developed countries under the Paris Agreement are yet to be fully transpired.

Initiatives of Govt. of India

India initiated the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC) in 2008, which introduced eight National Missions encompassing various efforts. In August 2022, the Government of India displayed greater determination in its efforts to address climate change by submitting its revised Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) to the UNFCCC. Through Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for the Environment), India advocated for a global shift in mindset and behaviour, moving away from thoughtless and harmful consumption towards purposeful and conscious utilisation.

Initiatives of RBI

Climate change is a rapidly emerging area of policy interest in the RBI. Back in 2007, the RBI advised banks to put in place Board-approved plans of action towards helping the cause of sustainable development. In 2015, the RBI included loans for generation of renewable energy and public utilities run on non-conventional energy as part of its priority sector lending (PSL) policy to incentivise the development of green energy sources.

RBI has also laid out guidance for voluntary initiatives by regulated entities (REs) on green finance, setting up of green branches and green data centres, encouraging greater use of electronic means of communication instead of paper, and renewable energy sources. In early 2023, the RBI issued sovereign green bonds to mobilise resources for the Government for green infrastructural investments. RBI has also released the framework for mobilising green deposits by REs. In February 2024, the RBI has issued draft guidelines on 'Disclosure framework on climate-related financial risks, 2024'. The framework mandates disclosure by REs on four key areas of governance, strategy, risk management and metric and targets, which is a step towards bringing the climate risk assessment, measurement and reporting requirements under mainstream compliance framework for financial sector entities in India.

Initiatives of NABARD

The whole spectrum of NABARD's functions and initiatives focus on the attainment of sustainable development. NABARD's initiatives in the Agriculture, Natural Resources, and Rural Development (ANR) sector have integral components of climate action – both mitigation and adaptation, for vulnerable sectors and communities. NABARD has been playing a key role in channelising climate finance to the nation as the Direct Access Entity (DAE) and the National Implementing Entity (NIE) for major climate funds such as the Green Climate Fund (GCF), Adaptation Fund (AF), and National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change (NAFCC). This role enables NABARD to access and deploy climate finance effectively, driving impactful initiatives that address the pressing challenges of climate change in the agricultural sector.

In a significant stride towards sustainable development, NABARD recently unveiled its Climate Strategy 2030. The strategy is structured around four key pillars: (i) Accelerating Green Lending across sectors, (ii) Playing a broader Market Making Role, (iii) Internal Green Transformation of NABARD, and (iv) Strategic Resource Mobilization. This strategic initiative not only reinforces NABARD's commitment to environmental stewardship but also positions it as a pivotal player in India's transition towards a resilient and sustainable economy.

Climate Change Scenario – At the State Level State Action Plan for Climate Change

The Tamil Nadu State Action Plan on Climate Change (TNSAPCC), launched in 2015, is a comprehensive framework. It provided the first State-wide and crosssectoral climate change impact and vulnerability assessment. The plan also formulated a range of adaptation and mitigation strategies to be implemented by various Departments. The Government of Tamil Nadu is also preparing the second edition of the State Action Plan on Climate Change (TNSAPCC2.0) for the years 2022-2030. The action plan has identified the following eleven vulnerable sectors, viz.,

1. Sustainable Agriculture & Allied Sectors
2. Water Resources
3. Forests & Biodiversity
4. Coastal Area Management
5. Strategic Knowledge and Climate Literacy
6. Children and Youth for Climate Action
7. Disaster Management and Mitigation
8. Health and Sanitation

9. Sustainable Habitat
10. Enhanced Energy Efficiency & Solar Mission
11. Gender and Climate Change

The Department of Environment, Government of Tamil Nadu is the Nodal Agency implementing all the Climate Change related programmes and coordinating with the concerned line Departments on the TNSAPCC in the State for submitting proposals under Green Climate Fund (GCF) and National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change (NAFCC) in consultation with the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD).

Tamil Nadu Governing Council on Climate Change: In order to ensure that all activities are in line with the objectives of the Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission, the Government has set up the Tamil Nadu Governing Council on Climate Change. Tamil Nadu is the pioneer in India to set up a Governing Council exclusively for Climate Change. Objectives of Tamil Nadu Governing Council on Climate Change

1. Provide a Policy directive to the Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission.
2. Advise on Climate adaptation and mitigation activities.
3. Approve Tamil Nadu State Action Plan on Climate Change.
4. Guide the State Climate Change Mission and District Climate Change Missions on implementing various climate initiatives.

The Tamil Nadu Governing Council on Climate Change was established with 26 members under the Chairmanship of the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu. The members include Ministers and Secretaries of various departments and eminent experts of National and International repute.

Any specific Climate Change initiative in the State by Govt. of India: National Mission on Strategic Knowledge on Climate Change (SCCC-NMSKCC): The Department of Environment and Climate Change, Government of Tamil Nadu, successfully implemented the Project entitled "Establishing/Strengthening the State Climate Change Centre/Cell under National Mission on Strategic Knowledge on Climate Change (SCCC-NMSKCC) in the State of Tamil Nadu" during the period from 2017 to 2022. The Department of Science and Technology, Government of India, has approved the NMSKCC Phase II project entitled "Providing Climate Smart Integrated Decision Support System (CSIDSS) Tools for Cadastral Level Adaptation" for implementation by Department of Environment and Climate Change (DoE&CC), Government of Tamil Nadu. DST has allocated ₹2.05 Crore for the five-year duration of NMSKCC Phase II to assess block level risk and vulnerability in agriculture and water sectors due to climate change in Tamil Nadu.

ICAR Institutions: In Tamil Nadu, various ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) institutions are actively involved in climate change initiatives. Some specific efforts include:

- i. **Climate-Resilient Crop Varieties:** ICAR institutions have been developing and promoting climate-resilient varieties of crops that can withstand extreme weather conditions such as droughts and floods.
- ii. **Agro-Meteorological Advisory Services:** They provide farmers with weather forecasts and agricultural advice to help them adapt their practices to changing climate conditions.
- iii. **Research on Carbon Sequestration:** Ongoing research projects aim to assess and enhance carbon sequestration in agricultural soils, which can help mitigate climate change.

State Government:

- i. **Green Tamil Nadu Mission:** GoTN has announced the Green Tamil Nadu Mission to increase the total area under forest and tree cover in Tamil Nadu to 33 percent of the state's land area. Under the Mission, a Massive Tree Plantation Programme of

indigenous and diverse species will be rolled out over the next 10 years.

- ii. **Tamil Nadu Wetlands Mission:** To restore wetlands in Tamil Nadu, a map 100 wetlands in 5 years will be identified and restored the ecological balance with a focus on livelihood options.
- iii. **Tamil Nadu Coastal Restoration Mission:** “Tamil Nadu Sustainably Harnessing Ocean Resources and Blue Economy (TN-SHORE)” aims to enhance the sustainable utilisation of coastal resources through a multi-pronged approach.
- iv. **Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission:** During the Budget Speech for the year 2021-2022, the Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission was launched to focus on climate change adaptation and mitigation activities, with a total outlay of ₹500 crores for a period of Five years.

NABARD:

- i. NABARD, has implemented climate-proofing projects under Adaptation Fund of the UNFCCC in nine watersheds with ₹3.78 crore in grants across Dindigul, Madurai, and Krishnagiri.
- ii. Green Climate Fund (GCF) under UNFCC aims to support global climate efforts. NABARD became the first NIE for GCF in July 2015 and four proposals are under scrutiny.
- iii. The National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change (NAFCC), established by GoI, supports states in implementing climate adaptation projects aligned with national and state action plans. In Tamil Nadu, ₹65.3 crore has been sanctioned, with ₹48.50 crore released.

Key projects include:

- i. **Coastal Habitat Management:** Sanctioned for ₹24.74 crore, with ₹23.12 crore released for biodiversity rehabilitation in Gulf of Mannar.
- ii. **Watershed Climate Proofing:** A project in Salem and Virudhunagar with a total outlay of ₹23.80 crore and ₹11.52 crore disbursed.
- iii. **Integrated Water Management:** Sanctioned for ₹16.76 crore in Puducherry, with ₹12.90 crore released.

Other Agencies: The Tamil Nadu Government, under the Department of Environment, Climate Change & Forest, has set up the Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC), which is a Not for-Profit Company and a unique platform to respond to Climate Change in the State. TNGCC is a first-of-its-kind ambitious initiative by the State Government. It will act as a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) to address the Climate Crisis in the State, which has become more widespread in recent times and calls for immediate attention to Climate Policy, leading to purposeful and equitable long-term solutions. TNGCC will drive innovative climate & sustainability solutions by transforming communities and urban & rural infrastructure across the State that are hardest hit by climate disruption.

Way Forward

India has significantly high climate finance needs. NABARD is dedicated to playing its part to expand climate financing in India through a range of financial and non-financial initiatives. Our goal is to promote adoption of innovative and new techniques, and paradigm shifts to build climate resilient agro-ecological livelihoods and sustainable agricultural systems, that are resilient to climate change. The fight against climate change necessitates cooperation, innovation, and a collective commitment to effect change. Currently, it is a crucial time for communities worldwide to expedite climate action before it becomes too late.

Appendix II

Potential of Geographical Indication in the State

Geographical Indication (GI) is an Intellectual Property Right (IPR) that identifies goods originating from a specific geographical location and have distinct nature quality and characteristics linked to that location. GIs can play an important role in rural development, empowering communities acting as product differentiators, support brand building, creates local employment, reduces rural migration, creating a regional brand generating spin-off effects in tourism and gastronomy, preserving traditional knowledge and traditional cultural expressions and conserving biodiversity.

NABARD's intervention in Geographical Indications envisages end-to-end support in facilitating pre-registration as well as post-registration activities for Geographical Indications, in order to appreciate quality, improve market access, create awareness, strengthen producer's capacity to enforce their rights, subsidize cost of registration, enforcement and marketing. Geographical Indication (GI) tagging is a vital intellectual property right that highlights the uniqueness of products from specific regions. It enhances marketability, preserves cultural heritage and provides legal protection. Dharmapuri district with its agricultural diversity and unique agro-climatic conditions can leverage GI tags to boost local economies, safeguard traditional knowledge and promote sustainable rural livelihoods.

Sl. No.	District	Potential GI Product
1	Chengalpattu	Chengalpattu Sirumani (Paddy)
2	Dharmapuri	Malgoa Mango, Bernisha Mango, White Brinjal (Dharmapuri Vellai Kathirikkai), Ragi, Horse Gram
3	Cuddalore	Panruti Jackfruit, Panruti Cashew Nut
4	Dindigul	Dindigul Lock, Sirumalai Virupakshi Banana, Kodaikanal Hill Garlic, Ayyampalayam Nettai Adhalaikkai (in pre-examination)
5	Karur	Sengal Thuvurai (Pigeon Pea)
6	Tiruvannamalai	Vandavasi Korai Mats, Modaiyur Stone and Wood Carving
7	Pudukkottai	Vadaku Jackfruit, Alavayal Brinjal, ACRI Kudimiyanmalai
8	Virudhunagar	Virudhunagar Adhalaikkai, Virudhunagar Samba Vathal (Chilly), Rajapalayam Mango, Aruppukottai Sarees, Sattur Cucumber, Kodukkapuli (Manila Tamarind)
9	Kanniyakumari	Coconut Shell Craft, Sea Shell Craft, Pepper, Hibiscus, Jackfruit, Banana Chips, Pineapple, Mundhiri Kothu, Cashew, Latex, Koil Vilakku, Tapioca, Herbs, Gandhari Milagai (Chilli)
10	Ariyalur & Thanjavur	Karuppur Kalamkari Paintings, Jayankondam Cotton Sarees, Udayanatham Brass Utensils, Cashew and Cement
11	Perambalur	Arumbavur Wood Carvings
12	Villuppuram	Panipayaru, Indigo

Sl. No.	District	Potential GI Product
13	Madurai	Madurai Marikolunthu known as Davana (already applied and under examination) Madurai Sungudi, Madurai Malli, Sholavandan Vetrilai, , Madurai Sengarumbu
14	Theni	Cumbum Panneer Thratchai (Grape)
15	Tirupathur	Wood Carving Products, Kodo Millet
16	Erode	Bhavani Jamakkalam, Erode Coconut and Coconut Products, Chennimalai Bedsheet
17	Kallakurichi	Kadukkai from Kalrayan Hills
18	Krishnagiri	Krishnagiri - Panneer Rose, Arasampatti - Coconut, Urigam - Puli (Tamarind)
19	Namakkal	Kolli Hills - Pepper, Rasipuram – Ghee
20	Ramanathapuram	Sivagangai Karuppu Kavuni Rice, Chettinad Kottan, Chettinad Sarees, Chettinad Snacks, Attangudi Tiles
21	The Nilgiris	Nilgiris Orthodox Tea, Ooty's Varkey, Toda tribe's embroidery (Pukhoor)
22	Tirunelveli	Nendhiran Banana – Kalakkad, Pottery - Karakurichi, Wooden Toy – Ambasamuthiram, Tirunelveli Senna Leaves.
23	Thoothukudi	Poovilla Chendu Banana - Tiruchendur, Monthan Banana - Sathankulam, Karukanni Cotton - Kayathar, Boli - Kadampur, Macroon - Thoothukudi, Muskoth Halwa - Mudhalur, Moondu Chilli – Vilathikulam
24	Mayiladuthurai	Thaikkal Rattan Craft of Kollidam Block
25	Ranipet	Meenambur Jeeraga Samba Rice, Arcot Makkan Peda
26	Thanjavur	Peravurani Coconut
27	Tiruvallur	Pazhaverkadu Palm Leaf Handicrafts
28	Vellore	Odugathur Guava, Gudiyatham Lungis
29	Ramanathapuram	Paramakudi Sarees, Chitraikar red rice & Pattarai Karuvadu

Annexure I

District-wise and Sector-wise PLP projections

₹ lakh

Sr. No.	Particulars	Ariyalur	Chengalpattu	Chennai	Coimbatore	Cuddalore	Dharmapuri	Dindigul	Erode
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	532822.42	1004855.85	0.00	1556576.36	1100777.11	1082078.2	943489.89	445809.30
1	Water Resources	4994.43	6606.49	0.00	12759.68	97965.04	16261.86	53981.18	76757.3
2	Farm Mechanisation	11822.64	16742.47	0.00	74443.89	88520.93	10817.34	53778.34	54905.46
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	4355.94	11414.03	0.00	49940.01	18305.2	25752.86	45165.77	12233.43
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	4585.29	1270.65	0.00	3164.42	25079.98	6563.68	12334.25	4123.36
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	37854.65	47743.95	0.00	35460.32	104327.52	63416.16	62096.59	180742.53
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	743.94	26705.40	0.00	62012.12	27953.18	12656.52	12803.78	107445.27
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	5240.27	5568.50	0.00	3480.46	33225.96	17450.56	16529.08	19441.9
8	Fisheries	1752.10	4357.54	31746.34	1929.1	59334.17	626.85	1854.38	5722.01
9	Farm Credit- Others	7214.40	1142.20	0	8799.62	2925.08	2571.84	1698.4	18917.2
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	78563.66	121551.23	31746.34	251989.62	457637.06	156117.67	260241.77	480288.46
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	611386.08	1126407.08	31746.34	1808565.98	1558414.17	1238195.82	1203731.66	926097.76
11	Construction of storage	3506.38	20268.72	0.00	32140.00	11974.78	16112.00	39102.00	40568.86
12	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	982.83	10184.09	0.00	21642.27	16824.22	4798.93	41007.40	7246.85
13	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	519.33	7727.20	0.00	32416.00	4259.20	1178.72	15238.40	50465.04
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	5008.54	38180.01	0.00	86198.27	33058.20	22089.65	95347.80	98280.75
14	Food & Agro Processing	1643.96	24314.72	219284.00	66055.12	6299.77	12251.40	46488.00	176529.02
15	Ancillary activities - Others	2522.40	10200.00	5400.00	18704.00	19840.00	7648.00	15624.00	59992.00
E	Ancilliary Activities Total (14 to 15)	4166.36	34514.72	224684.00	84759.12	26139.77	19899.40	62112.00	236521.02
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	620560.98	1199101.81	256430.34	1979523.37	1617612.14	1280184.87	1361191.46	1260899.53
G	MSME	60158.55	580928.00	13675472.00	3904837.60	262220.40	248336.00	387294.40	1412295.30
H	Export Credit	1500.00	20250.00	1875000.00	45675.00	33750.00	600.00	15187.50	49537.50
I	Education	3503.25	104550.00	1097250.00	148537.50	41478.75	7376.25	28796.25	31404.79
J	Housing Loan	8080.00	272000.00	2700000.00	320640.00	50020.00	98080.00	78784.00	20843.20
K	Social Infrastructure	2220.00	79350.00	48375.00	34762.50	24031.52	13397.84	37110.01	117245.59
L	Renewable Energy	1210.32	2841.75	29475.00	7559.10	9250.56	2489.63	11740.50	41789.29
M	Others	52770.90	220160.00	230000.00	119400.00	68626.00	95285.00	64070.40	258971.16
N	Total (H to M)	69284.47	699151.75	5980100.00	676574.10	227156.83	217228.72	235688.66	519791.53
O	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	750004.00	2479181.56	19912002.34	6560935.07	2106989.37	1745749.59	1984174.52	3192986.36

Sr. No.	Particulars	Kallakurichi	Kancheepuram	Kanyakumari	Karur	Krishnagiri	Madurai	Mayiladuthurai	Nagapattinam
		9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	825174.93	756598.44	906559.59	479808.92	1071961.79	1609120.84	325022.25	295427.71
1	Water Resources	8672.00	1794.89	8620.15	9299.69	15395.56	39587.77	5620.15	2537.34
2	Farm Mechanisation	33003.01	6621.13	6597.75	30257.72	23561.29	99603.07	21141.25	9024.56
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	5151.85	1276.40	90626.85	19489.03	48879.82	25637.97	4716.4	9380.73
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	5634.36	227.79	6916.05	5120.56	986.20	11235.82	1920.47	2048.19
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	138698.36	12286.31	35993.45	30791.15	100287.30	121702.52	25835.11	9764.55
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	16464.88	2734.80	140305.33	6150.02	37935.03	12874.60	3754.85	18750.45
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	5806.72	874.58	21352.74	19155.43	40389.75	15116.83	6283.08	3292.15
8	Fisheries	1144.67	164.88	41984.13	579.21	4043.32	4302.33	55082.43	15646.2
9	Farm Credit- Others	3190.40	888.20	1839.20	6237.60	2564.00	6060.48	9297.64	1531.2
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	217766.25	26868.98	354235.65	127080.41	274042.27	336121.39	133651.38	71975.37
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	1042941.18	783467.42	1260795.24	606889.33	1346004.06	1945242.23	458673.63	367403.08
11	Construction of storage	35197.91	3337.18	6212.40	15520.00	22261.89	37360.00	28350.00	20057.76
12	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	10298.07	109.51	10319.31	3246.50	1984.13	17517.02	365.42	461.73
13	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	12483.52	576.00	32611.71	20448.00	13129.90	5995.58	24480.00	1437.6
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	57979.50	4022.69	49143.42	39214.50	37375.92	60872.60	53195.42	21957.09
14	Food & Agro Processing	26004.76	374.00	14150.04	32714.80	29552.42	116077.84	6538.40	1893.84
15	Ancillary activities - Others	5908.00	160.00	3942.40	15316.00	12078.40	13247.20	40688.00	31060
E	Ancilliary Activities Total (14 to 15)	31912.76	534.00	18092.44	48030.80	41630.82	129325.04	47226.40	32953.84
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	1132833.44	788024.11	1328031.10	694134.63	1425010.80	2135439.87	559095.45	422314.01
G	MSME	92448.00	578068.40	517755.20	428166.40	600688.00	1133529.20	83454.90	60376
H	Export Credit	5250.00	5250.00	68512.50	12300.00	6375.00	24075.00	2625.00	4125
I	Education	17062.50	18481.90	9105.00	13631.25	3060.00	33608.25	9971.65	7447.53
J	Housing Loan	17776.00	10280.00	598166.40	68460.00	11456.00	95607.20	7420.80	10492
K	Social Infrastructure	7933.17	27675.00	314383.50	17861.25	6198.75	85498.53	877.50	2557.5
L	Renewable Energy	4293.00	4439.25	28523.88	2477.70	1575.00	9796.05	3250.35	2205
M	Others	118976.00	38514.50	4233.40	59218.68	156252.00	60857.48	27104.35	45982
N	Total (H to M)	171290.67	104640.65	1022924.68	173948.88	184916.75	309442.51	51249.65	72809.03
O	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	1396572.11	1470733.16	2868710.98	1296249.91	2210615.55	3578411.58	693800.00	555499.04

Sr. No.	Particulars	Namakkal	Nilgiris	Perambalur	Pudukottai	Ramanathapuram	Ranipet	Salem	Sivagangai
		17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	1075196.73	184232.03	443280.62	605595.16	767498.29	576750.25	1766440.88	946251.27
1	Water Resources	20849.78	4977.29	10,949.92	35651.62	1052.61	6061	15118.26	1357.73
2	Farm Mechanisation	54320.76	4945.36	23,079.01	74185.59	2198.46	13725.86	10728.49	2308.09
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	27507.19	40837.79	3,550.43	33766.79	1899.11	3899.96	37322.55	1415.4
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	3609.33	902.91	2,142.92	4402.04	1227.41	171.06	11992	2190.94
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	31116.29	9836.35	42,085.78	58769.78	71224.12	125727.7	164556.19	65461.86
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	121810.64	522.00	1,182.10	19053.86	4806.96	4839.92	25876.8	3740.63
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	13736.11	692.06	14,340.22	510.30	21462.28	8765.05	87081.61	40216.7
8	Fisheries	1435.90	89.60	539.74	39231.22	47808.02	1534.43	1428.42	785.22
9	Farm Credit- Others	938.00	42.24	7,874.40	242633.17	1355.96	412.44	3970	1343.76
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	275324.00	62845.60	105744.52	508204.37	153034.93	165137.42	358074.32	118820.33
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	1350520.73	247077.63	549025.14	1113799.53	920533.22	741887.67	2124515.20	1065071.60
11	Construction of storage	1778.40	1656.00	2855.96	7897.46	2084.00	10370.53	24379.55	1248.00
12	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	1540.33	2203.40	670.93	2917.57	2867.08	390.21	1422.88	2968.07
13	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	3894.28	4755.20	923.48	5931.52	524.64	1296	16518.40	482.88
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	7213.01	8614.60	4450.37	16746.55	5475.72	12056.74	42320.83	4698.95
14	Food & Agro Processing	70233.96	17680.00	2718.12	117471.94	2804.64	4611.12	10898.40	1110.60
15	Ancillary activities - Others	34030.40	2427.20	1222.40	60244.52	13017.60	21362.4	9568.00	10676.00
E	Ancilliary Activities Total (14 to 15)	104264.36	20107.20	3940.52	177716.46	15822.24	25973.52	20466.40	11786.60
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	1461998.10	275799.43	557416.03	1308262.54	941831.18	779917.93	2187302.43	1081557.15
G	MSME	809860.00	92800.00	64057.50	305012.00	135111.20	355498.4	1075934.40	201914.00
H	Export Credit	3375.00	1500.00	7500.00	4312.50	3525.00	20025	22200.00	5625.00
I	Education	4132.50	9150.00	5520.00	7259.25	1372.50	16717.5	20295.00	18187.50
J	Housing Loan	13656.00	17440.00	13248.00	10188.00	5750.40	54492	22160.00	32824.00
K	Social Infrastructure	6508.5	5220.00	4274.64	25664.25	8871.75	3079.75	9172.50	23928.00
L	Renewable Energy	5764.50	1012.50	1389.69	2862.90	2012.22	4991.4	11564.10	1657.17
M	Others	79604.10	43644.00	26801.50	187945.90	152080.00	91653.5	60403.00	189240.00
N	Total (H to M)	113040.60	77966.50	58733.83	238232.80	173611.87	190959.15	145794.60	271461.67
O	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	2384898.70	446565.93	680207.36	1851507.34	1250554.25	1326375.48	3409031.43	1554932.82

Sr. No.	Particulars	Tenkasi	Thanjavur	Theni	Thoothukudi	Tiruchirappalli	Tirunelveli	Tirupathur	Tiruppur
		25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	790399.61	1522246.01	885439.96	359197.33	984221.84	941040.37	518163.2	467917.02
1	Water Resources	18870.98	22948.45	29509.63	15063.42	34142.31	24742.7	5004.47	19518.84
2	Farm Mechanisation	27419.09	62341.45	56124.51	21077.05	56940.03	31220.7	12935.99	53074.76
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	37342.65	15860.94	46469.66	2184.23	16506.45	43555.86	6730.82	33543.97
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	580	2113.14	7807.84	13906.19	5913.49	4360.19	4526.96	1358.37
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	26389.3	66474.99	48375.16	51562.74	118503.68	103796.15	17429.46	191135.28
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	23871.2	13694.30	19448.77	73777.07	21132.69	39103.03	2815.33	24163.9
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	10379.3	12927.80	19798.65	42291.01	47785.63	10566.92	4996.6	24753.17
8	Fisheries	1257.6	25202.58	7834.48	81382.47	2150.73	5498.98	79.33	12690.02
9	Farm Credit- Others	6072	11817.60	1883.52	16944.7	38407.6	77122.88	3615.36	18377.8
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	152182.12	233381.25	237252.22	318188.88	341482.61	339967.41	58134.32	378616.11
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	942581.73	1755627.26	1122692.18	677386.21	1325704.45	1281007.78	576297.53	846533.13
11	Construction of storage	16747.90	26927.94	79292.00	87870.09	33988.00	69433.52	8612.00	149983.29
12	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	20233.80	3196.10	522.00	6220.05	1659.73	19194.84	2858.33	6246.46
13	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	3451.20	9550.40	3875.81	19427.65	12168.48	3881.76	3866.24	7864.80
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	40432.90	39674.44	83689.81	113517.79	47816.21	92510.12	15336.57	164094.55
14	Food & Agro Processing	20210.00	24005.08	39018.80	66549.65	104259.69	76582.70	7493.28	113047.27
15	Ancillary activities - Others	3760.00	50065.60	5836.80	129757.60	46517.60	3686.40	4916.00	43993.60
E	Ancillary Activities Total (14 to 15)	23970.00	74070.68	44855.60	196307.25	150777.29	80269.10	12409.28	157040.87
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	1006984.63	1869372.38	1251237.59	987211.25	1524297.95	1453787.00	604043.38	1167668.55
G	MSME	203280.00	420201.00	220687.20	600589.60	644173.20	286476.00	133096.00	2518076.40
H	Export Credit	337.50	7875.00	3000.00	183862.50	13312.50	150.00	2550.00	98475.00
I	Education	2298.80	12652.57	3978.75	53297.28	19594.50	3142.50	2794.50	30720.00
J	Housing Loan	13840.00	27216.00	18580.00	62985.60	278936.00	28304.00	9536.00	95588.80
K	Social Infrastructure	116.25	5698.50	3566.25	11960.50	66843.75	305.25	297.00	255421.63
L	Renewable Energy	162.00	931.95	1177.74	9563.76	14313.86	450.00	2656.80	78807.31
M	Others	24090.00	56052.60	35829.00	91710.08	179914.00	33313.50	38255.40	355741.00
N	Total (H to M)	40844.55	110426.62	66131.74	413379.72	572914.61	65665.25	56089.70	914753.74
O	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	1251109.18	2400000.00	1538056.53	2001180.57	2741385.76	1805928.25	793229.08	4600498.69

Sr. No.	Particulars	Tiruvallur	Tiruvannamalai	Tiruvarur	Vellore	Villupuram	Virudhunagar	TOTAL TN
		33	34	35	36	37	38	TN
A	Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing	1611922.94	1175059.50	331191.71	576750.25	651927.22	750196.25	3,08,67,002.00
1	Water Resources	14001.44	20326.26	15,902.69	6061.00	22621.720	11294.090	7,16,879.74
2	Farm Mechanisation	42100.03	5711.76	11,682.88	13725.86	61558.260	22873.390	12,05,118.23
3	Plantation & Horticulture with Sericulture	14643.80	11753.79	11645.34	3899.96	16932.180	4835.400	7,88,430.56
4	Forestry & Waste Land Development	16148.01	340.58	395.56	171.06	67764.820	1225.480	2,44,461.37
5	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	42732.35	169033.43	34,383.12	125727.70	67996.900	35863.660	26,75,182.46
6	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	27886.31	14942.59	31,415.09	4839.92	106934.890	23301.480	10,98,449.65
7	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat, Piggery	5891.61	6052.69	4,572.41	8765.05	16274.310	22534.850	6,37,602.34
8	Fisheries	24713.07	10193.21	4541.31	1534.43	5718.520	755.540	5,06,674.48
9	Farm Credit- Others	6423.00	2095.8	257001	412.44	2015.000	2077.500	7,77,713.63
B	Sub Total (1 to 10)	194539.62	240450.11	371539.40	165137.42	367816.60	124761.39	86,50,512.46
C	Farm Credit (A+B)	1806462.56	1415509.61	702731.11	741887.67	1019743.82	874957.64	3,95,17,514.46
11	Construction of storage	584.00	41573.23	4069.50	10370.53	31597.67	46128.56	9,91,418.01
12	Land development, Soil conservation, Wasteland development	8201.86	0.69	1080.33	390.21	26440.65	720.43	2,58,934.23
13	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	4609.28	4512.00	1296.00	1296.00	6081.92	4711.36	3,43,885.50
D	Agriculture Infrastructure Total (11 to 13)	13395.14	46085.92	6445.83	12056.74	64120.24	51560.35	15,94,237.74
14	Food & Agro Processing	21241.40	239.60	1632.84	4611.12	22666.92	37036.00	15,46,295.22
15	Ancillary activities - Others	16064.00	806.40	8624.80	21362.40	13728.00	36305.60	8,00,303.72
E	Ancillary Activities Total (14 to 15)	37305.40	1046.00	10257.64	25973.52	36394.92	73341.60	23,46,598.94
F	Agriculture Total (C+D+E)	1857163.10	1462641.53	719434.58	779917.93	1120258.98	999859.59	4,34,58,351.14
G	MSME	609784.00	392620.00	119660.00	355498.40	162344.00	791808.00	3,45,24,509.65
H	Export Credit	4500.00	1275.00	3675.00	20025.00	300.00	7350.00	25,84,762.50
I	Education	139125.00	73871.25	12171.80	16717.50	26910.00	17580.00	20,72,753.57
J	Housing Loan	237840.00	36064.00	28664.00	54492.00	39312.00	25884.00	54,95,106.40
K	Social Infrastructure	3506.25	81634.50	5707.50	3079.75	9530.69	9146.25	13,63,011.12
L	Renewable Energy	2256.75	5332.50	2250.90	4991.40	8043.75	9706.50	3,34,816.08
M	Others	165220.00	83945.00	87900.00	91653.50	152950.00	81265.00	39,29,632.95
N	Total (H to M)	552448.00	282122.25	140369.20	190959.15	237046.44	150931.75	15780082.620
O	Total Priority Sector (F+G+N)	3019395.10	2137383.78	979463.78	1326375.48	1519649.42	1942599.34	93762943.41

ANNEXURE II(A)
Overview of Ground Level Credit Flow - Agency-wise and Sector-wise - for last three years and Target for current FY

Table 1: Crop Loan (Rs. crore)							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	22336.82	99371.59	111268.79	179328.38	213595.13	242707.58	293544.09
RCBs	385.85	8592.52	6614.23	13609.37	18831.23	14555.43	17614.39
SCARDBs	47.62	0	16.66	0	10.05	0	0
RRBs	1270.76	8589.77	8541.32	18630.47	21311.92	22145	26834.66
Others	720.28	0	4645.78	0	2114.89	0	0
Sub total (A)	24761.33	116553.88	131086.78	211568.22	255863.22	279408.01	337993.14

Table 2: Term Loan (MT+LT)							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	12053.8	73602.2	73176.82	112186.69	124100.64	120418.63	149398.03
RCBs	26.81	257.66	1649.29	699.19	2583.77	553.33	1939.1
SCARDBs	39.06	0	76.88	0	46.28	0	0
RRBs	910.73	1012.7	2269.47	1863.3	3151.31	3954.42	4722.93
Others	480.29	0	718.46	0	736.58	0	0
Sub total (B)	13510.69	74872.56	77890.92	114749.18	130618.58	124926.38	156060.06

Table 3: Total Agri. Credit							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	34390.62	172973.79	184445.61	291515.07	337695.77	363126.21	442942.12
RCBs	412.66	8850.18	8263.52	14308.56	21415.00	15108.76	19553.49
SCARDBs	86.68	0.00	93.54	0.00	56.33	0.00	0.00
RRBs	2181.49	9602.47	10810.79	20493.77	24463.23	26099.42	31557.59
Others	1200.57	0.00	5364.24	0.00	2851.47	0.00	0.00
Sub total (C)	38272.02	191426.44	208977.70	326317.40	386481.80	404334.39	494053.20

Table 4: MSME							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	29182.93	128405.7	122810.9	177970.54	259994.49	225636.75	273313.11
RCBs	29.92	8.3	1339.14	19.82	1324.39	48.97	60.54
SCARDBs	3.31	0	15.49	0	13.19	0	0
RRBs	251.76	594.24	1191.88	2318.94	4319.09	1909.1	2326.68
Others	260.79	0	1344.73	0	963.22	1949.22	2388.77
Sub total (D)	29728.71	129008.24	126702.14	180309.30	266614.38	229544.04	278089.10

Table 5: Other Priority Sector							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	12326.79	12663.47	46030.89	17048.14	40593.35	20393.63	24677.58
RCBs	84.62	3147.06	1448.82	8582.16	5561.59	9576.31	11749.07
SCARDBs	3.84	0	69.3	0	37.63	0	0
RRBs	268.92	18.69	1396.54	69	879.21	144.9	175.63
Others	517.84	0	1288.73	0	251.55	0	0
Sub total (E)	13202.01	15829.22	50234.28	25699.30	47323.33	30114.84	36602.28

Table 6: Grand Total (C+D+E)							
Particulars	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25
	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target	Ach.	Target
CBs	75900.34	314042.96	353287.40	486533.75	638283.61	609156.59	740932.81
RCBs	527.20	12005.54	11051.48	22910.54	28300.98	24734.04	31363.10
SCARDBs	93.83	0.00	178.33	0.00	107.15	0.00	0.00
RRBs	2702.17	10215.40	13399.21	22881.71	29661.53	28153.42	34059.90
Others	1979.20	0.00	7997.70	0.00	4066.24	1949.22	2388.77
Grand Total	81202.74	336263.90	385914.12	532326.00	700419.51	663993.27	808744.58

Note : *OPS includes Export Credit, Education, Housing, Social Infrastructure, Renewable Energy

Note : # RCBs include StCBs, DCCBs and PACS (if any)

ANNEXURE II(B)

Sub sector-wise and Agency-wise credit flow under Agriculture and Allied Activities - for last three years and Target for current FY

Table 1 : Crop Loan

Particulars	2021-22						2022-23					
	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total
Crop Loan	99371.59	8592.52	0.00	8589.77	0.00	116553.88	179328.38	13609.37	0.00	18630.47	0.00	211568.22

Table 2 : Term Loan

Particulars	2021-22						2022-23					
	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total
Water Resources, Land Development, Farm Mechanization, Plantation & Horticulture including Sericulture, AH - Dairy Development, AH -Poultry Development, AH - Sheep / Goat / Piggery Devt., Fisheries Development, Forestry & Wasteland Dev., Storage Godown & Marketing Facilities, Agro and Food Processing, Others	73602.20	257.66	0.00	1012.70	0.00	74872.56	112186.69	699.19	0.00	1863.30	0.00	114749.18
Sub total	73602.20	257.66	0.00	1012.70	0.00	73602.20	112186.69	699.19	0.00	0.00	0.00	112186.69
Grand Total (I+II)	172973.79	8850.18	0.00	9602.47	0.00	191426.44	291515.07	14308.56	0.00	20493.77	0.00	326317.40
# RCBs include StCBs, DCCBs and PACS (if any)												

Table 1 : Crop Loan

Particulars	2023-24						2024-25 (Target)					
	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total
Crop Loan	242707.58	14555.43	0.00	22145.00	0.00	279408.01	293544.09	17614.39	0.00	26834.66	0.00	337993.14

Table 2 : Term Loan

Particulars	2023-24						2024-25 (Target)					
	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total	CBs	RCBs	SCARDBs	RRBs	Others	Total
Water Resources, Land Development, Farm Mechanization, Plantation & Horticulture including Sericulture, AH - Dairy Development, AH -Poultry Development, AH - Sheep / Goat / Piggery Devt., Fisheries Development, Forestry & Wasteland Dev., Storage Godown & Marketing Facilities, Agro and Food Processing, Others	120418.63	553.33	0.00	3954.42	0.00	124926.38	149398.03	1939.10	0.00	4722.93	0.00	156060.06
Sub total	120418.63	553.33	0.00	3954.42	0.00	124926.38	149398.03	1939.10	0.00	4722.93	0.00	156060.06
Grand Total (I+II)	363126.21	15108.76	0.00	26099.42	0.00	404334.39	442942.12	19553.49	0.00	31557.59	0.00	494053.20
# RCBs include StCBs, DCCBs and PACS (if any)												

Annexure III

Critical Infrastructure Support to be provided

Sl.No	Description	District
I.	Crop Production	
1	Agri-clinics with custom hiring center may established in all blocks of the district.	All districts
2	Drying yards in all Panchayat Village before selling them at Direct Procurement Centres.	
3	Setting up of State seed farm to meet the quality seed requirements of farmers.	
II.	Water Resources	
1	Rainwater Harvesting structures like Farm Ponds, Check Dams/ Percolation ponds and Ground water recharge structures may be promoted on large scale in critical and over-exploited blocks, considering the rainfall dependency of the district.	All districts
2	In the coastal areas, there is frequent salt water intrusions into the rivers/channels. There is need to install tail end regulators in all the rivers flowing in the district.	Nagapattinam
3	The completion of remaining phase of Kavery- Vaigai- Gundaru river linking project for improving agricultural productivity and livelihood in the district	Pudukkottai
4	De-siltation / Renovation of all 5451 tanks especially 77 PWD tanks. Cleaning and strengthening of water channels to store more water.	
5	Completion of remaining phase of Sadyanery- Thamirabharani river linking project for improving agricultural productivity and livelihood in the district	Thoothukudi
6	Renovation of all Irrigation structures.	Ariyalur, Ramanathapuram
7	Desilting, bunding and removal of bushes from majority of the tanks and feeder channels.	Kanniyakumari
8	Construction of dedicated sewage lines to protect the canal water.	Kanniyakumari, Madurai
9	Modernization of existing canal irrigation system will ensure availability of adequate water to tail end areas. Renovation of tanks will also improve the storage.	Kanniyakumari, Dindigul
10	Piped Irrigation system in Kallikudi, Kallupati , Sedappatti blocks from Vaigai Dam and Periyakulam block from Periyar Main Canal	Madurai
11	Tail-end regions in canal systems, such as those in Alangayam, Kandili, and Natrampalli blocks, face water deficits. Modernization of existing canal irrigation system will ensure availability of adequate water to tail end areas. Renovation of tanks will also improve the storage.	Tirupathur

Sl.No	Description	District
12	Concrete lining of Lower Bhavani Project (LBP) canal and bunds may be given top most priority as more than 50% of the water is lost due to severe seepage (as against the allowable limit of 33%). Besides, breaching of canal also occurs very often. This work would help in giving water till the tail end and also can bring additional area of 20000 ha. under irrigation.	Erode and Tirupur
III.	Farm Mechanization	
1	Establishment of Custom Hiring Centres in all the blocks and setting up of workshop for repairing high value farm machineries.	All districts
2	Usage of drones and IOT based farm automation in the application of agri-inputs through FPOs may be promoted for improving the efficient utilization of natural resources and wider reach of technology among the farmers.	
IV.	Plantation and Horticulture	
1	Scientific onion storage structure in Tiruchuli block is required to reduce post-harvest losses.	Virudhunagar
2	Processing and value addition of horticulture crops such as banana, mango and coconut may be encouraged through establishment of FPOs and setting up of food processing units in the crop-intensive blocks. Scientific storage structures for horticulture crops are also required.	Ranipet
3	Jasmine popularly called ‘Madurai Malli’ is the pride of Madurai with its unique fragrance. Dedicated air cargo services can ensure constant demand and price stability.	Madurai
	Tissue culture unit at Sirumalai to protect Native Virupakshi Banana species.	
4	Setting up of Nurseries for supplying quality seedlings.	All districts
5	a. Government can encourage setting up of small food processing zones for tomato, coconut, banana and drum stick. b. As regards coconut, though value addition is taking place in the form of copra, coir based products, etc., scope exist for setting up of food processing centres to produce desiccated coconut powder, virgin oil, neera and other coconut based products. Also scope exist for value addition in drum stick like setting up of unit to produce drum stick powder. c. Govt. may consider Setting up of a marketing centre for cocoon in Udumalpet, which will go in a long way in reducing the cost of transportation for the farmers (at present, the farmers go to Karnataka to sell cocoons) and improve expansion of sericulture activity in the district.	Tiruppur
6	Post-harvest marketing infrastructures like banana ripening chamber and market infrastructure like banana auction centre are required in the district.	Tirunelveli
7	a. Augmenting the capacity of godowns, cold chain and related infrastructures will help in minimizing post-harvest losses and increase in income for the farmers. b. Processing facilities for fruits and vegetables can be promoted.	Tirupathur
8	Strengthening of existing infrastructure and creation of additional infrastructure required for horticulture farm.	Ariyalur & Perambalur

Sl.No	Description	District
	Setting up of Horticulture Research Station.	
9	The district has 45242 ha. of cultivable wastelands, which are mostly under prosopis. In order to motivate the farmers to go for alternative commercial crops, there is need to create development centre with time bound action plan.	Thoothukudi
V	Forestry	
1	a. Forest reserves in the blocks of Kalakadu, Cheranmadhavi and Ambasamudram may be protected with stringent implementation of legal/administrative measures. b. Tourism may be regulated to protect the forest resources and animal reserves.	Tirunelveli
2	E Auction center for selling Timber should be introduced as already available in Kerala.	Tenkasi
3	Upgrading the infrastructure available at forest research centre and extension centre-cum-nursery.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
VI.	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	
1	Dairy infrastructure, new milk routes, producer organizations, etc. to be promoted in the district.	Vellore
2	Setting up milk cooling centers of 5000LPD capacity in Sawyerpuram, Vilathikulam and Seithunganallur, despite having very good milk production in these areas.	Thoothukudi
3	Development of model fodder farms	Kanniyakumari
4	Set up of 50 additional dispensaries.	Madurai
5	Animal Shelters in disaster prone areas of Muthupet to shelter animals during cyclones and Tsunamis.	Tiruvarur
6	There is no proper place to train the farmers and field level functionaries of Dept. of Animal Husbandry. In the recent years, VUTRC, Burgur Cattle Research Station (BCRS) and Kangeyam cattle research station (KCRS) conducting training programmes for the farmers. These centres lack infrastructure facilities such as proper class room, Audio-Visual aids, furniture, etc. There is an urgent need to strengthen these cattle research stations in the district to train the doctors and farmers.	Erode
7	Setting up of a cattle feed manufacturing plant in the district	Tirunelveli
8	The District Co-operative Milk Producers Union can increase the cold storage, milk processing, milk transportation and bulk milk chilling units since there is a high milk production in the district and creation of infrastructure will result in market linkage and price remuneration.	Dharmapuri
9	a. Renovation/repairing of veterinary dispensaries which are in bad condition. b. Outpatient shed is required to be constructed in certain dispensaries.	Ariyalur

Sl.No	Description	District
	c. A district level animal disease diagnostic lab is essential for disease surveillance and forecasting of animal disease for prevention/immunization.	
10	Setting up of animal husbandry farm/ fodder farm, hatcheries for poultry, milk procurement centres, bulk milk cooler and processing units.	Perambalur, Thoothukudi
VII.	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	
1	Cold storage for storing poultry products and egg exports	Namakkal
VIII.	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat & Piggery	
1	Setting up of market/ shandies for trading goats.	Nagapattinam
2	Cconstruction of at least 4-5 Modern Abattoirs in the district to maintain the hygienic condition of cut animals. The Abattoir should also have other facilities such as cleaning area for cut animals cold room for storing of left out meat toilets for the public tea / coffee parlour parking place for vehicle etc. The retail meat traders should be educated for the use of Modern Abattoir.	Namakkal, Tirunelveli, Kancheepuram, Erode, Thoothukudi, Tirunelveli, Tiruvannamalai
3	Promotion of regulated markets to support fair trade of animal	Ramanathapuram
4	Inadequate availability of pasture lands hinders sheep and goat rearing in the blocks. Quality native breeds like Pallayadu, Chenkanniyadu which yields 2-4 halves and are good for meat are almost extinct in the district.	Tenkasi
IX.	Fisheries	
1	<u>Solar Driers across Coastal Villages for Quality Dry Fish production.</u>	All coastal districts
2	<u>Fish landing centre should renovated in Tharuvaikulam, New Harbour, Vembar, Tiruchendur, Kayalpattinam, Veerapandiyan pattinam</u>	Thoothukudi
3	<u>Solar Lightings in Fishermen villages, Fishermen operate during night times for fish catch. The present lighting arrangement is very weak in Vembar, Keezhvaippar, Sippikulam, Periya samy puram, Pattinamaruthur, Thalamuthunagar, Kombuthurai, Singithurai and Veerapandiypattinam.</u>	
4	<u>Adequate processing centers, cold storages to be set up to avoid transporting the fish produce to other places.</u>	
5	<u>Shore protection measures by converting existing groynes into breakwaters subject to technical feasibility.</u>	Kanniyakumari
6	<u>Create additional infrastructure/facilities in the harbours, modernization of harbours, upgradation of fis8h landing points into fish landing centres with facilities such as auction centre, net mending hall and drying yards.</u>	

Sl.No	Description	District
7	<u>Integrated Ornamental Fish Market cum auction Center</u>	Madurai
8	<u>Dredging Koraiyaru and Valavanar river and removing the sea sledge</u>	Tiruvarur
9	<u>Creating additional infrastructure/ facilities in the harbours, modernization of harbours, upgradation of fish landing points into fish landing centres.</u>	Nagapattinam
10	<u>The district, has no freezing plant/ice plant/cold storages for fishery development. Desilting of tanks at regular intervals for taking up inland fisheries activities. Strengthening embankment of the lakes/tanks, provision of shutters in the canals would also pave way for more intensive inland fisheries activities. Government may strengthen the infrastructure in the fish seed farms including setting up of a freezing plant/cold storages</u>	Erode
11	<u>Tanks in the district need desiltation at regular intervals for undertaking inland fishery activities & strengthening embankment of tanks/lakes, replacement of shutters, regulators, etc., in the river canal would pave way for more intensive inland fishery activity.</u>	Tenkasi
12	<u>Aquarium to be setup near Courtallam</u>	
13	<u>Setting up of hatcheries for supply of fingerlings.</u>	All districts
X.	Construction of Storage and Marketing Infrastructure	
1	One drying yard per panchayat village may be developed by allotting required land by the district administration.	All districts
2	Renovation of cold storage in Pudur, Vilathikulam. It may helpful for chilli farmers in the district.	Tiruvarur
3	Warehouse/Rural Godown under hub and spoke model in Alwarthirunagari, Srivaikuntam and karungulam blocks	Thoothukudi
	Construction of Onion Cold storage facility in Tirumangalam	
4	Storage facilities for different kinds of agricultural products have to be created in the production areas or nearby places particularly in the rural areas so that the farmers can transport their produce to these places immediately after harvest in the shortest possible time	Sivagangai
5	Rural shandies/ markets should be established in all locations where weekly or daily shandies are held. Panchayats especially in the backward areas of Anchetty, Thally, Veppanapalli, Mathur, etc. may come forward with such proposals.	Krishnagiri
6	There is a need for creating adequate storage and marketing infrastructure to increase the holding capacity of farmers and enabling them to get remunerative prices for their produce.	Tenkasi
7	a. Establishment of more Primary Processing Centers (PPCs) will prove to be a boost amongst farmers	Dharmapuri, Tirupathur
	b. Promotion and strengthening of producers' groups to set up godowns / cold storages / primary processing facilities.	
8	a. Construction of godowns and upgradation of infrastructure of marketing committees.	Ariyalur & Perambalur

Sl.No	Description	District
	b. Creation of village level primary processing centres.	
XI.	Land Development, Soil Conservation and Watershed Development	
1	Irrigation potential can be created by bringing watershed projects in these blocks. The district suffers from poor soil conditions in "Theri Lands" at Radhapuram block in certain pockets due to the nearness of coast. Soil reclamation measures have to be taken up in coastal blocks of Nanguneri and Radhapuram to bring "Theri Lands" under cultivation.	Tirunelveli
2	Vast area in the district remain fallow especially in the blocks of Melaneelithanallur, Sankarankovil, Vasudevanallur, Kuruvikulam. Most of these lands are used for setting up of wind mills.	Tenkasi
3	Construction of farm ponds in farmers' fields.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
XII.	Agri Infrastructure - Others	
1	Development of Palmyra Cluster and Chill Cluster unit	
2	Establishment of Regulated Markets (RMs). To avoid exploitation of farmers by the middlemen, the government may establish RMs in uncovered blocks. Each RMs may have 2000 MT capacity Godown and a drying yard and approximate cost of construction would be around ₹50 lakh each. This project could be covered under RIDF.	Thoothukudi
3	Seed Processing Unit (SPUs) for Paddy and Millets . Timely availability of quality seeds is a constraint felt by the farming community. Therefore, establishment of Seed Processing Units (SPUs) for paddy, millets and pulses at strategic locations is very much needed.	
4	Setting up Drying yard at Vallam and Mailam blocks	Villuppuram
5	Activity based clusters with common facility centre for primary processing facility may be promoted among SHGs/JLGs/FIGs/FPOs in the district.	Sivaganga
6	Rural shandies/ markets infrastructure should be established in all locations where weekly or daily shandies are held. Panchayats especially in the backward areas of Anchetty, Thally, Veppanapalli, Mathur, etc.	Krishnagiri
7	Setting up of bio fertilisers production units and Seed processing units.	Nagapattinam
8	Effective technologies replacing the chemical inputs are being evolved on a continuous basis. It is therefore essential that encouragement to bio-inputs production centres need to be given in respect of bio-inputs whose efficacy have been proved	Tenkasi
XIII.	Food and Agro Processing	
1	Setting up Cashew Processing Centers	Cuddalore
2	Establishment of cashew Processing Center in Pachamalai Hills	Tiruchirapalli

Sl.No	Description	District
3	Establishing dedicated Turmeric Export Centers can streamline the logistics of handling and exporting turmeric. This should include facilities for sorting, grading, and packaging to meet international standards	Erode
4	Setting up of food processing centre in Madathukulam to improve the processing capacity in tomato, coconut and onion	Tiruppur
5	Setting up of Food Park/Agro Processing Cluster for Cashew	Ariyalur
6	Setting up of Tapiaco Processing unit (Sagosome) will help the farmers saving transportation cost as currently they depend upon the Sagosome unit in Salem.	Kallakurichi
7	Setting up Bulk Milk cooling/Chilling units in Kalvarayan Hills will help the farmers	
8	Setting up of Mango Processing Unit	Thiruvallur
9	Establishment of Processing centre for Egg powder, Cold storage and testing lab for egg exports	Namakkal
10	Mango Pulp units in the district require a Common facility centre with facility for tetra packing or plastic bottle packing. Such a common facility will benefit small traders.	Krishnagiri
11	As the region is a major producer of paddy, there is significant potential for establishing rice processing units to meet the growing demand for high-quality rice. Additionally, there is considerable scope for setting up rice bran oil extraction units, cattle feed units utilizing bran cakes, and facilities for producing husk-based products.	Thanjavur
12	Banana Ripening Chambers at Sawyerpuram, Srivaikuntam and Alwarthirunagari -The Tamirabarani Basin of Thoothukudi District covering three blocks viz., Alwarthirunagari, Srivaikuntam and Karungulam is having banana cultivation of 10000 ha. The existing facilities are far lower than the requirement. Facilities, for enhancing value addition. 200 ton capacity of Banana Ripening Chamber could be constructed with a cost of ₹60 lakh.	Thoothukudi
13	Tissue culture Propagation Unit at Srivaikuntam.	
14	Value Addition Units for Maize/Pulses at Thoothukudi, Kovilpatti and Vilathikulam	Kanniyakumari
15	Processing facilities for Banana, Jackfruit and Pine apple.	
16	Establish Common Facility centres (CFC) for groundnut processing at multiple places in the district to enable accessibility to high end processing infrastructure to all farmers in the district.	Tiruvannamalai
17	a. Setting up of Primary Processing units at Village/Cluster levels. b. Setting up of Agro Processing Clusters/Food Parks to promote food processing industries related to rice, pulses, groundnut, sesame, coconut, mango, cotton and fisheries.	Nagapattinam
18	Lime Producers are unorganized which is affecting the supply chain management and not attracting any investment and technology into this sector. Raw material required to be aggregated, contract farming to be encouraged and common facility centers like grading, packing should be encouraged.	Tenkasi

Sl.No	Description	District
XIV.	MSME	
1	DIC should initiate new intervention for developing Chilli Cluster and Palmyra Cluster	Thoothukudi
2	Establishment of common facility centre for handloom weavers. Establishment of a model textile park for power loom sarees and yarn bank.	Salem
3	District level marketing centers may be set up to provide marketing infrastructure for rural non-farm sector products.	Kanniyakumari
4	Setting up Common Facility Centers (CFCs) for sericulture clusters for reeling, spinning and shared equipment.	Dharmapuri
5	Safe disposal of effluents arising from dyeing, bleaching units, tanneries, etc. is the need of the hour. The Government may think of establishing higher capacity Common Effluent Treatment Plants either on its own or under PPP mode in Chennimalai, Perundurai SIPCOT, Bhavani and Erode.	Erode
XV.	Export Credit	
1	Establishment of Export promotion centre for Agri & MSME products	Thoothukudi, Tiruchirappalli
2	Establishing state of the art grading, sorting and packing unit in Gobichettipalayam to promote agriculture produce exports from the district	Erode
XVI.	Social Infrastructure	
	a. Provision of smart education facilities through long-range wifi connection in all unconnected tribal hamlets in Burgur, Kadambur, Thalavadi hills of Erode district.	Erode
1	b. Establishing rope way based connectivity infrastructure to improve the connectivity of remote tribal hamlets in Burgur, Kadambur and Thalavadi hills of the district,	
	c. Promotion of Eco-tourism may be explored by upgrading the potential tourist spots in the district such as Jawadu Hillsi, Satanur Dam etc., with provisions for livelihood support for the local community on user-fee basis will create a sustainable livelihood opportunity and steady income.	
	d. Construction of Rural Haats in Nasiyanur, Kavindapadi and Thalavadi in order to facilitate the public with standard marketing platform with basic amenities such as toilets, drinking water and waste collection arrangements.	
2	The number of hospitals, sub centres, primary and community health centres are required to be increased at block/village levels.	Dharmapuri
3	Road to Kesampatti to vellimalaipatti, Melur block Madurai- 5 kms	Madurai
	Solar Power generation units in tribal villages of Theni district	
XVII.	Informal Credit	
1	Establishment of common facility centres with marketing outlets in each blocks for the SHGs/ JLGs livelihood	Erode, Tirupur

Annexure IV

Critical Interventions required in Various Sectors/Sub Sectors

Sl. No.	Description	District
I.	Crop Production	
1.	There is a growing market for organic produce, and the district can benefit from promoting organic farming. Provide specific credit lines with subsidies for organic farming methods, soil fertility management, and natural pesticide usage. Financial support for certification and market linkages for organic products will also benefit the farmers.	All districts
2.	New technologies such as SRI in paddy, precision farming, integrated farming and ecofriendly organic farming need to be promoted with intensive extension works.	Virudhunagar, Tiruchirappalli, Karur, Nagapattinam
3.	Banks have to make efforts for covering all the farmers under KCC scheme as desired by Govt. of India. While extending the credit under KCC, banks have to follow RBI guidelines of extending 10% for household consumption & post-harvest expenses, 20% for maintenance/repair of farm assets and also insurance cost in addition to the Scale of Finance.	All Districts
4.	Awareness on Electronic National Agricultural Market (e-NAM) has to be created for getting better price for their produce. E-Kisan upaj nidhi has been added onto Jan samarth portal.	All Districts
5.	Develop loan products that cater to the diverse needs of different types of farmers (e.g., dairy, horticulture). Introduce repayment schedules aligned with the crop cycle to ease financial pressure during off-seasons.	All Districts
6.	Training in integrated pest management, Integrated disease management and integrated crop management techniques may be imparted to farmers on cluster basis, especially among those cultivating paddy, cotton, groundnut and pulses.	All Districts
7.	Banks may finance tenant farmers and share croppers by formation of JLGs. Banks may also facilitate and encourage different models of collective farming by farmers through Farmers Interest Groups (FIG), Joint Liability Groups, Farmers Producer Organisations, etc.	All Districts
8.	Efforts to bring fallow lands under cultivation through soil and water conservation measures/watershed development, etc. may be taken.	All Districts
9.	The income of paddy farmers could increase by 20-30% by encouraging them to adopt weather-based cropping patterns instead of relying solely on canal or river water for paddy cultivation.	All districts
10.	Encouraging farmers in producing seeds locally so as to ensure supply of quality seeds on time.	All districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
11.	A few FPOs, which have been sanctioned by NABARD/SFAC have started input supply shops and also engaged in procurement and sale of commodities. Support in terms of market linkage and working capital for those engaged in commodity procurement and sale is required.	All districts
12.	Farmers sell their produce immediately after harvest at a distressed rate as they need money immediately. This can be avoided by promoting storage of crops in godown and availing Negotiable Warehouse Receipt (NWR) loan.	All districts
13.	The major concern is availability of quality seeds, germplasm and low SRR (Seed Replacement Ratio). Establishment of few quality Seed Processing Units (SPUs) for Paddy is very much needed. Farmer Groups may also be encouraged to form seed production units	All districts
14.	Digitisation of land records to be hastened with provision for recording lease/tenancy and linking Aadhar to the records will help in better credit flow to the farmers, settlement of insurance claims and also help lessees to invest in agriculture.	All districts
15.	Coverage of non-loanee farmers and financing tenant farmers through JLG mode are important steps considered for increasing crop loan portfolio in the district.	All Districts
16.	Technologies such as AI, drone, IOT, that will reduce the input cost and increase/sustain the production, optimise soil nutrients, do quick diseases diagnosis etc. are to be popularised among the farmers.	All Districts
17.	Develop loan products specifically designed for the diverse agricultural activities in Nilgiris, including tea, coffee, and horticulture	The Nilgiris
18.	There is a serious threat on conversion of agricultural land for real estate purposes in districts closer to Chennai. Department officials to step up efforts to increase the area under cultivation through various schemes and incentives for farmers	Chennai, Tiruvallur and Chengalpattu
II.	Water Resources	
1.	Emphasis on water resilient crops like early- maturing cereal crop varieties, heat tolerant varieties, drought- tolerant legumes instead of common crops (paddy)	Sivagangai , Dharmapuri
2.	Credit flow towards drip, sprinkler irrigation, farm ponds and other rainwater harvesting infrastructure may be increased.	All Districts
3.	Specific focus on micro irrigation systems like sprinkler irrigation for field crops, drip irrigation for horticulture crops for improved water usage efficiency and also increase in production. Mulching and root zone irrigation technique should be promoted to save water.	All Districts
4.	Popularise use of IOT, AI for optimal utilisation of water resources	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
5.	Investment in rainwater harvesting and groundwater recharge structures is recommended especially in critical and over-exploited blocks.	All Districts
6.	Farmers should be encouraged to cultivate climate resilient crops for better utilization of water.	Tiruvarur
7.	a. Rainwater Harvesting structures like Farm Ponds, Check Dams/Percolation ponds, dug wells etc. may be promoted on large scale in all blocks with focus on critical and over-exploited blocks, considering the rainfall dependency of the district.	All Districts
	b. Paddy farmers may consider switching over to pulses and millets in drought periods.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
	c. Kudimaramathu' works in downstream areas of Kaveri River need to be taken up in advance instead of waiting for release of water from Mettur dam. These works may also be taken up through Water user associations.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
	d. There is large scope for expanding the installation of solar pumpset scheme in the years to come targeting especially farmers who do not have electricity connection and who run their motors with diesel energy. With the expansion of solar pumpset scheme to agri allied activities, the scheme will certainly get a boost.	All Districts
8.	a. Low cost sub surface Dykes may be tried in all the rivers flowing across the district to recharge the depleted ground water.	Tiruvarur
	b. Entire length of the channels of Cauvery River System are to be strengthened, renovated/reconstructed by concrete lining. Further, all cross masonries like Regulators, Sluices, Drainage Siphons and many Cross Bridges in the entire stretch of the Cauvery River System, which are in the most dilapidated condition, need to be renovated/repared/reconstructed for improving irrigation facilities till the tail end area of Tiruvarur district.	Tiruvarur, Tiruchirappalli, Karur
	c. Efforts may be taken for revival of ponds, tanks, clearance of inflow channels and other recharge structures.	Tiruvarur
9.	In Erode District, the quality of Ground Water generally ranges from moderate to good quality both in the shallow dug well and bore wells. The pricing policy for groundwater users is an important strategy in controlling the illegal extraction of groundwater by taking from lorries,etc. Unused dug wells and bore wells can be used as artificial recharge structures will be good concept in recharging the ground water in the over-exploited firkas.	Erode
10.	Promote contour farming and other soil conservation practices to reduce erosion and increase groundwater recharge	The Nilgiris
III.	Farm Mechanisation	
1.	Post-harvest equipment such as dryers, cleaners, graders, separators etc., may be popularized among the farmers by Agri. Engg. Department to get enhanced returns from selling quality produce.	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
2.	Though tractors and tillers are available on hire, during the peak season there is shortage of machinery. Further, other agricultural implements like improved ploughing equipment, bund-formers, seed drill (tractor/bullock drawn), threshing & cleaning equipment needs to be popularized.	Sivagangai
3.	Promote compact and multi-functional farm equipment suitable for fragmented and small landholdings. Encourage development and dissemination of low-cost, modular machinery for small and marginal farmers.	All Districts
4.	Awareness creation about the schemes of Agri. Engineering Department is very much needed to take the benefits to farmers for improving mechanisation in the district.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
5.	Capacity building of unemployed youth on repair & maintenance of farm machineries and supporting them in setting up of workshops. RSETIs and other training institute to focus on skill development of youth for repair of agri-machinery and equipment.	Tiruvarur, Nagapattinam, Ariyalur & Perambalur
6.	Establishment of more number of custom hiring centres with atleast one per block through PACCS/ FIGs/ FPOs wherein the entire set of machineries are available for hiring by farmers.	All Districts
7.	Advancements in agricultural machinery, including the integration of GPS and IoT technologies, are enhancing the efficiency of farming operations. These innovations are critical for precision farming and can significantly reduce labor dependency while increasing productivity	All districts
8.	Demonstrations on utility of latest machineries & equipments suitable for the cropping systems followed in the district to create awareness among farmers.	All districts
9.	Demonstration, Training and Distribution of post-harvest Technology and Management (PHTM) to popularize the technology for primary processing, value addition, low cost scientific storage/transport and the crop by-product management through demonstrations, capacity building of farmers and end users.	All districts
10.	Cooperative societies must be encouraged to provide access to a range of machinery suitable for different crops and farming practices in the Nilgiris, such as small tractors, tillers, and harvesting machines.	The Nilgiris
IV.	Plantation and Horticulture	
1.	To enhance credit linked development of potential long gestation horticulture crops and investments, project based approach, contract farming with user industries, cluster approach etc., are required to be adopted	Virudhunagar
2.	Tissue culture of local varieties of Horticulture crops can improve production and productivity	Namakkal
3.	All stakeholders need to advocate farmers to shift from pulp varieties to table varieties of mango to increase their income with the facility available	Krishnagiri
4.	a. Promotion of dryland horticulture crops mainly drumstick, amla, guava, custard apple, ber, pomegranate etc. by Horticulture Dept. in the district will help the farmers in getting good income	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
	b. Region specific scientific and ideal multi-tier or intercropping systems for horticulture crops to be standardized and adopted	
	c. Development of farm clusters for achieving economies of scale. State Govt. should encourage cooperative marketing through provision of suitable incentives for the same	
	d. Promotion of beekeeping with major focus on increasing pollination and crop production and honey as byproduct for getting additional income to the farmer.	
5.	In crops like Banana, Guava and medicinal and aromatic plants, there is lack of awareness on commercialisation and needs to be addressed. No collection centers or regulated markets are located in Tiruvarur district.	Tiruvarur
6.	Offer training workshops on best agricultural practices, pest management, and sustainable farming techniques. Promote agroforestry and permaculture principles to enhance biodiversity and resilience.	Coimbatore
7.	To meet the growing demand for high-quality planting materials, there is a need to increase the number of Horticulture farms and nurseries. Establishing additional nurseries and strengthening existing private ones will ensure a steady supply of improved planting material for horticultural and sericulture crops.	All Districts
8.	a. Promotion of Bee Keeping, Mushroom & Sericulture as an alternate livelihood activity for rural women. b. Unemployed youth may be encouraged to set up private nurseries, as there is a growing demand for good quality planting materials. c. Introduction of alternative horticultural crops such as lime, guava, papaya, drumstick and amla which are suitable for the district.	All districts
9.	The Horticulture department may set up permanent pandal vegetable system to reduce the crop damage and increase the vegetable yield.	All Districts
10.	Steps may be taken to motivate the small farmers in rainfed areas to perennial horticulture crops with suitable cropping system for ensuring sustainable agriculture in the dry lands of the district.	
11.	a. State horticultural farm should be strengthened with sufficient infrastructure and also financial capital so as to meet the planting materials requirement of the district. b. Unemployed youth may be encouraged to set up private nurseries, as there is a growing demand for good quality planting materials. c. There is a need for popularizing scientific practices for all horticulture crops cultivated and demonstration of multi-tier or inter cropping systems suitable for them. d. Promotion of Bee Keeping, Mushroom & Sericulture as an alternate livelihood activity for rural women.	All Districts
12.	Encourage farmers to cultivate hybrid varieties in Chilli which have higher productivity and also ready market.	Ramanathapuram

Sl. No.	Description	District
13.	Coconut cultivation The district is covered with large coconut plantations and intervention may be adopted. Innovations in Coconut Processing	Kanyakumari
14.	The State Government has invested heavily in Pochampalli unit of the Supply Chain Management Project with facility for VHT, IQF & irradiation treatments required for export of table varieties like Alphonso, Imampasand, etc. All stakeholders need to advocate to farmers to shift from pulp varieties to table varieties of mango to increase their income with the facility available	Krishnagiri
15.	Promoting Farmer Producer Organisations will help in aggregation of farmers to achieve remunerative prices for their produce through market linkage and value addition.	All Disripts
16.	Producers may be sensitized of the post-harvest technology in horticultural crops	All Disripts
17.	The district is a major vegetable growing district for lady's finger. Area under cultivation of lady's finger may be expanded in the district as the farmers could get a considerable share of the market in the State for this crop.	Ranipet
18.	High Density Plantation Technology for Guava, Jamun, Mango sapotta to be demonstrated and populised among farmers which will increase productivity, ensure enhanced income with less available land.	Theni
19.	Promotion of beekeeping with major focus on increasing pollination and crop production and honey as by-product may be focussed in Jawadu hills.	Tiruvannamalai
20.	Coconut cluster may be developed incorporating Muthupettai, Thiruthuraipoondi, Kottur, Mannargudi and Needamangalam.	Tiruvarur
21.	Expanding area under Elavambadi Spiny Brinjal cultivation and promotion of marketing of the same, will fetch premium price to farmers as the crop has GI tagging.	Vellore
22.	To enhance credit linked development of potential long gestation horticulture crops and investments, project based approach, contract farming with user industries, cluster approach etc., are required to be adopted	All Districts
V.	Forestry & Wasteland Development	
1.	The available wasteland in the district could be used for dry land horticulture development and for fuel, timber, silvipasture and fodder tree crops.	Virudhunagar and Erode
2.	Promotion on Non-Timber Forest Produce and medicinal plant cultivation for enhancing the livelihoods of forest dependent people, especially the tribal population of the district.	All Districts
3.	a. Sustainable livelihood programmes: Reduce dependency on forest resources by providing alternative income opportunities. Commercially important tree species like Casuarina, Subabul, Bamboo, Teak and Clonal Eucalyptus plantations may be promoted on a large scale under agroforestry by Forest department. Promote eco-tourism,	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
	sustainable harvesting of NTFPs, and skills development for green livelihoods (e.g., organic farming, bamboo crafts).	
	b. Social forestry to be promoted in rainfed areas.	
4.	Paper industries like Tamil Nadu News Print and Papers Ltd., Seshasayee Paper Boards may come forward to raise industrial pulpwood plantation in private lands through buy back arrangement with farmers/entrepreneurs.	Erode
5.	Forestry extension centre should play a proactive role in propagating importance of tree planting, trees suitable for local conditions, establishing demo plots of plantations and also ensure availability of good quality seedlings.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
6.	Village Forest Committees may be formed for promoting Joint Forest Management. Live Fencing of farm lands may be taken up with forest species.	Tiruvannamalai
7.	Promote the planting of indigenous tree species to restore natural ecosystems and enhance biodiversity. Encourage the integration of trees with agricultural practices to improve soil health, enhance productivity, and provide additional income sources	All Districts
8.	Forestry extension centre should play a proactive role in propagating importance of tree planting, trees suitable for local conditions, establishing demo plots of plantations and ensure availability of good quality seedlings.	All Districts
9.	Availability of good quality planting material needs to be ensured by the Forest Department.	Dindigul
10.	Banks may finance commercially viable tree species viz. neem, casuarina, teak, pongamia, forest nursery, subabul, etc.	Madurai
VI.	Animal Husbandry - Dairy	
1.	Banks may go in for tie-up arrangements with milk societies (government / private) for assured repayments, try cluster financing approach, market tie-up for better recovery of loans & encourage setting up of mini dairy units with fodder cultivation including hydroponics as an integral part of the scheme by individuals and/or SHGs/ FPOs.	All Districts
2.	Availability of green fodder is the major concern during the summer season. Silage should be promoted among farmers to overcome this.	All Districts
3.	Establishment of new milk routes and introduction of new Bulk Milk Coolers at strategic points are needed for enabling more milk procurement by Aavin.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
4.	There is a need for taking up fodder cultivation in wastelands/marginal lands and setting up of fodder banks. It is desirable to integrate fodder cultivation with financing of milch animals, wherever feasible.	All Districts
5.	There is a need to restore grazing lands in the district and raise fodder plants with labour from MGNREGS. In addition, farmers should be encouraged to go for "TANUVAS 10 cent fodder cultivation model" in their backyard/in	Nagapattinam, Ariyalur & Perambalur

Sl. No.	Description	District
	part of their agricultural land. To enable the landless families and poor farmers to take up animal husbandry activities, community feed and fodder banks with the help of Self-Help Groups may be established.	
6.	Department may consider training unemployed youth and make them as Community Animal Health Volunteers who can take care of emergency care and also first aid.	Nagapattinam
7.	Preservation of native breeds and bulls to be prioritized by the Government.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
8.	Animal Husbandry Department may consider Cattle Development Project (for cattle breeding), strengthening breeding infrastructure (AI centers, training for farmers) to provide gainful employment to the rural poor.	All Districts
9.	Area Based Scheme in convergence with DCCB, RRB, CBs support, KCC interest subvention, NRLM and Skill development programmes,	All Districts
10.	As dairy sector has good potential for development in the district, Veterinary dispensaries may be established in uncovered villages in order to improve animal health and reduce incidence of diseases. Mobile veterinary units may be created to improve access to remote areas and vaccinations to be promoted in dairy animals to prevent disease outbreak.	All Districts
11.	Balanced ration techniques and mineral mixtures should be popularised among farmers to improve milk quality and animal health	All Districts
12.	Climate smart dairying and creation of community based fodder development project to meet the feed requirement increasing livestock population in the district	All Districts
13.	Conduct training programs for farmers on best practices in dairy farming, including milking techniques, sanitation, herd management, processing milk into value-added products like cheese, yogurt and butter etc.	All Districts
14.	Cultivation of perennial high yielding fodder grass varieties like Cumbu-Napier Co3 Co4 Kolukkattai grass Para grass and Guinea grass etc. are to be encouraged. Propagate and popularise technology of converting crop residues into urea enriched fodder (silage making).	All Districts
15.	Farmers may be educated about Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF) which comes with Interest Subvention and Credit Guarantee to promote investment by private players and MSMEs in dairy, meat processing and animal feed plants.	All Districts
16.	Formation and strengthening of dairy cooperatives and Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs), Enhancing digital marketing platforms for dairy products. Promotion of climate-resilient dairy practices to adapt to environmental changes.	All Districts
17.	Genetic improvement programs and breed enhancement initiatives	Salem
18.	Establish cold storage facilities such as bulk milk cooler and processing units to ensure milk and dairy products remain fresh and safe for consumption. The District Co-operative Milk Producers Union can increase the cold storage, milk processing, milk transportation and bulk milk chilling units since there is a high milk production in	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
	the district and creation of infrastructure will result in market linkage and price remuneration. Financial assistance can be availed for the creation of dairy infrastructure through NABARD under RIDF and AHIDF.	
19.	Livestock insurance is generally not taken by the farmers when they do not avail bank loan for procuring dairy animals. With incidences of FMD and other diseases, they risk loss of animals. Such farmers need to be made aware of the importance of insurance and instead of annual insurance, the premium may be paid for a longer period of three years.	All Districts
20.	Setting up of a cattle feed manufacturing plant in the district	All districts
21.	Under ODOP scheme, promotion of dairy products has been envisaged in Vellore district. Dairy infrastructure, new milk routes, producer organizations, etc. may be promoted with available Govt. schemes and bank finance. Export hubs may also be promoted.	Vellore
VII.	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	
1.	The poultry industry has been demanding a full- fledged packaging centre and cold storage to improve egg exports.	Namakkal
2.	Banks may encourage contract farming for broiler activity and may finance units for capital investments like sheds and equipment after ascertaining the credibility and capability of the service providers.	All Districts
3.	Government may create adequate awareness among the farmers / poultry growers on the various schemes implemented by them with or without GoI support. Small poultry feed units operated by producer groups / small farmers group may be encouraged with suitable incentive / support.	Tiruvarur
4.	Maize, which is a major constituent accounting for 40% to 50% of the poultry feed, may be promoted among farmers and SHGs.	All Districts
5.	Hatchery units may be promoted in the district for production & supply of chicks of low-input technology variety birds.	All Districts
	Rearing of animals & birds in Integrated Farming System will enable the farmer to go for organic farming and use all the resources in the field itself to reduce the expenses and get better price for organic produce.	
6.	Establishment of poultry waste management systems (e.g., biogas from litter) to ensure sustainable farming practices in the rural areas.	All Districts
7.	Establish small-scale poultry feed mills using locally available raw materials like maize, rice bran, and soya meal to address the gap in feed supply	All Districts
8.	Best management practices (BMPs) should be in place and utilized in several different areas to help reduce ammonia emissions. Major sources of ammonia emissions from poultry production include the poultry house itself litter storage facilities and fields where litter is applied. Owing to poultry litter there has been complaints from the neighboring villagers of massive proliferation of flies. Methods of fly control and better utilisation of poultry waste	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
	has to be inculcated amongst the farmers. Most poultry litter is spread on grassland surface that has raised serious run-off and water quality concerns in many areas.	
9.	Implement selective breeding programs to enhance growth rates, egg production, and disease resistance. Ensure farmers have access to high-quality day-old chicks from reputable hatcheries.	All Districts
10.	Promote the construction of proper housing to protect birds from weather extremes and improve welfare.	All Districts
11.	The department may create awareness among farmers to go for hatcheries business as the chicks are being purchased from Namakkal and Karur.	All Districts
12.	The poultry industry has been demanding a full- fledged packaging centre and cold storage to improve egg exports.	Namakkal
13.	Promotion of backyard (desi bird) poultry through financing to SHGs & JLGs by bankers.	All Districts
14.	Promotion of Khadaknath breed – for its sturdy nature, disease resistance & better demand.	All Districts
VIII.	Animal Husbandry - Sheep, Goat and Piggery	
1.	The traditional activity has very good potential in the district. Banks may, subject to usual norms, liberalize the flow of credit to this sector in close coordination with the implementing agencies / department. Financing through SHGs/JLGs may be encouraged.	Virudhunagar, Tiruchirappalli, Karur
2.	Rearing of animals in Integrated Farming System (even in 2 ac of land) will enable the farmer to go for organic farming and use all the resources in the field to reduce the expenses and get better price for organic produce.	Sivagangai, Ariyalur & Perambalur
3.	Promotion of regulated markets in each district for ensuring fair trade of animals.	
4.	There is currently no cold storage facility for storage of meats. Atleast one cold storage per block for meat with 10 tonnes capacity requires to be set up.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
5.	District Livestock Farms to produce and maintain quality rams and ewes for selling them to local farmers to improve progeny and breeding. Department may arrange to provide quality breeds for increasing the meat production.	Tiruvarur, Tirunelveli
6.	Market linkages for meat products, including mutton, remain weak, with farmers facing challenges in accessing larger markets and securing fair prices. This issue is exacerbated by the lack of organized meat processing units, further highlighting the need for improved infrastructure to support the district's livestock sector fully.	All Districts
7.	Educate farmers on formulating balanced diets tailored to the specific needs of sheep, goats, and pigs to optimize growth and production. Promote the use of locally sourced feed and forage to reduce costs and improve sustainability. Establish feed mixing units at the block level.	All Districts
8.	Rearing of animals & birds in Integrated Farming System will enable the farmer to go for organic farming and use all the resources in the field itself to reduce the expenses and get better price for organic produce.	All Districts
9.	Setting up meat processing units for sheep, goat, and pig meat, including facilities for cutting, packaging, and cold storage.	Tiruvannamalai

Sl. No.	Description	District
10.	Promote KCC AH especially piggeries sector in Jawadu hills block.	Tiruvannamalai
11.	Promotion of regulated markets in for ensuring fair trade of animals.	All Districts
12.	Financing for Green fodder cultivation may be encouraged for ensuring better income to farmers taking up stall fed goat rearing.	All Districts
13.	District Livestock Farms to produce and maintain quality rams and ewes for selling them to local farmers to improve progeny and breeding. Department may arrange to provide quality breeds like kanniyadu Kodiayadu and Pallayadu of goats and Vembar and Kilakarisal of sheep for increasing the meat production. Technical support for rearing or breeding farms on commercial basis to be given by line department and Veterinary research institutions.	Thoothukudi
14.	Sheep farm in Mukundarayapuram provides quality animals of Madras Red breed to farmers. The activities of the sheep farm may be strengthened to reach more farmers and promote sheep rearing as a viable activity in the district.	Ranipet
IX.	Fisheries	
1.	Awareness camps and training on fresh water fish farming & ornamental fish breeding may be arranged by the fisheries department.	All Districts
	Banks may consider extending credit facilities for promoting culture and export of high demand species of ornamental aquarium fishes which needs limited water requirement.	
	b. The total volume of fish landing at Puthur Market is 17-18 tonnes. A cold storage unit of 20 tonne capacity is required in the district.	Karur
2.	Improvement of facilities at landing centres viz. auction centre etc. for getting better price.	Tiruvarur
	Provision of cold chain facilities for inland and marine fisheries to reach the urban markets.	
3.	SHGs/SHG Federations/FIGs/FCs may be encouraged to attempt fish culture in Panchayat tanks.	All Districts
4.	Exclusive Fish farmers Producer Company may be promoted in the District, keeping in view of inland fisheries potential identified and to support the fisheries sector to engage in value addition and direct marketing activities.	Erode , Tirupur
5.	Tanks in the district need desiltation at regular intervals for taking up inland fisheries activities.	Kancheepuram, Ariyalur and Perambalur
6.	Promotion of Sea weed culture and processing	All coastal districts
7.	Fishery FPOs need to be strengthened in the district.	
8.	Dry fish production in scientific way can be promoted in the district. Keeping in view the catch available in the district, FPO in fisheries sector can be promoted.	All coastal districts of Tamil Nadu

Sl. No.	Description	District
9.	Promotion and strengthening of producers' cooperative societies is required in the sector with special emphasis on marketing / value addition especially in Bhavanisagar and Anthiyur blocks. Curently the district does not have any fish based FPO.	Erode
10.	Exclusive Fish farmers Producer Company may be promoted in the District, keeping in view of inland fisheries potential identified and to support the fisheries sector to engage in value addition and direct marketing activities	Tiruppur
11.	Strengthening embankment of the lakes/tanks and provision of shutters in the canals would also pave way for more intensive inland fisheries activities.	Tiruvannamalai
12.	Educate fish farmers on sustainable aquaculture methods, including pond management, species selection, and feeding practices. Promote integrated aquaculture with crops and livestock to optimize resource use and increase overall farm productivity	All Districts
13.	Cold storage facilities are insufficient in the district to cater the needs of marine fisheries activities. Govt. should set up a facility or it should incentivize private entrepreneurs who are showing interest in setting up of the facility.	All coastal districts
14.	Integrated Farming System offers a gamut of activities that can be performed along with crop production for realizing the much needed additional income required by farmers for sustenance.	All Districts
15.	Fish production can be increased in village community ponds for adapting proper fishery management strategies and in newly excavated farm ponds by introducing suitable fish varieties. Shrimp cultivation may be promoted in the district by imparting awareness on shrimp culture. Accredited laboratory for fish/shrimp seed quality testing and certification may be established.	All Districts
16.	Non-availability of quality seed is a constraint for the existing hatcheries in the district especially for the fresh water prawn. Fishermen should be motivated to go for Prawn culture	Thoothukudi
17.	Establishment of fish/prawn disease diagnostic labs is very much essential. Department has to formulate and adopt regulatory measures for conservation and management of available fishery resources.	All Districts
18.	Seaweed farming can be a lucrative alternative livelihood option for coastal communities. It can also contribute to the economic growth of Tamil Nadu. Two new red algal seaweed species, which can be a potential raw material for those involved in jelly and ice cream production, have been discovered along India's coastline. 10 sites have been identified for potential seaweed production in Kanyakumari district, Thengapattinam, muttom, kovalam, Kanyakumari, etc. which has immense potential for seaweed cultivation. (NITIAYOG Study).	Kanniyakumari
19.	There is a lot of scope of Bio flock fish farming in the district. Dept.of Fishries may set a model Bio floc unit at every block to attract youth entrepreneurs	All districts
20.	Women members can be trained in value addition techniques for fish products, such as producing dried fish, fish pickles, and fish powder for soups, particularly using catfish and carps from freshwater farming.	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
21.	Setting up of Integrated Ornamental Fish Marketing Center in Madurai, which will facilitate Marketing	Madurai
X.	Construction of Storage and Market Infrastructure	
1.	Collaboration between producer cooperatives/ companies and the corporate sector are to be encouraged to promote agro-processing industry.	All Districts
	As Virudhunagar district is hub for trading of spices, oilseeds and pulses, Cold storage in each block of the district may help the farmers and traders.	Virudhunagar
2.	Awareness about Agricultural Marketing Infrastructure (AMI) and Agri Infrastructure Fund for creation of post-harvest infrastructure needs to created. Banks to step up finance in convergence with AMI and AIF schemes.	All Districts
3.	Promotion and strengthening of producers' groups to set up godowns / cold storages / primary processing facilities under AMI / GoI schemes.	Namakkal, Krishnagiri, Erode
4.	Collaboration between producer cooperatives/ companies and the corporate sector are to be encouraged to promote agro-processing industry.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
5.	In the regulated markets run by the District Market Committee, the department may install decorticators and farmers may be allowed to use it free of cost. All other facilities such as farmer's rest room, auctioning hall etc. may be provided. This will attract more farmers to the market. Identification of suitable location for creating of additional capacity and also renovation needed in existing infrastructure for better utilisation of already created capacity may be ensured.	Tiruvarur
6.	As an innovative measure, Construction of small godowns in the farmers land may be encouraged to reduce transport cost and post harvest losses. They may be trained to maintain the produce and sell the goods as and when prices of the commodity improves, thereby earn better income. This will reduce the cost of transportation of goods to godowns for storing	All Districts
7.	The existing storage facilities with various agencies including PACCS need to be accredited as per WDRA guidelines so that Negotiable Warehouse Receipt System can pick up in the district.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
8.	Farmers resort to distress sale of their produce post harvest due to various reasons like storage, transportation, perishability and liquidity problems. Availability of accredited cold storages, market yards and go downs will improve their conditions sizeably.	Thoothukudi
9.	Tanks are the main source of irrigation for small and marginal farmers needs rehabilitation. Government may consider rehabilitating the same under RIDF loan.	All districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
10.	Banks may finance rural godowns and market yards for creating infrastructure at the marketing hubs nearby the villages. Capital subsidy schemes of GoI could help the bankers to push the credit flow to this sector.	All Districts
11.	Promotion and strengthening of producers' groups to set up godowns / cold storages / primary processing facilities. Agriculture Department and the Dept. of AgriMarketing may provide necessary support to the banks in mobilizing viable projects for financing under the Govt. of India Scheme on Integrated Scheme for Agricultural Marketing Infrastructures, being implemented by DMI/NABARD and give wide publicity to attract private investments.	All Districts
12.	Develop local market hubs where farmers can directly sell their products to consumers, reducing reliance on intermediaries. Improve access roads and transportation facilities to facilitate efficient movement of goods from farms to markets.	All Districts
13.	The existing storage facilities with various agencies including PACCS needs to be accredited as per WDRA guidelines, so that Negotiable Warehouse Receipt System can pick up in the district.	All Districts
14.	Establishing drying yards and mini mills for processing minor millets in every block.	All Districts
XI.	Land Development, Soil Conservation and Watershed Development	
1.	Commercial Production of Organic Inputs viz. Biofertilizer, Vermi compost / vermi hatcheries & Compost from vegetable and fruits, etc., may be taken up by farmer aggregates like PACS, Producer Organizations, Societies etc.	All Districts
2.	Promotion of salt tolerant varieties of rice and other crops in areas affected by salinity.	Nagapattinam
3.	To increase the green cover in the district, there is an urgent need to implement watershed based projects in the district.	Tiruppur
4.	Departments may consider enhancing the margins through savings in input costs, avoiding wastage of resources, issuance of soil health cards and adopting productivity enhancement measures. Exisitng FPOs may be leveraged for this purpose	Cuddalore
5.	Banks may finance post-harvest centres and cold chain infrastructure to reduce post-harvest losses.	All Districts
6.	To increase the green cover in the district, there is an urgent need to implement watershed based projects in the district. The Corporates and Banks in the district may come forward to take up watershed projects in the district in collaboration with NABARD under the Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) arrangement.	All Districts
7.	Promotion of Integrated Pest Management (IPM) and integrated Nutrient Management (INM) practices among the farmers	All Districts
8.	Irrigation potential can be created by bringing watershed projects in these blocks. The district suffers from poor soil conditions in 'theri lands' at Radhapuram block in certain pockets due to the nearness of coast. Soil reclamation measures have to be taken up in coastal blocks of Nanguneri and Radhapuram to bring 'theri lands under cultivation.	Tirunelveli
9.	Finance land development activities on large scale and also extend finance for land reclamation activities in the areas of problem soils.	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
10.	Institutional credit support is required for development of private wastelands with horticulture and farm forestry components.	All Districts
11.	Watershed projects being implemented by NABARD in association with GoTN is expected to open up new credit opportunities for banks. Banks may therefore closely associate and familiarize themselves with the watershed development projects being implemented in different parts of the district and channelize credit.	All Districts
XII.	Agri Infrastructure - Others	
1.	The marketing linkage for quality seeds, bio pesticide and bio fertiliser need to be strengthened.	All Districts
2.	a. Promotion of bio fertilizer and pesticide units through entrepreneurs and unemployed youth. b. Department may encourage farmers in taking up certified seed production which will fetch better income and will also help in meeting the demand for seeds locally.	All Districts
3.	a. The marketing arrangements for supply of quality seeds, bio-pesticide and bio-fertilizer through the Farmers Producer Organizations (FPOs) need to be encouraged and strengthened b. There is one Bacterial culture production unit in the district and scope exists for setting up of more such units in the district as more and more farmers are adopting organic farming practices in agricultural operations.	Tiruppur
4.	Fermentation and Biotechnology • Coconut-based Probiotics: Fermentation of coconut water to produce probiotic beverages and nutraceuticals. • Enzyme-Assisted Processing: Enhances the extraction of coconut milk and oil with higher purity.	Kanyakumari
5.	Promote sustainable agricultural practices in the development of infrastructure, such as using renewable materials and energy-efficient technologies.	All Districts
XIII.	Food and Agro Processing	
1.	Mango Pulp units in the district require a Common facility centre with facility for tetra packing or plastic bottle packing. Such a common facility will benefit small traders.	Krishnagiri
2.	Activity based clusters for identified activity, e.g., value added products from paddy and pulses be developed by creating common brand, common facility centre for primary processing facility. The concept of Rural Business Hubs to be revived, wherein agro industries can tie up with farmers for production of raw materials through technology transfer and input supply as well.	All Districts
3.	Establishment of food processing training / model processing centres/ common service centres with grinding, labelling & packing facility, solar dryer or powder making units. Establishing Food Parks to promote more food processing units.	Erode, Tirupur

Sl. No.	Description	District
4.	"Improving the post-harvest infrastructure for all crops especially millets, pulses where the cultivation is sizeable and promotion of value added mini processing units in areas where market is in need.	
5.	Automation and Smart Processing technologies may be promoted such as Deshelling and Dehusking Machines, Coconut Milk Extractors, Centrifuge Technology, Cocopeat Production, neera, Virgin Coconut Oil (VCO), Coconut Sugar, Coconut Flour, Biochar from shells, fiber, based products from coconut.	Kanyakumari
6.	Agriculture Infrastructure Fund and PMFME scheme should be promoted for horticulture crops processing, targeting entire value chain.	All Districts
7.	Government can encourage setting up of small food processing zones for tomato, coconut, banana and drum stick. The district is leading producer in the medicinal plant viz Gloriosa superba. However, the farmers are dependent on intermediaries who fixes the rate. The farmers are not getting proper prices for the produce which is exported. The National Mission on medicinal plants may help the farmers in providing information on market prices for the produce	Tiruppur
8.	Establishment of Supply Chain activities for perishable Commodities to the farming community to reduce the post harvest loss in all blocks of the district.	All Districts
9.	Groundnut is ODOP of the district. Department may promote value addition like peanut butter, peanut cookies etc., through PMFME scheme.	Kancheepurm and Tiruvannamalai
10.	Capacity building programmes on simple primary processing techniques at farm level that can fetch higher returns for the farmer.	All Districts
11.	Lime Producers are unorganized which is affecting the supply chain management and not attracting any investment and technology into this sector. Raw material required to be aggregated contract farming to be encouraged and common facility centers like grading packing should be encouraged.	Tirunelveli
12.	As groundnut is the major crop in the district, value addition/oil extraction units may be established. Adequate market linkages to be forged to make bank finance viable.	Ranipet, Vellore
13.	Coconut processing, value addition units may be established, particularly in Timiri, Arcot and Walajah blocks where cultivation is being done.	Ranipet, Vellore
14.	Agri-Marketing Department may focus on utilization of the existing primary processing centers for tomato, mango and tapioca, since there is a good scope for value addition.	Dharmapuri
XIV.	Agri Anciliary – Others	
1.	Agri entrepreneurs may be encouraged to establish Agri-clinics and will help the farmers through services such as crop insurance, cropping practices, plant protection, etc. which would enhance productivity of crops/animals and	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
	ensure increased income to farmers. Also, agri-business centres can serve in providing Agri inputs, custom hiring of farm equipment, and other services.	
2.	Motivating PACS to take up all the business opportunities available in the village in order to provide a wide range of services to their members.	All Districts
3.	The state government should continue to provide seed funding, incubation support, and training programs to foster innovation. Additionally, collaboration with industry experts and academic institutions can enhance the entrepreneurial ecosystem.	All Districts
4.	Setting up mobile agri-clinics and custom hiring centers to provide on-field services to remote areas needs to be targeted. There is scope to increase the number of CHCs and include advanced technologies such as drone-based crop monitoring and precision farming tools.	All Districts
XV.	Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)	
1.	Banks have opportunity for providing loans to hitherto untapped looms, and working capital for small power loom units, etc.	Virudhunagar
2.	a. In order to give impetus to the Textile sector, a mini Textile Park could be established in Puthanatham region for creating a conducive environment to boost both domestic and international sales. The scheme for establishing a textile park was announced in 2015, but there has been very little progress b. The SIPCOT industrial park needs to be upgraded with roads and other amenities. State government had sanctioned ₹96 crores for development of the park. Trichy is part of the Defence Industrial Corridor, with the SIPCOT Park being the showpiece to attract investments. A dedicated SIPCOT office and liaison officer are required for supporting the MSMEs. There are also no large industries with ₹10 crore or more investment currently willing to set shop here. c. The Industrial estates in Thiruverumbur, and Valavandhan kottai are languishing due to non-transfer of land records, lack of internal roads and other infrastructure. The Ariyamangalam Industrial estate is lacking water and drainage facilities. The parks are also being illegally encroached. These need urgent attention. d. A branch of Food Safety and Standards Authority of India is required in Trichy to boost food processing sector.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
3.	Establishment of rural artisan complex/common work sheds/trade centre for strengthening the MSME sector and conducting exhibitions at block/taluk levels to facilitate sale of products by rural artisans and SHGs.	Nagapattinam, Ariyalur & Perambalur
4.	Identification of product-specific clusters for development of Off-farm by Government Departments / organisations. District level marketing centers may be set up to provide marketing infrastructure for Off-farm products.	Erode, Tirunelveli & Tenkasi

Sl. No.	Description	District
5.	Off-farm based producer organizations to be promoted for handloom and powerloom weavers in the district in order to improve the marketing linkages and quality standards. Handloom department may coordinate with NABARD for the promotion of POs in Sathyamangalam and Chennimalai	Erode, Vellore
6.	State Government may popularise the single window clearance to enable next generation entrepreneurs to take up business activity.	Ariyalur & Perambalur
7.	Promotion of MSME is essential to generate more employment in the district and arrest migration from the district. Rice mill, Spices & Chillies powder, Millets processing, Fish processing, Weaving, Coir based activities are the potential activities.	Ramanathapuram
8.	Bank may provide working capital to Stone sculpture workers for doubling their income prospects.	Tiruvannamalai
9.	Promote credit schemes for small and medium enterprises (SMEs) involved in agri-businesses, such as textile manufacturing from cotton, or processing of coconut products, to enhance income streams for farmers.	Tiruppur
10.	Banks may provide financial assistance at attractive rates of interest to the Textile industry. Under WCC, banks may provide credit facilities to weavers and avail the benefit of interest subvention.	All Districts
11.	Banks have opportunity for providing loans to hitherto untouched sectors in vessel manufacturing, semi automation of looms, and working capital for small power loom units, etc. Government may setup Technology Transfer Centre for providing guidance, technical knowhow etc. to the entrepreneurs around Rajapalayam/ Aruppukottai.	Virudhunagar
12.	Shipping delays and supply chain disruptions have significantly affected MSME operations in Erode, leading to increased costs and missed delivery deadlines. Initiatives to build resilient supply chains, such as offering flexible transportation solutions and leveraging technology, can help MSMEs overcome these challenges	Erode
13.	Digitalization: Encourage digital transformation among MSMEs to improve operational efficiency and access to e-commerce platforms.	Tiruppur
14.	Cluster Development: Strengthen existing industrial clusters (like textile and garment) by providing support in terms of infrastructure, technology, and skill upgradation.	Tiruppur
15.	The various training ecosystem like MSME-DI, ITIs and RSETIs should be leveraged to impart skill training and facilitate credit linkage.	coimbatore
16.	Establishment of common facility centres for handloom silk weaving, coir products and silver ornaments	Salem
17.	Vellore and Ranipet are popular for their leather industries. Financing of MSME units in leather manufacturing, processing and finished leather goods may be prioritised to establish the districts as an export hub for leather.	Vellore, Ranipet & Tirupathur
18.	Ranipet district houses traditional MSME industries viz., handloom industries in Sholinghur, Kaveripakkam and Arakkonam; agarbathi making units in Kaveripakkam. Credit support may be provided for sustenance of these traditional MSME units in the district.	Ranipet

Sl. No.	Description	District
19.	With the availability of data from several sources, including GSTN, Income Tax, Credit Bureaus, Fraud Registry, etc., it is now possible to do most of the due diligence online and appraise the MSME loan proposals expeditiously. Banks should have access to such surrogate data for speedier and robust credit underwriting standards	All Districts
20.	Banks in coordination with DIC SIPCOT, Coir Board, NGOs, SHGs Federations can provide financial support to potential areas of industrial development such as coir industries, plastic industries and fabrication machining units.	Dharmapuri
21.	Credit guarantee is an important risk mitigating tool which provides cushion to the lender for lending to MSEs. Currently, CGTMSE and NCGTC have devised credit guarantee schemes for MSE loans. Banks need to leverage the schemes to reach out the borrowers who may not be able to pledge adequate collateral, yet have a bankable business proposition.	All Districts
22.	In addition to lack of access to credit and risk capital, MSMEs perennially face delayed payments from large corporate and Government Agencies, both Central and State which adversely affects their working capital cycle/requirements and ultimately affects their operational efficiency. To overcome the delayed payments, MSMEs are participating in the Electronic bill discounting systems (such as Trade Receivables Discounting System- TReDS). Banks should participate in such bill discounting platforms to ease the pain of delayed payments. Trade Banks should also extend non-fund-based credit limits to the export oriented firms.	Madurai
XVI.	Export Credit	
23.	a. A DGFT branch has been demanded by many stakeholders in view of the increased handling of foreign currency transactions and goods, especially export of farm and agro produce especially delta region rice, processed onion etc.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
	b. CII, Trichy Zone has been emphasizing on establishment of Agricultural processing zone in the region.	
24.	Producer Organizations (Farm and off-farm sector) need to be promoted in the district specific to Bhavani carpets, Chenniamalai bedsheets and Sathyamangalam silk sarees in order to improve the export potential in the MSME sector and for linkages with related Govt. departments.	Erode
25.	Export infrastructure, particularly ports-related infrastructure, which affects trade, needs immediate attention. Port infrastructure issues include port connectivity, congestions, vessel berthing delays, poor cargo handling techniques and equipment, lack of access for containerized cargo, and frequent EDI server down or maintenance, resulting in multiple handlings, increased lead time, high transaction costs, and thus loss of market competitiveness	All Districts
26.	Erode district's MSME enterprises need support in accessing domestic and international markets. Initiatives like strengthening rural shandies, disseminating market intelligence, facilitating contract farming, and organizing buyers-sellers meetings can help improve their marketing capabilities	Erode
27.	Greater trade facilitation by removing the delays and high costs on account of procedural and documentation factors, besides infrastructure bottlenecks is another major challenge.	Nilgiris

Sl. No.	Description	District
28.	The District Export Promotion Committee of Ranipet has identified various potential products for export from the district such as leather products, pharmaceuticals, automobile components and engineering products. The district has potential for development as an export hub for these products. Adequate credit support by banks and creation of other facilities viz., infrastructure, policy & technology support, etc. would enable achievement of this goal.	Ranipet
29.	The District Export Promotion Committee of Vellore has identified various potential products for export from the district such as leather products, readymade garments, industrial chemicals, edible groundnut oil, mango pulp, dairy products, Elavambadi Spiny brinjal and Odugathur Guava. The district has potential for development as an export hub. Adequate credit support by banks and creation of other facilities viz., infrastructure, policy & technology support, etc. would enable achievement of this goal	Vellore
30.	1 There is a need to strengthen export credit facilities also make it less costly. Trade Facilitation (Documentation and Procedural Issues): Greater trade facilitation by removing the delays and high costs on account of procedural and documentation factors besides infrastructure bottlenecks is another major challenge	All Districts
31.	There are no dedicated export facilitation centers in the district making it difficult for MSMEs and agricultural producers to access the necessary knowledge resources and support for exporting their products. Setting up of export facilitation centers within the district would provide MSMEs with access to export-related information including market trends, product certifications and logistics support. These centers could also help bridge the knowledge gap regarding international trade regulations, quality standards and export financing.	Dharmapuri
XVII.	Education	
1.	DIC/TAHDCO/KVIC could organize joint campaigns with banks concerned to popularize schemes like UYEGP, NEEDS among student community, who have availed educational loans so as to make them entrepreneurs as well as pave way for recovery of education loans.	All Districts
2.	There is a need for the courses to be fine-tuned towards industry orientation to increase the employment potential of students. This will in turn reduce the growing NPAs in the sector. This is especially required for engineering colleges which have been hit due to low enrollment.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
3.	Education Loan Melas, in collaboration with the Lead Bank, can provide a practical solution to financial barriers by offering access to education loans and related financial assistance.	All Districts
4.	Banks may also give more thrust on new age courses for Industry 4.0 viz., AI, robotics, and mechatronics integrating into manufacturing and industrial processes.	All Districts
5.	There is a mismatch between the higher cost of education and the potential income levels of students after completion of education in some professional courses, which needs to be addressed. A credit guarantee scheme for educational loans will help the bankers to reduce the NPA level.	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
6.	Banks may extend adequate and timely loan to students, arrange financial literacy awareness programs in colleges through financial literacy centres on basic money management and to inculcate the habit of savings and repayment ethics among students.	All Districts
XVIII.	Housing	
1.	There is a need to address the issue of inadequate assistance for purchase of house-sites as well as streamline homestead plot provision through collaborative working of various departments.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
2.	A master plan needs to be developed for delineating housing plots not only in urban areas, but in all blocks also, to avoid indiscriminate expansion of buildings and prevent encroachment of water bodies and channels.	
3.	Green Building Norms: Encourage the adoption of green building practices and energy-efficient designs in new housing projects.	All Districts
4.	There is also a need to popularize reverse mortgage loans among senior citizens	All Districts
5.	Banks may prepare Banking Plan for providing credit support to weaker sections of people under PM Awas Yojana and Solar Powered Green House Scheme. Housing loan products may include support for installation of solar lighting, solar panels for power generation to domestic users and also solar water heaters	All Districts
6.	There is a need to address the issue of inadequate assistance for purchase of house-sites as well as streamline homestead plot provision through collaborative working of various departments.	All Districts
7.	Institutional reforms in land acquisition, approval processes and taxation are much needed to expedite development of affordable housing, which acts as a catalyst for creating a multiplier effect on job creation as well as growth in key ancillary sectors. Long-term perspective for provision of housing is critical to ensure inclusive development.	All Districts
8.	Rising land cost, spiraling construction costs, and inadequate availability and reach of finance measures are affecting the sector. Govt. may initiate necessary steps for controlling these factors.	All Districts
9.	Cost-effective and sustainable construction methods such as prefabricated buildings to reduce the cost and time of construction may be promoted	All Districts
10.	Under affordable housing, land availability, regulatory provisions, permission and approval, accessibility to housing finance are to be addressed to ensure convergence of all measures in the housing sector with the initiatives launched by the Government.	All Districts
11.	Banks to finance more housing loans in rural and semi urban areas for construction of new houses as well as renovation work of houses.	All Districts
12.	There is a huge demand for carrying out repair to houses, construction of toilets, house expansion, renovation and replacing thatched roof with concrete structure. Apart from HFCs, a few section 25 mFIs, NGOs have successfully demonstrated lending for this sector with good recovery at the ground level owing to less cumbersome procedures for availing credit. Banks could on lend through such entities	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
XIX.	Social Infrastructure	
1.	a. Tribals in Bettamugilalam Panchayat are requesting for macadam roads to reach their hamlets in the interior regions of their Panchayat. b. Macadam road may be laid in villages with undulated land in Irudhukottai Panchayat, for safe travel of farmers carrying agri produce to the market in two wheelers. c. Railway connectivity from Hosur to Krishnagiri or from Jolarpet to Krishnagiri or Morappur to Krishnagiri is required to usher in industrial development in other parts of the district also	Krishnagiri
2.	Financing for construction of toilets through PLFs of TNSRLM, who are entrusted the special task of provision of toilets for poor, may be attempted by banks as the same will pave way for bridging the gap in availability of funds with the poor people for this purpose.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur
3.	Strengthening of the cattle shandies in Kaanivadi, Kundadam and Muthur.	Tirupur
4.	Establishing Start-Up hubs in potential rural areas with necessary infrastructure like building, workshop sheds, computer labs etc., for promoting new Information Technology entrepreneurs in agriculture and allied activities.	Erode, Tirupur
5.	Promotion of Eco-tourism may be explored by upgrading the potential tourist spots in the district such as Kodiveri, Kalingarayan anaicut etc., with provisions for livelihood support for the local community on user-fee basis will create a sustainable livelihood opportunity and steady income.	Tiruvannamalai
6.	The school and hostel buildings in tribal areas of Erode District are in poor condition, with students often being accommodated in classrooms due to inadequate facilities. To address this, it is crucial to focus on the reconstruction, repair, and renovation of these government school hostels.	Erode
7.	Intervention should include the provision of necessary amenities such as well-equipped laboratories and libraries. Additionally, creating more sections in Higher Secondary Schools will help maintain an appropriate teacher-student ratio, ensuring better educational support and opportunities for tribal students.	Erode
8.	Implementing a systematic renovation program for existing schools and constructing new ones in underserved areas can significantly improve educational access and quality especially in tribal areas of Thalavadi and Burgur hills.	Erode
9.	In view of the encroachments and silt formation in water bodies, the storage capacity of the ponds and tanks in the district have depleted. This was felt by the farmers and others in recent times owing to monsoon failure. The position in the district is critical as farmers resorted to purchase of water at huge cost to irrigate and saved the coconut trees.	Tiruppur

Sl. No.	Description	District
10.	Many primary, secondary and higher secondary schools in rural areas are not having sufficient number of class rooms, lab facilities, toilet facilities, especially for girls, etc. Hence, there is potential for funding the activity.	Kancheepuram
11.	Upgrade existing primary healthcare centers and establish new ones to ensure accessible healthcare services for all communities. Deploy mobile health clinics to reach remote areas, providing essential health services and education on preventive care	Nilgiris
12.	There is a huge demand for carrying out repair to houses, construction of toilets, house expansion, renovation and replacing thatched roof with concrete structure. Apart from HFCs, a few section 25 mFIs, NGOs have successfully demonstrated lending for this sector with good recovery at the ground level owing to less cumbersome procedures for availing credit. Banks could on lend through such entities	Madurai
XX.	Renewable Energy	
1.	SPV lanterns, street lights, home lights, water pumps, power plants, standalone and grid connected, SPV power plants are some of the items of investments available for the banks to exploit.	Tiruchirappalli, Karur, Erode, Tirupur, Tiruvannamalai
2.	Financing of bio-gas could be increased by encouraging SHGs who have availed credit for purchase of milch animals, to install bio-gas plants.	Tiruvarur
3.	Wasteland under the installation of wind turbines need to be used for cultivation in order to prevent the shrinkage in cultivated area	Tenkasi
4.	Promote the installation of solar panels on rooftops and vacant lands. Given the district's high solar potential, incentivizing solar energy projects can significantly contribute to local energy needs in convergence with various Govt. schemes such as PM SuryaGhar.	All Districts
5.	Leverage agricultural waste, such as paddy husk and sugarcane bagasse, for biomass energy production. This not only provides an alternative energy source but also addresses waste management issues. FPOs in the district shall be encouraged to engage in biomass production with Govt. support to utilize the agricultural waste efficiently in the renewable energy generation.	All Districts
6.	Implement programs aimed at improving energy efficiency in local industries, especially in the textile sector. This could include upgrading machinery and adopting energy-efficient practices.	All Districts
7.	Tribal population in the hilly areas may be sensitised about the significance of solar based appliances to facilitate energy production and its applications in day to day life viz. solar lighting pumpsets for agriculture and electric vehicle in hilly areas to promote clean energy	All Districts
8.	There is need to attract investors through appropriate incentives to set up renewable source power generation/biomass/solid waste processing units in the district.	All Districts
9.	DRDA and TEDA may conduct awareness camps in various parts of the district for popularising solar energy devices.	All Districts

Sl. No.	Description	District
10.	Financing of SPV lanterns, SPV street lights, SPV home lights, SPV water pumps, SPV power plants Standalone and GRID connected, SPV power plants are some of the items of investments available for the banks to exploit. This is not only a clean / green energy but also reduces the dependence of conventional energy sources.	All Districts
11.	Steps need to be taken to improve the awareness among the rural masses about alternative sources of energy, its cost, technology transfer, after sales service, etc.	All Districts
XXI.	Informal Credit	
1.	Formation of new SHGs and JLGs in the potential Watershed areas, Tribal Development projects and FPO operational area and strive to establish convergence of schemes with SRLM, NABARD, Lead Bank and other line departments in the District.	All Districts
2.	Convergence of skilling/ upskilling schemes of various departments such as NABARD, Skill development department, SRLM, RSETI etc., to develop entrepreneurial skills of SHG members.	All Districts
3.	Banks and SHG promoting agencies to focus on micro enterprises development by SHG members	All Districts
4.	Vocational Training: Enhance sector-specific skills (e.g., tailoring, weaving, embroidery, agro-processing) to improve product quality and diversify income streams.	All Districts
5.	Cluster Development: Promote cluster-based development, especially in handloom, apparel, and dairy sectors, to increase scale and bargaining power.	All Districts
6.	Value Chain Development: Strengthen value chains in key sectors like textiles, agro-processing, and handicrafts, ensuring better income for SHG members.	All Districts
7.	Market Access and Branding: Establish stronger market linkages for SHGs/JLGs by promoting local products through fairs, exhibitions, and e-commerce platforms.	All Districts
8.	As regards the accuracy of data pertaining to SHGs it is felt that only detailed survey can give us reliable numbers. The LBR formats do not capture the JLG financing by banks though they may be reported as part of the individual sectors depending on the purpose of loan.	All Districts
9.	The Community Based Recovery Management System (CBRM) has to be strengthened in the district and Bankers need to take genuine interest in conducting meetings under this programme for early and effective recovery of loans.	All Districts
10.	Convergence of skilling/ upskilling schemes of various departments such as NABARD, Skill development department, SRLM, RSETI etc., to improve the credit flow to this sector.	All Districts

List of Abbreviations

AA	Account Aggregator	CAT	Capacity Building for Adoption of Technology
AABCS	Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme	CBBO	Cluster Based Business Organizations
ABP	Aspirational Block Programme	CBF	Capacity Building Fund
ACABC	Agri Clinic and Agri Business Centre	CBs	Commercial Banks
ACP	Annual Credit Plan	CBS	Core Banking Solution
ACRI	Agricultural college and Research Institute	CCB	Central Co-operative Banks
ADS	Area Development Scheme	CCF	Climate Change Fund
AEZ	Agri Export Zone	CD	ratio Credit-Deposit Ratio
AF	Adaptation Fund	CDF	Co-operative Development Fund
AH	Animal Husbandry	CDP	Cluster Development Programme
AHIDF	Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund	CDR	Credit Deposit Ratio
AI	Artificial Insemination	CEO	Chief executive officer
AIF	Agriculture Infrastructure Fund	CETP	Combined Effluent Treatment Plants
AIIRLIV AS	Advanced Institute for Integrated Research on Livestock and Animal Sciences	CFF	Credit Facility for Federations
AMI	Agriculture Marketing Infrastructure	CGFSEL	Credit Guarantee Fund Scheme for Education Loans
AMRUT	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation	CGFTS	Credit Guarantee Fund Trust Scheme
APCMS	Agricultural Producers Co-operative Marketing Societies	CGS	Credit Guarantee Scheme
APEDA	Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority	CGTMSE	Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises
APMC	Agricultural Produce Market Committee	CISS	Capital Investment Subsidy Scheme
APY	Atal Pension Yojana	CLR	Computerization of Land Records
ARC	Arasu Rubber Corporation Limited	CMSPGHS	Chief Minister's Solar Powered Green Housing Scheme
ASI	Annual Survey of Industries	CRAR	Capital to Risk weighted Asset Ratio
ASSOCHAM	Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India	CRZ	Coastal Regulation Zone
ATM	Automated teller machine	CSIS	Central Sector Interest Subsidy
ATMA	Agricultural Technology Management Agency	CSR	partners
B2B	Business-to-Business	CSS	Centrally Sponsored Scheme/ Central Sector Schemes
B2C	Business-to-Consumer	CWPRS	Central Water and Power Research Station
BC	Business Correspondent	DAC&FW	Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
BF	Business Facilitator	DADF	Department of Animal Husbandry Dairying and Fisheries
BLBC	Block Level Banker's Committee	DAP	Development Action Plan
BPL	Below Poverty Line	DAY	Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana
BSBDA	Basic Savings Bank Deposit Account	DBT	Direct Benefit Transfer
CAGR	Compound annual growth rate	DCC	District Consultative Committee
		DCCB	District Central Cooperative Bank
		DCP	District Credit Plan
		DDD-GKY	Deen Dayal Upadhyaya-Grameen Kaushal Yojana

DDM	District Development Manager
DFFDA	District Fish Farmers Development Agencies
DFPD	Department of Food and Public Distribution
DIDF	Dairy Processing and Infrastructure Development Fund
DLRC	District Level Review Committee
DLTC	District Level Technical Committee
DPR	Detailed Project Report
DRA	Direct Refinance Assistance to Co-operatives
DRDA	District Rural Development Agency
DTPC	District Tourism Promotion Council
EBP	Ethanol Blended Petrol
ECCS	Employees Co-operative Credit Societies
EDII	Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute
EDP	Entrepreneurship Development Programme
EEB	Eligible End Borrowers
EEZ	Exclusive Economic Zone
e-NAM	e-National Agriculture Market
e-NWR	Electronic Negotiable Warehouse Receipt
EPI	Export Preparedness Index
ETP	Effluent Treatment Plants
EV	Electric vehicles
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
FAOSTAT	Food and Agriculture Organization Statistics
FC&RI	Forest College and Research Institute
FCI	Food Corporation of India
FCO	Fertilizer (Control) Order
FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FHTC	Functional Household Tap Connection
FIDF	Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Fund
FIF	Financial Inclusion Fund
FIG	Farmer Interest Group
FIP	Financial Inclusion Plan
FIU	Financial Information User
FLC	Financial Literacy Centre
FLCC	Financial Literacy and Credit Counselling Centres
FLCCC	Financial Literacy and Credit Counselling Center

FM	Farm Mechanization
FPF	Food Processing Fund
FPO	Farmer Producers' Organization
FRP	Fair and Remunerative Price
FSPF	Farm Sector Promotion Fund
FSSAI	Food Safety and Standards Authority of India
FY	Fiscal Year
GCA	Gross Cropped Area
GCF	Green Climate Fund
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GER	Gross Enrollment Ratio
GI	Geographical Indication
GIA	Gross Irrigated Area
GIFT	Genetically Improved Farmed Tilapia
GLC	Ground Level Credit
GOBARDhan	Galvanizing Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan
GoI	Government of India
GoTN	Government of Tamil Nadu
GPS	Global Positioning System
GRAINS	Grower Online Registration of Agriculture Input System
GSDP	Gross State Domestic Product
GST	Goods and Services Tax
GSVA	Gross State Value Added
Ha.	Hectare
HDBP	High Density Block Plantation
HDPE	High Density Polyethylene
HYV	High Yielding Variety
ICAR	Indian Council of Agricultural Research
ICT	Information and Communications Technology
IFC	Infrastructure Finance Companies
IFS	Integrated Wet Land Farming System
IHDS	Integrated Horticulture Development Scheme
INM	Integrated Nutrient Management
IPDM	Integrated Pest and Disease Management
IPL	Indian Potash Limited
IRS	Indian Remote Sensing
IS	Interest Subvention
ISS	Interest Subvention Scheme
IWMS	Integrated Watershed Management Scheme

JJM	Jal Jeevan Mission	MoA&FW	Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
JLG	Joint Liability Group	MoC	Ministry of Co-operation
JLGPI	Joint Liability Promoting Institutions	MoRD	Ministry of Rural Development
KCC	Kisan Credit Card	MPCS	Multi-Purpose Co-operative Societies
KVIB/KVIC	Khadi and Village Industries Board/Commission	MRIN	Marketing Research and Information Network
KVIC	Khadi and Village Industries Commission	MSC	Multi Service Centre
KVK	Krishi Vigyan Kendra	MSCS	Multi state cooperatives
kW	kilowatt	MSME	Micro Small and Medium Enterprises
KYC	Know Your Customer	MSP	Minimum Support Price
LBR	Lead Bank Return	MT	metric tonnes
LDM	Lead District Manager	MU	Million Units
LDPFL	Low Density Plantation on Farm Lands	MW	Mega Watt
LEDP	Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programmes	NABARD	National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
LLPD	Lakh Litres Per Day	NADP	National Agricultural Development Programme
LTIF	Long Term Irrigation Fund	NAFCC	National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change
LTRCF	Long-Term Rural Credit Fund	NAFED	National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd.
LWE	Left Wing Extremism	NAM-MP	National AYUSH Mission - Medicinal Plants
MABIF	Madurai Agri Business Incubation Forum	NAS	National Accounts Statistics
MAFBIF	Mettupalayam Agroforestry Business Incubation Forum	NBFC	Non-Banking Financial Company
MCA	Mezzanine Capital Assistance	NBM	National Bamboo Mission
MCM	Million Cubic Meter	NCDC	National Cooperative Development Corporation
MCS	Marketing Co-operative Societies	NCGTC	National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Ltd
MDF	Moderately Dense Forest	NDDB	National Dairy Development Board
MEDP	Micro Enterprise Development Programme	NDQPM	Nursery Development for quality planting material
MF	Marginal Farmers	NEEDS	New Entrepreneur cum Enterprise Development Scheme
MFI	Micro Finance Institution	NEFT	National Electronic Fund Transfer
MGNREGS	Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme	NFDB	National Fisheries Development Board
MI	Minor Irrigation	NFIR	National Financial Information Registry
MICE	Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Exhibitions	NGO	Non-governmental organization
MIDH	Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture	NHB	National Housing Bank
MIF	Micro Irrigation Fund	NHB/NHM	National Horticulture Board/National Horticulture Mission
MISHTI	Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes	NHM	National Horticulture Mission
MNRE	Ministry of New and Renewable Energy	NIA	Net Irrigated Area
MNREGA	Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act	NIDA	NABARD Infrastructure Development Assistance

NIRF	National Institutional Ranking Framework	PMKSY	Prime Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana
NITI	National Institution for Transforming India.	PMKVY	Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana
NMBP	National Mission on Bovine Productivity	PM-MKSSY	Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana
NMSA	National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture	PMMSY	Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana
NPA	Non Performing Asset	PMMY	Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana
NPBB	National Programme for Bovine Breeding	PM-PRANAM	Pradhan Mantri Programme for Restoration Awareness Nourishment and Amelioration of Mother Earth
NRDWP	National Rural Drinking Water Programme	PMRY	Prime Minister's Rozgar Yojana
NRLM	National Rural Livelihood Mission	PMSBY	Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana
NRM	National Resource Management	PMU	Project Management Unit
NSA	Net Sown Area	PODF	Producer Organisation Development Fund
NSDL	National Securities Depository Limited	PODF-ID	Producers Organization Development Fund – Interest Differential
NSS	National Sample Survey	POPI	Producer Organisation Promoting Institution
NSSO	National Sample Survey Organisation	POS	Point of Sale
NWR	Negotiable Warehouse Receipt	PPC	Primary Processing Centers
OFFP	Off-Farm Promotion Fund	PPP	Public Private Partnership
OFPO	Off Farm Producers Organization	PRI	Panchayati Raj Institution
ONDC	Open Network for Digital Commerce	PRODUC E	Producers' Organization Development and Upliftment Corpus Fund
OPS	Other Priority Sector	PSL	Priority Sector Lending
P & H	Plantation & Horticulture	PVTG	Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups
PA	Participating Agencies	PWCS	Primary Weavers Cooperative Society
PACS	Primary Agricultural Cooperative Society	PWD	Public Works Department
PBP	Peripheral and Boundary Plantation	RAD	Rainfed Area Development
PCARDB	Primary Cooperative Agriculture & Rural Development Bank	RBI	Reserve Bank of India
PDMC	Per Drop More Crop	RCB	Rural Cooperative Banks
PDS	Public Distribution System	RE	Renewable Energy
PFMS	Public Finance Management System	RFA	Reserved Forest Area
PIA	Project Implementing Agencies	RFS	Revolving Fund Support
PKVY	Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana	RGM	Rashtriya Gokul Mission
PLF	Panchayat Level Federations	RIDF	Rural Infrastructure Development Fund
PMAY -G	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana Gramin	RKBY	Rashtriya Krishi Bima Yojana
PMAY -U	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana Urban	RKCC	Rupay Kisan Cards
PMC	Project Management Consultancy	RKVY	Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana
PMFBY	Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana	RNFS	Rural Non-Farm Sector
PMFME	Pradhan Mantri Scheme for Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises	ROC	Registrar of Companies
PMJDY	Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana	RPL	Recognition of Prior Learning
PMJJBY	Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana	RRB	Regional Rural Bank
		RSETI	Rural Self Employment Training Institute

RUDSET I	Rural Development & Self Employment Training Institute	TANGED CO	Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution Corporation
SAARC	South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation	TANTEA	Tamil Nadu Tea Plantation Corporation Limited
SAGL	State Agmark Grading Laboratories	TANTRA NSCO	Tamil Nadu Transmission Corporation Limited
SAMIS	Service Area Monitoring and Information System	TANUVA S	Tamil Nadu Veterinary and Animal Sciences University
SAO	Seasonal Agriculture Operation	TAWDEV A	Tamil Nadu Watershed Development Agency
SCARDB	State Cooperative Agriculture & Rural Development Bank	TCMPF	Tamil Nadu Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation
SCB	Scheduled Commercial Banks	TDF	Tribal Development Fund
SDCFPO	State Dairy Cooperative & Farmers Producers Organization	TEDA	Tamil Nadu Energy Development Agency
SDI	Skill Development Initiative	TFO	Total Fund Outlay
SDP	Skill development Program	TIIC	Tamil Nadu Industrial Investment Corporation Limited
SEPC	State Export Promotion Committee	TMCft	Thousand Million Cubic Feet
SF	Small Farmers	TN-APEX	Tamil Nadu Food Processing and Agri Export Promotion Corporation
SF/MF	Small Farmer / Marginal Farmer	TNAU	Tamil Nadu Agricultural University
SFAC	Small Farmers' Agri-Business Consortium	TNCDW	Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women
SHG	Self Help Group	TNCU	Tamil Nadu Co-operative Union
SHG-BLP	Self Help Group – Bank Linkage Programme	TNeGA	Tamil Nadu e-Governance Agency
SHPI	Self Help Group Promotion Institution	TNFDC	Tamil Nadu Fisheries Development Corporation Limited
SIDBI	Small Industries Development Bank of India	TNFU	Tamil Nadu Dr J Jayalalitha Fishery University
SIDCO	State Industrial Development Corporation	TNGMCA S	Tamil Nadu Government Mezzanine Capital Assistance Scheme
SIPCOT	State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited	TNHB	Tamil Nadu Housing Board
SLBC	State level Banker's Committee	TNIAMP	Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization Project
SMAF	Sub-mission on Agro forestry	TNPHC	Tamil Nadu Police Housing Corporation
SMAM	Sub Mission on Agricultural Mechanization	TNPL	Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Limited
SME	Small and Micro Enterprises	TNSAMB	Tamil Nadu State Agricultural Marketing Board
SMP	Skimmed Milk Powder	TNSCAR DB	Tamil Nadu State Co-operative Agricultural and Rural Development Bank
SPV	Special Purpose Vehicle	TNSCB	Tamil Nadu Slum Clearance Board
SRI	System of Rice Intensification	TNSFAC	Tamil Nadu Small Farmers Agri-business Consortium
SRLM	State Rural Livelihood Mission	TNSRLM	Tamil Nadu State Rural Livelihoods Mission
SSE	Social Stock Exchange		
StCB	State Cooperative Bank		
STT	Short Term Training		
SWC	State Warehousing Corporation		
TAFCOR N	Tamil Nadu Forest Plantation Corporation Limited		
TAMIL NILAM	Tamil Nadu Info system on Land Administration and Management		

<i>TNStCB</i>	<i>Tamil Nadu State Apex Co-operative Bank Ltd</i>
<i>TNWRCRC</i>	<i>Tamil Nadu Water Resources Conservation and Rivers Restoration Corporation</i>
<i>TRFFPC</i>	<i>Tamil Nadu Government Revolving Fund Scheme for FPCs</i>
<i>TRIFED</i>	<i>Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India</i>
<i>UATT</i>	<i>Uzhavar Aluvalar Thodarbu Thittam</i>
<i>UK</i>	<i>United Kingdom</i>
<i>UNESCO</i>	<i>United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization</i>
<i>US</i>	<i>United States</i>
<i>UYEGP</i>	<i>Unemployed Youth Employment Generation Programme</i>
<i>VDF</i>	<i>Very Dense Forest</i>
<i>VUTRC</i>	<i>Veterinary University Training And Research Centre</i>
<i>VWC</i>	<i>Village Watershed Committees</i>
<i>WBM</i>	<i>Water Bound Macadam</i>
<i>WCS</i>	<i>Weavers Co-operative Societies</i>
<i>WDF</i>	<i>Watershed Development Fund</i>
<i>WDRA</i>	<i>Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority</i>
<i>WIF</i>	<i>Warehouse Infrastructure Fund</i>
<i>WMP</i>	<i>Whole Milk Powder</i>
<i>WSHG</i>	<i>Women Self Help Group</i>

Cluster Officers and District Development Managers Tamil Nadu Regional Office

Sr. No	Cluster office	Districts covered	Name of the Officer	Mobile No.	E-mail
1	Chennai Metro	Chennai	Divya K, Manager	7358282206	chennaimetro.cluster@nabard.org
2		Chengalpattu			
3		Tiruvallur			
4		Ranipet	Shyampriya R, AGM	9489603301	
5		Vellore	M Vijay Neehar, AGM	9009305215	
6		Kancheepuram			
7		Tiruvannamalai			
8	Pondicherry	UT of Puducherry	R V Sidharthan, AGM	7299790400	pondicherry.cluster@nabard.org
9		Cuddalore	Senthilvel B, Manager	9962256223	
10		Viluppuram			
11		Kallakurichi			
12	Salem	Salem	K.K. Narmadha, Manager	6382286435	salem.cluster@nabard.org
13		Krishnagiri	S. Ramesh, AGM	9952863594	
14		Namakkal			
15		Dharmapuri	Shebha Sangeetha S, AGM	8754575865	
16		Tirupathur			
17	Tiruchirappalli	Tiruchirappalli	Mohan Karthik N M, AGM	9790235550	tiruchirappalli.cluster@nabard.org
18		Karur	Prabaharan B, AGM	9791137922	
19		Ariyalur			
20		Perambalur			
21	Pudukkottai	Pudukkottai	Deepakkumar R, Manager	8848596797	pudukkottai.cluster@nabard.org
22		Mayiladuthurai	Anish Kumar G S, AGM	9789597761	
23		Thanjavur	Viswanth Kanna S, AGM	7558129622	
24		Tiruvarur			
25		Nagapattinam			
26	Madurai	Madurai	Sakthi Balan A S, AGM	9003619210	madurai.cluster@nabard.org
27		Theni			
28		Dindigul	Harish V, AGM	9940189717	
29	Tirunelveli	Thoothukudi	Suresh Ramalingam RK, AGM	8691999873	tirunelveli.cluster@nabard.org
30		Kanniyakumari	Sashi Kumar B, AGM	8291050808	
31		Tirunelveli			
32		Tenkasi			
33	Coimbatore & Nilgiris		Thirumala Rao C , AGM	8108703105	coimbatore@nabard.org
34	Virudhnagar		Rajasureshwaran B, AGM	9994665692	virudhunagar@nabard.org
35	Sivagangai Ramanathapuram &		Arun Kumar K, AGM	9324863269	Ramanathapuram@nabard.org
36	Erode & Tirupur		Ashok Kumar T, AGM	8667329206	erode@nabard.org